

Everyday English

Grammar, Speaking and Writing Made Simple

সহজ ইংরেজি: ব্যাকরণ, কথা বলা ও লেখা

A practical self-study book for beginner to lower-intermediate learners (A1-B1)

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Introduction

Dear learner,

Welcome! If you have ever known the answer in your head but could not say it in English, this book is for you. If you have ever written an email and then worried, "Is this correct?", this book is for you too.

Most of us in Bangladesh study English for twelve years or more. We learn many rules, but we rarely **use** them. So when the moment comes – a phone call from an office, a job interview, an email to a teacher, a conversation with a foreigner – we freeze. The problem is not that you are weak in English. The problem is that nobody showed you **which** English you really need and **how** to use it.

আমরা অনেক বছর ইংরেজি পড়ি, কিন্তু ব্যবহার করি কম। এই বইটি আপনাকে দেখাবে কোন ইংরেজি সবচেয়ে বেশি দরকার, আর কীভাবে তা ব্যবহার করবেন।

What makes this book different

- **Only the most used English.** No rare rules, no long theory. Just the grammar, sentences and patterns you will use at home, at university, at the office, and in exams and interviews.
- **Simple words, short explanations.** Every rule is explained in plain words, with a short Bangla translation so you never feel lost.
- **Real life, not textbook life.** The examples come from places you know: the bazaar, a CNG ride, a WhatsApp group, a bank in Motijheel, an office in Gulshan.
- **Speak, write, practise.** Every chapter makes you *use* the English – read it aloud, write it, and test yourself.

What you will be able to do

After finishing this book, you will be able to:

1. Use the most common grammar correctly in speaking and writing.
2. Hold everyday conversations with confidence.
3. Write clear sentences, paragraphs, emails and short messages.
4. Express your thoughts and opinions in simple, correct English.
5. Answer job interview questions clearly and professionally.
6. Write well in timed English writing tests.

How the book is organised

Part	What you learn	Chapters
1. Essential Grammar	The grammar you use every day, and the mistakes to avoid	1-15
2. Daily Speaking	Ready-to-use phrases and dialogues for real situations	16-28
3. Basic Writing	Sentences, paragraphs, emails, applications and short essays	29-36
4. Job Interview English	Model answers, STAR, difficult moments and mock interviews	37-44
5. Writing Tests	Writing well under time pressure, with timed model answers	45-47
6. Practice and Reference	A 30-day plan, verb lists, a phrase bank and all answers	48-52

Mistakes are part of learning. Every mistake you notice and fix makes you stronger. Be patient with yourself, practise a little every day, and you will be surprised how far you go.

ভুল করা শেখারই অংশ। প্রতিদিন একটু একটু অনুশীলন করুন --- আপনি নিজেই অবাক হবেন।

– Aifee Aadil

How to Use This Book

Every chapter has the same 8 parts

Chapters 1–47 all follow the same pattern, so you always know what comes next:

Part	What to do with it
1. Why this matters	Read it to know <i>why</i> the chapter is useful for you.
2. The rule in plain words	Read slowly. Look at the formula and the tables.
3. Examples	Read every sentence aloud . Check the Bangla only if you are not sure.
4. Common mistakes	Cover the “Correct” column and try to fix each mistake yourself first.
5. Speak it	Read the dialogue aloud – both parts. Then change the names and details to your own life.
6. Write it	Do the task before you read the model answer. Then compare.
7. Exercises	Write your answers in a notebook, then check them in Chapter 52.
8. Quick summary	Read it again the next day. This is your revision.

A good way to study one chapter (about 45 minutes)

- 10 min** Read *Why this matters*, the rule and the examples (aloud).
- 5 min** Study the common mistakes.
- 10 min** *Speak it*: read the dialogue aloud 2–3 times. Record yourself if you can.
- 10 min** *Write it*: do the writing task, then compare with the model.
- 10 min** Do the 10 exercises and check your answers.

Tips for success

- **A little every day is better than a lot once a week.** Follow the 30-day plan in Chapter 48.
- **Always speak aloud.** Your mouth needs practice, not only your eyes.
- **Keep a mistake notebook.** Write down every mistake you make and the correct version.
- **Use English in real life.** Write your shopping list in English. Send one English WhatsApp message a day. Describe your day to yourself in English before you sleep.
- **Don’t translate word by word.** Learn whole sentences and patterns, like the ones in Chapter 28.
- **Preparing for a job?** After Parts 1–3, spend extra time on Part 4 (interviews) and Part 5 (writing tests).

Symbols used in this book



A correct sentence.



A wrong sentence – don't copy it!

Teacher's tip

A short, useful piece of advice.

Model answer

A good example answer to compare with yours.

Remember

The key points of the chapter.

(120 words)

The length of a model answer, so you know how much to write.

PART I

Essential Grammar

Chapter 1

Parts of Speech in Simple Words

1 Why this matters

Every English sentence is made of words, and every word has a **job**. Some words name things, some show action, and some describe. When you know a word's job, you know **where to put it** in a sentence. This one idea will make every other chapter in this book easier.

প্রতিটি শব্দের একটা কাজ আছে। শব্দের কাজ জানলে বাক্যে কোথায় বসাতে হবে, তা সহজে বোঝা যায়।

2 The rule in plain words

English has **8 parts of speech**. "Part of speech" simply means **the job a word does**.

Part of speech	Its job	Examples	Bangla
Noun	Names a person, place, thing or idea	Rahim, Dhaka, phone, love	বিশেষ্য
Pronoun	Takes the place of a noun	I, you, he, she, it, we, they	সর্বনাম
Verb	Shows an action or a state	eat, go, work, is, have	ক্রিয়া
Adjective	Describes a noun	big, hot, new, kind	বিশেষণ
Adverb	Describes a verb: how, when, how often	slowly, today, always, very	ক্রিয়া-বিশেষণ
Preposition	Shows place, time or direction	in, on, at, to, from, with	পদাঙ্কীয় অব্যয়
Conjunction	Joins words or ideas	and, but, or, because, so	সংযোজক অব্যয়
Interjection	Shows a sudden feeling	Wow! Oh! Oops!	আবেগসূচক অব্যয়

See them working together

Rahim_{noun} quickly_{adverb} ate_{verb} a hot_{adjective} samosa_{noun} at_{preposition} the canteen_{noun}.

- **Who?** → Rahim (noun)
- **Did what?** → ate (verb)
- **What kind of samosa?** → hot (adjective)
- **How did he eat?** → quickly (adverb)
- **Where?** → at the canteen (preposition + noun)

Three easy questions to find a word's job

1. Can you put **a, the** or **my** in front of it? (*a phone, my book*) → It's probably a **noun**.
2. Can you put **I, you** or **they** in front of it? (*I eat, they go*) → It's probably a **verb**.
3. Does it answer "**what kind?**" → **adjective**. Does it answer "**how?**" → **adverb**.

Teacher's tip: One word can do **different jobs** in different sentences. Look at what the word is *doing*, not just the word itself.

*I **work** in Dhaka.* → verb *My **work** is easy.* → noun

3 Examples

1. Nusrat lives in Chattogram.

নুসরাত চট্টগ্রামে থাকে।

Nusrat, Chattogram = nouns lives = verb in = preposition

2. She is a teacher.

সে একজন শিক্ষক।

She = pronoun (it replaces "Nusrat") is = verb

3. The tea is very hot.

চা-টী খুব গরম।

hot = adjective very = adverb (it tells us *how* hot)

4. Please speak slowly.

দয়া করে আস্তে কথা বলুন।

speak = verb slowly = adverb

5. My phone is on the table.

আমার ফোনটা টেবিলের উপর।

phone, table = nouns on = preposition

6. I like rice, but my brother likes bread.

আমি ভাত পছন্দ করি, কিন্তু আমার ভাই রুটি পছন্দ করে।

but = conjunction (it joins two ideas)

7. Wow! Your new bike looks great.

বাহ! তোমার নতুন বাইকটা দারুণ লাগছে।

Wow = interjection new, great = adjectives

8. We usually go to the bazaar on Friday.

আমরা সাধারণত শুক্রবারে বাজারে যাই।

usually = adverb to, on = prepositions

9. Tania sent me a long message.

তানিয়া আমাকে একটা লম্বা মেসেজ পাঠিয়েছে।

sent = verb me = pronoun long = adjective

10. I was tired, so I went to bed early.

আমি ক্লান্ত ছিলাম, তাই তাড়াতাড়ি ঘুমাতে গেলাম।

so = conjunction early = adverb

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
She very beautiful.	She is very beautiful.	Every English sentence needs a verb . In Bangla we can drop it (সে খুব সুন্দর), but in English we can't.
He speaks English very good.	He speaks English very well .	<i>Good</i> is an adjective. To describe <i>how</i> someone speaks, use the adverb <i>well</i> .
My sister, he is a doctor.	My sister... she is a doctor.	Bangla uses সে for everyone. English uses he for a man and she for a woman.
I bought a shirt red.	I bought a red shirt .	In English, the adjective comes before the noun.
She has two beautifuls dresses.	She has two beautiful dresses.	Adjectives never take -s. Only the noun becomes plural.

5 Speak it

Read this short conversation aloud. Two colleagues meet at the office canteen.

Karim: Hi, Rahim! You look happy today.

Rahim: I am! I finally got a new phone.

Karim: Wow! Is it fast?

Rahim: Yes, it's very fast, and the camera is amazing.

Karim: Nice. Where did you buy it?

Rahim: At a shop in Bashundhara City. It was expensive, but I love it.

Now try this: Find one noun, one verb, one adjective, one adverb and one conjunction in the dialogue.

(Example: "phone" is a noun, "bought" is a verb.)

6 Write it

Task: Write **5 sentences** about your room. Then write the job of the main words in brackets.

Model answer

1. My room is small but clean. (*room = noun, small/clean = adjectives, but = conjunction*)
2. There is a big window near my bed. (*window, bed = nouns, near = preposition*)
3. I study at a wooden desk every evening. (*study = verb, wooden = adjective*)
4. My books are on a shelf. (*books, shelf = nouns, on = preposition*)
5. I really love my room. (*I = pronoun, really = adverb, love = verb*)

7 Exercises

A. What is the job of the word in bold? (noun, pronoun, verb, adjective, adverb, preposition, conjunction, interjection)

1.1 My father **drives** a CNG.

1.2 The weather is **cold** today.

1.3 Sadia sings **beautifully**.

1.4 I will meet you **after** lunch.

1.5 **They** are my cousins from Sylhet.

1.6 Do you want tea **or** coffee?

B. Correct the mistakes

1.7 My brother very tall.

1.8 She cooks very good.

1.9 I have two news phones.

C. Make a sentence

1.10 Write one sentence about your family that uses an **adjective** and an **adverb**.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- A part of speech is simply the **job** a word does in a sentence.
- **Nouns** name things, **verbs** show action, **adjectives** describe nouns, **adverbs** describe verbs.
- Every English sentence needs a **verb**, even *is*, *am* or *are*.
- Adjectives come **before** the noun and **never** take -s.
- The same word can do different jobs, so look at what it is **doing**.

Chapter 2

Basic Sentence Structure

1 Why this matters

Bangla and English put words in a **different order**. In Bangla we say "I rice eat" (*ami bhat khai*), but in English we say "I **eat** rice". If you learn the English word order, people will understand you easily, even if your vocabulary is small.

বাংলায় ক্রিয়া বাক্যের শেষে বসে, কিন্তু ইংরেজিতে ক্রিয়া বসে কর্তার ঠিক পরে।

2 The rule in plain words

Most English sentences follow one simple pattern: **Subject + Verb + Object**.

- **Subject** = who or what does the action (*Rahim, she, my phone*). কর্তা
- **Verb** = the action or state (*eat, play, is*). ক্রিয়া
- **Object** = who or what receives the action (*rice, football, a letter*). কর্ম

Subject + Verb + Object (+ place / time)

Nusrat_{subject} drinks_{verb} tea_{object} in the morning.

Some sentences have no object. That's fine: *Tania sleeps*. *The bus stopped*. Place and time usually go at the **end**: *I meet Karim **at the office every day***.

Positive, negative and question

To make a **negative** or a **question**, we need a helper. With most verbs the helper is **do / does / did**. With **be** (am, is, are, was, were) we need no helper.

	Positive	Negative	Question
I / you / we / they	They work in Gulshan.	They do not (don't) work in Gulshan.	Do they work in Gulshan?
he / she / it	He works in Gulshan.	He does not (doesn't) work in Gulshan.	Does he work in Gulshan?
Past (everyone)	He worked in Gulshan.	He did not (didn't) work in Gulshan.	Did he work in Gulshan?
With be	She is a nurse.	She is not (isn't) a nurse.	Is she a nurse?
With be (past)	They were at home.	They were not (weren't) at home.	Were they at home?

Negative: Subject + do/does/did + **not** + verb (base form) + object

Question: Do/Does/Did + subject + verb (base form) + object?

With be: move *am/is/are/was/were* to the front for a question; add *not* after it for a negative.

Teacher's tip: After **does** and **did**, the verb goes back to its simple form. The helper already carries the -s or the past.

He **doesn't like** fish. (not likes) **Did you go?** (not went)

Teacher's tip: For *Wh-* questions, put the question word first: **Where** do you live? **What** did she buy?

3 Examples

- Adiyat reads the newspaper every morning.
আদিয়াত প্রতিদিন সকালে পত্রিকা পড়ে।
Adiyat = subject reads = verb the newspaper = object
- I don't eat beef.
আমি গরুর মাংস খাই না।
Negative: don't + eat
- Does your brother play cricket?
তোমার ভাই কি ক্রিকেট খেলে?
Question with *does*; *play*, not *plays*
- Mitu bought vegetables at the bazaar.
মিতু বাজার থেকে সবজি কিনেছে।
Past: *bought* place at the end
- We didn't watch the match last night.
আমরা গত রাতে খেলাটা দেখিনি।
Past negative: *didn't* + *watch*
- Did you call the bank?
তুমি কি ব্যাংকে ফোন করেছিলে?
Past question: *Did* + *you* + *call*
- The office is not open on Friday.
শুক্রবার অফিস খোলা থাকে না।
be sentence: *no do* needed
- Are you a student?
তুমি কি ছাত্র?
Question with *be*: *Are* comes first
- Where does Farhana work?
ফারহানা কোথায় কাজ করে?
Wh-word + *does* + subject + verb
- My father was in Sylhet last week.
আমার বাবা গত সপ্তাহে সিলেটে ছিলেন।
be (past): *was*

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I rice eat every day.	I eat rice every day.	In English the verb comes right after the subject, not at the end.
He not like tea.	He doesn't like tea.	Negatives need a helper: <i>don't / doesn't / didn't</i> .
Does she works here?	Does she work here?	After <i>does</i> , use the base verb. No -s.
You are coming?	Are you coming?	In a question, the helper comes before the subject.
Do you are busy?	Are you busy?	With <i>be</i> , don't use <i>do</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Sadia meets a new neighbour in Mirpur.

Sadia: Hi! Are you new here?

Hasan: Yes, I moved in last week. I'm Hasan.

Sadia: Nice to meet you. Do you work near here?

Hasan: No, I don't. I work in Motijheel. I take the bus every day.

Sadia: Does it take long?

Hasan: Yes, about an hour. Did you grow up in Dhaka?

Sadia: No, I didn't. I'm from Chattogram.

Now try this: Ask a friend three questions: one with *do*, one with *does* and one with *did*. Answer each with a short positive or negative answer (*Yes, I do. / No, she doesn't.*).

6 Write it

Task: Write **6 sentences** about your daily life: 2 positive, 2 negative and 2 questions you might ask a friend.

Model answer

1. I get up at 6 o'clock. (*positive*)
2. I take a rickshaw to my office. (*positive*)
3. I don't eat breakfast at home. (*negative*)
4. My boss doesn't come to the office on Saturday. (*negative*)
5. Do you cook dinner every day? (*question*)
6. Did you watch the news last night? (*question*)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with **do, does, did, is or are**

2.1 _____ you like spicy food?

2.2 Karim _____ not live in Dhaka.

2.3 _____ they at the hospital now?

2.4 _____ you go to Cox's Bazar last year?

B. Correct the mistakes

2.5 I tea drink every morning.

2.6 She not speak English.

2.7 Did he went to the bank?

2.8 Do you are tired?

C. Change the sentence

2.9 Tania works in a bank. → (negative)

2.10 They watched the match. → (question)

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- The basic English order is **Subject + Verb + Object**. The verb comes right after the subject.
- Negatives and questions use **do / does / did**, and the main verb stays in its **base form**.
- With **am / is / are / was / were**, don't use *do*: just add *not*, or move *be* to the front.
- In a question, the helper comes **before** the subject: *Do you...? Is she...?*
- Place and time words usually go at the **end** of the sentence.

Chapter 3

Present Simple and Present Continuous

1 Why this matters

You use these two tenses all day: to talk about your **routine** (*I work in Banani*) and about **what is happening now** (*I'm working from home today*). Mixing them up is one of the most common mistakes in job interviews and IELTS speaking, so let's make the difference clear.

অভ্যাস ও সত্য কথার জন্য Present Simple, আর এই মুহূর্তে যা ঘটছে তার জন্য Present Continuous।

2 The rule in plain words

Present Simple: habits, routines and facts

Subject + verb (base form) I / you / we / they **work**.
he / she / it + verb + s/es She **works**. He **watches**. It **goes**.
Negative: don't / doesn't + verb Question: Do / Does + subject + verb?

- Most verbs: add **-s** (work → works, eat → eats).
- Verbs ending in -sh, -ch, -s, -x, -o: add **-es** (wash → washes, go → goes).
- Consonant + y: change to **-ies** (study → studies). But play → plays.
- *have* → **has**.

Present Continuous: happening now, or around now

Subject + am / is / are + verb-ing
I **am** cooking. She **is** cooking. They **are** cooking.
Negative: am/is/are + **not** + verb-ing Question: **Am/Is/Are** + subject + verb-ing?

Spelling: make → making (drop -e), sit → sitting, run → running (double the last letter).

Which one? Look at the time words

Present Simple (habit / fact)	Present Continuous (now / these days)
always, usually, often, sometimes, never	now, right now, at the moment
every day, every week, on Fridays	today, this week, these days
Rahim goes to the gym every day.	Rahim is going to the gym right now.
Water boils at 100 degrees.	The water is boiling . Turn it off!
I live in Dhanmondi. (permanent)	I'm staying with my uncle these days. (temporary)

Teacher's tip: Some verbs are **not usually used in -ing** because they are feelings or thoughts, not actions: **like, love, hate, want, need, know, understand, believe, remember**. Say **I know him**, not *I am knowing him*.

3 Examples

1. My mother wakes up at 5 every morning.
আমার মা প্রতিদিন ভোর ৫টায় ঘুম থেকে ওঠেন।
Habit + every morning → Present Simple, *wakes (+s)*
2. Karim doesn't drink coffee.
করিম কফি খায় না।
Negative: *doesn't + drink*
3. Does the bus stop at Farmgate?
বাসটা কি ফার্মগেটে থামে?
Question about a routine
4. The sun rises in the east.
সূর্য পূর্ব দিকে ওঠে।
A fact → Present Simple
5. I'm talking to my boss right now. Can I call you later?
আমি এখন বসের সাথে কথা বলছি। পরে ফোন দিই?
right now → Present Continuous
6. It's raining in Sylhet today.
আজ সিলেটে বৃষ্টি হচ্ছে।
Happening today
7. Nusrat is studying for the IELTS these days.
নুসরাত আজকাল আইইএলটিএস-এর জন্য পড়াশোনা করছে।
these days → temporary situation
8. Why are you laughing?
তুমি হাসছ কেন?
Wh-question: *Why + are + you + laughing*
9. We aren't watching TV. We're eating.
আমরা টিভি দেখছি না। আমরা খাচ্ছি।
Negative: *aren't + -ing*
10. I want a cup of tea.
আমি এক কাপ চা চাই।
want is not usually used in -ing

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
She go to university every day.	She goes to university every day.	With he/she/it, add -s/-es in Present Simple.
I am going to office every day.	I go to the office every day.	<i>Every day</i> = habit → Present Simple.
He playing football now.	He is playing football now.	Present Continuous needs am/is/are + -ing.
I am understanding you.	I understand you.	<i>Understand</i> is not usually used in -ing.
Does he likes rice?	Does he like rice?	After <i>does</i> , use the base verb.

5 Speak it

Read this phone call aloud. Adiyat calls his friend Tania.

Adiyat: Hi Tania, what are you doing?

Tania: I'm sitting in a CNG. I'm going to Gulshan for a meeting.

Adiyat: Oh! Do you usually go to Gulshan on Mondays?

Tania: No, I usually work from home on Mondays. But this week is different.

Adiyat: I see. Is the traffic bad?

Tania: Yes, we're not moving at all! It always happens at this time.

Now try this: Tell a partner three things you do **every day** and three things people around you are doing **right now**.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short WhatsApp message (about 50 words) to a friend. Say what you usually do on Fridays, and what you are doing this Friday.

Model answer

Hi Mitu! On Fridays I usually stay at home. I sleep late, I help my mother in the kitchen, and in the evening I watch a movie. But this Friday is different. I'm visiting my cousin in Narayanganj. Right now I'm sitting on the bus. The roads are empty today, so we're moving fast!

(54 words)

7 Exercises

A. Put the verb in the correct form (Present Simple or Present Continuous)

3.1 My father _____ (read) the newspaper every morning.

3.2 Be quiet! The baby _____ (sleep).

3.3 Sadia _____ (not / eat) meat.

3.4 Look! It _____ (rain) again.

3.5 I _____ (know) his phone number.

B. Correct the mistakes

3.6 He work in a bank.

3.7 I am liking this song.

3.8 They watching TV now.

C. Make sentences

3.9 Write one sentence about something you do **every weekend**.

3.10 Write one sentence about something you are doing **these days**.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **Present Simple** = habits, routines and facts. Add **-s/-es** for he/she/it.
- **Present Continuous** = am/is/are + verb-ing, for now and for temporary situations.
- Time words help: *always, every day* → simple; *now, right now, these days* → continuous.
- Feeling and thinking verbs (*like, know, want*) are not usually used in -ing.

Chapter 4

Past Simple and Past Continuous

1 Why this matters

Every day we tell stories: what happened at work, how the traffic was, what we did on holiday. To tell any story in English, you need the **Past Simple** for the main events and the **Past Continuous** for the background.

অতীতের শেষ হয়ে যাওয়া কাজের জন্য Past Simple, আর অতীতে কোনো সময় চলছিল এমন কাজের জন্য Past Continuous।

2 The rule in plain words

Past Simple: finished actions

Use it for actions that started and finished in the past, often with *yesterday*, *last week*, *in 2020*, *two days ago*.

Positive: Subject + **V2** (past form) I **visited** Sylhet last month.
Negative: Subject + **did not (didn't)** + verb (base) I **didn't visit** Sylhet.
Question: **Did** + subject + verb (base)? **Did** you **visit** Sylhet?

- **Regular verbs** add **-ed**: work → worked, call → called, study → studied, stop → stopped.
- **Irregular verbs** change: go → **went**, eat → **ate**, buy → **bought**, see → **saw**, take → **took**, come → **came**.
- *be* has two past forms: I/he/she/it **was**; you/we/they **were**.

Past Continuous: an action in progress in the past

Subject + was / were + verb-ing
I/he/she/it **was** cooking. You/we/they **were** cooking.
Negative: **wasn't / weren't + -ing** Question: **Was/Were** + subject + **-ing?**

At 9 pm last night, I **was watching** the news. → The action was in the middle; it was not finished at 9 pm.

Using them together: when and while

A long background action (Past Continuous) is **interrupted** by a short action (Past Simple).

when + short action (Past Simple)	while + long action (Past Continuous)
I was cooking when the power went off .	The power went off while I was cooking .
We were sleeping when the phone rang .	The phone rang while we were sleeping .

Teacher's tip: **When** usually goes with the short action; **while** goes with the long action. Two long actions at the same time can both use the continuous: *While I **was studying**, my brother **was playing** games.*

Teacher's tip: After **did** and **didn't**, never use V2. *Did you **see**?* not *Did you saw?*

3 Examples

1. I went to Cox's Bazar last winter.
আমি গত শীতে কক্সবাজার গিয়েছিলাম।
Irregular verb: go → went
2. Rahim called me yesterday.
রহিম গতকাল আমাকে ফোন করেছিল।
Regular verb: call → called
3. She didn't come to class on Monday.
সে সোমবার ক্লাসে আসেনি।
didn't + come (base form)
4. Did you pay the electricity bill?
তুমি কি বিদ্যুৎ বিল দিয়েছ?
Question: Did + you + pay
5. We were at the hospital all night.
আমরা সারা রাত হাসপাতালে ছিলাম।
be (past): were
6. At 8 o'clock, I was having breakfast.
৮টার সময় আমি নাশতা করছিলাম।
Action in progress at a past time
7. I was cooking when the power went off.
আমি রান্না করছিলাম, তখন বিদ্যুৎ চলে গেল।
Long action interrupted by a short one
8. Mitu saw an accident while she was waiting for the bus.
মিতু বাসের জন্য অপেক্ষা করার সময় একটা দুর্ঘটনা দেখল।
while + Past Continuous
9. What were you doing at 10 last night?
গত রাত ১০টায় তুমি কী করছিলে?
Wh-question in Past Continuous
10. Mr. Chowdhury wasn't working when I arrived. He was having tea.
আমি যখন পৌঁছালাম, চৌধুরী সাহেব কাজ করছিলেন না। তিনি চা খাচ্ছিলেন।
Negative: wasn't + -ing

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I didn't went to office.	I didn't go to the office.	After <i>didn't</i> , use the base verb.
Yesterday I go to the bazaar.	Yesterday I went to the bazaar.	<i>Yesterday</i> = finished past → V2.
They was very tired.	They were very tired.	Use were with you/we/they.
I cooking when he came.	I was cooking when he came.	Past Continuous needs was/were + -ing.
When I was sleeping, the phone was ringing.	While I was sleeping, the phone rang .	The short, interrupting action uses Past Simple.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Farhana is late for work.

Boss: Farhana, you're late. What happened?
Farhana: I'm sorry, sir. I left home at 8, but the bus broke down.
Boss: Oh no! Where were you when it broke down?
Farhana: We were crossing the flyover. Everyone got off and waited.
Boss: Did you take a CNG?
Farhana: Yes. While I was looking for one, it started to rain! So it took a long time.

Now try this: Tell a partner what you were doing at **7 pm yesterday**, and one thing that happened while you were doing it.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short paragraph (60–70 words) about a day something went wrong. Use at least one *when* or *while*.

Model answer

Last Friday was a bad day. In the morning I went to the bazaar with my brother. While we were buying fish, I lost my wallet. We looked everywhere, but we didn't find it. Then, in the evening, I was cooking dinner when the power went off. We ate by candlelight. It wasn't all bad, though. My mother laughed and said it was very romantic!

(65 words)

7 Exercises

A. Put the verb in the Past Simple or Past Continuous

- 4.1** I _____ (buy) a new phone last week.
4.2 We _____ (not / see) Karim at the party.
4.3 At 6 pm, Nusrat _____ (study) in her room.
4.4 I was walking home when it _____ (start) to rain.

4.5 _____ you _____ (call) your mother yesterday?

B. Correct the mistakes

4.6 Did she bought a ticket?

4.7 The children was playing outside.

4.8 While I watched TV, my friend was calling me.

C. Make sentences

4.9 Join the ideas with **when**: *I / take a shower + someone / knock on the door.*

4.10 Write one sentence about what you did last weekend.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **Past Simple** = finished actions: V2 (*worked, went*); *didn't* + base verb; *Did...?*
- **Past Continuous** = was/were + verb-ing, for an action in progress at a past time.
- Long action (continuous) + short interrupting action (simple): *I was cooking **when** the power went off.*
- **when** + short action; **while** + long action.

Chapter 5

Future Forms

1 Why this matters

In Bangla, one future form does most of the work (*korbo*). English has **three common ways** to talk about the future, and each one sends a slightly different message. Choosing the right one makes you sound natural in meetings, on the phone, and in interviews ("What are your plans?").

ইংরেজিতে ভবিষ্যৎ বোঝাতে will, going to এবং Present Continuous ব্যবহার হয়। প্রতিটির কাজ একটু আলাদা।

2 The rule in plain words

1. will

Subject + will + verb (base) I **will** (I'll) help you.
Negative: **will not (won't)** + verb Question: **Will** + subject + verb?

Use **will** for:

- **Decisions made right now:** *The phone is ringing. I'll get it.*
- **Promises and offers:** *I won't be late, I promise. I'll carry that bag for you.*
- **Predictions** (what you think or guess): *I think Bangladesh will win today.*

2. be going to

Subject + am / is / are + going to + verb (base)
I'm **going to** apply for the job. She isn't **going to** come. **Are you going to** sell your bike?

Use **going to** for:

- **Plans** (you decided before now): *I'm going to start an IELTS course next month.*
- **Predictions with evidence** (you can see it coming): *Look at those black clouds. It's going to rain.*

3. Present Continuous for fixed arrangements

Subject + am / is / are + verb-ing + a future time
I'm **meeting** the manager at 3 pm tomorrow. We're **flying** to Sylhet on Sunday.

Use it when the plan is **fixed**: a time is set, a ticket is bought, or another person is involved.

Which one?

Situation	Use	Example
Deciding at the moment of speaking	will	"It's hot." "I'll turn on the fan."
Promise or offer	will	I'll send you the file tonight.
Opinion or guess about the future	will	I think prices will go up.
Plan decided earlier	going to	I'm going to buy a laptop this year.
You can see it will happen	going to	Slow down! You're going to hit the rickshaw!
Fixed arrangement (time, place, people)	Present Cont.	I'm seeing the doctor on Thursday.

Teacher's tip: Don't worry too much: **going to** and **Present Continuous** are often both correct for plans. The big mistake to avoid is using **will** for a plan you made earlier. "What are you doing tonight?" → *I'm going to watch a movie.* (not *I will watch*)

3 Examples

- Don't worry, I'll call you when I reach home.
চিন্তা কোরো না, বাসায় পৌঁছে তোমাকে ফোন দেব।
Promise → will
- "We have no milk." "OK, I'll buy some."
"দুধ নেই।" "ঠিক আছে, আমি কিনে আনছি।"
Decision made now → will
- I think it will be very hot this summer.
আমার মনে হয় এবার গরম খুব বেশি পড়বে।
Prediction (opinion) → will
- Will you help me with this form?
তুমি কি এই ফর্মটা পূরণ করতে আমাকে সাহায্য করবে?
Request with will
- Sadia is going to study medicine.
সাদিয়া মেডিকলে পড়বে।
Plan → going to
- We're going to move to Chattogram next year.
আমরা আগামী বছর চট্টগ্রামে চলে যাব।
Plan decided earlier
- Be careful! You're going to drop the plates!
সাবধান! প্লেটগুলো ফেলে দেবে তো!
Evidence: we can see it → going to
- I'm not going to buy a car. It's too expensive.
আমি গাড়ি কিনব না। খুব দাম।
Negative: not going to
- Hasan is meeting the client at 11 tomorrow.
হাসান কাল ১১টায় ক্লায়েন্টের সাথে দেখা করছে।

Fixed arrangement → Present Continuous

10. What are you doing on Eid day?

ঈদের দিন তুমি কী করছ?

Asking about arrangements

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I will to go to Sylhet.	I will go to Sylhet.	After <i>will</i> , use the base verb. No <i>to</i> .
She will goes tomorrow.	She will go tomorrow.	<i>Will</i> never takes -s, and neither does the verb after it.
I going to call him.	I'm going to call him.	<i>Going to</i> needs am/is/are .
I will meet my uncle tonight, we planned it last week.	I'm meeting my uncle tonight.	A fixed plan made earlier: use Present Continuous or <i>going to</i> .
I will be call you later.	I'll call you later.	Don't add <i>be</i> before a normal verb.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Two friends are chatting at university.

Nusrat: What are you doing this weekend, Adiyat?

Adiyat: I'm going to Cox's Bazar with my family. We're leaving on Thursday night.

Nusrat: Lucky you! What are you going to do there?

Adiyat: We're going to relax on the beach. I think it'll be great.

Nusrat: Look at the sky. It's going to rain here soon.

Adiyat: Oh no, I don't have an umbrella.

Nusrat: Don't worry. I'll share mine.

Now try this: Tell a partner one **plan** for next month (*going to*), one **fixed arrangement** for this week (Present Continuous) and one **prediction** about your city (*will*).

6 Write it

Task: An interviewer asks: "What are your plans for the next five years?" Write a short answer (60–70 words). Use *going to* and *will*.

Model answer

In the next five years, I'm going to improve my skills and grow in my career. First, I'm going to finish my MBA. I'm also going to take an IELTS course, because good English is important at work. I hope I will lead a small team one day. I believe this company will give me the right experience, and I will work hard to do my best.

(67 words)

7 Exercises

A. Choose the best form: will, going to, or Present Continuous

- 5.1 "I'm thirsty." "Wait, I _____ (get) you some water."
5.2 Look at that man! He _____ (fall) off the ladder!
5.3 I _____ (meet) Dr. Rahman at 4 pm tomorrow. It's booked.
5.4 I promise I _____ (not / tell) anyone.
5.5 Tania has decided. She _____ (learn) to drive this year.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 5.6 He will comes to the party.
5.7 We going to visit our grandparents.
5.8 I will to send the email tomorrow.

C. Make sentences

- 5.9 Write one **prediction** about Dhaka in 2035, using *will*.
5.10 Write one **plan** for your next holiday, using *going to*.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary**Remember**

- **will** + base verb: decisions made now, promises, offers and opinions about the future.
- **am/is/are going to** + base verb: plans made earlier, and predictions you can see coming.
- **Present Continuous** + future time: fixed arrangements (*I'm meeting him at 3*).
- Never say *will to go* or *will goes*. After *will*, just use the base verb.

Chapter 6

Present Perfect

1 Why this matters

We use the Present Perfect all the time to share news (*I've just finished*), talk about life experience (*Have you ever been to Sylhet?*) and say how long (*I've worked here for two years*). You will hear it in job interviews, in IELTS Speaking and in office emails every day.

খবর দিতে, অভিজ্ঞতা বলতে আর “কতদিন ধরে” বোঝাতে Present Perfect লাগে।

2 The rule in plain words

The Present Perfect connects the **past** with **now**. Something happened before, and it matters now.

Subject + have / has + V3 (past participle)

I / you / we / they → **have** he / she / it → **has**

আমি খেয়েছি = I have eaten সে চলে গেছে = She has gone

Positive	Negative	Question
I have (I've) finished.	I haven't finished.	Have you finished?
She has (She's) left.	She hasn't left.	Has she left?

V3 is the third form of the verb: *work* → *worked*, *eat* → *eaten*, *go* → *gone*, *see* → *seen*, *do* → *done*, *write* → *written*, *buy* → *bought*.

Three common uses

Use	Key words	Example
1. Life experience	ever, never, before	Have you ever eaten pitha? I've never been to Cox's Bazar.
2. Recent news	just, already, yet	I've just reached office. She's already paid. Has he called yet ?
3. Unfinished time (started in the past, still true now)	for, since	I've lived in Mirpur for five years / since 2020.

- **for** + a length of time: *for two hours, for a week, for ten years*
- **since** + a starting point: *since Monday, since 9 o'clock, since 2019*
- **just** and **already** go between *have* and V3. **yet** goes at the end, in questions and negatives.

Present Perfect or Past Simple?

No time given / time not finished → Present Perfect: *I **have lost** my wallet.*

Finished past time (yesterday, last week, in 2020, ago) → Past Simple: *I **lost** my wallet **yesterday**.*

Teacher's tip: If you say **when** it happened (*yesterday, last year, two days ago*), use the **Past Simple**. Never say "*I have seen him yesterday.*"

Teacher's tip: In Bangla we say আমি পাঁচ বছর ধরে ঢাকায় থাকি, but in English the present simple is wrong here. Say *I **have lived** in Dhaka for five years.*

3 Examples

- Have you ever been to Sylhet?
তুমি কি কখনো সিলেটে গিয়েছ?
Experience *ever* is used in questions
- I've never ridden a bike.
আমি কখনো বাইক চালাইনি।
Experience *never* = not ever
- Nusrat has just sent the file.
নুসরাত এইমাত্র ফাইলটা পাঠিয়েছে।
Recent news *just* = a moment ago
- We've already eaten lunch.
আমরা ইতিমধ্যে দুপুরের খাবার খেয়ে ফেলেছি।
already = sooner than expected
- Has the bus come yet?
বাস কি এখনো এসেছে?
yet at the end of a question
- I haven't paid the electricity bill yet.
আমি এখনো বিদ্যুৎ বিল দিইনি।
yet at the end of a negative
- Karim has worked at this bank for six years.
করিম ছয় বছর ধরে এই ব্যাংকে কাজ করছে।
Unfinished time *for* + length of time
- I've known Sadia since 2018.
আমি ২০১৮ সাল থেকে সাদিয়াকে চিনি।
since + starting point
- Oh no! I've lost my phone.
হায়! আমি আমার ফোন হারিয়ে ফেলেছি।
No time given, result now: I don't have it
- I lost my phone last night.
আমি গতকাল রাতে আমার ফোন হারিয়েছি।
Finished time (*last night*) → Past Simple

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I have seen him yesterday.	I saw him yesterday.	A finished time (<i>yesterday</i>) needs the Past Simple.
I live in Dhaka since 2015.	I have lived in Dhaka since 2015.	Started in the past and still true → Present Perfect.
She has went home.	She has gone home.	After <i>have/has</i> , use V3 (<i>gone</i>), not V2 (<i>went</i>).
He have finished his work.	He has finished his work.	<i>he / she / it</i> → has .
I have worked here since five years.	I have worked here for five years.	<i>five years</i> is a length of time, so use for .

5 Speak it

Read this job interview aloud. Mr. Chowdhury is talking to Adiyat.

Mr. Chowdhury: How long have you worked in sales?

Adiyat: I've worked in sales for four years, since 2022.

Mr. Chowdhury: Have you ever managed a team?

Adiyat: Yes, I have. Last year I managed a team of five people in Chattogram.

Mr. Chowdhury: Good. Have you read our job description?

Adiyat: Yes, I've already read it, and I've just checked your website too.

Now try this: Answer aloud: *How long have you lived in your home? Have you ever been to Cox's Bazar?*

6 Write it

Task: Write a short WhatsApp message (40–60 words) to a friend with your news. Use *just*, *already*, *yet* and *for* or *since*.

Model answer

Hi Mitu! Big news: I've just got a new job at a bank in Gulshan! I've already signed the contract, but I haven't told my parents yet. I want to surprise them tonight. I've waited for this job for almost a year, so I'm really happy. Have you finished your exams yet? Let's meet soon!

(55 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with the Present Perfect of the verb in brackets

6.1 Tania _____ (finish) her report.

6.2 _____ you ever _____ (eat) hilsa curry?

6.3 We _____ (not / see) the new film yet.

B. Write *for* or *since*

6.4 I have lived here _____ 2019.

6.5 She has been sick _____ three days.

C. Present Perfect or Past Simple? Choose the correct form

6.6 I (have visited / visited) Sylhet last month.

6.7 Look! Someone (has broken / broke) the window.

D. Correct the mistakes

6.8 He has wrote three emails today.

6.9 I know Hasan since 2010.

E. Make a sentence

6.10 Write one sentence about something you have **never** done.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary**Remember**

- Form: **have / has + V3**. Use **has** with he, she, it.
- Use it for **experience** (ever, never), **recent news** (just, already, yet) and **unfinished time** (for, since).
- **for** + length of time; **since** + starting point.
- If you say **when** (yesterday, last week, ago), use the **Past Simple**.

Chapter 7

Articles: A, An and The

1 Why this matters

A, an and the are among the most common words in English. Bangla has no exact match for them, so many learners drop them or use the wrong one. Getting them right makes your English sound natural at once, in speaking, emails and exams.

বাংলায় a/an/the এর ঠিক মিল নেই, তাই এগুলো ঠিকভাবে শিখলে ইংরেজি অনেক স্বাভাবিক শোনায়।

2 The rule in plain words

Articles are small words that come before a noun. They tell us if the noun is **any one** or a **known, specific** one.

a / an = any one (not specific) একটা / একজন
the = the one we both know ওই / নির্দিষ্টটা (টা, টি)

1. Use a / an with ONE countable thing

- **First mention:** *I bought **a** shirt.* (the listener doesn't know which shirt yet)
- **Jobs:** *She is **a** doctor. He is **an** engineer.*
- **One:** *I need **a** pen. Wait **a** minute. Twice **a** day.*

2. A or an? Listen to the first SOUND, not the letter

a + consonant sound	an + vowel sound (a, e, i, o, u)
a book, a car, a teacher	an apple, an egg, an office, an umbrella
a u niversity, a u niform (sounds like "you")	an h our, an h onest man (the <i>h</i> is silent)
a o ne-taka coin (sounds like "won")	an M BA, an S MS (sounds like "em", "es")

3. Use the when we know which one

- **Second mention:** *I bought a shirt. **The** shirt is blue.*
- **Specific:** ***The** tea in this shop is great. Please close **the** door.*
- **Only one exists:** ***the** sun, **the** moon, **the** sky, **the** internet*
- **Some places:** ***the** Padma, **the** Bay of Bengal, **the** USA, **the** UK*

4. No article

When	Example
Plurals and uncountables in general	<i>Cats are cute. Rice is cheap here. I love music.</i>
Meals	<i>I had breakfast at 8. Let's have lunch.</i>
Languages and subjects	<i>She speaks English. I study maths.</i>
Most countries and cities	<i>Bangladesh, India, Dhaka, Sylhet</i>
go to school / work / bed / university	<i>I go to work by bus. It's late, go to bed.</i>

Teacher's tip: Translate টা / টি in your head. বইটা দাও = Give me **the** book. একটা বই দাও = Give me **a** book.

3 Examples

1. My brother is an engineer.
আমার ভাই একজন প্রকৌশলী।
Job → a/an *engineer* starts with a vowel sound
2. I waited for an hour at the bus stop.
আমি বাস স্টপে এক ঘণ্টা অপেক্ষা করেছি।
hour: silent h → an
3. Sadia studies at a university in Dhaka.
সাদিয়া ঢাকার একটা বিশ্ববিদ্যালয়ে পড়ে।
university sounds like "you" → a
4. I saw a rickshaw. The rickshaw was very colourful.
আমি একটা রিকশা দেখলাম। রিকশাটা খুব রঙিন ছিল।
First mention → a Second mention → the
5. Can you turn off the fan, please?
ফ্যানটা একটু বন্ধ করবে?
We both know which fan
6. The sun is very hot today.
আজ রোদ খুব কড়া।
Only one sun → the
7. Rahim goes to work by CNG.
রহিম সিএনজিতে করে কাজে যায়।
go to work → no article
8. We usually have dinner at 10.
আমরা সাধারণত রাত দশটায় রাতের খাবার খাই।
Meals → no article
9. Farhana speaks English and Hindi.
ফারহানা ইংরেজি আর হিন্দি বলতে পারে।
Languages → no article
10. Mangoes are sweet in summer.

গ্রীষ্মকালে আম মিষ্টি হয়।

Plural in general → no article

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
She is teacher.	She is a teacher.	Jobs need <i>a/an</i> in English, even though Bangla has none.
I'll be back in a hour.	I'll be back in an hour.	The <i>h</i> is silent, so it starts with a vowel sound.
He studies at an university.	He studies at a university.	<i>University</i> starts with a "you" sound.
I go to the school every day.	I go to school every day.	<i>go to school / work / bed</i> → no article.
The life in Dhaka is busy.	Life in Dhaka is busy.	General ideas and uncountables take no article.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Tania is at a phone shop in Dhanmondi.

Tania: Excuse me, I'm looking for a phone cover.

Shopkeeper: We have a red one and a black one.

Tania: Can I see the red one, please?

Shopkeeper: Sure. It's an original cover from the company.

Tania: How much is it?

Shopkeeper: Five hundred taka. It comes with a one-year warranty.

Now try this: Say three things in your room with *a* or *an*, then say one more thing about each with *the*. (Example: *There is a fan. The fan is old.*)

6 Write it

Task: Write 5-6 sentences about your morning. Underline every *a*, *an* and *the*.

Model answer

I wake up at 6 and drink a cup of tea. Then I have breakfast with my family. At 8, I take a bus to work. The bus is always full, so I stand for an hour. I work in an office in Motijheel. The office is on the fifth floor.

(51 words)

7 Exercises

A. Write a or an

7.1 _____ umbrella

7.2 _____ uniform

7.3 _____ honest man

B. Fill in the blanks with *a, an, the* or - (no article)

7.4 I saw _____ cat in the garden. _____ cat was white.

7.5 _____ moon looks beautiful tonight.

7.6 My father goes to _____ work at 9.

7.7 Do you speak _____ French?

C. Correct the mistakes

7.8 My sister is nurse.

7.9 We had the lunch at a restaurant in Gulshan.

D. Make a sentence

7.10 Write two sentences about something you bought: use *a* in the first and *the* in the second.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **a / an** = one, any one: first mention, jobs, *a minute*.
- Choose *a* or *an* by the first **sound**: *an hour, a university*.
- **the** = we know which one: second mention, specific things, only one (*the sun*).
- **No article** with general plurals and uncountables, meals, languages, most countries and cities, and *go to school / work / bed*.

Chapter 8

Nouns: Singular, Plural, Countable and Uncountable

1 Why this matters

Every time you shop at the bazaar, order food or ask for help, you use nouns with numbers and amounts: *two kilos of rice, a few eggs, some advice*. If you know which nouns you can count and which you can't, you will stop making the most common noun mistakes.

কোন বিশেষ্য গণনা যায় আর কোনটা যায় না, তা জানলে much/many, a/some ঠিকভাবে ব্যবহার করা যায়।

2 The rule in plain words

A **noun** is a word for a person, place or thing. **Singular** = one. **Plural** = more than one.

1. Making plurals

Rule	Examples
Most nouns: add -s	book → books, phone → phones, day → days
Ends in -s, -sh, -ch, -x, -o: add -es	bus → buses, dish → dishes, watch → watches, box → boxes, potato → potatoes
Consonant + y: y → -ies	city → cities, baby → babies, party → parties
Ends in -f / -fe: → -ves	knife → knives, wife → wives, leaf → leaves
Irregular (learn by heart)	man → men , woman → women , child → children , person → people , foot → feet , tooth → teeth

2. Countable and uncountable

Countable (you can say 1, 2, 3)	Uncountable (you can't count them)
Have a plural: <i>an egg, two eggs</i> egg, chair, taka, bottle, job, friend	No plural, no a/an: <i>water, rice</i> water, rice, money, information, advice, furniture, news, milk, sugar, traffic
<i>The chairs are new.</i>	<i>The furniture is new. (singular verb)</i>

Teacher's tip: Money is uncountable, but *taka* is countable: *I don't have much **money**. I have fifty **taka**.* And *news* looks plural but is singular: *The news **is** good.*

3. How much? How many?

	Countable (plural)	Uncountable
<i>much / many</i> (questions, negatives)	How many eggs? Not many .	How much rice? Not much .
Small number / amount	a few friends	a little sugar
Large number / amount	a lot of people	a lot of traffic
<i>some</i> (positive)	some apples	some milk
<i>any</i> (questions, negatives)	Do you have any pens?	I don't have any money.

4. Counting uncountables: use a unit

a / two + unit + of + uncountable noun

a **cup** of tea a **glass** of water a **kilo** of rice a **bottle** of oil
a **piece** of advice a **piece** of information a **piece** of furniture two **packets** of biscuits

Teacher's tip: In positive sentences, *a lot of* sounds more natural than *much*: say *I drink a lot of* tea, not *I drink much* tea.

3 Examples

- There are three buses on this route.
এই রুটে তিনটা বাস চলে।
bus → *buses* (-es)
- Many people live in Dhaka.
ঢাকায় অনেক মানুষ থাকে।
people is the plural of *person*
- Mitu has two children.
মিতুর দুটি সন্তান আছে।
child → *children*
- Can I have a glass of water, please?
আমাকে এক গ্লাস পানি দেবেন?
water is uncountable → use a unit
- How much is a kilo of rice?
এক কেজি চালের দাম কত?
How much for price and uncountables
- How many eggs do you need?
তোমার কয়টা ডিম লাগবে?
eggs are countable → *How many*
- Let me give you a piece of advice.
তোমাকে একটা পরামর্শ দিই।
Not an advice
- I need some information about the course.
কোর্সটা সম্পর্কে আমার কিছু তথ্য দরকার।
Not informations

9. There is a lot of traffic in Gulshan today.

আজ গুলশানে অনেক জ্যাম।

traffic is uncountable → is

10. Add a little salt and a few green chillies.

একটু লবণ আর কয়েকটা কাঁচামরিচ দাও।

a little + uncountable, a few + plural

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
He gave me many advices.	He gave me a lot of advice .	<i>Advice</i> is uncountable: no -s, no <i>many</i> .
I bought new furnitures.	I bought new furniture .	<i>Furniture</i> has no plural.
Two childs are playing.	Two children are playing.	<i>Child</i> has an irregular plural.
How much people came?	How many people came?	<i>People</i> is countable (plural) → <i>many</i> .
The news are bad.	The news is bad.	<i>News</i> is uncountable, so it takes a singular verb.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Hasan is buying groceries at a shop in Mirpur.

Hasan: Bhai, I need two kilos of rice and a bottle of oil.

Shopkeeper: Sure. Anything else?

Hasan: Yes, a dozen eggs and a little sugar, please.

Shopkeeper: How much sugar do you want?

Hasan: Half a kilo. And do you have any biscuits?

Shopkeeper: Yes, we have a lot of biscuits. How many packets?

Hasan: Just two, thanks. How much is everything?

Now try this: Make your own shopping list aloud with five items. Use *a kilo of*, *a few*, *a little* and *some*.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short message (40–60 words) to a family member about what to buy for a dinner party. Use countable and uncountable nouns correctly.

Model answer

Apa, can you buy a few things on your way home? We need two kilos of chicken, a kilo of onions and some potatoes. We also need a little ginger and a bottle of soft drink. We have a lot of rice, so don't buy any. Ten people are coming, so please buy enough sweets too. Thanks!

(57 words)

7 Exercises

A. Write the plural

8.1 city → _____

8.2 watch → _____

8.3 man → _____

B. Choose the correct word

8.4 How (much / many) money do you have?

8.5 There are only (a few / a little) students in the class today.

8.6 Can I have (a / some) information about the flight?

8.7 I'd like a (piece / cup) of tea, please.

C. Correct the mistakes

8.8 My mother gave me a good advice.

8.9 The furnitures in this room are very old.

D. Make a sentence

8.10 Write one sentence about your kitchen using *a lot of* and *a few*.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Plurals: add **-s**, **-es** or **-ies**; learn *men, women, children, people*.
- **Uncountable** nouns (*water, rice, money, information, advice, furniture, news*) have no plural and no *a/an*.
- **many / a few** + plural countables; **much / a little** + uncountables; **a lot of, some, any** + both.
- To count an uncountable, use a unit: *a cup of tea, a piece of advice*.

Chapter 9

Pronouns and Possessives

1 Why this matters

Pronouns like *I*, *me*, *my* and *mine* are in almost every sentence you say. They save you from repeating names again and again. Mixing up *he* and *she*, or *me* and *my*, is one of the first things listeners notice, so let's fix it once and for all.

সর্বনাম বারবার নাম বলা থেকে বাঁচায়। he/she আর me/my ঠিকভাবে বললে ইংরেজি অনেক পরিষ্কার শোনায়।

2 The rule in plain words

A **pronoun** takes the place of a noun: *Nusrat is late. **She** is in traffic.* English has four main forms. Learn this table well.

Subject (does the action)	Object (receives the action)	Possessive adjective (+ noun)	Possessive pronoun (alone)	Reflexive
I	me	my	mine	myself
you	you	your	yours	yourself
he	him	his	his	himself
she	her	her	hers	herself
it	it	its	-	itself
we	us	our	ours	ourselves
they	them	their	theirs	themselves
আমি	আমাকে	আমার (বই)	আমার (টা)	নিজে

Subject before the verb: **She** called.

Object after the verb or a preposition: I called **her**. Come with **me**.

Possessive adjective + noun: This is **my** bag.

Possessive pronoun with no noun after it: This bag is **mine**.

He or she? The সে problem

Bangla uses সে / তিনি for both men and women. English does not.

- A man or boy → **he / him / his**: Karim is my boss. **He** is kind.
- A woman or girl → **she / her / hers**: Farhana is my boss. **She** is kind.

It and they for things

- One thing or animal → **it**: I bought a new phone. **It** is fast.

- More than one (people or things) → **they / them**: *Where are my keys? I can't find **them**.*
- **its** (no apostrophe) = belonging to it. **it's** = it is.

Possessive 's and s'

Rule	Example
One person / irregular plural + 's	Rahim 's car, my sister 's room, the children 's toys
Plural ending in -s + '	my parents s' house, the students s' exam

Teacher's tip: Before you say *he* or *she*, think for one second: **man or woman?** Saying it slowly a few times builds the habit fast.

Teacher's tip: Use **myself, yourself** etc. when the subject and object are the same person: *I cut **myself**. She made it **herself**.* Don't say "Myself Rahim"; say "I'm Rahim."

3 Examples

1. My sister is a nurse. She works in a hospital.
আমার বোন একজন নার্স। সে একটা হাসপাতালে কাজ করে।
A woman → she
2. Mr. Chowdhury is our manager. He is very strict.
চৌধুরী সাহেব আমাদের ম্যানেজার। তিনি খুব কড়া।
A man → he
3. Please call me after lunch.
দুপুরের খাবারের পর আমাকে ফোন দিও।
Object after the verb → me
4. Is this your umbrella? No, it isn't mine.
এটা কি তোমার ছাতা? না, এটা আমার না।
your + noun mine alone
5. Tania lost her phone, but she found it later.
তানিয়া তার ফোন হারিয়ে ফেলেছিল, কিন্তু পরে খুঁজে পেয়েছে।
her phone it for a thing
6. Adiyat and I are friends. We study together.
আদিয়াত আর আমি বন্ধু। আমরা একসাথে পড়ি।
Subject → Adiyat and I, we
7. These shoes are nice. Where did you buy them?
জুতাগুলো সুন্দর। কোথা থেকে কিনেছ?
Plural thing → them
8. This is Sadia's laptop.
এটা সাদিয়ার ল্যাপটপ।
One person → 's
9. The students' results are out.
ছাত্রছাত্রীদের ফলাফল বের হয়েছে।
Plural ending in -s → s'

10. The cat is cleaning its paws.

বিড়ালটা তার থাৰা পৰিষ্কাৰ কৰছে।

its = belonging to it (no apostrophe)**4 Common mistakes**

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
My mother is a teacher. He teaches maths.	My mother is a teacher. She teaches maths.	A woman → <i>she</i> . Bangla সে is for both.
Me and Rahim went to Sylhet.	Rahim and I went to Sylhet.	Use the subject form <i>I</i> before the verb.
This is my brother book.	This is my brother's book.	Show belonging with 's .
This pen is my.	This pen is mine .	No noun after it → possessive pronoun.
The company changed it's logo.	The company changed its logo.	<i>it's</i> = it is; <i>its</i> = belonging to it.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Nusrat and Hasan are at a family wedding.

Nusrat: Who is that man in the blue panjabi?**Hasan:** That's my uncle. He lives in Chattogram with his family.**Nusrat:** And the woman next to him?**Hasan:** She's his wife, my aunt. Their son is the groom!**Nusrat:** Oh, nice! Is that your car outside?**Hasan:** No, it isn't mine. It's my cousin's. Ours is at home.**Now try this:** Point to three people in a family photo and say who they are. Use *he/she, his/her* and one *'s*.**6 Write it****Task:** Write 6–7 sentences about two family members, one man and one woman. Use *he, she, his, her* and *'s* correctly.**Model answer**

My father's name is Abdul Karim. He works at a bank in Motijheel. His office is near our house. My mother's name is Rokeya. She is a school teacher. Her students love her because she is very kind. They have been married for thirty years.

(45 words)

7 Exercises**A. Choose the correct word****9.1** Farhana is my cousin. (He / She) lives in Sylhet.

9.2 Can you help (I / me) with this form?

9.3 Is this (your / yours) bag?

9.4 This phone isn't (my / mine).

9.5 I bought a new watch, but (it / they) stopped working.

B. Add 's or ' in the right place

9.6 This is Karim car.

9.7 My parents house is in Dhanmondi.

C. Correct the mistakes

9.8 Me and my friend went to the cinema.

9.9 My grandmother is 80, and he is still very active.

D. Make a sentence

9.10 Write one sentence about a friend's phone using *his* or *her* and *it*.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **Subject** (I, she) before the verb; **object** (me, her) after the verb or a preposition.
- **my, your, his** + noun; **mine, yours, his** alone.
- Man → **he / him / his**; woman → **she / her / hers**. Things → **it / they**.
- Show belonging with **'s** (Rahim's car) or **s'** for plurals in -s (my parents' house).
- **its** = belonging to it; **it's** = it is.

Chapter 10

Prepositions of Time, Place and Movement

1 Why this matters

Small words like **in**, **on** and **at** appear in almost every sentence: *at 9 am, on Friday, in Dhaka*. A wrong preposition rarely stops people from understanding you, but it makes your English sound unnatural. Learn a few simple charts and you will get them right most of the time.

in, on, at প্রায় প্রতিটি বাক্যে লাগে। কয়েকটি সহজ চার্ট মনে রাখলেই বেশিরভাগ সময় সঠিক হবে।

2 The rule in plain words

A **preposition** is a small word before a noun that shows **time**, **place** or **direction**. Think of a pyramid: **in** is for big things, **on** for medium things, **at** for small, exact points.

1. Time: in, on, at

Word	Use it for	Examples
in	Months, years, seasons, long periods, parts of the day	in June, in 2025, in winter, in the morning, in the evening
on	Days and dates	on Monday, on 5 May, on Friday night, on my birthday, on Eid day
at	Exact clock times and a few fixed phrases	at 7 pm, at 10:30, at night, at noon, at the weekend

Teacher's tip: Say **in** the morning, **in** the afternoon, **in** the evening, but **at** night. And use **no preposition** before *today, tomorrow, yesterday, next week, last month, every day: I'll call you tomorrow* (not *on tomorrow*).

2. Place: in, on, at

Word	Use it for	Examples
in	Inside an area or a closed space; cities and countries	in Dhaka, in Bangladesh, in the room, in my bag, in a car, in a CNG
on	On a surface; big public transport	on the table, on the floor, on the wall, on the bus, on a train, on the second floor
at	A point or a place where we do something	at the office, at the station, at the door, at home, at university, at the bus stop

3. Movement: where are you going?

Word	Meaning	Example
to	Towards a place (destination)	I go to work by bus.
from	Starting point	She came from Sylhet.
into	Moving from outside to inside	He walked into the room.
out of	Moving from inside to outside	Get out of the rickshaw.
through	In one side and out the other	The train goes through a tunnel.

from Mirpur → **to** Gulshan walk **into** the bank come **out of** the bank

4. Two more useful words: for and with

- **for** + a length of time: *I lived in Chattogram **for** three years.*
- **for** + a purpose or a person: *This gift is **for** you. We went out **for** lunch.*
- **with** = together: *I live **with** my parents.*
- **with** = using a tool: *Cut it **with** a knife. He paid **with** bKash.*

Teacher's tip: We say **go home** and **come home**, with no *to*. But we say *go **to** school, go **to** the office.*

3 Examples

1. My exam starts at 10 am on Sunday.
আমার পরীক্ষা রবিবার সকাল ১০টায় শুরু।
at + clock time on + day
2. Nusrat was born in 2003.
নুসরাত ২০০৩ সালে জন্মেছে।
in + year
3. It's very cold in January.
জানুয়ারিতে খুব ঠান্ডা পড়ে।
in + month
4. I usually read the news in the morning.
আমি সাধারণত সকালে খবর পড়ি।
in the morning, but at night
5. Your keys are on the table.
তোমার চাবিগুলো টেবিলের উপর।
on + surface
6. Karim is at the office right now.
করিম এখন অফিসে আছে।
at + place where we do something
7. Mitu lives in Dhanmondi with her aunt.
মিতু ধানমন্ডিতে তার খালার সাথে থাকে।
in + area with = together

8. I met Adiyat on the bus to Cox's Bazar.

কক্সবাজারের বাসে আদিয়াতের সাথে দেখা হয়েছিল।

on the bus to = destination

9. The cat ran out of the kitchen and into the garden.

বিড়ালটা রান্নাঘর থেকে বেরিয়ে বাগানে ঢুকে গেল।

out of = leaving into = entering

10. We waited at the station for two hours.

আমরা স্টেশনে দুই ঘণ্টা অপেক্ষা করেছিলাম।

for + length of time

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I will see you in Monday.	I will see you on Monday.	Days take on .
The meeting is in 3 pm.	The meeting is at 3 pm.	Clock times take at .
I am going to home.	I am going home .	No <i>to</i> before <i>home</i> .
He entered into the room.	He entered the room. / He went into the room.	<i>Enter</i> needs no preposition. Bangla ঢুকল makes us add one.
I am living here since 2020.	I have lived here since 2020. / I have lived here for five years.	for + length of time; since + starting point.

5 Speak it

Read this phone call aloud. Sadia is planning to meet her friend Farhana.

Sadia: Hi Farhana! Are you free on Friday?**Farhana:** Yes, but only in the afternoon. I'm at my cousin's house in the morning.**Sadia:** No problem. Let's meet at 4 pm at Jamuna Future Park.**Farhana:** Great. I'll come from Uttara by bus. Where exactly?**Sadia:** At the main gate. Then we can go into the food court for snacks.**Farhana:** Perfect. I'll bring the book for you, too!

Now try this: Tell a partner your weekly plan. Use **on** + a day, **at** + a time, and **in** or **at** + a place.
(Example: "On Saturday at 6 pm, I go to the gym in Mirpur.")

6 Write it

Task: Write a short WhatsApp message (40–60 words) inviting a friend to a meeting or party. Say the day, time and place, and how to get there.

Model answer

Hi Hasan! I'm having a small birthday party on Saturday, 12 July, at 7 pm. It's at my flat in Mirpur 10, on the fourth floor. Take a rickshaw from the metro station to the City Bank building. My house is next to it. Please come with Tania. See you there!

(51 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with **in**, **on** or **at**

- 10.1** My flight leaves _____ 6:15 am.
10.2 We have a holiday _____ 16 December.
10.3 Rahim works _____ a bank _____ Motijheel.
10.4 There is a calendar _____ the wall.

B. Choose the right word: **to**, **from**, **into**, **out of**, **through**, **for**, **with**

- 10.5** The bus goes _____ Dhaka _____ Sylhet every hour.
10.6 She took her phone _____ her bag.
10.7 I studied _____ three hours last night.

C. Correct the mistakes

- 10.8** I will call you on tomorrow.
10.9 My sister is in home now.

D. Make a sentence

- 10.10** Write one sentence about your daily routine using **at**, **in** and **with**.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Time: **in** June / 2025 / the morning; **on** Monday / 5 May; **at** 7 pm / night.
- Place: **in** Dhaka / the room; **on** the table / the bus; **at** the office / the door.
- Movement: **to** (destination), **from** (start), **into**, **out of**, **through**.
- **for** = how long or purpose; **with** = together or using.
- No preposition before *home*, *today*, *tomorrow*, *next week*.

Chapter 11

Adjectives and Adverbs

1 Why this matters

Adjectives and adverbs add **colour** to your English. They help you describe people, food, prices and jobs, and compare things: *This phone is **cheaper**. She works **hard**.* You need them at the bazaar, in interviews and in IELTS Speaking.

বিশেষণ ও ক্রিয়া-বিশেষণ দিয়ে আমরা কোনো কিছু বর্ণনা ও তুলনা করি। বাজারে, ইন্টারভিউতে, সব জায়গায় এগুলো লাগে।

2 The rule in plain words

An **adjective** describes a **noun** (a **new** phone). An **adverb** describes a **verb**: it tells us **how** something happens (drive **carefully**).

1. Where do adjectives go?

- **Before a noun:** a **big** house, **hot** tea, a **kind** teacher
- **After be, look, feel, seem, taste:** The tea is **hot**. You look **tired**. This biryani tastes **great**.

2. -ed or -ing?

Ending	Meaning	Examples
-ed	How a person feels	I am bored . She is interested in music. We were tired .
-ing	The thing that causes the feeling	The film is boring . Cricket is interesting . The journey was tiring .

3. Making adverbs

Rule	Examples
Most adjectives: add -ly	slow → slowly, quick → quickly, careful → carefully
Ending in -y: change to -ily	easy → easily, happy → happily
Special: good → well	She is a good singer. She sings well .
Same word	fast → fast, hard → hard, early → early, late → late

Teacher's tip: *Hardly* does **not** mean "hard". It means "almost not": *I **hardly** slept* = I slept very little. So say *Karim works **hard***, not *works hardly*.

4. very, really, too, enough

- **very / really** make a word stronger: *It's **very** hot today. The food is **really** good.*
- **too** = more than you want (a problem): *This shirt is **too** expensive. I can't buy it.*
- **enough** = the right amount. It comes **after** an adjective: *He is old **enough** to drive.*

5. Comparing: comparatives and superlatives

Adjective type	Comparative (two things)	Superlative (the top one)
Short (1 syllable): cheap, tall	cheaper, taller	the cheapest, the tallest
Short, ends in vowel + consonant: big, hot	bigger, hotter	the biggest, the hottest
Ends in -y: busy, easy	busier, easier	the busiest, the easiest
Long (2+ syllables): expensive	more expensive	the most expensive
Irregular: good, bad, far	better, worse, farther	the best, the worst, the farthest

Comparative + **than**: *Dhaka is bigger **than** Sylhet.*
as + adjective + as (equal): *My phone is **as** good **as** yours.* **not as ... as** (less): *Rajshahi is **not as** busy **as** Dhaka.*

3 Examples

1. Tania bought a beautiful red sari.
তানিয়া একটা সুন্দর লাল শাড়ি কিনেছে।
adjectives before the noun
2. You look tired today.
আজ তোমাকে ক্লান্ত দেখাচ্ছে।
adjective after *look*
3. I was bored in the meeting. It was so boring!
মিটিংয়ে আমার বিরক্ত লাগছিল। মিটিংটা খুবই একঘেয়ে ছিল!
bored = my feeling boring = the meeting
4. Please drive slowly. The road is wet.
দয়া করে আস্তে চালান। রাস্তা ভেজা।
slow → slowly
5. Adiyat speaks English very well.
আদিয়াত খুব ভালো ইংরেজি বলে।
good → well
6. This bag is too heavy for me.
এই ব্যাগটা আমার জন্য খুব বেশি ভারী।
too = a problem
7. Is the room big enough for ten people?
ঘরটা কি দশজনের জন্য যথেষ্ট বড়?
enough after the adjective
8. A CNG is faster than a rickshaw.

রিকশার চেয়ে সিএনজি দ্রুত।
comparative + than

9. This is the most expensive shop in Gulshan.

এটা গুলশানের সবচেয়ে দামি দোকান।
the most + long adjective

10. Today's traffic is worse than yesterday's.

আজকের যানজট গতকালের চেয়ে খারাপ।
bad → worse → the worst

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I am very boring in class.	I am very bored in class.	Your feeling = -ed . <i>I am boring</i> means you make others bored!
She is more taller than me.	She is taller than me.	Use -er or more , never both.
This is the most best hotel.	This is the best hotel.	<i>Best</i> is already a superlative.
He works very hardly.	He works very hard .	<i>Hard</i> is already an adverb. <i>Hardly</i> means "almost not".
The tea is too much hot.	The tea is too hot. / The tea is very hot.	Put too directly before the adjective. Bangla খুব বেশি makes us add <i>much</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Hasan is buying a phone at a shop in Bashundhara City.

Hasan: Excuse me, which phone is better, this one or that one?

Seller: This one is newer and faster, but it's more expensive.

Hasan: How much is it?

Seller: Thirty-two thousand taka. That one is twenty-five thousand.

Hasan: Hmm, that's too expensive for me. Is the cheaper one good enough for photos?

Seller: Yes, its camera is almost as good as the new one. It's our most popular model.

Hasan: Great. I'll take the cheaper one, then.

Now try this: Compare two places you know (for example, Dhaka and your village). Say three sentences with **-er than**, **more ... than** and **as ... as**.

6 Write it

Task: Write 50–70 words comparing two ways to travel in your city (for example, bus and metro rail). Use comparatives, a superlative and at least one adverb.

Model answer

In Dhaka, I can go to work by bus or by metro rail. The bus is cheaper, but it is much slower because of the traffic. It is also very crowded and noisy. The metro is more expensive, but it is cleaner, safer and more comfortable. It runs smoothly and arrives on time. For me, the metro is the best way to travel in Dhaka.

(65 words)

7 Exercises

A. Choose the correct word

11.1 The film was very (bored / boring).

11.2 Mitu sings (beautiful / beautifully).

11.3 He did (good / well) in his exam.

B. Write the comparative or superlative

11.4 Chattogram is _____ (big) than Sylhet.

11.5 This is _____ (good) restaurant in Dhanmondi.

11.6 English is _____ (easy) than I thought.

11.7 Gold is _____ (expensive) than silver.

C. Correct the mistakes

11.8 My brother is more younger than me.

11.9 I am not enough old to drive.

D. Make a sentence

11.10 Use **as ... as** to compare two people in your family.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Adjectives go **before a noun** or **after be/look/feel**. They never take -s.
- **-ed** = how you feel (bored); **-ing** = what causes it (boring).
- Adverbs: usually **-ly**; but good → **well**, and **fast, hard** stay the same.
- **too** = a problem; **enough** comes after the adjective.
- Short words: **-er / -est**; long words: **more / the most**; good → better → best, bad → worse → worst.

Chapter 12

Modal Verbs

1 Why this matters

Modal verbs like **can**, **could**, **should** and **would** help you ask politely, give advice, talk about ability and explain rules. “*Could you help me?*” sounds much more polite than “*Help me.*” In the office, at the bank or in an interview, these small words make a big difference.

can, could, should, would দিয়ে আমরা ভদ্রভাবে অনুরোধ করি, পরামর্শ দিই, সামর্থ্য ও নিয়মের কথা বলি।

2 The rule in plain words

A **modal verb** is a helping verb that adds a meaning like **ability**, **permission**, **advice** or **need** to the main verb.

Subject + modal + base verb She **can swim**. You **should rest**.

No **to** after the modal No **-s** on the modal No **-s/-ed** on the main verb

- **Negative:** add **not**: *can't (cannot), couldn't, shouldn't, mustn't, won't*
- **Question:** put the modal first: **Can** you drive? **Should** I call him?

The main modals and their uses

Modal	Use	Example
can	Ability now; informal request or permission	I can speak three languages. Can I sit here?
could	Ability in the past; polite request	I could swim at age six. Could you open the door?
may	Formal permission; possibility (maybe)	May I come in? It may rain today.
should	Advice; the right thing to do	You should see a doctor.
must	Strong rule or strong need (from the speaker)	You must wear a helmet. I must finish this today.
have to	Rule or need from outside (job, law)	I have to be at the office at 9.
would	Polite offer or request	Would you like some tea? I'd (would) like a coffee, please.

Teacher's tip: **have to** is not a pure modal, so it changes with the subject: He **has to** work on Saturday. We **had to** wait. And watch the negatives: You **mustn't** smoke here = it is not allowed. You **don't have to** come = it is not necessary.

Polite levels: asking for something

Polite level	Example	Use it with
Direct (can be rude)	Give me the file.	Avoid this
Friendly	Can you give me the file?	Friends, family, colleagues
Polite	Could you give me the file, please?	Boss, shopkeeper, strangers
Very polite	Would you mind giving me the file? / May I have the file, please?	Formal office, interviews, customers

Teacher's tip: To ask for something, *I would like...* (I'd like) is softer than *I want...* Say "I'd like a cup of tea, please" at a restaurant, not "I want tea."

3 Examples

1. Sadia can play the guitar.
সাদিয়া গিটার বাজাতে পারে।
can = ability (no -s on can, no -s on play)
2. Could you lower your voice, please?
দয়া করে একটু আস্তে কথা বলবেন?
could = polite request
3. May I use your phone?
আমি কি আপনার ফোনটা ব্যবহার করতে পারি?
may = formal permission
4. It may rain this afternoon.
আজ বিকেলে বৃষ্টি হতে পারে।
may = possibility
5. You should drink more water.
তোমার আরও পানি খাওয়া উচিত।
should = advice
6. Students must wear an ID card on campus.
ক্যাম্পাসে ছাত্রছাত্রীদের অবশ্যই আইডি কার্ড পরতে হবে।
must = strong rule
7. Rahim has to work on Saturdays.
রহিমকে শনিবারেও কাজ করতে হয়।
has to = need from outside (his job)
8. Would you like some more rice?
আপনি কি আরেকটু ভাত নেবেন?
would like = polite offer
9. I'd like to open a bank account.
আমি একটা ব্যাংক অ্যাকাউন্ট খুলতে চাই।
I'd like = polite way to say I want
10. I couldn't sleep last night because of the noise.
গতকাল রাতে শব্দের কারণে ঘুমাতে পারিনি।
couldn't = past ability (negative)

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I can to speak English.	I can speak English.	No to after a modal.
She cans drive.	She can drive.	A modal never takes -s .
He should goes home.	He should go home.	After a modal, use the base verb .
You must to submit the form.	You must submit the form.	No to after <i>must</i> . (But <i>have to</i> needs to .)
Can you give me a pen? (to your boss)	Could you give me a pen, please?	With seniors, <i>could</i> + <i>please</i> sounds more polite.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Nusrat visits a bank in Dhanmondi.

Officer: Good morning. How can I help you?
Nusrat: Good morning. I'd like to open a savings account.
Officer: Sure. Could you show me your NID card, please?
Nusrat: Here it is. Do I have to bring photos?
Officer: Yes, you must give two passport-size photos. You should also add a nominee.
Nusrat: May I fill in the form here?
Officer: Of course. Would you like a pen?
Nusrat: Yes, please. Thank you!

Now try this: Your friend has a headache before an exam. Give three pieces of advice with **should** and one with **shouldn't**.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short, polite email (40–60 words) to your manager asking for one day's leave. Use at least two modal verbs.

Model answer

Dear Mr. Chowdhury,
 I would like to request one day's leave on Thursday, 14 August. I have to take my mother to the hospital for a check-up. I can finish my report on Wednesday, and Karim could handle urgent calls. Could you please approve my leave?
 Thank you.
 Farhana Akter

(50 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with **can**, **could**, **may**, **should**, **must** or **would**

12.1 You look sick. You _____ go home and rest.

12.2 _____ you like a cup of tea, sir?

12.3 When I was young, I _____ climb trees very fast.

12.4 Drivers _____ stop at a red light. It's the law.

B. Correct the mistakes

12.5 She can sings very well.

12.6 We should to leave now.

12.7 He musts pay the bill today.

C. Make it more polite

12.8 Give me a glass of water.

12.9 I want the bill.

D. Make a sentence

12.10 Write one sentence about a rule at your office or university using **have to** or **must**.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Formula: **subject + modal + base verb**. No *to*, no *-s*.
- **can/could** = ability and requests; **may** = permission or "maybe".
- **should** = advice; **must/have to** = rules and strong need.
- **mustn't** = not allowed; **don't have to** = not necessary.
- For politeness use **Could you...?**, **Would you like...?** and **I'd like...**

Chapter 13

Making Questions and Negatives

1 Why this matters

Every conversation needs questions: *Where do you live? How much is this? When does the bus leave?* In Bangla we often make a question just by changing our voice. In English, we must **change the word order**. Learn one simple formula and you can ask almost anything. বাংলায় শুধু সুর বদলে প্রশ্ন করা যায়, কিন্তু ইংরেজিতে শব্দের ক্রম বদলাতে হয়। একটি সূত্র শিখলেই প্রায় সব প্রশ্ন করা যাবে।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Yes/No questions

Move the **helping verb** (be, do, can, will...) to the front. If there is no helping verb, add **do / does / did**.

Statement	Question
She is a nurse.	Is she a nurse?
You can drive.	Can you drive?
They will come.	Will they come?
You live in Sylhet.	Do you live in Sylhet?
He works at a bank.	Does he work at a bank? (works → work)
Mitu called you.	Did Mitu call you? (called → call)

Teacher's tip: After **does** and **did**, the main verb goes back to its **base form**. The -s or -ed moves to the helper: *Does he **work**?* (not works) *Did you **go**?* (not went).

2. Wh-questions

Wh-word + helping verb + subject + main verb ...?
Where do you live? What is she doing? When did they arrive?

Wh-word	Asks about	Example
What	a thing or action	What do you do? (= What is your job?)
Where	a place	Where is the bus stop?
When	a time	When does the office open?
Who	a person	Who is your manager?
Why	a reason	Why are you late?
How	the way, condition	How do you go to work? How are you?
Which	a choice	Which colour do you want, red or blue?
How much	price, uncountable amount	How much is this sari? How much rice do we need?
How many	countable number	How many brothers do you have?
How long	length of time	How long does it take to reach Gulshan?
How often	frequency	How often do you visit your village?

3. Subject questions: no do/does/did

When **who** or **what** is the **subject** (the person doing the action), keep normal word order.

- **Who called** you? (Somebody called you. Who?) not *Who did call* you?
- **What happened?** not *What did happen?*
- Compare: *Who **did** you call?* (You called somebody. Who?)

4. Negatives

Positive	Negative
I like fish. / She likes fish.	I don't like fish. / She doesn't like fish.
We went out.	We didn't go out.
He is at home. / They are busy.	He isn't at home. / They aren't busy.
I can swim. / I will come.	I can't swim. / I won't (will not) come.

5. Question tags: *isn't it?* *don't you?*

A question tag is a mini-question at the end, used to check something. Simple rule: **positive sentence** → **negative tag**; negative sentence → positive tag. Use the same helping verb.

- *It's hot today, **isn't it?*** *You live in Mirpur, **don't you?***
- *She can't come, **can she?*** *They didn't call, **did they?***

6. Polite indirect questions

To sound more polite, start with **Could you tell me...?** or **Do you know...?** Then use **normal word order** (subject + verb).

- *Where is the bank?* → *Could you tell me where **the bank is?***
- *What time does the train leave?* → *Do you know what time **the train leaves?***

3 Examples

1. Do you speak English?
আপনি কি ইংরেজি বলেন?
Do + subject + base verb
2. Does your brother work in Chattogram?
তোমার ভাই কি চট্টগ্রামে চাকরি করে?
Does + he/she + base verb
3. Where did you buy this bag?
তুমি এই ব্যাগটা কোথা থেকে কিনেছ?
Wh + did + subject + base verb
4. How much does a CNG cost to Motijheel?
মতিঝিল পর্যন্ত সিএনজিতে কত টাকা লাগে?
how much = price
5. How often do you go to the gym?
তুমি কত ঘন ঘন জিমে যাও?
how often = frequency
6. Who broke the glass?
গ্লাসটা কে ভেঙেছে?
subject question: no *did*
7. I didn't see your message.
আমি তোমার মেসেজটা দেখিনি।
didn't + base verb
8. Tania doesn't eat beef.
তানিয়া গরুর মাংস খায় না।
doesn't + base verb
9. You're from Sylhet, aren't you?
তুমি সিলেটের, তাই না?
positive sentence → negative tag
10. Could you tell me where the toilet is?
টয়লেটটা কোথায়, একটু বলতে পারবেন?
polite question: normal word order

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
You are coming?	Are you coming?	In English, change the word order. Don't just raise your voice.
Where you live?	Where do you live?	Wh-questions need a helping verb.
Does she works here?	Does she work here?	After <i>does</i> , use the base verb.
I not understand.	I don't understand.	Negatives need <i>don't/doesn't/didn't</i> . Bangla না goes at the end, so we forget the helper.
Can you tell me where is the station?	Can you tell me where the station is ?	In indirect questions, use normal word order.

5 Speak it

Read this job interview aloud. Mr. Chowdhury is interviewing Adiyat.

Mr. Chowdhury: Where do you live, Adiyat?

Adiyat: I live in Mohammadpur, sir.

Mr. Chowdhury: How long does it take to get here?

Adiyat: About forty minutes by bus.

Mr. Chowdhury: Did you work anywhere before?

Adiyat: Yes, I worked at a software company for two years.

Mr. Chowdhury: Why did you leave?

Adiyat: I wanted more challenges. Could you tell me what the working hours are?

Mr. Chowdhury: Nine to five. You don't have any problem with Saturdays, do you?

Adiyat: No, sir. That's fine.

Now try this: You meet a new classmate. Ask five questions using **where**, **what**, **how long**, **how often** and one **do/does** question.

6 Write it

Task: You want to join an English course. Write a short message (40–60 words) to the course office with at least four questions.

Model answer

Hello, I saw your English course on Facebook. Could you tell me when the next batch starts? How long is the course, and how many classes are there each week? Do you have evening classes? Also, how much is the fee, and can I pay with bKash? Thank you.

Sadia

(50 words)

7 Exercises

A. Make questions

13.1 She lives in Khulna. → _____ in Khulna?

13.2 They went to Cox's Bazar. (Where) → _____?

13.3 Someone opened the window. (Who) → _____?

B. Make these sentences negative

13.4 Karim drinks coffee.

13.5 We watched the match last night.

C. Add a question tag

13.6 It's a nice day, _____?

13.7 You can swim, _____?

D. Correct the mistakes

13.8 What time you wake up?

13.9 Could you tell me where is the post office?

E. Make a sentence

13.10 Write one question with **how much** and one with **how many** that you could ask at a bazaar.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Yes/No questions: put the helping verb first; if none, use **do/does/did** + base verb.
- Wh-questions: **Wh-word + helping verb + subject + verb.**
- Subject questions (*Who called you?*) need **no** do/does/did.
- Negatives: **don't/doesn't/didn't** + base verb; **isn't, can't, won't.**
- Tags: positive sentence → negative tag. Polite questions: *Could you tell me where **it is**?*

Chapter 14

Linking Words

1 Why this matters

Short sentences are fine, but too many of them sound like a robot: *I was hungry. I ate rice. I slept.* **Linking words** join your ideas and show how they connect. They make your speaking smooth and your writing clear. In IELTS and job tests, examiners look for them.

লিংকিং ওয়ার্ড দিয়ে আমরা বাক্য ও ধারণাগুলো জোড়া লাগাই। এতে কথা ও লেখা সুন্দর এবং পরিষ্কার হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

A **linking word** is a word that joins two ideas and shows their relationship: adding, contrasting, giving a reason, showing a result, giving an example, or showing order.

Purpose	Linking words	Example	Bangla
Add	and, also	I like tea, and I also like coffee.	এবং, ও
Contrast	but, however, although	The room is small, but it is clean.	কিন্তু, যদিও
Choice	or	Do you want tea or coffee?	অথবা
Reason	because	I was late because it rained.	কারণ
Result	so	It rained, so I was late.	তাই
Example	for example	I like fruit, for example , mango.	যেমন
Order	first, then, after that, finally	First I wash, then I eat.	প্রথমে, তারপর

1. And, but, or: the three simple joiners

- **and** adds a similar idea: *Rahim is kind **and** helpful.*
- **but** shows a surprise or opposite idea: *The bus was full, **but** I got a seat.*
- **or** gives a choice: *We can take a CNG **or** a rickshaw.*

Put a **comma before but** when it joins two full sentences. With short lists and *and*, you often need no comma.

2. Because vs so: watch the direction

Result + because + reason I stayed home because I was sick.	=	Reason + , so + result I was sick, so I stayed home.
--	---	---

Because introduces the *reason* (কারণ). **So** introduces the *result* (তাই). Never use both in one sentence.

3. However and although: two ways to show contrast

- **However** usually starts a **new sentence** and takes a **comma** after it:
*The flat is nice. **However**, the rent is too high.*
- **Although** is followed by a **full clause** (subject + verb). It can go at the start or in the middle:
***Although** it was raining, we went out. We went out **although** it was raining.*

4. For example, also, and order words

- **For example** gives an example; put commas around it: *Some cities are crowded, **for example**, Dhaka.*
- **Also** goes **before** the main verb but **after** *is/am/are*: *I **also** work. She is **also** a nurse.*
- **First, then, after that, finally** put steps or stories in order. Use a comma after *First, After that* and *Finally*.

Teacher's tip: Bangla speakers often write "Although..., but..." because we say যদিও...তবুও.... In English, use **only one**: **Although** *it was hot, we played.* or *It was hot, **but** we played.*

3 Examples

1. Nusrat works in Gulshan, and her husband works in Mirpur.

নুসরাত গুলশানে কাজ করে, আর তার স্বামী মিরপুরে কাজ করে।

and = adds information

2. The shirt is nice, but it is too expensive.

শার্টটা সুন্দর, কিন্তু খুব দামি।

but = contrast; comma before it

3. Do you want to pay in cash or by bKash?

আপনি নগদে দেবেন, না বিকাশে?

or = choice

4. I missed the bus because I woke up late.

আমি বাস মিস করেছি কারণ ঘুম থেকে উঠেছি।

because + reason

5. The road was blocked, so we took a rickshaw.

রাস্তা বন্ধ ছিল, তাই আমরা রিকশা নিলাম।

so + result

6. The job is good. However, the office is far from my home.

চাকরিটা ভালো। তবে অফিসটা আমার বাসা থেকে অনেক দূরে।

However, at the start of a new sentence

7. Although Karim was tired, he finished the report.

যদিও করিম ক্লান্ত ছিল, সে রিপোর্টটা শেষ করেছে।

Although + clause; no "but"

8. You can eat local fruit, for example, guava or jackfruit.

তুমি দেশি ফল খেতে পারো, যেমন পেয়ারা বা কাঁঠাল।

for example, with commas

9. Sadia speaks English. She also speaks a little Hindi.

সাদিয়া ইংরেজি বলে। সে একটু হিন্দিও বলে।

also before the main verb

10. First, fill in the form. Then pay the fee. Finally, collect your card.

প্রথমে ফর্মটা পূরণ করুন। তারপর ফি দিন। শেষে কার্ডটা নিন।

order words for steps

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Although it was late, but he came.	Although it was late, he came.	Use one contrast word only: <i>although</i> or <i>but</i> , not both.
Because I was sick, so I stayed home.	Because I was sick, I stayed home.	<i>Because</i> and <i>so</i> together say the same thing twice. Choose one.
I was hungry so I ate because.	I was hungry, so I ate.	<i>Because</i> needs a reason after it. It cannot end a sentence.
However the price is high.	However , the price is high.	Put a comma after <i>However</i> at the start of a sentence.
I also am a student.	I am also a student.	<i>Also</i> comes after <i>am/is/are</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Two friends are talking on the phone.

Mitu: Hi Hasan! Are you coming to Cox's Bazar with us on Friday?

Hasan: I want to, but I have an exam on Sunday.

Mitu: Oh no. Can you study on the bus? It's a long journey.

Hasan: Maybe. However, I get sick on buses, so I can't read.

Mitu: Although it's a short trip, it will be fun. We can go to the beach and eat fresh fish.

Hasan: OK, I'll ask my parents first. Then I'll call you back.

Now try this: Tell a friend about your plans for the weekend. Use **and**, **but**, **because** and **so** at least once.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short paragraph (60–80 words) about **your daily journey to work or university**. Use at least five different linking words.

Model answer

I live in Mirpur, **but** I study at a university in Dhanmondi. **First**, I take a rickshaw to the main road. **Then** I get on a bus. The bus is cheap. **However**, it is always crowded, **so** I often stand for an hour. Sometimes I take a CNG **because** it is faster. **Although** the journey is tiring, I use the time well. **For example**, I listen to English podcasts. **Finally**, I reach my class at nine.

(76 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with *and, but, or, because, so*

- 14.1** I called Tania, _____ she didn't answer.
14.2 Would you like rice _____ roti?
14.3 The shop was closed, _____ we went home.
14.4 Adiyat is absent today _____ he has a fever.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 14.5** Although the food was cheap, but it was tasty.
14.6 Because it was raining, so we stayed inside.
14.7 The hotel was clean. However the staff were rude.
14.8 I also am from Sylhet.

C. Join the sentences

- 14.9** Join with **although**: *He is rich. He lives in a small flat.*
14.10 Write two sentences about your phone. Use **because** in one and **so** in the other.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary**Remember**

- **and** adds, **but** contrasts, **or** gives a choice.
- **because** + reason; **, so** + result. Never use both in one sentence.
- **However**, starts a new sentence and takes a comma.
- **Although** + subject + verb, and **never** with *but*.
- Use **for example** for examples and **first, then, after that, finally** for steps.

Chapter 15

The 25 Most Common Grammar Mistakes

1 Why this matters

Most Bangla speakers make the **same small mistakes** again and again, because we translate directly from Bangla. The good news: if you fix just these 25, your English will sound **much more correct** in interviews, emails and everyday talk. This chapter is your personal checklist.

আমরা বাংলা থেকে সরাসরি অনুবাদ করি বলে একই ভুল বারবার করি। এই ২৫টি ভুল ঠিক করলেই আপনার ইংরেজি অনেক শুদ্ধ শোনাবে।

2 The rule in plain words

Here are the 25 mistakes, grouped into four families. Read the **Wrong** column, cover it, then say the **Correct** sentence aloud. The **Quick fix** gives the rule in a few words.

A. Verbs and tenses

#	✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Quick fix
1	She very busy.	She is very busy.	Every sentence needs a verb. Add <i>am/is/are</i> . <i>is/am/are</i> বাদ দেবেন না।
2	He work in a bank.	He works in a bank.	He/she/it + verb- s . he/she/it হলে verb-এ s।
3	Did you went there?	Did you go there?	After <i>did</i> , use the base verb. <i>did</i> -এর পরে verb-এর মূল রূপ।
4	I am agree with you.	I agree with you.	<i>Agree</i> is a verb; no <i>am</i> . <i>agree</i> নিজেই verb।
5	I have seen him yesterday.	I saw him yesterday.	Finished time (<i>yesterday, last week, in 2020</i>) → past simple. নির্দিষ্ট অতীত সময় হলে past simple।
6	I am living here from 2020 / since 3 years.	I have been living here since 2020 / for 3 years.	From past to now → <i>have been</i> + <i>-ing</i> . since + start point, for + length of time. <i>since</i> = কবে থেকে, <i>for</i> = কতদিন ধরে।
7	I can able to drive.	I can drive. / I am able to drive.	Use <i>can</i> or <i>be able to</i> , not both. <i>can</i> আর <i>able to</i> একসাথে নয়।

B. Nouns, pronouns and articles

#	✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Quick fix
8	My mother, he is a teacher.	My mother... she is a teacher.	Man = <i>he</i> , woman = <i>she</i> . সে মানে he বা she।
9	He is my cousin brother.	He is my cousin .	<i>Cousin</i> means both male and female. cousin-এর সাথে brother/sister লাগে না।
10	There were much people.	There were many people.	<i>many</i> + countable, <i>much</i> + uncountable. গোনায় যায় → <i>many</i> ।
11	I need some informations about furnitures.	I need some information about furniture .	These words never take -s: <i>information, furniture, advice, news, luggage</i> . এগুলোর বহুবচন হয় না।
12	One of my friend lives in Sylhet.	One of my friends lives in Sylhet.	<i>One of</i> + plural noun. <i>one of</i> -এর পরে বহুবচন।
13	She is engineer. / I go to the school by the bus.	She is an engineer. / I go to school by bus.	Use <i>a/an</i> for jobs. No article with <i>go to school, by bus</i> . পেশার আগে <i>a/an</i> ।

Teacher's tip: Countable or uncountable? Ask: *Can I say "one, two, three"?* *One chair, two chairs* → countable. *One furniture* → wrong, so *furniture* is uncountable. Say *a piece of furniture, a piece of advice*.

C. Prepositions and extra words

#	✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Quick fix
14	Let's discuss about the plan.	Let's discuss the plan.	<i>Discuss</i> needs no <i>about</i> . <i>discuss</i> -এর পরে <i>about</i> নয়।
15	Please return back the book.	Please return the book.	<i>Return</i> already means "go/give back". <i>return</i> মানেই ফেরত।
16	Can you explain me this rule?	Can you explain this rule to me ?	<i>explain something to someone</i> . <i>explain</i> -এর পরে সরাসরি <i>me</i> নয়।
17	She got married with Adiyat.	She got married to Adiyat.	<i>married to</i> , not <i>with</i> . <i>married to</i> বলতে হয়।
18	He is good in English.	He is good at English.	<i>good at</i> a skill or subject. <i>good at</i> ।
19	He told that he was busy.	He said that he was busy. / He told me that...	<i>tell</i> needs a person: <i>tell me, tell her</i> . <i>say</i> does not. <i>tell</i> -এর পরে কাকে বলল তা লাগে।

D. Sentence building and word order

#	✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Quick fix
20	Where you live?	Where do you live?	Question = question word + <i>do/does/is</i> + subject. প্রশ্নে <i>do/does</i> আগে বসে।
21	This phone is more better.	This phone is better .	<i>Better</i> is already a comparative. <i>more</i> আর <i>better</i> একসাথে নয়।
22	Although it rained, but we went out.	Although it rained, we went out.	Use <i>although</i> or <i>but</i> , not both. যদিও...কিন্তু দুটো একসাথে নয়।
23	I like very much Dhaka.	I like Dhaka very much .	<i>Very much</i> goes after the object. <i>very much</i> বাক্যের শেষে।
24	I am interesting in music.	I am interested in music.	<i>-ed</i> = how you feel; <i>-ing</i> = what causes it. আমি আগ্রহী → <i>interested</i> ।
25	I don't know nothing.	I don't know anything . / I know nothing .	One negative only. এক বাক্যে দুটো না-বাচক শব্দ নয়।

Teacher's tip: Many of these mistakes come from translating word by word. Think of the **English pattern**, not the Bangla sentence. For example, আমি একমত is *I agree*, not *I am agree*.

3 Examples

1. My sister is a doctor, and she works in Chattogram.
আমার বোন একজন ডাক্তার, আর সে চট্টগ্রামে কাজ করে।
is (not dropped); *she* for a woman; *works* with *-s*
2. Did you call Mr. Chowdhury?
আপনি কি মিস্টার চৌধুরীকে ফোন করেছিলেন?
did + base verb (*call*)
3. I agree with your idea.
আমি তোমার আইডিয়ায় সাথে একমত।
agree, not "*am agree*"
4. We discussed the budget in the meeting.
আমরা মিটিংয়ে বাজেট নিয়ে আলোচনা করেছি।
discuss + object, no "*about*"
5. I have been working here for five years.
আমি এখানে পাঁচ বছর ধরে কাজ করছি।
for + length of time
6. Can you give me some information about the course?
কোর্সটা সম্পর্কে আমাকে কিছু তথ্য দিতে পারবেন?
information, never "*informations*"
7. One of my colleagues lives in Dhanmondi.
আমার এক সহকর্মী ধানমন্ডিতে থাকে।
one of + plural noun
8. Where does your brother work?
তোমার ভাই কোথায় কাজ করে?
question word + *does* + subject + verb

9. Farhana is very good at maths.

ফারহানা গণিতে খুব ভালো।

good at

10. He said that the bus was late.

সে বলল যে বাস দেরি করেছে।

said that (no person needed)

4 Common mistakes

All 25 are important, but these **five** are the most serious. Examiners and interviewers notice them at once.

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
My father very strict.	My father is very strict.	A sentence without a verb is not a sentence. Bangla can drop it; English can't.
She go to office at nine.	She goes to the office at nine.	Missing -s with he/she/it is the most common error in exams.
Did he called you?	Did he call you?	<i>Did</i> already shows past time, so the verb stays in base form.
What you want?	What do you want?	Questions need a helping verb before the subject.
I am agree.	I agree .	<i>Agree</i> is a verb, not an adjective. It needs no <i>am</i> .

5 Speak it

Read these five correct sentences aloud three times. Say them slowly first, then at normal speed.

1. I **agree** with you, but let's **discuss** it tomorrow.
2. My **cousin lives** in Sylhet, and **she** is **an** engineer.
3. I **saw** Karim yesterday. I **have known** him **for** ten years.
4. **Where do you** work? **Did you go** to the office today?
5. I'm **interested** in this job because I'm good **at** English.

Now try this: Ask a friend to listen while you talk for one minute about your family. They raise a hand every time they hear one of the 25 mistakes.

6 Write it

Task: The message below has **six** mistakes. Rewrite it correctly.

Hi Tania, one of my friend is coming from Khulna. She very nice. Did you met her last year? She is good in cooking. Let's discuss about a plan for Friday. Can you explain me the way to your house?

Model answer

Hi Tania, one of my **friends** is coming from Khulna. She **is** very nice. Did you **meet** her last year? She is good **at** cooking. Let's **discuss** a plan for Friday. Can you explain the way to

your house **to me**?

(41 words)

7 Exercises

A. Choose the correct word

- 15.1** There are too (*much* / *many*) cars on the road today.
- 15.2** Can you give me some (*advice* / *advices*)?
- 15.3** Rahim got married (*with* / *to*) Mitu last year.
- 15.4** I have lived in Dhaka (*since* / *for*) 2018.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 15.5** Did she went to the hospital?
- 15.6** My cousin sister he works in a bank.
- 15.7** Although he is poor, but he is happy.
- 15.8** I am interesting in football.
- 15.9** Why you are late?

C. Make a sentence

- 15.10** Write one correct sentence using **told** and one using **said**.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Never drop *am/is/are*, and add **-s** to the verb with he/she/it.
- After *did*, *can* and other helping verbs, use the **base verb**.
- Some words never take -s: *information*, *furniture*, *advice*, *news*.
- Don't add extra words: *discuss*, *return*, *better*, *cousin* are complete alone.
- Questions need *do/does/did* or *is/are* **before** the subject.

PART II

Daily Speaking

Chapter 16

Greetings, Introductions and Small Talk

1 Why this matters

The first ten seconds of any conversation are the most important. A warm greeting and a clear introduction make people **like you and trust you**, at a job interview, in a new office, or with a foreign guest. Small talk then keeps the conversation going in a friendly way.

ভালো শুভেচ্ছা আর পরিচয় দিয়ে শুরু করলে মানুষ আপনাকে পছন্দ করে ও ভরসা করে।

2 The rule in plain words

You don't need grammar rules here. You need **ready phrases**. Choose formal or informal depending on **who** you are talking to.

1. Saying hello

Formal (boss, teacher, client)	Informal (friends, classmates)	Bangla
Good morning / Good afternoon / Good evening.	Hi! / Hey! / Hello!	শুভ সকাল / হাই
How are you?	How's it going? / What's up?	কেমন আছেন? / কী খবর?
I'm very well, thank you. And you?	Not bad. / Pretty good. You?	ভালো আছি, আপনি?
It's nice to see you again.	Long time no see!	অনেক দিন পর দেখা!

2. Introducing yourself and others

Myself: Hello, I'm [name]. / My name is [name]. I work at / study at [place].

Someone else: This is [name]. He's / She's my [colleague / friend / cousin].

Reply: Nice to meet you. → Nice to meet you **too**. / Pleased to meet you.

3. Small talk: safe topics

Topic	Easy questions and answers
Weather	It's really hot today, isn't it? / Looks like rain.
Travel	How was the traffic? → Terrible! I was stuck in Farmgate for an hour.
Work / study	How's work these days? / What are you studying?
Hometown	Where are you from? → I'm from Sylhet, but I live in Dhaka now.
Weekend	Did you do anything nice at the weekend?

4. Saying goodbye

Formal: It was nice meeting you. / Have a good day. / I look forward to seeing you again.

Informal: See you! / See you later. / Take care. / Bye for now.

Teacher's tip: In English, people don't ask "Have you eaten?" or "What is your salary?" as small talk. Avoid questions about **money, age, weight, marriage plans and religion** with people you just met. Stick to weather, travel, work and food.

Teacher's tip: *How do you do?* is very formal and old-fashioned. The answer is *How do you do?*, not *I'm fine*. Today most people simply say **Nice to meet you**.

3 Examples

1. Good morning, sir. How are you today?
শুভ সকাল, স্যার। আজ কেমন আছেন?
Formal greeting for a boss or teacher.
2. Hi, Mitu! Long time no see. How's it going?
হাই মিতু! অনেক দিন পর দেখা। কী খবর?
Informal, for a friend.
3. Hello, I'm Adiyat Hossain. I work in the accounts department.
হ্যালো, আমি আদিয়াত হোসেন। আমি হিসাব বিভাগে কাজ করি।
Name + workplace: a perfect first introduction.
4. This is Sadia. She's my colleague from the Chattogram office.
এ হলো সাদিয়া। সে চট্টগ্রাম অফিসে আমার সহকর্মী।
Use **This is**, not "He is", to introduce someone.
5. Nice to meet you, Sadia.
তোমার সাথে পরিচিত হয়ে ভালো লাগলো, সাদিয়া।
The reply is *Nice to meet you too*.
6. It's really hot today, isn't it?
আজ সত্যিই খুব গরম, তাই না?
Weather is the safest small-talk topic.
7. How was the traffic this morning?
আজ সকালে জ্যাম কেমন ছিল?
Every Dhaka person has an answer to this one!
8. Where are you from originally?
আপনার আসল বাড়ি কোথায়?
A friendly way to ask about someone's hometown.
9. It was nice meeting you. Have a good evening.
আপনার সাথে দেখা হয়ে ভালো লাগলো। সন্ধ্যাটা ভালো কাটুক।
Formal goodbye. Use *meeting* at the end of a conversation.
10. OK, I have to go. See you tomorrow!
আচ্ছা, আমাকে যেতে হবে। কাল দেখা হবে!
Informal goodbye.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Myself Rahim.	I'm Rahim. / My name is Rahim.	"Myself Rahim" is a direct translation. It is not correct English.
I am fine. What about you? (to every greeting)	Pretty good, thanks. And you?	"I am fine" is not wrong, but it sounds like a textbook. Try different answers.
Good night! (when you arrive in the evening)	Good evening !	<i>Good night</i> is only for saying goodbye or going to bed.
He is my friend Karim.	This is my friend Karim.	When you introduce someone who is with you, say This is .
Nice to meet you also.	Nice to meet you too .	At the end of a short reply, use too .

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. It is Nusrat's first day at a new office in Gulshan.

Mr. Chowdhury: Good morning! You must be Nusrat.

Nusrat: Yes, good morning, sir. I'm Nusrat Jahan. It's nice to meet you.

Mr. Chowdhury: Nice to meet you too. Welcome to the team. This is Hasan. He'll help you this week.

Hasan: Hi, Nusrat! Pleased to meet you. How was the traffic?

Nusrat: Not too bad, actually. I came by metro rail from Mirpur.

Hasan: Lucky you! It took me an hour from Uttara. So, where are you from?

Nusrat: I'm from Rajshahi, but I studied in Dhaka.

Hasan: Great. Come on, I'll show you your desk.

Now try this: Practise with a friend. Greet them, introduce yourself, ask one small-talk question and say goodbye. Then do it again, but this time be **formal**.

6 Write it

Task: You have joined a new WhatsApp group for your office team. Write a short message (40–60 words) to introduce yourself.

Model answer

Hello everyone! I'm Tania Akter, and I've just joined the marketing team. I'm from Khulna, but I live in Dhanmondi now. Before this, I worked at a bank for two years. I'm really happy to be part of this team and I look forward to working with all of you. See you at the office!

(55 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

16.1 A: Nice to meet you. B: Nice to meet you _____.

16.2 You arrive at a dinner at 8 pm. You say: "Good _____!"

16.3 _____ is my cousin, Farhana. She lives in Sylhet.

16.4 A: How's it going? B: Not _____, thanks. You?

B. Correct the mistakes

16.5 Myself Karim, I am from Bogura.

16.6 (Meeting your boss at 10 am) Good night, sir.

16.7 He is my friend Adiyat. Adiyat, he is Rahim.

C. Formal or informal? Rewrite each one in the other style

16.8 Hey! What's up?

16.9 It was a pleasure meeting you. Have a good day.

D. Make sentences

16.10 Write two small-talk questions you could ask a new colleague.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Use **Good morning / How are you?** for formal people and **Hi / How's it going?** for friends.
- Introduce yourself with **I'm...** or **My name is...**, never "Myself...".
- Introduce others with **This is...** and reply **Nice to meet you too.**
- Small talk = weather, traffic, work, hometown. Avoid money, age and marriage.
- **Good night** is only for goodbye. Say **Good evening** when you arrive.

Chapter 17

Talking About Yourself, Family, Work and Study

1 Why this matters

"Tell me about yourself" is the first question in almost every job interview, IELTS Speaking test and new friendship. If you can talk about yourself, your family, your job and your studies for one minute, you already sound confident.

নিজের, পরিবারের, কাজ ও পড়াশোনার কথা এক মিনিট বলতে পারলেই আপনাকে আত্মবিশ্বাসী মনে হবে।

2 The rule in plain words

Most sentences about yourself use the **present simple**: facts that are true now (*I live, I work, she studies*). Here are the patterns you need.

1. About you

Pattern	Example
My name is .../ I'm ...	I'm Rahim Uddin. My friends call me Rimu.
I'm ...years old.	I'm 24 years old. (not I have 24 years)
I'm from .../ I grew up in ...	I'm from Cumilla. I grew up in a small village.
I live in ...with ...	I live in Mirpur with my parents.
In my free time, I like / enjoy ...+ -ing	In my free time, I enjoy playing cricket.

2. About your family

There are **five** people in my family. / I have **one** brother and **two** sisters.
My father **is** a ... My mother **works** as a ... My brother **studies** at ...
I'm the **eldest / youngest / only child**. I'm **married** and I have a daughter.

Useful family words: parents, elder brother (বড় ভাই), younger sister (ছোট বোন), cousin, uncle, aunt, husband, wife, in-laws (শ্বশুরবাড়ির লোকজন), housewife / homemaker.

3. About work and study

Work	Study
I work as a sales officer.	I'm a student at Dhaka University.
I work for / at a garments company.	I study / I'm studying English literature .
I'm in charge of customer service.	I'm in my second year .
I've been there for three years.	I'm preparing for the BCS exam.
I'm looking for a job right now.	I finished my Honours last year .

Teacher's tip: A good "Tell me about yourself" answer has **four steps**: name and home-town → study → work → one interest or goal. Keep it to about one minute. Don't recite your whole CV!

Teacher's tip: Remember the **-s** for he/she: *My father **works**, my sister **studies**, my brother **lives***. This is the most common mistake in speaking tests.

3 Examples

- I'm 22 years old, and I'm from Barishal.
আমার বয়স ২২ বছর, আর আমি বরিশালের মানুষ।
*Age with **am**, not **have**.*
- I live in a shared flat in Mohammadpur.
আমি মোহাম্মদপুরে একটা শেয়ার করা ফ্ল্যাটে থাকি।
live in + area.
- There are four people in my family.
আমার পরিবারে চারজন সদস্য।
There are + number + people.
- My father is a retired schoolteacher.
আমার বাবা একজন অবসরপ্রাপ্ত স্কুলশিক্ষক।
*Jobs need **a/an**: a teacher, an engineer.*
- My mother is a homemaker. She runs the whole house!
আমার মা গৃহিণী। পুরো সংসার উনিই সামলান!
homemaker sounds more respectful than "just a housewife".
- My elder sister works as a nurse in Sylhet.
আমার বড় বোন সিলেটে নার্স হিসেবে কাজ করেন।
works as + job.
- I work for a mobile banking company in Gulshan.
আমি গুলশানে একটা মোবাইল ব্যাংকিং কোম্পানিতে চাকরি করি।
work for + company.
- I'm in my final year of BBA at a private university.
আমি একটা প্রাইভেট বিশ্ববিদ্যালয়ে বিবিএ শেষ বর্ষে পড়ি।
in my first / final year.
- I'm preparing for IELTS because I want to study abroad.
আমি আইইএলটিএস-এর প্রস্তুতি নিচ্ছি, কারণ বিদেশে পড়তে চাই।
*Give a reason with **because**.*

10. In my free time, I enjoy reading and watching football.

অবসরে আমি বই পড়তে আর ফুটবল দেখতে ভালোবাসি।

enjoy + verb-**ing**.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I have 25 years.	I am 25 years old.	In English, age uses be , not <i>have</i> .
My father is service holder.	My father works in an office / for a bank .	"Service holder" is not used outside South Asia. Say the real job, and use a/an .
We are five members in our family.	There are five people in my family.	Use There are...people . "Members" sounds like a club.
My brother study in class nine.	My brother studies in Class 9 / is in Year 9 .	He/she needs -s . (In the UK they say <i>Year 9</i> ; in the US <i>ninth grade</i> .)
I am doing job in a bank.	I work in a bank.	"Doing job" is a translation of চাকরি করি. Just say work .

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Sadia is at a job interview in Banani.

Interviewer: So, Sadia, tell me a little about yourself.**Sadia:** Sure. I'm Sadia Islam, and I'm from Chattogram. I did my BBA in Marketing at Chittagong University.**Interviewer:** And what are you doing now?**Sadia:** I work as a sales executive at a pharmaceutical company. I've been there for two years.**Interviewer:** Why do you want to leave?**Sadia:** I enjoy my job, but I want more responsibility. I'd like to work in digital marketing.**Interviewer:** I see. And what do you do in your free time?**Sadia:** I write a small food blog, so I take a lot of photos of *biryani*!**Interviewer:** (laughs) That's useful for marketing.**Now try this:** Answer "Tell me about yourself" aloud in four steps. Record yourself on your phone and check: did you use **-s** for he/she?

6 Write it

Task: Write a short paragraph (60–80 words) about yourself and your family for a pen-pal website.**Model answer**

Hi! My name is Hasan, and I'm 20 years old. I'm from Sylhet, but I live in Dhaka now because I study Computer Science at a university here. There are five people in my family. My father runs a small grocery shop, and my mother is a homemaker. I have two younger sisters. They are both in school. In my free time, I love playing cricket and learning to code. I'd love to make friends from other countries!

(78 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (as, for, in, at, is, are)

- 17.1** My uncle works _____ a driver.
17.2 There _____ six people in my family.
17.3 I'm a student _____ Rajshahi University.
17.4 She works _____ a big NGO.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 17.5** I have 19 years.
17.6 My sister work in a bank.
17.7 My father is businessman.
17.8 I am doing job in a garments factory.

C. Make sentences

- 17.9** Write two sentences about one member of your family (job + where they live).
17.10 Write one sentence about what you enjoy doing in your free time.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Talk about yourself with the **present simple**: *I live, I work, she studies*.
- Age: **I am 25 years old**. Family: **There are five people in my family**.
- Jobs: **work as** + job, **work for** + company, and always **a/an** before a job.
- Don't forget **-s** with he/she: *my father works*.
- "Tell me about yourself" = name and hometown → study → work → interest or goal.

Chapter 18

Daily Routines and Habits

1 Why this matters

“What do you do every day?” is a favourite question in IELTS Speaking Part 1, in interviews and in friendly chats. Talking about your routine uses simple words, but it shows that you can use the present simple and **how-often words** (*always, usually, never*) correctly.

প্রতিদিনের রুটিন বলতে পারলে বর্তমান কাল আর “কত ঘন ঘন” বোঝানোর শব্দগুলো ঠিকভাবে ব্যবহার করা শেখা হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

For routines and habits, use the **present simple**: *I get up, she gets up, we don't eat...*

1. Routine phrases you use every day

Morning	Daytime	Evening / night
wake up / get up	go to work / class	come back home
brush my teeth	catch a bus / take a CNG	have tea and snacks
say my prayers	have lunch	help my kids with homework
take a shower	attend meetings	scroll through Facebook
have breakfast	take a short break	go to bed / fall asleep

2. Frequency adverbs: how often?

Word	How often	Example	Bangla
always	100%	I always drink tea in the morning.	সবসময়
usually	80%	She usually takes a rickshaw.	সাধারণত
often	60%	We often eat out on Fridays.	প্রায়ই
sometimes	40%	I sometimes work from home.	মাঝে মাঝে
rarely	10%	He rarely cooks.	কদাচিৎ
never	0%	I never skip breakfast.	কখনোই না

3. Where do they go? Three simple rules

Rule 1: before the main verb → I **usually** get up at 6.

Rule 2: after am / is / are → She **is always** late.

Rule 3: between a helping verb and the main verb → I don't **often** watch TV. / Do you **usually** walk?

Sometimes and *usually* can also go at the **start**: *Sometimes I walk to the office.*

4. Other useful time phrases (at the end of the sentence)

every day, every morning, once a week, twice a month, three times a year, on weekdays, at weekends, on Fridays.

Teacher's tip: *Never* and *rarely* are already negative. Don't add *not*: *I **never** eat meat*, not *I don't never eat meat*.

Teacher's tip: To ask about routines, use **How often...?** → *How often do you go to the gym?* → *Twice a week*.

3 Examples

1. I usually wake up at 6 o'clock.
আমি সাধারণত ছয়টায় ঘুম থেকে উঠি।
Adverb **before** the main verb.
2. My father always reads the newspaper with his tea.
আমার বাবা সবসময় চায়ের সাথে পত্রিকা পড়েন।
He/she + verb-**s**.
3. Tania is never late for class.
তানিয়া কখনোই ক্লাসে দেরি করে না।
Adverb **after** *is*.
4. We often order food from Foodpanda on Friday nights.
আমরা প্রায়ই শুক্রবার রাতে ফুডপান্ডা থেকে খাবার অর্ডার করি।
often before *order*.
5. I don't usually take a CNG. It's too expensive.
আমি সাধারণত সিএনজি নিই না। খুব খরচ।
Between *don't* and the main verb.
6. Karim rarely eats breakfast at home.
করিম কদাচিৎ বাসায় নাস্তা করে।
rarely = almost never.
7. Sometimes I listen to podcasts on the bus.
মাঝে মাঝে আমি বাসে পডকাস্ট শুনি।
Sometimes can start the sentence.
8. How often do you call your parents?
তুমি কত ঘন ঘন বাবা-মাকে ফোন করো?
Ask with **How often**.
9. I go to the gym three times a week.
আমি সপ্তাহে তিনবার জিমে যাই।
Time phrase at the **end**.
10. After dinner, I usually check my WhatsApp messages and go to bed.
রাতের খাবারের পর আমি সাধারণত হোয়াটসঅ্যাপ মেসেজ দেখে ঘুমাতে যাই।
A full routine sentence.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I go always to the office by bus.	I always go to the office by bus.	The adverb goes before the main verb.
She always is busy.	She is always busy.	With am/is/are, the adverb goes after .
I don't never eat beef.	I never eat beef.	<i>Never</i> is already negative.
My mother get up at 5.	My mother gets up at 5.	He/she/it needs -s .
I am going to office every day.	I go to the office every day.	For daily habits, use the present simple , not <i>am going</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. It is an IELTS-style Speaking Part 1 practice.

Examiner: Let's talk about your daily routine. What do you usually do in the morning?

Adiyat: I usually get up at around six. I say my prayers, have a quick breakfast and catch the office bus at seven.

Examiner: Do you always have breakfast?

Adiyat: Almost always. My mother never lets me leave without eating!

Examiner: What do you do in the evening?

Adiyat: I'm often tired, so I just relax. I sometimes play *carrom* with my brother, and I rarely go to bed before midnight.

Examiner: Would you like to change anything about your routine?

Adiyat: Yes, I'd like to exercise more. Right now I hardly ever go to the gym.

Now try this: Answer the examiner's questions about **your** routine. Use at least four different frequency adverbs.

6 Write it

Task: Write a paragraph (60–80 words) about a typical weekday in your life. Use at least four frequency adverbs.

Model answer

On weekdays, I always wake up at 6:30. I usually have *ruti* and an egg for breakfast. Then I take a bus to my office in Motijheel. The traffic is often terrible, so I sometimes listen to music on the way. I have lunch at my desk at one o'clock. I come back home at about seven and have tea with my family. I rarely watch TV at night. I usually read for a while and go to bed at eleven.

(81 words)

7 Exercises

A. Put the adverb in the correct place

18.1 I drink coffee at night. (never)

18.2 My brother is hungry. (always)

18.3 We go to Cox's Bazar in winter. (often)

18.4 Do you take a rickshaw to college? (usually)

B. Correct the mistakes

18.5 She goes sometimes to the gym.

18.6 My father watch the news every night.

18.7 I don't never miss my class.

C. Make sentences

18.8 Write a question with **How often** and answer it.

18.9 Write one sentence about something you **rarely** do.

18.10 Write one sentence about what your mother or father **usually** does in the morning.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Use the **present simple** for routines: *I get up, she gets up.*
- always (100%) → usually → often → sometimes → rarely → never (0%).
- Adverb goes **before** the main verb, but **after** am/is/are.
- *Never* and *rarely* don't need *not*.
- Ask with **How often...?** and answer with *once a week, twice a month, every day.*

Chapter 19

Asking for Help, Permission and Information

1 Why this matters

Every day we need something from someone: directions, a favour, a day off, a phone charger. In English, **how** you ask matters as much as **what** you ask. A polite question gets a “yes” much more often than a direct order.

ইংরেজিতে কী চাইছেন তার মতোই জরুরি কীভাবে চাইছেন। ভদ্রভাবে চাইলে “হ্যাঁ” পাওয়ার সম্ভাবনা বেশি।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Three levels of politeness

Level	Asking for help (someone does something)	Asking for permission (you do something)
Friendly (friends, family)	Can you pass the salt?	Can I borrow your pen?
Polite (most people)	Could you send me the file, please?	Could I leave a bit early today?
Very polite (boss, stranger, formal email)	Would you mind checking this for me?	May I come in? / Do you mind if I open the window?

Could / Can / Would you + verb ..., please? → Could you **help** me?

Can / Could / May I + verb ...? → May I **use** your phone?

Would you mind + verb-ing? → Would you mind **closing** the door?

2. Asking for information

Start with **Excuse me** to get attention. For a softer question, use **Do you know...?** or **Could you tell me...?** Then the question becomes a **normal sentence order**.

Direct question	Softer, more polite
Where is the bus stop?	Do you know where the bus stop is ?
What time does the bank open?	Could you tell me what time the bank opens ?
Is there an ATM near here?	Do you know if there is an ATM near here?

3. How to answer

Yes	No (politely)
Sure! / Of course. / No problem.	Sorry, I'm afraid I can't right now.
Go ahead. (for permission)	I'm sorry, but that's not possible.
Not at all. (for <i>Would you mind...?</i>)	Sorry, I'm not from around here.

Teacher's tip: Be careful with **Would you mind...?** It means "Is it a problem for you?". So the polite **yes** answer is "*No, not at all*" or "*Of course not*". If you say "Yes", it means you **do** mind!

Teacher's tip: In Bangla, একটু makes a request soft. In English, use **please, could**, and small words like **a minute** or **quickly**: *Could you help me for a minute?*

3 Examples

- Excuse me, could you tell me where the ticket counter is?
মাফ করবেন, টিকিট কাউন্টারটা কোথায় বলতে পারবেন?
Soft question: *where the counter is*.
- Can you lend me 100 taka? I'll pay you back tomorrow.
আমাকে ১০০ টাকা ধার দিতে পারবি? কালকে ফেরত দেব।
Friendly level, between friends.
- Could you speak a little more slowly, please?
একটু আস্তে বলবেন, প্লিজ?
Very useful on the phone!
- May I come in, sir?
স্যার, ভেতরে আসতে পারি?
Very polite: classroom, boss's office.
- Could I leave the office an hour early today? I have a doctor's appointment.
আজ কি এক ঘণ্টা আগে অফিস থেকে যেতে পারি? ডাক্তারের অ্যাপয়েন্টমেন্ট আছে।
Give a short **reason**.
- Would you mind sending me the report by email?
রিপোর্টটা কি একটু ইমেইলে পাঠিয়ে দেবেন?
mind + verb-ing.
- Do you mind if I charge my phone here?
এখানে ফোনটা চার্জ দিলে কি অসুবিধা হবে?
Asking permission very politely.
- Do you know if this bus goes to Mohakhali?
এই বাসটা কি মহাখালী যায়, জানেন?
Use **if** for yes/no questions.
- Sorry to bother you, but could you help me with this form?
বিরক্ত করার জন্য দুঃখিত, এই ফর্মটা পূরণে একটু সাহায্য করবেন?
A polite opener at a bank or office.
- Sure, go ahead.

অবশ্যই, করুন।

Short "yes" to a permission question.

4 Common mistakes

X Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Give me your pen.	Could I borrow your pen?	An order sounds rude in English, even with a smile.
Can you tell me where is the bank?	Can you tell me where the bank is ?	After <i>Can you tell me / Do you know</i> , use normal sentence order.
Would you mind to open the window?	Would you mind opening the window?	<i>mind</i> is always followed by verb- ing .
May you help me?	Could you help me?	<i>May</i> is only for I / we (permission). For others, use <i>Could you</i> .
Please do the needful.	Could you please check this and reply ?	"Do the needful" is old-fashioned and unclear. Say exactly what you need.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Farhana is new in Chattogram and needs help at a bank.

Farhana: Excuse me. Do you know where I can open a savings account?

Guard: Yes, madam. Desk number four, on the left.

Farhana: Thank you. (at the desk) Hello. Sorry to bother you, but could you help me open an account?

Officer: Of course. Please have a seat. May I see your NID card?

Farhana: Here you are. Do you mind if I take a photo of the form? I want to fill it in at home.

Officer: Not at all, go ahead. Could you bring two passport-size photos too?

Farhana: Sure. Could you tell me what time you close?

Officer: We close at four o'clock, Sunday to Thursday.

Farhana: Great. Thanks so much for your help.

Now try this: You are at a bus counter in Sylhet. Ask (1) the time of the next bus to Dhaka, (2) the price of a ticket, (3) permission to leave your bag at the counter for ten minutes.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short, polite message (40–60 words) to your manager asking for one day of leave.

Model answer

Dear Mr. Chowdhury,
I hope you are well. Could I take a day off this Thursday, 14 November? My younger brother is getting married in Cumilla, and I need to travel there. I will finish my report before Wednesday evening. Please let me know if this is possible.
Best regards,
Karim

(51 words)

7 Exercises

A. Make the requests more polite (use the word in brackets)

- 19.1** Open the door. (Could)
19.2 I want to use your laptop. (May)
19.3 Turn down the music. (Would you mind)

B. Make softer questions

- 19.4** Where is the post office? → Do you know ...?
19.5 When does the train leave? → Could you tell me ...?

C. Correct the mistakes

- 19.6** Would you mind to wait a minute?
19.7 May you give me a glass of water?
19.8 Can you tell me where is the toilet?

D. What would you say?

- 19.9** Your friend asks, "Would you mind if I sit here?" You are happy for them to sit. Answer.
19.10 You want to ask a stranger on the street how to get to Dhanmondi Lake. Write a polite question.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Friendly: **Can you / Can I**. Polite: **Could you / Could I**. Very polite: **May I / Would you mind**.
- **Would you mind** + verb-ing; the polite "yes" is *No, not at all*.
- Start with **Excuse me** or **Sorry to bother you**.
- After **Do you know / Could you tell me**, use normal order: *where the bank is*.
- Add **please** and a short reason. Never give orders to people you don't know well.

Chapter 20

Shopping, Restaurants and Bargaining

1 Why this matters

Shopping and eating out are part of everyday life, from New Market and Bashundhara City to a *biryani* house in Old Dhaka. In big shopping malls, hotels, and abroad, you will often need English to ask prices, find your size, order food and pay the bill. And yes, you can bargain politely in English too!

দাম জিজ্ঞেস করা, মাপ খোঁজা, খাবার অর্ডার আর বিল চাওয়া ইংরেজিতে পারলে যেকোনো জায়গায় স্বচ্ছন্দ থাকবেন।

2 The rule in plain words

1. In a shop: prices and sizes

You (customer)	Shopkeeper
How much is this shirt? / How much are these shoes?	It's 1,200 Tk. / They're 2,500 Tk.
Do you have this in a medium / a bigger size?	Let me check. / Sorry, that's the last one.
Do you have it in blue?	Yes, here you are.
Can I try it on? Where's the trial room?	Sure, it's over there.
It's too tight / too loose / a bit long.	Try this one. It's one size up.
I'll take it. / I'm just looking, thanks.	Cash or card? / bKash is fine too.

How much is + one thing? **How much are** + two or more things?

Say prices like this: **350 Tk** = "three hundred and fifty taka". **1,500 Tk** = "one thousand five hundred taka" or "fifteen hundred taka".

2. In a restaurant

Step	What to say
Arriving	A table for four, please. / Do you have a table for two?
Menu	Could we see the menu, please? / What do you recommend?
Ordering	I'll have the chicken biryani. / Could I have a plate of <i>kacchi</i> , please?
Special needs	Is this very spicy? / Can you make it less spicy? / No onions, please.
During the meal	Could we have some more water? / Excuse me, this isn't what I ordered.
Paying	Could we have the bill, please? / Can I pay by card? / Keep the change.
Takeaway	Can I get this to take away? / Could you pack the rest, please?

3. Bargaining politely at a market

Polite phrase	Bangla idea
That's a bit expensive.	দামটা একটু বেশি।
Can you give me a better price? / Can you do it for 800?	একটু কমানো যায়? / ৮০০ দেবো?
What's your best price?	শেষ দাম কত?
If I buy two, will you give me a discount?	দুটো নিলে কম রাখবেন?
OK, let's meet in the middle: 900 Tk.	মাঝামাঝি ৯০০ টাকা রাখেন।
Thanks, I'll think about it. (and walk away slowly!)	আচ্ছা, দেখি।

Teacher's tip: Bargain in markets (New Market, Gausia, street shops), but **not** in shopping malls, supermarkets or restaurants with fixed prices. There you can only ask: *Is there any discount on this?*

Teacher's tip: Use **I'll have...** or **Could I have...?** to order. *I want...* and *Give me...* sound rude to a waiter in English.

3 Examples

- Excuse me, how much is this *panjabi*?
মাফ করবেন, এই পাঞ্জাবিটার দাম কত?
One thing → **is**.
- How much are these mangoes per kilo?
এই আমগুলো কেজি কত?
Many things → **are**.
- Do you have this shirt in a large?
এই শার্টটা কি লার্জ সাইজে আছে?
Ask for size with in.
- Can I try these jeans on?
এই জিন্সটা কি একটু পরে দেখতে পারি?
try on = wear to check the size.
- It's a bit tight. Do you have a bigger size?
একটু টাইট হচ্ছে। এর চেয়ে বড় সাইজ আছে?
tight / loose / long / short.
- That's too expensive. Can you do it for 600 taka?
খুব বেশি দাম। ৬০০ টাকায় দেবেন?
Polite bargaining with a clear offer.
- A table for three, please.
তিনজনের জন্য একটা টেবিল, প্লিজ।
First thing to say in a restaurant.
- I'll have a beef *tehari* and a glass of *borhani*, please.
আমি একটা বিফ তেহারি আর এক গ্লাস বোরহানি নেব।
Order with I'll have.
- Could you make it less spicy, please?

একটু কম ঝাল করে দেবেন, প্লিজ?
Ask politely for a change.

10. Could we have the bill, please? Can I pay with bKash?
বিলটা দেবেন, প্লিজ? বিকাশে দিতে পারব?
bill (UK) = *check* (US).

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
How much price?	How much is it? / What's the price?	<i>How much</i> already asks about price. Don't use both.
Give me one plate biryani.	Could I have a plate of biryani, please?	Use a plate of, a cup of , and a polite request.
It's very costly.	It's very expensive .	<i>Costly</i> is rarely used in daily speech; expensive is natural.
Less the price a little.	Can you give me a better price? / Can you lower the price a bit?	<i>Less</i> is not a verb. Use a polite question.
I want to take a trial.	Can I try it on?	<i>Try on</i> is the natural phrase for clothes.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Mitu is buying a *salwar kameez* at New Market before Eid.

Mitu: Excuse me, how much is this green one?
Seller: That's 2,800 taka, apa. Very good quality cotton.
Mitu: 2,800? That's a bit expensive. Do you have it in a medium?
Seller: Yes, here you are. You can try it on over there.
Mitu: (comes back) It fits well. What's your best price?
Seller: For you, 2,500. Fixed price.
Mitu: Hmm, can you do it for 2,000? I'll buy one for my sister too.
Seller: Two pieces? OK, 2,200 each. Last price.
Mitu: Let's meet in the middle: 2,100 each, and I'll take both.
Seller: (smiles) OK, apa. Cash or bKash?

Now try this: With a partner, act out a restaurant scene: arrive, order two dishes and a drink, ask for less spice, and ask for the bill.

6 Write it

Task: You ordered food online, but it came cold and one item was missing. Write a short, polite message (40–60 words) to the restaurant.

Model answer

Hello, I ordered a chicken biryani and a *jali kabab* from your restaurant at 8 pm today (order number 4512). Unfortunately, the biryani arrived cold, and the kabab was missing. I paid 520 Tk by bKash. Could you please send the missing item or give me a refund? Thank you

for your help.
Nusrat

(54 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (is, are, on, of, have, bill)

20.1 How much _____ these sunglasses?

20.2 Can I try this _____?

20.3 I'll _____ a cup of tea, please.

20.4 Could we have the _____, please?

B. Correct the mistakes

20.5 How much price this bag?

20.6 Give me two plate kacchi.

20.7 This phone cover is too costly. Less the price.

C. What would you say?

20.8 The shoes are too small. Ask for another size.

20.9 The seller says 1,000 Tk. You want to pay 700 Tk. Bargain politely.

20.10 The food is too spicy for your child. Ask the waiter politely.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **How much is** this? (one) / **How much are** these? (many). Never "How much price".
- Sizes: *Do you have this in a medium?* *Can I try it on?*
- Order with **I'll have...** or **Could I have...?**, and ask for **the bill**.
- Bargain politely: *That's a bit expensive. What's your best price? Can you do it for...?*
- Bargain at markets, not in malls or fixed-price shops.

Chapter 21

Directions, Transport and Travel

1 Why this matters

You are new in an area, your Uber driver can't find your house, or you are checking in at a hotel in Cox's Bazar. In all these moments you need a few **short, clear phrases**. You don't need perfect grammar here. You need the right words, said politely.

রাস্তা জিজ্ঞেস করা, গাড়ি ঠিক করা বা হোটেলে চেক-ইন করতে কয়েকটা ছোট, পরিষ্কার বাক্যই যথেষ্ট।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Asking the way

Always start with **Excuse me**. Then ask your question.

Polite (strangers, older people)	Casual (friends, rickshaw-wala)
Excuse me, could you tell me how to get to the bank?	How do I get to the bank?
Excuse me, is there a pharmacy near here?	Any pharmacy around here?
Sorry to bother you. Which way is Mirpur 10?	Which way to Mirpur 10?
Is it far from here? / Can I walk there?	Is it far? Walking distance?

2. Giving directions

Phrase	Meaning	Bangla
Go straight (ahead).	Don't turn.	সোজা যান
Turn left / right.	Change direction.	বামে / ডানে ঘুরুন
Take the second left.	Turn at the 2nd road on the left.	দ্বিতীয় বাম রাস্তায় ঢুকুন
Cross the road.	Go to the other side.	রাস্তা পার হন
It's next to the mosque.	Beside it.	মসজিদের পাশে
It's opposite the school.	On the other side, facing it.	স্কুলের উল্টো দিকে
It's between the bank and the pharmacy.	In the middle of two places.	ব্যাংক আর ফার্মেসির মাঝখানে
It's at the end of the road.	Where the road stops.	রাস্তার শেষ মাথায়
It's on the corner.	Where two roads meet.	মোড়ে

Go straight → turn left/right at [landmark] → it's on your left/right, next to / opposite [landmark].

3. Transport: rickshaw, CNG, bus, train, Uber

- **Rickshaw / CNG:** *Will you go to Dhanmondi 27? How much? That's too much. Tk 150 is fine?*
- **Bus:** *Does this bus go to Farmgate? Where should I get off? Please stop here.*
- **Train:** *One ticket to Chattogram, please. Which platform is it? Is this seat free?*
- **Uber / Pathao:** *I'm standing in front of the gate. I'm wearing a blue shirt. Please come to the main road.*

4. Airport and hotel

- **Airport:** *Where is the check-in counter for Biman? Can I take this bag on board? Is the flight on time?*
- **Hotel:** *I have a booking under the name Adiyat Hossain. What time is check-out? Is breakfast included? Could I have the Wi-Fi password?*

Teacher's tip: Use **landmarks**, not road numbers. In Bangladesh people know the mosque, petrol pump, school or big shopping mall better than street names. "Opposite Bashundhara City" works better than "Road 7".

3 Examples

- Excuse me, how can I get to Gulshan 1?
মাফ করবেন, গুলশান ১-এ কীভাবে যাব?
Excuse me first, then the question.
- Go straight and turn right at the petrol pump.
সোজা গিয়ে পেট্রোল পাম্পে ডানে ঘুরবেন।
Order: straight → turn → landmark.
- The pharmacy is opposite the hospital.
ফার্মেসিটা হাসপাতালের উল্টো দিকে।
opposite = on the other side, facing it.
- It's about five minutes' walk from here.
এখান থেকে হেঁটে প্রায় পাঁচ মিনিট।
*Say how far in **minutes**.*
- Mama, will you go to Mohakhali? How much?
মামা, মহাখালী যাবেন? কত?
Natural with rickshaw and CNG drivers.
- Please let me know when we reach Farmgate.
ফার্মগেট এলে আমাকে একটু বলবেন।
Ask the bus conductor to tell you.
- I'm waiting near the main gate of Dhaka University.
আমি ঢাকা বিশ্ববিদ্যালয়ের মেইন গেটের কাছে অপেক্ষা করছি।
Clear location for an Uber driver.
- Two tickets to Sylhet for tomorrow morning, please.
কাল সকালের সিলেটের দুটো টিকিট দিন।
Number + place + time + please.

9. I have a booking under the name Sadia Rahman.

সাদিয়া রহমান নামে একটা বুকিং আছে।

Use *under the name* at hotels.

10. What time do I need to check out?

কয়টার মধ্যে চেক-আউট করতে হবে?

A key question at any hotel.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Where is the bank? Tell me.	Excuse me , where is the bank?	Strangers expect <i>Excuse me</i> . "Tell me" sounds like an order.
Go straight and take right.	Go straight and turn right .	We turn right/left. "Take right" is not natural.
The shop is in front of the school. (meaning across the road)	The shop is opposite the school.	<i>In front of</i> = on the same side. <i>Opposite</i> = across the road.
I will get down here.	I'll get off here. / Please stop here.	For buses and trains we say get off , not <i>get down</i> .
How much will you take? Very much!	How much? That's a bit much . Would you take Tk 120?	Bargain politely. Offer a price.

5 Speak it

Hasan is new in Mirpur. He asks a shopkeeper the way.

Hasan: Excuse me, bhai. Is there a Dutch-Bangla Bank near here?

Shopkeeper: Yes, there is. Go straight down this road.

Hasan: Okay.

Shopkeeper: At the mosque, turn left. Walk for two minutes. The bank is on your right, next to a sweet shop.

Hasan: So, straight, left at the mosque, and it's on the right?

Shopkeeper: That's it. It's opposite a big pharmacy. You can't miss it.

Hasan: Is it walking distance?

Shopkeeper: Yes, five minutes at most.

Hasan: Thanks a lot!

Shopkeeper: No problem.

Notice: Hasan **repeats the directions** to check. This is a very useful habit.

Now try this: Explain to a friend how to go from your home to the nearest bus stop. Use *go straight*, *turn*, *next to* and *opposite*.

6 Write it

Task: Your friend is coming to your home for the first time. Write a short WhatsApp message with directions from the main road.

Model answer

Hi Mitu! When you get off the bus at Mirpur 10, cross the road and take a rickshaw to Shah Ali Mosque. Get off at the mosque and walk straight for two minutes. Turn right at the yellow building. My house is the third one on the left, opposite a small tea stall. Call me when you reach the mosque, and I'll come down!

(64 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (opposite, straight, next to, get off, under)

- 21.1** Go _____ until you see the traffic light.
- 21.2** The ATM is _____ the pharmacy. They are side by side.
- 21.3** The school is _____ the park, on the other side of the road.
- 21.4** I need to _____ the bus at Shahbagh.
- 21.5** I have a booking _____ the name Karim Uddin.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 21.6** Go straight and take left at the corner.
- 21.7** I will get down from the train at Airport station.
- 21.8** Where is the bus stand? Tell me.

C. Make sentences

- 21.9** Write one sentence you would say to a CNG driver to agree on the fare.
- 21.10** Write two questions you would ask at a hotel reception.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Start with **Excuse me** when you ask a stranger for directions.
- Key words: **go straight, turn left/right, next to, opposite, between, on the corner.**
- Give directions with **landmarks** and time (*five minutes' walk*).
- On buses and trains, you **get on** and **get off**.
- Repeat the directions back to check you understood.

Chapter 22

Phone Calls and Appointments

1 Why this matters

Phone calls are hard because you **can't see** the other person's face or hands. You can't point or smile. So you need a few **fixed phrases** that everyone understands: how to start, how to ask for someone, how to leave a message, and how to book a time.

ফোনে মুখ দেখা যায় না, তাই কিছু নির্দিষ্ট বাক্য জানা থাকলে কথা বলা অনেক সহজ হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Opening a call

	Formal (office, bank, clinic)	Informal (friends, family)
Answer	Good morning, ABC Traders. How can I help you?	Hello? / Hi, Nusrat!
Say who you are	Hello, this is Adiyat Hossain from Delta Bank.	Hi, it's Adiyat.
Ask for someone	Could I speak to Mr. Chowdhury, please?	Is Karim there?
Ask who is calling	May I ask who's calling?	Who's this?
Ask them to wait	One moment, please. I'll put you through.	Hold on a sec.

Teacher's tip: On the phone, say **"This is Rahim"** or **"It's Rahim"**, not "I am Rahim". And say **"Is that Tania?"**, not "Are you Tania?"

2. When the person is not available

- *I'm sorry, he's not at his desk right now. / She's in a meeting.*
- *Would you like to leave a message? Can I take a message?*
- *Could you ask him to call me back? My number is 01711-234567.*
- *Could you spell your name, please? Let me read that back to you.*

3. Problems on the line

Problem	What to say
You can't hear well	Sorry, the line is bad. Could you speak up a little?
Too fast	Could you speak more slowly, please?
Missed a word	Sorry, could you say that again?
Call is breaking	You're breaking up. I'll call you back.
Wrong number	Sorry, I think you have the wrong number.

4. Appointments: book, change, cancel

Book: I'd like to make an appointment with Dr. Farhana, please. Is Thursday evening possible?

Change: I have an appointment on Monday at 5. Could I change it to Tuesday?

Cancel: I'm sorry, I need to cancel my appointment for tomorrow.

Confirm: Just to confirm, that's Tuesday the 14th at 11 a.m.?

5. Closing a call

Thanks for calling. / Thanks for your help. / Talk to you later. / Okay, bye!

Teacher's tip: Before you hang up, **repeat the key details:** day, date, time and name. "So, that's Sunday at 4 p.m. with Dr. Hasan. Thank you!" This saves many mistakes.

3 Examples

1. Hello, this is Sadia from Brac Bank.
হ্যালো, আমি ব্র্যাক ব্যাংক থেকে সাদিয়া বলছি।
This is + name + from + company.
2. Could I speak to Mr. Chowdhury, please?
মিস্টার চৌধুরীর সাথে কি একটু কথা বলতে পারি?
The standard polite way to ask for someone.
3. May I ask who's calling?
কে বলছেন জানতে পারি?
Polite. "Who are you?" sounds rude.
4. He's in a meeting right now. Can I take a message?
উনি এখন মিটিংয়ে আছেন। কোনো মেসেজ রেখে দেব?
Offer to help when someone is not free.
5. Could you ask her to call me back?
ওনাকে কি আমাকে কল ব্যাক করতে বলবেন?
call back = return the call.
6. Sorry, the line is bad. Could you say that again?
দুঃখিত, লাইনটা খারাপ। আবার বলবেন?
Very useful with weak mobile networks.
7. I'd like to make an appointment for next Sunday.

আগামী রবিবারের জন্য একটা অ্যাপয়েন্টমেন্ট নিতে চাই।
I'd like to = polite I want to.

8. Could we move it to 3 o'clock instead?
 আমরা কি এটা বদলে ৩টায় করতে পারি?
move it to = change the time.

9. I'm afraid I have to cancel my appointment.
 দুঃখিত, আমাকে অ্যাপয়েন্টমেন্টটা বাতিল করতে হবে।
I'm afraid makes bad news softer.

10. Thanks for your help. Have a nice day.
 সাহায্যের জন্য ধন্যবাদ। দিনটা ভালো কাটুক।
A friendly way to close a formal call.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Hello, I am Rahim speaking.	Hello, this is Rahim.	On the phone, use this is / it's .
Who are you?	May I ask who's calling?	"Who are you?" sounds rude to a caller.
Give me Mr. Karim.	Could I speak to Mr. Karim, please?	"Give me" is a direct translation and sounds like an order.
I want to take an appointment.	I'd like to make an appointment.	We make or book an appointment.
Please call me back later. (to say "wait")	Please hold on. / One moment, please.	<i>Call back</i> means "phone again later", not "wait".

5 Speak it

Tania calls a clinic in Dhanmondi to book a check-up.

Receptionist: Good afternoon, Green Life Clinic. How can I help you?
Tania: Hello, I'd like to make an appointment with Dr. Farhana Islam, please.
Receptionist: Sure. When would you like to come?
Tania: Is Thursday evening possible?
Receptionist: Let me check... Sorry, Thursday is full. How about Saturday at 6 p.m.?
Tania: Saturday at 6 is fine.
Receptionist: May I have your name and phone number?
Tania: Tania Akter. My number is 01819-556677.
Receptionist: Sorry, the line is a bit bad. Could you repeat the number?
Tania: Of course. 0-1-8-1-9, 5-5-6-6-7-7.
Receptionist: Thank you. So that's Saturday at 6 p.m. with Dr. Farhana.
Tania: Perfect. Thanks a lot. Bye!

Now try this: Role-play the same call, but this time Tania calls back to **change** the appointment to Sunday.

6 Write it

Task: You answered a call for your colleague Mr. Hasan. Write the phone message you leave on his desk.

Model answer

Message for: Mr. Hasan **Time:** 11:30 a.m., Monday
Mr. Karim Uddin from Star Printing called about the brochure order. The printing will be one day late. He wants to know if Wednesday is okay. Please call him back before 4 p.m. today. His number is 01912-778899.

Taken by: Mitu

(48 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (this is, speak to, take, line, cancel)

- 22.1** Hello, _____ Nusrat from the HR department.
22.2 Could I _____ the manager, please?
22.3 She's not here. Can I _____ a message?
22.4 Sorry, the _____ is bad. I can't hear you.
22.5 I'm afraid I need to _____ my appointment for Friday.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 22.6** Hello, I am Adiyat speaking from Robi.
22.7 Who are you? Why are you calling?
22.8 I want to take an appointment with the dentist.

C. Make sentences

- 22.9** Write what you would say to change a doctor's appointment from Monday to Wednesday.
22.10 Write a polite sentence to close a phone call with a bank officer.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Start with **This is** + name. Ask with **Could I speak to..., please?**
- If someone is busy: **Can I take a message?** / **Could you ask him to call me back?**
- Bad line: **Sorry, could you say that again / speak up?**
- We **make, change** and **cancel** appointments.
- Repeat the day, time and name before you hang up.

Chapter 23

Workplace and Office English

1 Why this matters

In many offices in Dhaka and Chattogram, meetings, emails and updates happen in English. You don't need long speeches. You need **short, polite phrases** to ask for help, give an update, talk about deadlines and speak to your boss with confidence.

অফিসে লম্বা বক্তৃতা লাগে না; সাহায্য চাওয়া, আপডেট দেওয়া আর ডেডলাইন নিয়ে কথা বলার কয়েকটা ভদ্র বাক্য জানলেই চলে।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Polite requests: three levels

Level	Use with	Example
Casual	Close colleagues	Can you send me the file?
Polite	Most people at work	Could you send me the file, please?
Very polite	Boss, clients, big favours	Would you mind sending me the file? / I was wondering if you could help me with this.

Could you + verb ..., please?
Could you check this report, please?

Would you mind + verb-**ing** ...?
Would you mind checking this report?

2. Reporting progress

Situation	What to say
Finished	I've finished the sales report. / It's done.
Still working	I'm working on it. It's about 70% done.
On time	I'm on track to finish it by Thursday.
Late	I'm running a bit behind. I need one more day.
Problem	I'm stuck on the budget part. Could you take a look?

3. Deadlines

- *When is the deadline? When do you need this by?*
- *I'll send it **by** 5 p.m. (= not later than 5) I'll be here **until** 5. (= the whole time up to 5)*
- *Could I have an extension until Monday? Sorry, I missed the deadline.*

4. In meetings

You want to...	Say
Give your opinion	I think... / In my opinion...
Agree	I agree. / That's a good point.
Disagree politely	I see your point, but... / I'm not sure about that.
Ask for clarity	Sorry, could you explain that again?
Add something	Can I add something here?

Teacher's tip: With your boss, avoid **"I can't"** and **"It's not possible"** alone. Give a reason and an option: "I'm busy with the audit today, but **I can do it first thing tomorrow**. Is that okay?"

3 Examples

- Could you help me with this Excel sheet, please?
এই এক্সেল শিটটায় একটু সাহায্য করতে পারবেন?
Could you..., please? = safe for everyone.
- Would you mind checking my email before I send it?
পাঠানোর আগে আমার ইমেইলটা একটু দেখে দেবেন?
After would you mind, use verb-ing.
- I've finished the first draft of the proposal.
প্রস্তাবের প্রথম খসড়াটা শেষ করেছি।
I've finished = done now.
- I'm still working on the budget. It'll be ready by tomorrow.
বাজেট নিয়ে এখনও কাজ করছি। কালকের মধ্যে রেডি হবে।
by tomorrow = not later than tomorrow.
- When do you need this by?
এটা কবের মধ্যে লাগবে?
Ask for the deadline clearly.
- I'm running a bit behind. Could I have one more day?
একটু পিছিয়ে আছি। আরেকটা দিন পাওয়া যাবে?
Be honest early, and ask for a new time.
- Sorry to interrupt, but can I add something?
মাঝখানে বলার জন্য দুঃখিত, আমি কি কিছু যোগ করতে পারি?
Polite way to speak in a meeting.
- I see your point, but I think the price is too high.
আপনার কথা বুঝতে পারছি, কিন্তু আমার মনে হয় দামটা বেশি।
Disagree softly with I see your point, but.
- Just a quick update: the client has approved the design.
একটা ছোট আপডেট: ক্লায়েন্ট ডিজাইনটা অনুমোদন করেছেন।
Start updates with Just a quick update.
- Do you have a minute? I'd like to discuss my leave.
একটু সময় হবে? আমার ছুটি নিয়ে কথা বলতে চাই।
A polite way to start talking to the boss.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Do the needful.	Could you please send me the file ?	Old-fashioned. Say exactly what you need.
Would you mind to check it?	Would you mind checking it?	After <i>mind</i> , use verb- ing .
I will submit it within 5 p.m.	I will submit it by 5 p.m.	For a deadline time, use by .
I am doing the report since morning.	I've been doing the report since morning.	With <i>since</i> , use <i>have been</i> + verb-ing.
Sir, I want leave tomorrow.	Sir, could I take a day off tomorrow?	Ask; don't just say "I want".

5 Speak it

Nusrat gives her manager, Mr. Chowdhury, an update.

Nusrat: Good morning, sir. Do you have a minute?

Mr. Chowdhury: Sure, Nusrat. What's up?

Nusrat: Just a quick update on the Sylhet project. I've finished the cost sheet, and I've sent it to you.

Mr. Chowdhury: Great. And the client presentation?

Nusrat: I'm still working on it. It's about 60% done. I'm waiting for the sales figures from Adiyat.

Mr. Chowdhury: The meeting is on Wednesday. Can you finish it by Tuesday?

Nusrat: I think so, if I get the figures today. Would you mind reminding Adiyat? He's very busy.

Mr. Chowdhury: No problem. I'll talk to him.

Nusrat: Thank you, sir. I'll send you the draft by Tuesday afternoon.

Now try this: Give a 3-sentence update about your own work or study: one thing you've finished, one thing you're working on, and one deadline.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short message to your team leader. Say what you have finished, what you are doing now, and ask for one more day for one task.

Model answer

Hi Sadia apa,
Just a quick update. I've finished the customer list and uploaded it to the shared folder. I'm now working on the monthly sales report. Unfortunately, I'm running a bit behind because the data from the Khulna branch came late. Could I have one more day? I'll send it by Thursday noon.
Thanks,
Hasan

(56 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (by, checking, working, could, finished)

- 23.1** _____ you send me the meeting notes, please?
- 23.2** Would you mind _____ my presentation?
- 23.3** I'm still _____ on the report.
- 23.4** Please submit your forms _____ Sunday.
- 23.5** I've _____ the invoice. It's on your desk.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 23.6** Would you mind to send me the file?
- 23.7** I will finish it within tomorrow.
- 23.8** Sir, I want leave on Thursday.

C. Make sentences

- 23.9** Write a polite way to disagree with a colleague in a meeting.
- 23.10** Write one sentence to tell your boss you need more time for a task. Give a reason.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Ask with **Could you..., please?** or **Would you mind + verb-ing?**
- Updates: **I've finished..., I'm working on..., I'm running a bit behind.**
- Deadlines use **by**: *by Friday, by 5 p.m.*
- In meetings, disagree softly: **I see your point, but...**
- With the boss, give a reason and an option, not just "no".

Chapter 24

Health, Doctor and Emergencies

1 Why this matters

When you are sick or in danger, you need to explain the problem **fast and clearly**. Many doctors, hospital forms and medicine labels use English. A few body words, symptom phrases and emergency sentences can save time, and sometimes a life.

অসুস্থ বা বিপদে পড়লে সমস্যাটা দ্রুত ও পরিষ্কারভাবে বলতে পারা খুব জরুরি।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Body words you need most

head মাথা	throat গলা	chest বুক	stomach পেট
back পিঠ	tooth/teeth দাঁত	ear কান	eye চোখ
arm বাহু	leg পা	knee হাঁটু	skin চামড়া

2. Saying what is wrong

I have a + problem: *I have a **headache / fever / cough / cold / sore throat**.*

My + body part + **hurts**: *My **back** hurts. My **knee** hurts.*

I feel + adjective: *I feel **dizzy / weak / sick**.*

How long: *I've had it **for** three days. / **since** Monday.*

Word	Meaning	Bangla
fever	High body temperature	জ্বর
cough / cold	Coughing / runny nose	কাশি / সর্দি
diarrhoea	Loose, watery stool	ডায়রিয়া / পাতলা পায়খানা
vomiting / I threw up.	Food coming out of the mouth	বমি
dizzy	The room seems to spin	মাথা ঘোরা
allergic to	Your body reacts badly to something	অ্যালার্জি আছে

3. At the doctor and the pharmacy

The doctor may ask	You may ask
What seems to be the problem?	Is it serious?
How long have you had this?	Do I need any tests?
Are you taking any medicine?	How many times a day should I take it?
Are you allergic to anything?	Before or after meals?
Let me check your blood pressure.	When should I come back?

At the pharmacy: *Do you have something for a cough? / Can I get this medicine without a prescription? / Does it make you sleepy?*

4. Emergencies: call 999

In Bangladesh, **999** is the free national emergency number for **police, fire service and ambulance**. When you call, say **what**, **where** and **who**:

What: There's been a road accident. / There's a fire. / A man has fainted.
Where: We are on Mirpur Road, near Science Lab, opposite the petrol pump.
Who: One person is badly hurt and bleeding. He is not moving.
Then: My name is Karim. My number is 01711-112233. Please hurry!

Short shouts: *Help! / Call an ambulance! / Call the police! / Fire! / Stop! / Is anyone hurt?*

Teacher's tip: Give the **landmark** first, then the road. Speak slowly and stay on the line. For health advice (not emergencies) you can also call **16263**, the government health helpline.

3 Examples

1. I've had a fever and a headache since Tuesday.

মঙ্গলবার থেকে আমার জ্বর আর মাথাব্যথা।

since + day.

2. My stomach hurts after I eat.

খাওয়ার পর আমার পেট ব্যথা করে।

My + body part + hurts.

3. I feel dizzy and weak.

আমার মাথা ঘুরছে আর দুর্বল লাগছে।

I feel + adjective.

4. I'm allergic to penicillin.

আমার পেনিসিলিনে অ্যালার্জি আছে।

Always tell the doctor about allergies.

5. Take one tablet three times a day after meals.

দিনে তিনবার খাওয়ার পর একটা করে ট্যাবলেট খাবেন।

Typical doctor's instruction.

6. Do you have something for a sore throat?

গলা ব্যথার জন্য কিছু আছে?

Useful at any pharmacy.

7. My son has had diarrhoea for two days.

আমার ছেলের দুই দিন ধরে পাতলা পায়খানা হচ্ছে।

*for + length of time.***8. Please call an ambulance! He can't breathe.**

অ্যাম্বুলেন্স ডাকুন! উনি শ্বাস নিতে পারছেন না।

*Short and urgent.***9. There's a fire in our building in Dhanmondi.**

ধানমন্ডিতে আমাদের বিল্ডিংয়ে আগুন লেগেছে।

*Say what + where.***10. Someone stole my bag. I need to report it.**

কেউ আমার ব্যাগ চুরি করেছে। আমি রিপোর্ট করতে চাই।

For the police.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I am feeling headache.	I have a headache.	We have an illness. We feel sick/tired.
My head is paining.	My head hurts . / I have a headache.	"Paining" is not natural English.
I have fever from two days.	I've had a fever for two days.	Use for + time, and <i>I've had</i> .
I have allergy of dust.	I'm allergic to dust.	The phrase is allergic to .
Doctor, give me medicine.	Could you prescribe something for this?	Ask politely, don't order.

5 Speak it

Adiyat visits a doctor at a clinic in Chattogram.

Doctor: Good evening. Please sit down. What seems to be the problem?**Adiyat:** I've had a bad cough and a sore throat for four days, doctor.**Doctor:** Any fever?**Adiyat:** Yes, a little, mostly at night. And I feel very tired.**Doctor:** Are you taking any medicine now?**Adiyat:** Only paracetamol. Oh, and I'm allergic to some antibiotics.**Doctor:** Good that you told me. Let me check your throat... It looks infected. I'll give you a safe medicine.**Adiyat:** How many times a day should I take it?**Doctor:** Twice a day, after meals, for five days. Drink lots of warm water.**Adiyat:** Is it serious?**Doctor:** No, don't worry. Come back if the fever goes up.**Now try this:** Practise a 999 call. Say *what* happened, *where* you are (with a landmark), and *who* is hurt.

6 Write it

Task: You are sick and can't go to the office. Write a short message to your manager explaining your symptoms.

Model answer

Good morning, sir. I'm sorry, but I can't come to the office today. I've had a high fever and a bad headache since last night, and I feel very weak. I'm going to see a doctor this morning. I'll keep you updated and check my email if I can. Thank you for understanding.
Farhana

(54 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (hurts, allergic, for, since, have)

- 24.1 I _____ a terrible toothache.
24.2 My left knee _____ when I walk.
24.3 I've had this cough _____ a week.
24.4 She has had a fever _____ Friday.
24.5 Are you _____ to any food?

B. Correct the mistakes

- 24.6 My stomach is paining since morning.
24.7 I am feeling fever.
24.8 I have allergy of prawns.

C. Make sentences

- 24.9 Write two questions to ask a doctor about your medicine.
24.10 You see a road accident near Farmgate. Write what you would say when you call 999.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **I have a** headache/fever/cough. **My** back **hurts**. **I feel** dizzy.
- Time: **for** three days, **since** Monday, with *I've had*.
- Always tell the doctor: **I'm allergic to...**
- In Bangladesh, call **999** for police, fire or ambulance.
- On an emergency call, say **what, where** (landmark) and **who**.

Chapter 25

Thanking, Apologizing, Inviting, Accepting and Refusing

1 Why this matters

"Thank you", "Sorry" and "Would you like to come?" are the small words that build good relationships. The right phrase at the right **level of politeness** makes you sound kind and confident. And knowing how to say **no nicely** is just as important as saying yes.

ঠিক জায়গায় ঠিক ভদ্রতার শব্দ সম্পর্ক ভালো রাখে; আর সুন্দর করে "না" বলতে পারাও খুব জরুরি।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Thanking and replying

Level	Thanking	Replying
Casual	Thanks! / Thanks a lot!	No problem. / Anytime.
Polite	Thank you so much. That's very kind of you.	You're welcome. / My pleasure.
Formal	I really appreciate your help. / Thank you for your time.	It was my pleasure. / Glad I could help.

Thank you for + noun / verb-ing: *Thank you for **the gift**. Thank you for **helping** me.*

2. Apologizing and replying

Level	Apologizing	Replying
Small	Sorry! / Oops, my bad.	No worries. / It's okay.
Medium	I'm so sorry I'm late.	Don't worry about it.
Serious / formal	I apologize for the mistake. It won't happen again.	I understand. / Apology accepted.

A good apology has **three parts: Sorry + reason + fix**. *I'm sorry I missed your call. I was in a meeting. I'll call you back in ten minutes.*

3. Inviting

Casual	Polite / formal
Want to grab a coffee?	Would you like to join us for dinner on Friday?
Come to my place on Saturday!	We'd be happy if you could come to our daughter's birthday.
How about a movie tonight?	I'd like to invite you to our office Iftar party.

4. Accepting and refusing

Accepting	Refusing kindly
Sure, I'd love to!	I'd love to, but I'm busy that day.
That sounds great. What time?	Thanks for asking, but I can't make it.
Thank you, I'd be happy to come.	I'm afraid I have another plan. Maybe next time?

Kind refusal = thanks / positive word + but + reason + another time

Thanks so much for inviting me! I'd love to come, but I have my cousin's wedding in Sylhet that day. Can we meet next week?

Teacher's tip: A plain **"No"** or **"I can't"** sounds rude in English. Always add a reason and a warm line. Also, in English we say **thank you** much more than in Bangla, even to waiters, drivers and family. Use it often!

3 Examples

- Thank you for helping me with the shifting.
বাসা বদলাতে সাহায্য করার জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
Thank you for + verb-ing.
- That's very kind of you.
আপনি খুব দয়ালু।
Say this when someone does something nice.
- I really appreciate your support.
আপনার সহযোগিতার জন্য সত্যিই কৃতজ্ঞ।
Formal; good for emails and bosses.
- I'm so sorry I'm late. The traffic was terrible.
দেরি হওয়ার জন্য খুব দুঃখিত। জামটা ভয়াবহ ছিল।
Sorry + reason.
- I apologize for the delay. I'll send it today.
দেরির জন্য ক্ষমা চাইছি। আজই পাঠিয়ে দেব।
Formal: sorry + fix.
- Would you like to come to my sister's wedding?
আমার বোনের বিয়েতে আসবে?
Would you like to...? = polite invitation.

7. How about lunch at Dhanmondi on Friday?

শুক্রবার ধানমন্ডিতে লাঞ্চ করলে কেমন হয়?

Casual invitation.

8. Sure, I'd love to! What time should I come?

অবশ্যই, খুব ভালো লাগবে! কয়টায় আসব?

Accept + ask for details.

9. I'd love to, but I have an exam the next day.

আসতে পারলে ভালো লাগত, কিন্তু পরদিন আমার পরীক্ষা।

Refuse with *I'd love to, but...***10. Thanks for asking. Maybe next time?**

জিজ্ঞেস করার জন্য ধন্যবাদ। পরের বার হবে?

End a refusal warmly.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Thank you for help me.	Thank you for helping me.	After <i>for</i> , use verb- ing or a noun.
Most welcome.	You're welcome.	"Most welcome" is not used by native speakers.
Sorry for late.	Sorry I'm late . / Sorry for being late.	<i>Late</i> is an adjective; it needs <i>I'm</i> or <i>being</i> .
You are invited to come my home.	Would you like to come to my home?	Add to , and a question sounds warmer.
No, I will not come.	I'd love to, but I can't make it.	A flat "no" sounds rude. Add thanks and a reason.

5 Speak it

Sadia invites her colleagues to her new flat.

Sadia: Hey, Rahim! We're having a small dinner at our new flat on Friday. Would you like to come?**Rahim:** Oh, congratulations on the new place! Sure, I'd love to. What time?**Sadia:** Around 8. I'll send you the location on WhatsApp.**Rahim:** Great. Can I bring anything?**Sadia:** No, just yourself! ... Mitu, are you free on Friday too?**Mitu:** Thank you so much for asking, Sadia. I'd really love to come, but my parents are coming from Rajshahi that evening.**Sadia:** Oh, no problem. Another time, then.**Mitu:** Definitely! And sorry again. Let's have lunch next week.**Sadia:** Deal!**Notice:** Mitu refuses with **thanks + I'd love to, but + reason + another plan**. Nobody feels bad.**Now try this:** A friend invites you to a cricket match on Saturday. Accept once, then refuse once with a reason.

6 Write it

Task: Your colleague invited you to his wedding reception, but you will be out of town. Write a short, kind message to refuse.

Model answer

Dear Karim bhai,
Thank you so much for inviting me to your wedding reception. I'm really happy for you both! Unfortunately, I'll be in Cox's Bazar for an office training that week, so I can't make it. I'm very sorry to miss it. Wishing you a lifetime of happiness. Let's celebrate together when I'm back!
Best wishes,
Tania

(58 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (welcome, inviting, apologize, love, kind)

- 25.1** Thank you for _____ me to the party.
- 25.2** A: Thanks for the help! B: You're _____.
- 25.3** I _____ for the mistake in the report.
- 25.4** I'd _____ to come, but I'm working that day.
- 25.5** You brought me lunch? That's very _____ of you.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 25.6** Thank you for help me yesterday.
- 25.7** Sorry for late, sir.
- 25.8** A: Thank you! B: Most welcome.

C. Make sentences

- 25.9** Invite a friend to have *fuchka* with you this evening (casual).
- 25.10** Refuse a dinner invitation from your boss kindly. Give a reason.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Choose the level: **Thanks!** (casual) → **I really appreciate it** (formal).
- **Thank you for / Sorry for** + noun or verb-**ing**.
- A good apology = **sorry + reason + fix**.
- Invite with **Would you like to...?** Accept with **I'd love to!**
- Refuse kindly: **thanks + I'd love to, but + reason + maybe next time**.

Chapter 26

Giving Opinions, Agreeing and Disagreeing

1 Why this matters

Every day people ask what you think: in class, in a meeting, in a job interview, even at the tea stall. If you only say “Yes” or “No”, you sound unsure or rude. A few **ready phrases** help you share your view, agree warmly and disagree **politely**. IELTS Speaking also asks for your opinion with a reason.

মতামত দেওয়া, একমত হওয়া আর ভদ্রভাবে দ্বিমত করার জন্য কয়েকটা তৈরি বাক্যই যথেষ্ট।

2 The rule in plain words

You don't need grammar theory here. You need **phrases you can say without thinking**. Learn one or two from each table.

1. Giving your opinion

Phrase	Example	Level
I think...	I think the traffic is getting worse.	everyday
I don't think...	I don't think it will rain today.	everyday
In my opinion,...	In my opinion, online classes are useful.	a bit formal
I feel (that)...	I feel the price is too high.	soft
I believe...	I believe hard work pays off.	strong
If you ask me,...	If you ask me, the movie was boring.	friendly
Personally,...	Personally, I prefer tea to coffee.	everyday

2. Asking for someone's opinion

What do you think? What's your opinion? How do you feel about...? Do you agree?

3. Agreeing

Strong agreement	Partial agreement
I totally agree.	I agree up to a point.
Exactly! / Absolutely!	That's true, but...
That's right.	Maybe, but...
You're absolutely right.	I see what you mean, but...
Me too. / Me neither.	I partly agree.

4. Disagreeing: from soft to strong

Level	Phrase	Use it with
1 (softest)	I see your point, but...	boss, teacher, client, elders
2	I'm not sure about that.	almost anyone
3	I'm afraid I don't agree.	meetings, formal talk
4	I don't think so. / I disagree.	friends, colleagues
5 (strong)	No way! / That's not true at all.	close friends only

5. Always give a reason

Opinion + because / as / since + reason (+ For example,...)

*I think Dhaka needs more metro lines **because** the roads are always jammed.*

Teacher's tip: In Bangla we often say না, এটা ঠিক না directly. In English, a direct "No, you are wrong" sounds rude, especially at work. Start with something positive first: *"That's a good point, but..."*

Teacher's tip: Answer with **So do I / Neither do I** to agree quickly. *"I love fuchka."* - *"So do I!"* *"I don't like rain."* - *"Neither do I."*

3 Examples

- I think we should leave early because of the traffic.
আমার মনে হয় যানজটের কারণে আমাদের তাড়াতাড়ি বের হওয়া উচিত।
opinion + because + reason
- In my opinion, Cox's Bazar is the best place for a holiday.
আমার মতে, ছুটি কাটানোর জন্য কক্সবাজারই সেরা জায়গা।
a little formal: good for exams and interviews
- I don't think this phone is worth Tk 40,000.
আমার মনে হয় না এই ফোনটির দাম ৪০,০০০ টাকা হওয়া উচিত।
say I don't think it is, not I think it isn't
- What do you think about the new office timing?
অফিসের নতুন সময় নিয়ে তোমার কী মনে হয়?
asking for an opinion
- You're absolutely right. The meeting was too long.
তুমি একদম ঠিক বলেছ। মিটিংটা অনেক লম্বা ছিল।
strong agreement
- That's true, but online shopping is not always cheaper.
কথাটা সত্যি, তবে অনলাইনে কেনাকাটা সবসময় সস্তা না।
partial agreement
- I see your point, sir, but the client wants it by Sunday.
স্যার, আপনার কথা বুঝতে পারছি, কিন্তু ক্লায়েন্ট রবিবারের মধ্যে চায়।
soft disagreement with a boss

8. I'm afraid I don't agree with that plan.

দুঃখিত, আমি ওই পরিকল্পনার সাথে একমত নই।

polite and clear

9. I'm not sure about that. Can you explain a bit more?

এ ব্যাপারে আমি নিশ্চিত নই। আরেকটু বুঝিয়ে বলবে?

soft way to say no and keep talking

10. Personally, I prefer the bus because the CNG is too expensive.

ব্যক্তিগতভাবে আমি বাস পছন্দ করি, কারণ সিএনজি অনেক দামি।

personal choice + reason

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I am agree with you.	I agree with you.	Agree is a verb. Don't add <i>am</i> .
According to me, it's good.	In my opinion , it's good.	<i>According to</i> is for other people or sources (<i>according to the news</i>), not for yourself.
I think it is not true.	I don't think it is true.	English puts the <i>not</i> on <i>think</i> . It sounds more natural.
No, you are wrong.	I see your point, but...	Too direct. Soften it, especially at work.
Me also.	Me too. / So do I.	<i>Me also</i> is not natural in spoken English.

5 Speak it

Read aloud. Three colleagues in a Gulshan office are planning the team picnic.

Mr. Chowdhury: So, where should we go for the picnic? What do you think, Sadia?**Sadia:** I think Sylhet is a good choice because it's green and peaceful.**Adiyat:** I see your point, but it's a long trip. In my opinion, a resort near Gazipur is better.**Sadia:** That's true. We can't waste a whole day on the bus.**Mr. Chowdhury:** I agree with Adiyat. Gazipur is close and cheaper.**Adiyat:** Exactly! And we can come back the same evening.**Sadia:** Okay, I'm convinced. Gazipur it is!**Now try this:** Your friend says, "*Facebook is a waste of time.*" Answer three ways: (1) agree strongly, (2) agree partly, (3) disagree politely. Give a reason each time.

6 Write it

Task: "Should students use mobile phones in class?" Write 4-5 sentences. Give your opinion, one reason, one example, and politely mention the other side.**Model answer**

In my opinion, students should not use mobile phones in class. I think phones take their attention away from the teacher. For example, many students check Facebook during lectures and miss important points. I see why some people want phones for quick searches, but a short break is a better time for that.

(53 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks with a suitable phrase

26.1 _____ my opinion, English is very important for jobs.

26.2 "I don't like spicy food." - "_____ do I."

26.3 I see your _____, but I think we need more time.

26.4 I want to work from home _____ the traffic is terrible.

B. Correct the mistakes

26.5 I am agree with your idea.

26.6 According to me, the price is too high.

26.7 I think he is not coming today.

C. Make it polite

26.8 Your boss says, "We should finish the report tonight." You disagree. Write a polite answer.

D. Give your opinion with a reason

26.9 Is Dhaka a good city to live in?

26.10 Which is better for students: a laptop or a smartphone?

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Start an opinion with **I think**, **In my opinion** or **Personally**.
- Always add a reason with **because**, and an example if you can.
- Say **I agree** (not *I am agree*) and **So do I / Neither do I** to agree fast.
- Disagree softly: **I see your point, but...** or **I'm not sure about that**.
- Keep strong phrases like *No way!* for close friends only.

Chapter 27

Filler Phrases: Keeping the Conversation Going

1 Why this matters

Even native speakers stop to think. The difference is that they **fill the silence** with small phrases like *Well...* or *Let me think...* If you know these phrases, you will never freeze, you will sound natural, and you can handle words you don't know. They are also very useful in IELTS Speaking and job interviews.

কথা বলার মাঝে থেমে গেলে কিছু ছোট বাক্য ব্যবহার করলে কথা চালিয়ে যাওয়া সহজ হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

Think of these phrases as **tools**. Each one has a job. Pick one or two from each group and practise them until they come out automatically.

Job	Phrases	Bangla idea
Buying time to think	Well... / Let me think... / Let me see... / That's a good question. / Hmm, how can I put it...	একটু ভেবে বলি...
Making your meaning clear	What I mean is... / I mean... / In other words... / Basically...	আমি বোঝাতে চাইছি...
Asking for repetition	Sorry? / Pardon? / Could you say that again, please? / Could you speak a bit more slowly?	আবার বলবেন?
Checking you understood	So you mean...? / Do you mean...? / If I understand correctly...	মানে আপনি বলছেন...?
Checking they understood	Does that make sense? / Do you know what I mean? / Is that clear?	বোঝাতে পেরেছি?
Showing interest	Really? / That's great! / Oh, nice! / Oh no! / I see. / Seriously?	তাই নাকি? দারুণ!
Going back to the topic	Anyway... / So, as I was saying...	যাই হোক...

When you don't know a word: explain it

Don't stop! Describe the thing with one of these patterns.

It's a kind of + thing...	<i>It's a kind of sweet, made with milk. (roshogolla)</i>
It's something you use to + verb...	<i>It's something you use to cut vegetables. (boti)</i>
It's a person who + verb...	<i>It's a person who repairs pipes. (plumber)</i>
It's a place where + sentence...	<i>It's a place where you buy medicine. (pharmacy)</i>
It's like + thing, but ...	<i>It's like a bus, but smaller. (minibus)</i>
What do you call it...?	<i>What do you call the thing that cools a room?</i>

Teacher's tip: Don't fill every silence with "umm" or "actually". Bangladeshi speakers often say *actually* in every sentence. Use **Well...** or **Let me think...** instead. They sound calm and confident.

Teacher's tip: "Pardon?" and "Sorry?" with a rising voice are polite. "What?" alone can sound rude, especially to elders or a boss.

3 Examples

- Well, let me think... I usually get up at seven.
আচ্ছা, একটু ভেবে বলি... আমি সাধারণত সাতটায় উঠি।
buying time before answering
- That's a good question. I've never thought about it.
ভালো প্রশ্ন। আমি এটা নিয়ে কখনো ভাবিনি।
great for interviews
- Sorry, could you say that again, please?
দুঃখিত, আবার একটু বলবেন?
polite request for repetition
- Could you speak a bit more slowly? The line is not clear.
একটু আস্তে বলবেন? লাইনটা পরিষ্কার না।
useful on the phone
- So you mean the meeting is on Monday, not Sunday?
মানে মিটিংটা রবিবার না, সোমবার?
checking your understanding
- What I mean is, I need more time to finish it.
আমি বলতে চাইছি, এটা শেষ করতে আমার আরও সময় লাগবে।
making your idea clear
- Really? You got the job? That's great!
সত্যি? তুমি চাকরিটা পেয়েছ? দারুণ!
showing interest and happiness
- It's a kind of rice dish, cooked with meat and spices.
এটা এক ধরনের ভাতের খাবার, মাংস আর মসলা দিয়ে রান্না করা।
explaining biryani to a foreigner
- It's something you use to dry your hair.
এটা চুল শুকানোর জন্য ব্যবহার করা হয়।
you forgot the word hair dryer

10. Anyway, as I was saying, the bus was very late.

যাই হোক, যা বলছিলাম, বাসটা অনেক দেরিতে এসেছিল।

coming back to your story

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
What? What?	Sorry? Could you say that again?	<i>What?</i> alone sounds rude.
Actually, actually I am...	Well, I am...	Too much <i>actually</i> . It means "in fact", not a filler.
Please repeat again.	Could you repeat that, please?	<i>Repeat</i> already means "say again".
I am not understanding.	I don't understand. / I didn't get that.	<i>Understand</i> is not used in the <i>-ing</i> form here.
How to say...	How can I say it... / What's the word...	A full question sounds natural.

5 Speak it

Read aloud. Tania meets a foreign visitor, Emma, at a Dhanmondi cafe.

Emma: What's your favourite Bangladeshi food?

Tania: Hmm, let me think... I love *pitha*.

Emma: Sorry? Could you say that again?

Tania: *Pitha*. It's a kind of cake, made from rice flour. We eat it in winter.

Emma: Really? That sounds lovely. Is it sweet?

Tania: Usually, yes. Some have ... how can I say it... palm sugar inside. Does that make sense?

Emma: Yes, I see. I'd love to try it!

Tania: That's great! Anyway, my mother makes the best ones. You must come home.

Now try this: Explain these to a foreign friend **without** using the word: *rickshaw*, *mosquito net*, *tea stall*. Start with *It's a kind of...* or *It's something you use to...*

6 Write it

Task: Write a short WhatsApp chat (4-6 lines) where you ask a friend to repeat something, check your understanding, and show interest.

Model answer

Hasan: Bro, the exam is moved to next week.

Me: Sorry? Which exam?

Hasan: The accounting final.

Me: So you mean we have seven more days?

Hasan: Exactly. Thursday, 10 am.

Me: Really? That's great! I need more time to study.

(35 words)

7 Exercises

A. Choose the best phrase for each situation

- 27.1** You didn't hear your boss on the phone. (What? / Sorry, could you say that again?)
- 27.2** Your friend says, "I passed my driving test!" (I see. / Really? That's great!)
- 27.3** An interviewer asks a hard question and you need a few seconds. (That's a good question. / I don't know.)
- 27.4** You want to check that your listener understood you. (Does that make sense? / You understand?)

B. Correct the mistakes

- 27.5** Please repeat again.
- 27.6** I am not understanding your point.
- 27.7** Sorry, can you speak more slow?

C. Explain the word without saying it

- 27.8** a doctor
- 27.9** an umbrella
- 27.10** a bank

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Buy time with **Well...**, **Let me think...** or **That's a good question.**
- Ask politely: **Sorry? Could you say that again, please?** Never just *What?*
- Check meaning: **So you mean...?** and **Does that make sense?**
- Show interest: **Really? That's great! Oh no!**
- Forgot a word? Say **It's a kind of...**, **It's something you use to...**, **It's a place where...**

Chapter 28

100 Most Useful Everyday Sentences

1 Why this matters

You don't need thousands of sentences to speak English every day. A small set of **ready-made sentences** covers most real situations: greeting people, talking on the phone, buying things, taking a CNG, seeing a doctor, texting a friend. Learn these 100 by heart and you will always have something correct to say.

প্রতিদিনের বেশিরভাগ কথাবার্তা এই ১০০টি বাক্য দিয়েই চালানো যায়। এগুলো মুখস্থ করে ফেলুন।

2 The rule in plain words

There is no grammar rule to learn here. The "rule" is simple: **learn whole sentences, not single words**. The sentences below are grouped by situation. Each group has 10 sentences.

How to learn them: read aloud → cover the English → say it from the Bangla → use it today

10 sentences a day → all 100 in **10 days**

Teacher's tip: Many sentences start with the same few "starters". Learn these and you can make hundreds more: **Can I...?** (ask permission) **Could you...?** (polite request) **I'll...** (promise/plan) **I'm...** (how you feel) **Let's...** (suggestion)

1. Greetings and small talk

No.	English	Bangla
1	Good morning! How are you?	সুপ্রভাত! কেমন আছেন?
2	I'm fine, thanks. And you?	আমি ভালো আছি, ধন্যবাদ। আপনি?
3	Nice to meet you.	আপনার সাথে পরিচিত হয়ে ভালো লাগল।
4	Long time no see!	অনেক দিন দেখা নেই!
5	What's new with you?	নতুন কী খবর?
6	Where are you from?	আপনার বাড়ি কোথায়?
7	I'm from Sylhet, but I live in Dhaka.	আমার বাড়ি সিলেটে, কিন্তু আমি ঢাকায় থাকি।
8	What do you do?	আপনি কী করেন?
9	See you later.	পরে দেখা হবে।
10	Take care.	ভালো থেকো।

2. At home

No.	English	Bangla
11	I'm going out. I'll be back soon.	আমি বাইরে যাচ্ছি। তাড়াতাড়ি ফিরব।
12	Is dinner ready?	রাতের খাবার কি তৈরি?
13	Can you turn off the fan, please?	ফ্যানটা একটু বন্ধ করে দেবে?
14	The electricity has gone again.	আবার কারেন্ট চলে গেছে।
15	Who's at the door?	দরজায় কে?
16	Please lock the door when you leave.	যাওয়ার সময় দরজায় তালা দিয়ে যেও।
17	Where did you keep my keys?	আমার চাবি কোথায় রেখেছ?
18	I'm tired. I'm going to bed.	আমি ক্লান্ত। ঘুমাতে যাচ্ছি।
19	Please wake me up at six.	আমাকে ছয়টায় ডেকে দিও।
20	Don't forget to take your umbrella.	ছাতা নিতে ভুলো না।

3. On the phone

No.	English	Bangla
21	Hello, who's speaking?	হ্যালো, কে বলছেন?
22	Can I speak to Mr. Chowdhury, please?	মিস্টার চৌধুরীর সাথে কি একটু কথা বলা যাবে?
23	Please hold on a minute.	একটু লাইনে থাকুন।
24	Sorry, I can't hear you. The network is bad.	দুঃখিত, শুনতে পাচ্ছি না। নেটওয়ার্ক খারাপ।
25	Can I call you back later?	আমি কি পরে আপনাকে কল ব্যাক করতে পারি?
26	Sorry, I missed your call.	দুঃখিত, আপনার কলটা ধরতে পারিনি।
27	He's not here right now. Can I take a message?	উনি এখন এখানে নেই। কোনো মেসেজ রাখব?
28	My phone's battery is almost dead.	আমার ফোনের চার্জ প্রায় শেষ।
29	Please send me your number.	আপনার নম্বরটা পাঠিয়ে দিন।
30	Thanks for calling.	ফোন করার জন্য ধন্যবাদ।

4. At work and study

No.	English	Bangla
31	I'm running a little late.	আমার একটু দেরি হচ্ছে।
32	What time is the meeting?	মিটিং কয়টায়?
33	Could you help me with this?	এটাতে আমাকে একটু সাহায্য করবেন?
34	I'll send it by email today.	আজই ইমেইলে পাঠিয়ে দেব।
35	I've finished the report.	আমি রিপোর্টটা শেষ করেছি।
36	Can I take a day off tomorrow?	কাল কি একদিন ছুটি নিতে পারি?
37	I'm not sure. Let me check.	আমি নিশ্চিত না। দেখে বলছি।
38	What's the deadline?	জমা দেওয়ার শেষ সময় কবে?
39	Sorry, I didn't get that. Could you explain again?	দুঃখিত, বুঝিনি। আবার একটু বুঝিয়ে বলবেন?
40	Good job! Keep it up.	খুব ভালো করেছ! এভাবেই চালিয়ে যাও।

5. Shopping and money

No.	English	Bangla
41	How much is this?	এটার দাম কত?
42	It's too expensive. Can you give me a discount?	অনেক দাম। একটু কম রাখা যায়?
43	Do you have this in a bigger size?	এটা কি আরও বড় সাইজে আছে?
44	Can I try it on?	এটা কি পরে দেখতে পারি?
45	I'm just looking, thanks.	শুধু দেখছি, ধন্যবাদ।
46	Can I pay by bKash?	বিকাশে কি পেমেন্ট করা যাবে?
47	Do you have change for 500?	৫০০ টাকার ভাংতি হবে?
48	Please give me a receipt.	একটা রসিদ দিন।
49	I'll take this one.	আমি এটা নেব।
50	Can I return it if it doesn't fit?	মাপে না হলে কি ফেরত দেওয়া যাবে?

6. Food and eating out

No.	English	Bangla
51	I'm hungry. Let's eat something.	আমার খিদে পেয়েছে। চলো কিছু খাই।
52	Can I see the menu, please?	মেনুটা একটু দেখতে পারি?
53	What do you recommend?	আপনি কোনটা খেতে বলবেন?
54	One plate of biryani, please.	এক প্লেট বিরিয়ানি দিন।
55	Not too spicy, please.	বেশি ঝাল দেবেন না, প্লিজ।
56	Could I have a glass of water?	এক গ্লাস পানি দেবেন?
57	The food is delicious.	খাবারটা খুব মজার।
58	Can we have the bill, please?	বিলটা দিন, প্লিজ।
59	It's my treat today.	আজ আমি খাওয়াচ্ছি।
60	I'm full. I can't eat any more.	পেট ভরে গেছে। আর খেতে পারব না।

7. Travel and directions

No.	English	Bangla
61	Excuse me, how do I get to Mirpur 10?	মাফ করবেন, মিরপুর ১০ কীভাবে যাব?
62	Is it far from here?	এখান থেকে কি অনেক দূর?
63	Will you go to Dhanmondi?	মামা, ধানমন্ডি যাবেন?
64	How much is the fare?	ভাড়া কত?
65	Please stop here.	এখানে থামুন।
66	Which bus goes to Gulshan?	কোন বাস গুলশান যায়?
67	What time does the train leave?	ট্রেন কয়টায় ছাড়বে?
68	I'd like a ticket to Chattogram, please.	চট্টগ্রামের একটা টিকিট দিন।
69	The traffic is terrible today.	আজ ভয়ংকর জ্যাম।

No.	English	Bangla
70	I'm stuck in traffic. I'll be late.	আমি জ্যামে আটকে আছি। দেরি হবে।

8. Health

No.	English	Bangla
71	I don't feel well.	আমার শরীরটা ভালো লাগছে না।
72	I have a headache.	আমার মাথা ব্যথা করছে।
73	I've had a fever since yesterday.	গতকাল থেকে আমার জ্বর।
74	I need to see a doctor.	আমার ডাক্তার দেখানো দরকার।
75	Where is the nearest pharmacy?	সবচেয়ে কাছের ফার্মেসি কোথায়?
76	How many times a day should I take this medicine?	এই ওষুধটা দিনে কয়বার খাব?
77	I'm allergic to dust.	আমার ধূলায় অ্যালার্জি আছে।
78	Get well soon!	তড়াতাড়ি সুস্থ হয়ে ওঠো!
79	Take rest and drink plenty of water.	বিশ্রাম নাও আর বেশি করে পানি খাও।
80	I feel much better now.	এখন অনেক ভালো লাগছে।

9. Feelings and reactions

No.	English	Bangla
81	I'm so happy for you!	তোমার জন্য আমি খুব খুশি!
82	Congratulations!	অভিনন্দন!
83	I'm really sorry.	আমি সত্যিই দুঃখিত।
84	Don't worry. Everything will be fine.	চিন্তা করো না। সব ঠিক হয়ে যাবে।
85	I'm a bit nervous about the interview.	ইন্টারভিউ নিয়ে একটু নার্ভাস লাগছে।
86	That's a great idea!	দারুণ আইডিয়া!
87	I'm bored.	আমার একঘেয়ে লাগছে।
88	Thank you so much for your help.	সাহায্যের জন্য অনেক ধন্যবাদ।
89	You're welcome.	কোনো ব্যাপার না।
90	I miss you.	তোমার কথা খুব মনে পড়ছে।

10. Social media and messages

No.	English	Bangla
91	I'll text you later.	পরে তোমাকে মেসেজ দেব।
92	Did you see my message?	আমার মেসেজটা দেখেছ?
93	Sorry for the late reply.	দেরিতে উত্তর দেওয়ার জন্য দুঃখিত।
94	Send me the photos on WhatsApp.	ছবিগুলো হোয়াটসঅ্যাপে পাঠিয়ে দাও।
95	Happy birthday! Have a wonderful day.	শুভ জন্মদিন! দিনটা দারুণ কাটুক।

No.	English	Bangla
96	Can you share the link?	লিংকটা শেয়ার করবে?
97	I'm online now. Call me.	এখন অনলাইনে আছি। কল দাও।
98	Please add me to the group.	আমাকে গ্রুপে অ্যাড করে দাও।
99	Let me know when you reach home.	বাসায় পৌঁছে আমাকে জানিও।
100	Talk to you soon.	শীঘ্রই কথা হবে।

Teacher's tip: Say **please** and **thank you** more than you think you need to. In English, a request without *please* or *Could you...*? can sound like an order, even when you don't mean it.

3 Examples

All 100 example sentences are in the tables above. Here are the **10 you will use most**. Learn these first.

1. Sorry, I didn't get that. Could you explain again?

দুঃখিত, বুঝিনি। আবার একটু বুঝিয়ে বলবেন?

No. 39: *use it at work, in class, anywhere*

2. Can I call you back later?

আমি কি পরে আপনাকে কল ব্যাক করতে পারি?

No. 25: *Can I...?* = asking permission

3. How much is this?

এটার দাম কত?

No. 41: *not How much price?*

4. Could you help me with this?

এটাতে আমাকে একটু সাহায্য করবেন?

No. 33: *Could you...?* is very polite

5. I'm running a little late.

আমার একটু দেরি হচ্ছে।

No. 31: *send it before you are late, not after*

6. I don't feel well.

আমার শরীরটা ভালো লাগছে না।

No. 71: *a soft way to say you are sick*

7. I'm stuck in traffic. I'll be late.

আমি জ্যামে আটকে আছি। দেরি হবে।

No. 70: *the most Dhaka sentence in this book!*

8. Thank you so much for your help.

সাহায্যের জন্য অনেক ধন্যবাদ।

No. 88: *so much makes it warmer*

9. Sorry for the late reply.

দেরিতে উত্তর দেওয়ার জন্য দুঃখিত।

No. 93: *perfect start for a late message or email*

10. Let me know when you reach home.

বাসায় পৌঁছে আমাদের জানিও।

No. 99: *reach home*, not *reach to home*

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
How much price?	How much is this? / What's the price?	<i>How much</i> already asks about the price.
What is your good name?	What's your name? / May I have your name?	<i>Good name</i> is not used in natural English.
Give me discount.	Can you give me a discount?	Use a question, and don't forget a.
I will reach to home at 9.	I will reach home at 9. / I will get home at 9.	<i>Reach</i> needs no <i>to</i> .
Close the light, please.	Turn off the light, please.	We <i>turn on</i> / <i>turn off</i> lights and fans. We <i>close</i> doors.

5 Speak it

Read aloud. Mitu calls her friend Farhana on a busy evening. How many of the 100 sentences can you find?

Farhana: Hello, who's speaking?

Mitu: It's Mitu! Long time no see! How are you?

Farhana: I'm fine, thanks. And you? Sorry, I missed your call this morning.

Mitu: No problem. I'm at New Market. Do you want anything?

Farhana: Oh, can you buy me a phone cover? Not too expensive.

Mitu: Sure. Sorry, I can't hear you well. The network is bad.

Farhana: I said, *not too expensive*! Send me the photos on WhatsApp.

Mitu: Okay. My phone's battery is almost dead. I'll text you later.

Farhana: Thank you so much! Let me know when you reach home. Take care.

Now try this: Choose one group (for example, *Food and eating out*) and make a 6-line dialogue using at least 5 sentences from it.

6 Write it

Task: Write a WhatsApp message (40-60 words) to your colleague. You are late for work because of traffic, and you need help with something. Use at least four sentences from this chapter.

Model answer

Hi Hasan, sorry for the late reply. I'm stuck in traffic near Farmgate, so I'm running a little late. I'll be there by 10:30. Could you help me with something? Please print the sales report and keep it on my desk. The meeting is at 11. Thank you so much for your help. Talk to you soon!

(57 words)

7 Exercises

A. What do you say? Write the sentence from the chapter

- 28.1** You want to know the price of a shirt.
- 28.2** You want to wear a pair of jeans in the shop before buying.
- 28.3** Your friend has a new job.
- 28.4** The rickshaw is at your gate and you want to get off.
- 28.5** You answer a message three days late.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 28.6** Close the fan, please.
- 28.7** I will reach to office at nine.
- 28.8** How much price is this bag?

C. Translate into English

- 28.9** গতকাল থেকে আমার জ্বর।
- 28.10** আজ আমি খাওয়াছি।

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Learn **whole sentences**, not single words. Start with 10 a day.
- Use the starters **Can I...?**, **Could you...?**, **I'll...**, **I'm...**, **Let's...** to make new sentences.
- Ask politely with **please** and **Could you...?**
- Say **How much is this?**, **turn off the fan** and **reach home** (no to).
- Practise out loud every day until the sentences come out without thinking.

PART III

Basic Writing

Chapter 29

From Words to Sentences to Paragraphs

1 Why this matters

Good writing is built like a house: **words** make **sentences**, and sentences make **paragraphs**. If your sentences are complete and your paragraph has a clear plan, your emails, exam answers and job applications will be easy to read. Readers will understand you the first time.

শব্দ দিয়ে বাক্য, আর বাক্য দিয়ে অনুচ্ছেদ তৈরি হয়। বাক্য পূর্ণ আর অনুচ্ছেদ গোছানো হলে লেখা সহজে বোঝা যায়।

2 The rule in plain words

Step 1: The complete sentence

Complete sentence = Subject + Verb + Complete idea

পূর্ণ বাক্য = কর্তা + ক্রিয়া + পূর্ণ ভাব

- **Subject:** who or what the sentence is about (*Rahim, The bus, She*).
- **Verb:** the action or state (*works, came, is*).
- **Complete idea:** the reader does not wait for more.

Step 2: Two problems to avoid

Problem	What it is	Example → Fix
Fragment	A piece of a sentence. It has no subject, no verb, or no complete idea. অসম্পূর্ণ বাক্য	<i>Because the road was busy. → I was late</i> because the road was busy.
Run-on	Two sentences joined with nothing, or only with a comma. দুটি বাক্য ভুলভাবে জোড়া	<i>I am tired I want to sleep. → I am tired. I want to sleep. / I am tired, so I want to sleep.</i>

Step 3: Joining short sentences

Too many short sentences sound like a robot. Join them with a **linking word**.

Word	Use it to...	Example
and	add an idea	I bought rice, and Mitu bought fish.
but	show a contrast	The phone is old, but it works well.
so	show a result	It was raining, so we took a CNG.
because	give a reason	I stayed home because I was sick.
when	show time	Call me when you reach Mirpur.

Step 4: The paragraph

A paragraph is a group of sentences about **one main idea**. It has three parts:

- 1. Topic sentence** → tells the main idea (first sentence).
- 2. Supporting sentences** → give 2-4 reasons, details or examples.
- 3. Concluding sentence** → closes the paragraph, often repeating the main idea in new words.

মূল বাক্য → সহায়ক বাক্য → উপসংহার বাক্য

Teacher's tip: Before you write, ask: "What is my **one** main idea?" Write it as your topic sentence. Every other sentence must support it. If a sentence talks about something else, cut it.

3 Examples

- Hasan works in a bank.
হাসান একটি ব্যাংকে কাজ করে।
Complete: subject (Hasan) + verb (works) + complete idea.
- Going to the office.
অফিসে যাচ্ছি।
Fragment: no subject. Better: *I am going to the office.*
- When I reached home.
যখন আমি বাসায় পৌঁছলাম।
Fragment: the idea is not finished. Better: *When I reached home, I ate dinner.*
- The shop was closed, I went back home.
দোকান বন্ধ ছিল, আমি বাসায় ফিরে গেলাম।
Run-on (comma only). Better: *The shop was closed, **so** I went back home.*
- Sadia is clever, and she works hard.
সাদিয়া বুদ্ধিমান, এবং সে পরিশ্রমী।
Two short sentences joined with *and*.
- The rickshaw was cheap, but it was slow.
রিকশাটা সস্তা ছিল, কিন্তু ধীর ছিল।
but joins two opposite ideas.
- I missed the bus because I woke up late.
আমি দেরিতে ঘুম থেকে উঠেছিলাম বলে বাস মিস করেছি।
because gives the reason.
- My neighbourhood is a great place to live.

আমার এলাকাটা থাকার জন্য দারুণ জায়গা।

A good topic sentence: one clear main idea.

9. For example, there is a market, a school and a park nearby.

যেমন, কাছেই একটি বাজার, একটি স্কুল আর একটি পার্ক আছে।

A supporting sentence with an example.

10. That is why I never want to move.

এ কারণেই আমি কখনো অন্য জায়গায় যেতে চাই না।

A concluding sentence.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
My father a businessman.	My father is a businessman.	No verb. Bangla can drop it (আমার বাবা ব্যবসায়ী); English can't.
Because I was sick.	I was absent because I was sick.	A <i>because</i> part alone is a fragment. Add the main idea.
I like Dhaka it is busy but exciting.	I like Dhaka. It is busy but exciting.	Run-on. Put a full stop between the two sentences.
I went to the market, I bought vegetables.	I went to the market and bought vegetables.	A comma alone cannot join two sentences. Use <i>and</i> , <i>so</i> , <i>but</i> or a full stop.
Is very hot today.	It is very hot today.	English needs a subject. For weather and time, use <i>it</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Adiyat is helping his younger sister Mitu with her homework.

Mitu: Bhaiya, my teacher says my paragraph is a big mess.

Adiyat: Let me see. Hmm, your first sentence is "Because I love cricket." That's not complete.

Mitu: Why not? It has a verb.

Adiyat: Yes, but the idea isn't finished. Start with your main idea: "Cricket is my favourite sport."

Mitu: Okay. Then I write my reasons?

Adiyat: Exactly. Give two or three reasons, and finish with a closing sentence.

Mitu: That sounds easy. Thanks, Bhaiya!

Now try this: Say your own topic sentence aloud about your favourite food. Then say two reasons and one closing sentence.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short paragraph (60–80 words) about **your best friend**. Use a topic sentence, 2–3 supporting sentences and a concluding sentence. Join some sentences with *and*, *but*, *so* or *because*.

Model answer

My best friend Tania is the kindest person I know. We met at school in Dhanmondi, and we have been friends for ten years. She always helps me when I have a problem. Last year I was sick before my exams, so she brought me her notes every day. She is also very funny, and she makes everyone laugh. **I am lucky to have a friend like Tania.**

(68 words)

Bold = topic sentence and concluding sentence. The sentences in between support the main idea.

7 Exercises

A. Write C (complete), F (fragment) or R (run-on)

29.1 Nusrat teaches English at a college in Sylhet.

29.2 After lunch at the canteen.

29.3 It is late I have to go home.

B. Correct the mistakes

29.4 My brother very busy these days.

29.5 The traffic was terrible, I was late for the meeting.

29.6 Because the shop was closed.

C. Join the two sentences with the word in brackets

29.7 I was hungry. I ate two parathas. (so)

29.8 The hotel was small. It was very clean. (but)

D. Paragraph skills

29.9 Which sentence is the best topic sentence? (a) I eat it with dal. (b) Rice is the most important food in my family. (c) My mother cooks it.

29.10 Write a concluding sentence for a paragraph about why you like Cox's Bazar.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- A complete sentence needs a **subject**, a **verb** and a **complete idea**.
- A **fragment** is only part of a sentence; a **run-on** is two sentences with no proper join.
- Join short sentences with **and, but, so, because, when**, or use a full stop.
- A paragraph = **topic sentence** + **supporting sentences** + **concluding sentence**.
- One paragraph, **one main idea**.

Chapter 30

Punctuation and Capital Letters

1 Why this matters

Punctuation marks are the **traffic signals** of writing. They tell the reader when to stop, pause or ask. Capital letters show where a sentence starts and which words are names. Small mistakes here make a CV or an email look careless, so a few simple rules will make your writing look professional.

যতিচিহ্ন লেখার ট্রাফিক সিগন্যাল। সঠিক যতিচিহ্ন আর বড় হাতের অক্ষর লেখাকে পরিষ্কার ও পেশাদার করে।

2 The rule in plain words

The main punctuation marks

Mark	When to use it	Example
Full stop (.)	At the end of a statement. দাঁড়ি	I live in Chattogram.
Comma (,)	(1) Between items in a list (2) After a linking word at the start (3) Before <i>but</i> / <i>so</i> joining two sentences	I bought rice, eggs and oil. However, the bus was late. It rained, so we stayed home.
Question mark (?)	At the end of a question.	Where do you work?
Exclamation mark (!)	For strong feeling. Use it rarely, never in formal writing.	What a beautiful view!
Apostrophe (')	(1) Short forms (contractions) (2) Possession (who owns it)	I'm, don't, it's, can't Karim's bike, my sister's phone
Quotation marks (" ")	Around someone's exact words.	He said, "I am busy."

Apostrophe for possession

One owner: add **'s** → the teacher's desk, Tania's bag

Plural owner ending in -s: add only **'** → the students' rooms, my parents' house

একজনের জিনিস: 's অনেকের জিনিস (শেষে s): শুধু '

Teacher's tip: **it's** = it is (*It's hot today*). **its** = belonging to it (*The cat licked its paw*). If you can say "it is", write *it's*.

Capital letters

Bangla has no capital letters, so we often forget them. Use a capital for:

Use a capital for...	Examples
The first word of a sentence	M y office is near G ulshan.
The word I (always)	Yesterday I met Hasan.
Names of people	F arhana, M r. C howdhury
Places (cities, countries, rivers)	D haka, B angladesh, the P adma
Days and months	F riday, J anuary
Languages and nationalities	B angla, E nglish, B angladeshi

Teacher's tip: Seasons do **not** take a capital: *summer, winter, monsoon*. Subjects don't either, unless they are languages: *maths, physics*, but *English*.

3 Examples

1. My brother works in Sylhet.
আমার ভাই সিলেটে কাজ করে।
Capital M (start), capital S (place), full stop at the end.
2. Can you send me the file today?
তুমি কি আজ ফাইলটা আমাকে পাঠাতে পারবে?
A question needs a question mark.
3. We need potatoes, onions, garlic and chillies.
আমাদের আলু, পেঁয়াজ, রসুন আর মরিচ লাগবে।
Commas in a list; usually no comma before *and*.
4. First, open the app. Then, enter your PIN.
প্রথমে অ্যাপটি খুলুন। তারপর পিন দিন।
Comma after a linking word at the start.
5. I called him, but he didn't answer.
আমি তাকে ফোন করেছিলাম, কিন্তু সে ধরেনি।
Comma before *but*; *didn't* = did not.
6. This is Sadia's laptop.
এটা সাদিয়ার ল্যাপটপ।
's shows possession: the laptop belongs to Sadia.
7. The doctors' room is on the second floor.
ডাক্তারদের রুম দোতলায়।
Many doctors → doctors'.
8. I'm free on Saturday in March.
আমি মার্চ মাসে শনিবার ফ্রি আছি।
I'm = I am; capitals for days and months.
9. Wow, you passed the exam!
বাহ, তুমি পরীক্ষায় পাস করেছ!
An exclamation mark shows strong feeling.
10. My mother said, "Come home early."

আমার মা বললেন, “তাড়াতাড়ি বাসায় এসো।”

Quotation marks around her exact words; the full stop goes inside.

4 Common mistakes

Bangla speakers often make these mistakes. Bangla uses I (dari) and has no capital letters, so the English rules feel new.

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
yesterday i went to dhaka.	Y esterday I went to D haka.	Capitals for the first word, <i>I</i> , and place names.
I can speak bangla and english.	I can speak B angla and E nglish.	Languages always take a capital.
My fathers name is Abdul.	My f ather's name is Abdul.	Possession needs an apostrophe.
I have two brother's.	I have two b rothers.	A simple plural has no apostrophe.
Its very hot today!!!	I t's very hot today.	<i>It's</i> = it is. Use only one ! (or a full stop).

5 Speak it

Punctuation also changes your voice. Read these aloud: **stop** at a full stop, **pause** at a comma, **go up** at the end of a yes/no question, and sound **excited** at an exclamation mark.

1. I'm going to Cox's Bazar on Thursday.
2. Are you coming with us?
3. We'll take a bus, but we'll come back by plane.
4. Bring a hat, sunglasses and some sunscreen.
5. It's going to be so much fun!

Now try this: Read sentence 3 again. Where do you pause? Why?

6 Write it

Task: This WhatsApp message has no punctuation or capitals. Rewrite it correctly.

hi nusrat im in mirpur now can you meet me on sunday we need to buy a gift for mitus birthday a book a cake and some flowers see you soon

Model answer

Hi Nusrat, I'm in Mirpur now. Can you meet me on Sunday? We need to buy a gift for Mitu's birthday: a book, a cake and some flowers. See you soon!

(31 words)

7 Exercises

A. Add capital letters and punctuation

30.1 my cousin lives in london

30.2 where is the bank

30.3 rahim speaks bangla english and hindi

30.4 we have an exam on monday

B. Use an apostrophe: rewrite with 's or '

30.5 the car of Mr. Chowdhury

30.6 the books of the students

30.7 I am not = _____ (short form)

C. Correct the mistakes

30.8 i am going to sylhet in december.

30.9 The cat is drinking it's milk.

30.10 My sister's are both doctors.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- End statements with a **full stop**, questions with a **question mark**; use **!** rarely.
- Use commas in **lists**, after **linking words** at the start, and before **but/so**.
- Apostrophes show **short forms** (I'm) and **possession** (Karim's); never use them for simple plurals.
- Capitals for the **first word**, **I**, **names**, **places**, **days**, **months** and **languages**.

Chapter 31

The PEEL Paragraph

1 Why this matters

In exams, job tests and IELTS, you often have to give an opinion and support it. Many learners know the answer but write it in a confusing order. **PEEL** is a simple four-step plan that makes every paragraph clear, logical and complete. Once you learn it, you will never wonder “What do I write next?”

PEEL হলো অনুচ্ছেদ লেখার চার ধাপের একটি সহজ কাঠামো। এটি মানলে লেখা পরিষ্কার ও যুক্তিপূর্ণ হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

PEEL is a short way to remember the four parts of a strong paragraph.

Step	What you do	Useful starters
P = Point	Say your main idea in one clear sentence. মূল কথা	In my opinion, .../ One reason is ...
E = Explain	Explain why or how . Give more detail. ব্যাখ্যা	This is because .../ This means ...
E = Example	Give a real example, fact or short story. উদাহরণ	For example, .../ For instance, ...
L = Link	Connect back to the point or the question. সংযোগ	Therefore, .../ This shows that ...

Point → **Explain** → **Example** → **Link**

মূল কথা → ব্যাখ্যা → উদাহরণ → সংযোগ

PEEL is just the paragraph plan from Chapter 29 made stronger: the **Point** is your topic sentence, **Explain** and **Example** are your supporting sentences, and the **Link** is your concluding sentence.

A colour-labelled model

Question: Should students learn to use computers at school?

[P] I strongly believe that every student should learn computer skills at school. **[E]** This is because almost every job today needs some knowledge of computers, from banking to teaching. Students who start early become confident and do not fear technology later. **[E]** For example, my cousin Sadia learnt Word and Excel in Class 8 at her school in Sylhet. Last year, she got an office job easily because she could already make reports and spreadsheets. **[L]** Therefore, computer classes are not a luxury; they are a basic need for students in Bangladesh.

(89 words)

Teacher's tip: One PEEL paragraph = **one** point. If you have three reasons, write three PEEL paragraphs. In a short exam answer, one good PEEL paragraph is often enough.

Teacher's tip: Your **Example** should be specific: a name, a place, a number or a real event. "For example, many people use it" is too general.

3 Examples

1. In my opinion, reading every day is very useful.
আমার মতে, প্রতিদিন পড়া খুব উপকারী।
Point: one clear idea.
2. One reason is that public transport saves money.
একটি কারণ হলো, গণপরিবহনে টাকা বাঁচে।
Point: starts with "One reason is".
3. This is because a bus ticket costs much less than a CNG.
কারণ বাসের ভাড়া সিএনজির চেয়ে অনেক কম।
Explain: tells why.
4. This means families can spend more on food and education.
এর মানে পরিবারগুলো খাবার ও শিক্ষায় বেশি খরচ করতে পারে।
Explain: shows the result.
5. For example, Karim saves Tk 3,000 a month by taking the metro rail.
যেমন, করিম মেট্রোরেল চড়ে মাসে ৩,০০০ টাকা বাঁচায়।
Example: a name and a number.
6. For instance, my mother learnt to use bKash in one day.
যেমন, আমার মা এক দিনেই বিকাশ ব্যবহার করা শিখেছেন।
Example: a real story.
7. Therefore, everyone should try public transport.
তাই, সবার গণপরিবহন ব্যবহার করে দেখা উচিত।
Link: returns to the point.
8. This shows that mobile banking is easy for everyone.
এটি দেখায় যে মোবাইল ব্যাংকিং সবার জন্য সহজ।
Link: connects the example to the main idea.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Starting with a long story before the point.	Start with the Point , then explain.	Readers and examiners want your main idea first.
For example, many people like it.	For example, my neighbour Hasan walks 5 km every day.	An example must be specific and real.
Putting three different ideas in one paragraph.	One point per paragraph.	Too many ideas make the paragraph confusing.
Ending with the example.	Add a Link sentence at the end.	Without a link, the paragraph feels unfinished.
According to me, ...	In my opinion, .../ I believe ...	"According to me" is a common Bangladeshi error; natural English uses <i>in my opinion</i> .

5 Speak it

PEEL works for speaking too, for example in a job interview or IELTS Speaking. Read this aloud.

Interviewer: Why do you want to work in our company?

Farhana: I want to work here because I can learn a lot. Your company is one of the biggest in Bangladesh, and you train new staff very well. For example, my friend Adiyat joined last year, and he has already finished two training courses. So I believe this is the best place to grow my career.

Interviewer: That's a very clear answer. Thank you.

Now try this: Answer aloud with PEEL: "Is it good to live in a big city like Dhaka?"

6 Write it

Task: Use this frame to write a PEEL paragraph (70–90 words) on: *Should mobile phones be allowed in classrooms?*

[P] In my opinion, mobile phones _____ be allowed in classrooms.

[E] This is because _____. This means _____.

[E] For example, _____.

[L] Therefore, _____.

Model answer

In my opinion, mobile phones should not be allowed in classrooms. This is because phones distract students from the lesson. This means they miss important points and get lower marks. For example, in my college in Chattogram, many students checked Facebook during class. After the principal banned phones, the average exam result went up by ten percent. Therefore, keeping phones out of the classroom helps students focus and learn better.

(70 words)

7 Exercises

A. Label each sentence P, E (explain), E (example) or L

- 31.1** For example, my uncle in Sylhet grows his own vegetables.
- 31.2** Therefore, growing food at home is a smart choice.
- 31.3** Growing vegetables at home is good for families.
- 31.4** This is because home-grown food is fresh and cheap.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 31.5** According to me, sports are important for children.
- 31.6** For example, many people like sports. (make the example specific)

C. Complete the PEEL paragraph

Topic: Learning English helps you get a better job.

- 31.7** Write the **Point**.
- 31.8** Write the **Explain** sentence (start with *This is because*).
- 31.9** Write the **Example** sentence (start with *For example*).
- 31.10** Write the **Link** sentence (start with *Therefore*).

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- PEEL = **Point**, **Explain**, **Example**, **Link**.
- Put your main idea **first**, and only **one** point in each paragraph.
- Make your example **specific**: a name, a place, a number.
- Finish with a **Link** back to the point or the question.
- Use PEEL for exams, job tests and interview answers.

Chapter 32

Descriptive and Opinion Paragraphs

1 Why this matters

Two kinds of paragraph come up again and again in school exams, job tests and IELTS: **describing** something (a person, a place, a thing) and **giving your opinion**. A descriptive paragraph helps the reader see what you see. An opinion paragraph helps the reader *agree* with you.

বর্ণনামূলক অনুচ্ছেদ পাঠককে ছবি দেখায়, আর মতামতের অনুচ্ছেদ পাঠককে আপনার সাথে একমত করায়।

2 The rule in plain words

Part A: The descriptive paragraph

Use your **five senses** and strong **adjectives** (describing words). Don't just say *nice* or *good*.

Sense	Ask yourself	Useful words
See দেখা	What does it look like?	tall, tiny, crowded, colourful, bright, old, modern
Hear শোনা	What sounds are there?	noisy, quiet, loud horns, the call to prayer, birds singing
Smell গন্ধ	What does it smell like?	fresh, sweet, spicy, the smell of rain, frying fish
Taste স্বাদ	How does it taste?	delicious, salty, sweet, sour, hot
Touch স্পর্শ	How does it feel?	soft, rough, warm, cool, smooth, sticky

Plan: Topic sentence (what and where) → 3-4 details using the senses → how you feel about it.

পরিকল্পনা: কী ও কোথায় → ইন্দ্রিয় দিয়ে ৩-৪টি বর্ণনা → আপনার অনুভূতি

Describing a person? Talk about appearance (*tall, short grey hair, a warm smile*), character (*kind, patient, funny, hard-working*) and one thing they often do.

Teacher's tip: Show, don't just tell. Instead of "The bazaar is busy," write "The bazaar is full of shouting sellers, ringing rickshaw bells and the smell of fresh fish."

Part B: The opinion paragraph

Say what you think, then **prove** it with reasons and examples. This is PEEL (Chapter 31) with two reasons.

Opinion (In my opinion / I believe ...)

Reason 1 (Firstly, ...) + **example** (For example, ...)

Reason 2 (Secondly, / Also, ...) + **example**

Conclusion (For these reasons, / Therefore, ...)

মতামত → কারণ ১ + উদাহরণ → কারণ ২ + উদাহরণ → উপসংহার

Teacher's tip: Use **I think, I believe, In my opinion** or **In my view** only once, at the start. Don't repeat "I think" in every sentence.

3 Examples

1. My grandmother is a short woman with soft white hair.

আমার দাদি খাটো, তাঁর চুল নরম আর সাদা।

Describing a person: appearance.

2. She is patient and always speaks gently.

তিনি ধৈর্যশীল এবং সবসময় নরম স্বরে কথা বলেন।

Describing character.

3. The tea stall smells of ginger and condensed milk.

চায়ের দোকান থেকে আদা আর কনডেন্সড মিল্কের গন্ধ আসে।

Smell.

4. You can hear the waves crashing all night.

সারা রাত ঢেউ আছড়ে পড়ার শব্দ শোনা যায়।

Hearing.

5. My old leather bag feels soft and smooth.

আমার পুরনো চামড়ার ব্যাগটা নরম আর মসৃণ।

Touch; two adjectives before the noun.

6. In my opinion, online classes are useful but tiring.

আমার মতে, অনলাইন ক্লাস উপকারী কিন্তু ক্লান্তিকর।

Opinion: stated clearly at the start.

7. Firstly, students can study from home and save time.

প্রথমত, শিক্ষার্থীরা ঘরে বসে পড়তে পারে এবং সময় বাঁচে।

Reason 1.

8. For example, Mitu saves two hours a day on travel.

যেমন, মিতু প্রতিদিন যাতায়াতের দুই ঘণ্টা বাঁচায়।

Example supporting reason 1.

9. For these reasons, I prefer to live in a small town.

এসব কারণে আমি ছোট শহরে থাকতে পছন্দ করি।

Conclusion of an opinion paragraph.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
The place is very nice and very good.	The place is peaceful and green .	<i>Nice</i> and <i>good</i> say nothing. Choose exact adjectives.
He has a smile warm.	He has a warm smile .	Adjectives go before the noun.
Dhaka is too much crowded.	Dhaka is very crowded.	<i>Too much</i> goes with nouns. With adjectives, use <i>very</i> (or <i>too</i> for a problem).
I think ... I think ... I think ...	I believe ... Firstly , ... Also , ...	Say your opinion once, then use linking words.
In my opinion, I think smoking is bad.	In my opinion , smoking is bad.	<i>In my opinion</i> and <i>I think</i> mean the same. Use one.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Two friends talk about a weekend trip.

Nusrat: How was Sylhet?

Tania: Beautiful! The tea gardens were bright green, and the air smelled fresh after the rain.

Nusrat: Sounds lovely. Was it better than Cox's Bazar?

Tania: In my opinion, yes. Firstly, it's quieter. Secondly, it's cooler in summer.

Nusrat: Okay, you've convinced me. I'll go next month!

Now try this: Describe your home town aloud in three sentences using **three different senses**. Then say if you would like to live there forever, with one reason.

6 Write it

Task 1: Write a descriptive paragraph (70–90 words) about a place you know well.

Model answer

Every Friday morning, I go to the fish market near our house in Mirpur. It is a noisy, crowded place. Sellers shout prices, and customers argue loudly over every taka. The air smells strongly of fish, wet earth and ice. Silver hilsa lie in neat rows on banana leaves, and huge rui fish shine in the morning sun. The floor is wet and slippery, so I always wear old sandals. It is not a clean place, but I love its energy and colour.

(83 words)

Task 2: Write an opinion paragraph (70–90 words): *Is it better to live in a city or a village?*

Model answer

In my opinion, it is better to live in a village. Firstly, village life is healthier. The air is clean, and the food is fresh. For example, my uncle in Bogura eats vegetables from his own field every day. Secondly, people in villages are closer to each other. When my grandfather was sick, all the neighbours came to help. In Dhaka, many people do not even know their neighbours' names. For these reasons, I would choose a quiet village over a busy city.

(83 words)

7 Exercises

A. Which sense does each sentence use? (see, hear, smell, taste, touch)

- 32.1** The mango was sweet and juicy.
- 32.2** The kitchen smelled of fried onions.
- 32.3** The baby's hands were soft and warm.

B. Replace "nice" or "good" with a better adjective

- 32.4** We had a *nice* dinner at a restaurant in Gulshan.
- 32.5** My teacher is a *good* person.

C. Correct the mistakes

- 32.6** She is wearing a dress beautiful.
- 32.7** In my opinion, I think homework is useful.
- 32.8** Chattogram is too much hilly.

D. Write

- 32.9** Write two sentences describing a family member: one about appearance and one about character.
- 32.10** Write an opinion sentence and one reason about this topic: *Should children have smartphones?*

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- A **descriptive** paragraph uses the **five senses** and exact adjectives.
- Adjectives go **before** the noun; avoid empty words like *nice* and *good*.
- An **opinion** paragraph = opinion → reasons with examples → conclusion.
- State your opinion **once**; then use *Firstly*, *Secondly*, *For example*, *For these reasons*.

Chapter 33

Writing Emails: Formal and Informal

1 Why this matters

Today almost every job, university and office in Bangladesh uses email. You write to HR, to your boss, to a teacher or to a friend abroad. A clear, polite email makes people trust you, and a messy one can cost you a chance. The good news: every email follows the **same six steps**.

চাকরি, অফিস, বিশ্ববিদ্যালয় সব জায়গায় এখন ইমেইল লাগে। প্রতিটি ইমেইল একই ছয়টি ধাপে লেখা হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

The six parts of an email

Part	What to write	Example
1. Subject line	3-8 words that tell the main point	<i>Request for leave on 12 May</i>
2. Greeting	Dear + name, then a comma	<i>Dear Mr. Chowdhury,</i>
3. Opening line	Why you are writing	<i>I am writing to ask about...</i>
4. Body	The details: what, when, why. 1-3 short paragraphs	<i>The meeting is on Sunday at 10 am.</i>
5. Closing line	What you want next, or thanks	<i>I look forward to hearing from you.</i>
6. Sign-off	A polite ending + your name	<i>Best regards, Rahim Uddin</i>

Formal or informal?

Formal = for people you don't know well: a boss, HR, a teacher, a company, a bank. **Informal** = for friends, family and close colleagues. অপরিচিত বা উঁচু পদের মানুষকে ফরমাল, বন্ধু ও পরিবারকে ইনফরমাল ইমেইল।

Part	Formal	Informal
Greeting	Dear Mr. Karim, / Dear Ms. Sadia, / Dear Sir or Madam,	Hi Nusrat, / Hello Adiyat, / Hey Mitu,
Opening	I am writing to.../ I am writing regarding...	How are you? / Hope you're doing well. / Just a quick note to...
Asking	Could you please...? / I would be grateful if you could...	Can you...? / Could you...?
Giving news	I would like to inform you that...	Guess what! / Just wanted to tell you...
Attachment	Please find attached my CV.	I've attached the photos.
Closing	I look forward to hearing from you. / Thank you for your time.	See you soon! / Write back soon. / Talk later.
Sign-off	Best regards, / Kind regards, / Yours sincerely,	Take care, / Love, / Cheers,

- Formal emails use **full forms**: *I am, I would*. Informal emails use **short forms**: *I'm, I'd, can't*.
- Keep paragraphs short: **2-3 sentences** each, with an empty line between them.
- **One email = one purpose**. A busy reader should understand it in 30 seconds.

Teacher's tip: Don't know the person's name? Write *Dear Sir or Madam*, or *Dear Hiring Manager*,. If you know the name, use it: *Dear Ms. Farhana*, feels much more personal.

3 Examples

1. Subject: Application for the post of Junior Accountant
বিষয়: জুনিয়র অ্যাকাউন্ট্যান্ট পদের জন্য আবেদন
Subject line: short and clear
2. I am writing to apply for the job you advertised on Bdjobs.
আপনারা বিজিবসে যে চাকরির বিজ্ঞাপন দিয়েছেন, তার জন্য আবেদন করতে লিখছি।
Formal opening line
3. Could you please send me the meeting agenda?
অনুগ্রহ করে মিটিংয়ের আলোচ্যসূচিটা পাঠাবেন?
Polite request
4. Please find attached my CV and certificates.
আমার সিভি ও সনদপত্র সংযুক্ত করে দিলাম।
Formal: talking about an attachment
5. I would be grateful if you could reply by Thursday.
বৃহস্পতিবারের মধ্যে উত্তর দিলে কৃতজ্ঞ থাকব।
Very polite request
6. Thank you for your quick reply.
দ্রুত উত্তর দেওয়ার জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
Good first line when you reply
7. Hope you're doing well!
আশা করি ভালো আছ!
Informal opening
8. Just wanted to let you know that I reached Sylhet safely.

শুধু জানাতে চাইছিলাম যে আমি নিরাপদে সিলেট পৌঁছেছি।

Informal news

9. I look forward to hearing from you.

আপনার উত্তরের অপেক্ষায় রইলাম।

Formal closing line

10. Take care, and see you on Friday!

ভালো থেকো, শুক্রবার দেখা হবে!

Informal closing

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Subject: Application	Subject: Leave request for 12 May	A one-word subject tells the reader nothing. Say the main point.
Kindly do the needful.	Could you please send me the form?	"Do the needful" is old and unclear. Say exactly what you want.
Please find the attachment.	Please find attached my CV.	Use <i>attached</i> and name the file.
Waiting for your kind reply.	I look forward to hearing from you.	This is the natural, polite closing line in modern English.
Thanks and regards, Yours faithfully, Rahim	Best regards, Rahim	Use one sign-off only, then your name.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Tania is helping her cousin Adiyat with his first work email.

Adiyat: Apu, I need to email my manager. Should I start with "Respected Sir"?

Tania: In emails, "Dear Mr. Hasan" is better. It's polite and modern.

Adiyat: OK. And then I write my problem?

Tania: First, one line saying why you're writing. Then the details.

Adiyat: How do I finish?

Tania: Say "Thank you for your time", then "Best regards" and your name. Keep it short!

Now try this: Say aloud a subject line, a greeting and an opening line for an email to your teacher asking for extra time for an assignment.

6 Write it

Task A (formal): Write to Ms. Farhana Rahman in HR. You applied for a job two weeks ago. Ask about your application.

Model answer

Subject: Follow-up on my application for Sales Executive

Dear Ms. Farhana,

I am writing to ask about my application for the Sales Executive post. I sent my CV on 2 March.

I am still very interested in this job. Could you please tell me if there is any update? I have attached my CV again for your convenience.

Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.

Best regards,
Rahim Uddin
Phone: 01712-345678

(76 words)

Task B (informal): Write to your friend Nusrat. Invite her to your birthday dinner.

Model answer

Subject: Birthday dinner on Friday!

Hi Nusrat,

How are you? Hope work isn't too crazy these days!

Guess what? I'm turning 25 next week, and I'm having a small dinner on Friday at 8 pm. It's at Café Mango in Dhanmondi. Mitu and Karim are coming too.

Can you come? Let me know by Wednesday so I can book the table.

Can't wait to see you!

Love,
Sadia

(68 words)

7 Exercises

A. Formal or informal? Write F or I

33.1 Hope you're doing well!

33.2 I would be grateful if you could send me the details.

33.3 Kind regards,

33.4 See you soon!

B. Correct the mistakes

33.5 Please find the attachment of my CV.

33.6 Waiting for your kind reply.

33.7 Kindly do the needful.

C. Write it

33.8 Write a good subject line for an email asking your manager for leave on 20 June.

33.9 Write a formal opening line for an email to a bank about a problem with your card.

33.10 Rewrite this informal line in a formal way: *Can you send me the form?*

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Every email has six parts: **subject, greeting, opening line, body, closing line, sign-off.**
- The subject line tells the **main point** in a few words.
- Formal: *Dear Mr. Karim, I am writing to..., Best regards.* Informal: *Hi Mitu, Hope you're well, Take care.*
- Keep paragraphs short and use **one sign-off** only.
- Ask clearly and politely: *Could you please...?*

Chapter 34

Messages, Applications and Short Letters

1 Why this matters

Every day you send WhatsApp messages, ask for leave, or complain about a problem. These short pieces of writing are also very common in school exams and job tests in Bangladesh. If you learn a few fixed patterns, you can write them quickly and correctly every time.

মেসেজ, ছুটির দরখাস্ত আর ছোট চিঠি প্রতিদিনের জীবনে ও পরীক্ষায় লাগে। কয়েকটি নির্দিষ্ট প্যাটার্ন শিখলেই হবে।

2 The rule in plain words

1. WhatsApp and SMS messages

A good message is **short, clear and polite**. Say **who you are** (if the person may not know your number), **what you need**, and **when**.

Purpose	Useful message
Running late	Sorry, I'm stuck in traffic in Mirpur. I'll be 15 minutes late.
Asking	Hi Karim, could you send me today's class notes when you're free?
Confirming	Got it, thanks! See you at 5 at the office.
Informing a boss	Good morning, sir. I'm not feeling well today, so I'll work from home. I'll be online by 10.
Unknown number	Assalamu alaikum, this is Hasan from ABC Traders. Is this a good time to call?

Teacher's tip: With your boss or a teacher, avoid "u", "plz" and "thnx". Write full words: *you, please, thanks*.

2. Leave application (school or office)

In Bangladesh, a leave application follows a fixed format. Keep the format, but use **simple, modern sentences**.

Date → **To** + the person's post + school/office name → **Subject** → **Dear Sir/Madam**, → reason + dates → polite request → **Yours obediently** (school) / **Yours sincerely** (office) → name and details

Teacher's tip: Old phrases like *"I beg most respectfully to state that..."* and *"I shall remain ever grateful"* are not needed. Just write *"I would like to request leave for..."* and *"I would*

be grateful if you could grant me leave."

3. A simple complaint letter

Use four short parts: **(1)** what you bought or used and when, **(2)** the problem, **(3)** what you want them to do, **(4)** thanks. Be firm, but stay polite.

Model answer

5 May 2025

The Customer Service Manager
QuickBuy Online Shop, Gulshan, Dhaka

Subject: Complaint about a damaged rice cooker (Order no. 45821)

Dear Sir or Madam,

I ordered a rice cooker from your website on 28 April. It arrived yesterday, but the lid is broken and it does not switch on.

I would like you to replace it or give me a full refund within seven days. I have attached photos of the damage.

Thank you for your help.

Yours faithfully,
Adiyat Hossain
Mobile: 01811-223344

(85 words)

4. A short note

A note is a few lines left for family, a flatmate or a colleague. Use the person's name, the message, and your name.

Model answer

Ammu,
I've gone to Nusrat's house to study for the exam. I'll be back by 9 pm. I have my phone with me.
Mitu

(24 words)

3 Examples

1. I'm on my way. I'll reach in 10 minutes.

আমি রাস্তায় আছি। ১০ মিনিটের মধ্যে পৌঁছাব।

Quick WhatsApp update

2. Could you call me when you're free?

ফ্রি হলে আমাকে একটা কল দিতে পারবে?

Polite request by message

3. Subject: Application for three days' leave

বিষয়: তিন দিনের ছুটির জন্য আবেদন

Subject line of a leave application

4. I have had a high fever since last night.
গতকাল রাত থেকে আমার খুব জ্বর।
Giving the reason (present perfect + since)
5. I would like to request leave from 10 to 12 March.
আমি ১০ থেকে ১২ মার্চ পর্যন্ত ছুটির আবেদন করছি।
Modern way to ask for leave
6. I would be grateful if you could grant me leave for these days.
এই দিনগুলোর জন্য ছুটি মঞ্জুর করলে কৃতজ্ঞ থাকব।
Polite request at the end
7. I am writing to complain about the poor service at your branch.
আপনাদের শাখার খারাপ সেবা নিয়ে অভিযোগ জানাতে লিখছি।
Opening line of a complaint
8. Please repair or replace the product as soon as possible.
অনুগ্রহ করে যত দ্রুত সম্ভব পণ্যটি মেরামত বা বদলে দিন।
Saying what you want
9. Dinner is in the fridge. Please heat it up.
রাতের খাবার ফ্রিজে আছে। গরম করে নিও।
Short note at home
10. Got your message. Thanks a lot!
তোমার মেসেজ পেয়েছি। অনেক ধন্যবাদ!
Friendly reply

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I am suffering from fever from yesterday.	I have had a fever since yesterday.	For a time that started in the past and continues, use <i>have had</i> + <i>since</i> .
I want leave for 3 days.	I would like to request leave for 3 days.	<i>I want</i> sounds rude to a boss. <i>Would like</i> is polite.
Sir, plz give me leave tmrw.	Sir, could I please take leave tomorrow ?	No short forms like <i>plz</i> or <i>tmrw</i> with a boss or teacher.
I am very angry with your bad shop!	I am not happy with the service I received.	In a complaint, explain the problem calmly. Anger doesn't help.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Hasan is calling his manager in the morning.

Hasan: Good morning, Mr. Chowdhury. This is Hasan.
Mr. Chowdhury: Good morning, Hasan. Is everything OK?
Hasan: Not really. My mother is in hospital, so I can't come to the office today.
Mr. Chowdhury: I'm sorry to hear that. Take the day off.
Hasan: Thank you, sir. I'll send you a leave application by email.
Mr. Chowdhury: That's fine. I hope she gets well soon.

Now try this: Say a WhatsApp message to your friend telling him you will be late for a movie at

Bashundhara City.

6 Write it

Task: You are Sadia Akter, a Class 9 student. Write a leave application to your principal for three days because of fever.

Model answer

12 March 2025

To

The Principal

Dhanmondi Girls' High School, Dhaka

Subject: Application for three days' leave

Dear Madam,

I am a student of Class 9, Section B. I have had a high fever since last night, and the doctor has told me to rest for a few days. So I will not be able to attend school from 12 to 14 March.

I would be grateful if you could grant me leave for these three days.

Yours obediently,

Sadia Akter

Class 9, Section B, Roll 17

(87 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

- 34.1** I have had a cold _____ Monday.
- 34.2** I would _____ to request leave for two days.
- 34.3** I am writing to _____ about the late delivery of my order.
- 34.4** At the end of a school leave application, write: Yours _____,

B. Correct the mistakes

- 34.5** I am suffering from fever from two days.
- 34.6** Sir, plz give me leave tmrw.
- 34.7** I want refund now for this bad phone.

C. Write it

- 34.8** Write a WhatsApp message to your colleague Tania. You will be 20 minutes late because of traffic.
- 34.9** Write a short note to your flatmate Karim. Tell him you have gone to the bazaar.
- 34.10** Write a subject line for a complaint about a broken ceiling fan you bought last week.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Messages: short, clear, polite. Use full words with a boss or teacher.
- Leave application: **Date, To, Subject, Dear Sir/Madam, reason + dates, request, sign-off.**
- Use modern phrases: *I would like to request leave...*, *I would be grateful if...*
- Complaint: what happened, the problem, what you want, thanks. Stay calm.
- A note needs only three things: the name, the message, your name.

Chapter 35

Short Essays: Introduction, Body, Conclusion

1 Why this matters

IELTS Writing Task 2, university exams and many job tests ask you to write a short essay of about 250 words. Examiners are not looking for difficult words. They want a **clear answer**, **good reasons** and a **tidy structure**. Learn one simple plan and use it for every topic.

পরীক্ষক কঠিন শব্দ চান না; চান স্পষ্ট উত্তর, ভালো যুক্তি আর গোছানো কাঠামো। একটাই সহজ প্ল্যান সব টপিকে ব্যবহার করো।

2 The rule in plain words

The four-paragraph essay

Paragraph	Length	What it does
1. Introduction	2-3 sentences	Says what the topic is and gives your answer (the thesis sentence).
2. Body paragraph 1	4-5 sentences	Your first reason , explained, with an example.
3. Body paragraph 2	4-5 sentences	Your second reason , explained, with an example.
4. Conclusion	2-3 sentences	Repeats your answer in new words. No new ideas.

Plan in 5 minutes

1. **Read the question twice** (1 min). Underline the key words. What exactly is it asking?
2. **Decide your answer** (1 min). Agree or disagree? City or village? Choose one side.
3. **Write two reasons** (2 min). For each, note one example from real life.
4. **Write your thesis sentence** (1 min). Then start writing.

The thesis sentence

The thesis sentence is the **most important sentence** in your essay. It gives your answer and your two reasons. থিসিস বাক্যে তোমার মত আর দুটি কারণ থাকে।

In my opinion, **[your answer]** because **[reason 1]** and **[reason 2]**.

In my opinion, students should learn to cook because it saves money and keeps them healthy.

A body paragraph: P-E-E

- **Point:** the topic sentence. *The first reason is that...*
- **Explain:** one or two sentences. *This means that.../ This is because...*
- **Example:** real life, Bangladesh is fine. *For example, in Dhaka...*

Useful linking words

Job	Words
Start a reason	The first reason is that.../ Another reason is that.../ Firstly, / Secondly,
Give an example	For example, / For instance, / such as
Show a result	As a result, / So, / Therefore,
Show the other side	However, / On the other hand, / Of course,
Finish	In conclusion, / To sum up,

Teacher's tip: Short essays get better marks when every sentence is **correct**. A simple sentence with no mistakes beats a long sentence with three mistakes.

3 Examples

1. Many people today move from villages to big cities.

আজকাল অনেক মানুষ গ্রাম থেকে বড় শহরে চলে যায়।

Introduction: introduce the topic

2. In my opinion, online classes are useful because they save time and money.

আমার মতে, অনলাইন ক্লাস উপকারী, কারণ এতে সময় ও টাকা বাঁচে।

Thesis sentence: answer + two reasons

3. I strongly agree that children should learn English from an early age.

আমি দৃঢ়ভাবে একমত যে শিশুদের ছোটবেলা থেকেই ইংরেজি শেখা উচিত।

Another way to give your answer

4. The first reason is that public transport reduces traffic.

প্রথম কারণ হলো, গণপরিবহন যানজট কমায়।

Topic sentence of body paragraph 1

5. This is because one bus can carry fifty people.

কারণ একটি বাসে পঞ্চাশজন মানুষ যেতে পারে।

Explain the point

6. For example, the Dhaka Metro Rail carries thousands of passengers every day.

যেমন, ঢাকা মেট্রোরেল প্রতিদিন হাজার হাজার যাত্রী বহন করে।

Real-life example

7. As a result, people reach their offices on time.

ফলে মানুষ সময়মতো অফিসে পৌঁছায়।

Show a result

8. Another reason is that exercise reduces stress.

আরেকটি কারণ হলো, ব্যায়াম মানসিক চাপ কমায়।

Topic sentence of body paragraph 2

9. Of course, mobile phones can also waste students' time.

অবশ্য মোবাইল ফোন ছাত্রছাত্রীদের সময়ও নষ্ট করতে পারে।

Showing the other side briefly

10. In conclusion, I believe the advantages are greater than the disadvantages.

উপসংহারে বলা যায়, আমার মনে হয় সুবিধাগুলো অসুবিধার চেয়ে বেশি।

Conclusion: repeat your answer

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
In this modern era of science and technology, everything is changing...	Many people today use smartphones for study.	Memorised openings waste words and say nothing. Go straight to the topic.
There are many advantages and disadvantages. (no answer)	In my opinion, the advantages are greater.	The examiner must see your answer in the introduction.
Because cities have more jobs.	Many people move to cities because they have more jobs.	A sentence cannot start and end with only a <i>because</i> part.
In conclusion, another problem is pollution.	In conclusion, I believe city life is better.	Never add a new idea in the conclusion.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Nusrat and Adiyat are preparing for IELTS together.

Nusrat: The topic is "City life or village life: which is better?" Where do I start?

Adiyat: First, choose a side. Which do you prefer?

Nusrat: The city, I think. There are more jobs and better hospitals.

Adiyat: Great, that's your two reasons. Now give an example for each.

Nusrat: My cousin got a job in Gulshan after one month. And my uncle had surgery at a big hospital in Dhaka.

Adiyat: Perfect. Your plan is ready. Now just write!

Now try this: Choose a side for this topic and say your thesis sentence aloud: "*Is it better to study alone or in a group?*"

6 Write it

Task: Some people prefer to live in a big city, while others prefer a village. Which do you prefer, and why? Write about 250 words.

5-minute plan: Answer: city. **Reason 1:** more jobs (example: graduates in Dhaka). **Reason 2:** education and hospitals (example: specialist doctors).

Model answer

Every year, thousands of people move from villages to cities such as Dhaka and Chattogram. City life is busy and exciting, while village life is calm and simple. In my opinion, living in a city is better, mainly because it offers more jobs and better services.

The first reason is that cities have far more job opportunities. Most offices, banks, factories and IT companies are in big cities. For example, a young graduate in Dhaka can apply for work in many different fields, but in a village the choices are usually farming or running a small shop. As a result, people in cities often earn more and build better careers. My own cousin, for instance, found a well-paid job in Gulshan only two months after finishing university.

Another reason is that cities have better education and health care. The best universities, coaching centres and libraries are in cities, so students have more chances to learn. Many families even move to the city just for their children's schooling. Good hospitals are also close by, which means people can get treatment quickly in an emergency. In contrast, villagers sometimes have to travel for hours to see a specialist doctor.

In conclusion, cities do have problems, such as traffic jams, noise and pollution, while villages have fresh air and friendly neighbours. However, I believe the chances for work, study and medical care make city life the better choice. If the government improves transport and housing, cities will become even better places to live.

(250 words)

7 Exercises

A. Which part of the essay is it? (introduction, body, conclusion)

- 35.1** To sum up, I believe online shopping saves people a lot of time.
- 35.2** For example, my father pays all his bills with bKash.
- 35.3** In my opinion, students should wear school uniforms because they save money and look neat.

B. Fill in the blanks with a linking word

- 35.4** The first reason is that reading improves vocabulary. _____, my English got better after I read one newspaper every day.
- 35.5** Fast food is cheap and tasty. _____, it is not good for our health.
- 35.6** Many roads in Dhaka are full of cars. _____, people waste hours in traffic.

C. Correct the mistakes

- 35.7** Because exercise is good for health.
- 35.8** In conclusion, another advantage is that it is cheap.

D. Write it

- 35.9** Write a thesis sentence for this topic: *Should children have their own mobile phones?*
- 35.10** Write a topic sentence for a body paragraph about this reason: *exercise gives us more*

energy.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Use four paragraphs: **introduction, body 1, body 2, conclusion.**
- Spend 5 minutes planning: read, decide, two reasons, two examples.
- The thesis sentence gives **your answer + two reasons.**
- Each body paragraph: **Point, Explain, Example.**
- The conclusion repeats your answer. No new ideas.

Chapter 36

How to Edit Your Own Writing

1 Why this matters

Even good writers make mistakes in their first draft. The difference is that they **check** their work before they send it. Five minutes of editing can turn a weak email, application or essay into a strong one, and in IELTS it can raise your band score.

ভালো লেখকরাও প্রথমবার ভুল করেন, কিন্তু পাঠানোর আগে তাঁরা লেখা যাচাই করেন। পাঁচ মিনিটের সম্পাদনাই লেখাকে অনেক ভালো করে।

2 The rule in plain words

Read three times, for three different things

1. **Read for meaning.** Did you answer the question? Is every paragraph about one idea?
2. **Read for grammar.** Look at every verb and every noun. This is where most marks are lost.
3. **Read for small things.** Capital letters, full stops, spelling, word count.

তিনবার পড়ো: প্রথমে অর্থ, তারপর গ্রামার, শেষে ছোটখাটো বিষয়।

Teacher's tip: Read your writing **slowly and quietly aloud**, or move your pen under each word. Your ears often catch mistakes that your eyes miss.

Before and after: editing in action

Adiyat wrote this paragraph about a trip. The mistakes are underlined.

Before

Last friday I go to Cox's Bazar with my family. We was very excited because it was my first time to see the sea. The journey take ten hours by bus but it was not boring. we stayed in a hotel near the beach, the hotel was very beautiful. In the evening we walk on the beach and eat fresh fish. It was a unforgettable trip, i want to go there again.

After

Last **Friday**, I **went** to Cox's Bazar with my family. We **were** very excited because it was my first time **seeing** the sea. The journey **took** ten hours by bus, **but** it was not boring. **We** stayed in a hotel near the **beach**. **The** hotel was very beautiful. In the evening, we **walked** on the beach and **ate** fresh fish. It was **an** unforgettable trip, **and I** want to go there again.

- **Verbs:** go → went, was → were, take → took, walk → walked, eat → ate (the trip is in the past).
- **Capitals:** friday → Friday, we → We, i → I.

- **Article:** a unforgettable → **an** unforgettable (vowel sound).
- **Punctuation:** two full sentences were joined with a comma, so we used a full stop or *and*.

Your editing checklist

Photocopy this table, or copy it into your notebook, and tick each box every time you write.

Check	Ask yourself	Example	Done
Task	Did I answer the question and include every point asked?	Asked for 3 points → 3 points	☐
Grammar	Does every sentence have a subject and a verb?	She is busy. (not <i>She busy.</i>)	☐
Verbs	Do subject and verb agree?	He goes . They go .	☐
	Are plurals correct?	two books , many people	☐
	Is the tense right, and the same all through?	Yesterday I went ...and saw ...	☐
Articles	Are past forms correct?	take → took , buy → bought	☐
	Does each singular countable noun have <i>a/an/the/my</i> ?	I bought a phone.	☐
Punctuation	<i>An</i> before a vowel sound?	an hour, an umbrella	☐
	Capital letter at the start, for <i>I</i> , names, days, months?	On F riday I met R ahim.	☐
Spelling	Full stop at the end of each sentence? No comma between two full sentences?	It rained. We stayed home.	☐
	Did I check words I often get wrong?	because, receive, beautiful, government	☐
Linking	Are my ideas joined with linking words? Not always <i>and</i> ?	however, because, so, for example	☐
Word count	Is it within the limit? Not too short, not too long?	Task 2: at least 250 words	☐

3 Examples

1. She goes to the office at 9 am.
সে সকাল ৯টায় অফিসে যায়।
Before: *She go...* → *he/she/it + verb-s*
2. Yesterday we visited my uncle in Sylhet.
গতকাল আমরা সিলেটে মামার বাসায় গিয়েছিলাম।
Before: *we visit* → *past tense for yesterday*
3. I need an umbrella today.
আজ আমার একটা ছাতা লাগবে।
Before: *a umbrella* → *an* before a vowel sound
4. My brother is a doctor.
আমার ভাই একজন ডাক্তার।
Before: *My brother doctor.* → *add the verb is*
5. There are many people at the bus stop.
বাসস্ট্যান্ডে অনেক মানুষ।

Before: *There is many peoples* → *are + people*

6. I met Tania on Monday.

সোমবার তানিয়ার সাথে দেখা হয়েছিল।

Before: *i met tania on monday* → capital letters

7. It was raining. We stayed at home.

বৃষ্টি হচ্ছিল। আমরা বাসায় ছিলাম।

Before: *It was raining, we stayed at home.* → full stop

8. I could not come because I was ill.

অসুস্থ ছিলাম বলে আসতে পারিনি।

Before: *becuase* → check spelling

9. The rent is high. However, the flat is near my office.

ভাড়া বেশি। তবে ফ্ল্যাটটা আমার অফিসের কাছে।

Before: *and, and, and* → use a better linking word

10. Please send me the information.

অনুগ্রহ করে আমাকে তথ্যগুলো পাঠান।

Before: *informations* → *information* has no -s

4 Common mistakes

X Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I am agree with this idea.	I agree with this idea.	Agree is already a verb. Don't add <i>am</i> .
He don't like tea.	He doesn't like tea.	With he/she/it, use <i>doesn't</i> .
Me and my friend went to Gulshan.	My friend and I went to Gulshan.	Use <i>I</i> as the subject, and put yourself last.
I have alot of work today.	I have a lot of work today.	<i>A lot</i> is two words.
I gave them many advices.	I gave them a lot of advice .	<i>Advice</i> and <i>information</i> never take -s.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Sadia is checking her friend Hasan's job application email.

Hasan: Can you check my email before I send it?

Sadia: Sure. Hmm, here you wrote "I am graduate from Dhaka University."

Hasan: Is that wrong?

Sadia: Say "I graduated from Dhaka University." It's a past action.

Hasan: Oh, right! Anything else?

Sadia: Just one thing: "an experienced", not "a experienced". Otherwise it's really good!

Now try this: Find one email or message you sent this week. Read it aloud and find one mistake.

6 Write it

Task: Edit this paragraph using the checklist. There are 8 mistakes.

My name is Karim. I am work in a bank in motijheel since 2020. Every day I wakes up at 6 am and take bus to office. My job is very interesting but sometime it is stressful. I meet many customer every day.

Model answer

My name is Karim. I **have worked** in a bank in **Motijheel** since 2020. Every day, I **wake** up at 6 am and take **a** bus to **the** office. My job is very interesting, **but sometimes** it is stressful. I meet many **customers** every day.

(45 words)

7 Exercises

A. Find and correct the mistake in each sentence

- 36.1** My father work in a garment factory.
36.2 Last week I buy a new phone.
36.3 She is a honest person.
36.4 we went to sylhet in june.
36.5 There is many shops in New Market.
36.6 I am agree with you.
36.7 The weather was hot, we stayed inside.

B. Which checklist item? (grammar, verbs, articles, punctuation, spelling)

- 36.8** *I recieved your email.* → *I received your email.*
36.9 *I saw elephant at the zoo.* → *I saw an elephant at the zoo.*

C. Edit it

- 36.10** Correct this short message: *dear sir, i can not come office today because i am sick. i will come tomorow.*

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Always leave a few minutes to **edit** before you send or submit.
- Read three times: **meaning**, then **grammar**, then **small things**.
- Check every **verb** (tense, -s, past forms) and every **noun** (a/an/the, plurals).
- Check capitals, full stops, spelling and word count.
- Use the checklist every time until it becomes a habit.

PART IV

Job Interview English

Chapter 37

Professional Vocabulary and Power Verbs

1 Why this matters

In an interview, two people can have the same experience, but one sounds strong and the other sounds weak. The difference is often just a few words. “I **did** some work with customers” sounds small. “I **handled** 40 customer calls a day” sounds professional. This chapter gives you the words that make your CV and your answers sound confident.

একই অভিজ্ঞতা দুর্বল শব্দে বললে ছোট শোনায়, আর শক্তিশালী শব্দে বললে পেশাদার শোনায়।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Ready-made professional phrases

These phrases are used in almost every interview. Learn them like a formula, then add **your own details**.

Phrase	Example answer
I'm responsible for ...	I'm responsible for checking daily cash reports at our branch.
I have experience in ...	I have experience in customer service and data entry.
I'm familiar with ...	I'm familiar with MS Excel, Google Sheets and Tally.
I'm good at ...	I'm good at explaining things to new customers.
I'm a quick learner.	I'm a quick learner. I learned our billing software in one week.
I work well under pressure.	I work well under pressure, especially at month-end.
I'm comfortable with ...	I'm comfortable with travelling to field offices.
I have a strong background in ...	I have a strong background in accounting.
I enjoy ...	I enjoy working with numbers and solving problems.
My main role was to ...	My main role was to follow up with buyers by email.

Teacher's tip: A phrase alone is empty. Always add **proof**: a number, a tool, or a short example.

I'm a quick learner → I'm a quick learner. I learned Python basics in two months from YouTube.

2. Power verbs

A **power verb** is a strong action word that shows **what you did**. Use the past form for past jobs and projects. Start your CV bullet points with them.

Power verb + what + number or result*Trained 12 new sales staff in two weeks.*

Verb	Bangla	CV / interview example
managed	পরিচালনা করেছি	Managed the club's budget of Tk 50,000.
led	নেতৃত্ব দিয়েছি	Led a team of five in my final-year project.
improved	উন্নত করেছি	Improved response time from two days to one day.
organised	আয়োজন করেছি	Organised a blood donation camp at DU.
created	তৈরি করেছি	Created a sales report template in Excel.
solved	সমাধান করেছি	Solved a common login problem for 200 users.
increased	বাড়িয়েছি	Increased monthly sales by 15%.
reduced	কমিয়েছি	Reduced printing costs by 20%.
trained	প্রশিক্ষণ দিয়েছি	Trained new staff on the billing system.
handled	সামলেছি	Handled 40 customer calls a day.
coordinated	সমন্বয় করেছি	Coordinated with buyers and factory teams.
developed	গড়ে তুলেছি	Developed a simple website for a local shop.
designed	নকশা করেছি	Designed posters for a university event.
achieved	অর্জন করেছি	Achieved 110% of my sales target.
completed	সম্পন্ন করেছি	Completed a three-month internship at BRAC.
supported	সহায়তা করেছি	Supported the HR team during recruitment.
prepared	প্রস্তুত করেছি	Prepared weekly reports for the manager.
analysed	বিশ্লেষণ করেছি	Analysed survey data from 300 farmers.
presented	উপস্থাপন করেছি	Presented our project to the department.
negotiated	দর-কম্বাকষি করেছি	Negotiated better prices with suppliers.
planned	পরিকল্পনা করেছি	Planned the delivery schedule for the week.
monitored	তদারকি করেছি	Monitored stock levels in the warehouse.
launched	চালু করেছি	Launched a Facebook page for our NGO project.
built	বানিয়েছি	Built a mobile app for class attendance.
tested	পরীক্ষা করেছি	Tested new software features before release.
communicated	যোগাযোগ করেছি	Communicated with clients by email and phone.
resolved	মিটিয়েছি	Resolved customer complaints within 24 hours.
maintained	বজায় রেখেছি	Maintained accurate records of all payments.
taught	পড়িয়েছি	Taught English to Class 8 students.
guided	পথ দেখিয়েছি	Guided junior volunteers during the flood relief.
volunteered	স্বেচ্ছাসেবা দিয়েছি	Volunteered with JAAGO Foundation for a year.
served	সেবা দিয়েছি	Served 100+ customers daily at the front desk.

3. Avoid weak words

Weak	Strong
I did many things.	I managed orders and prepared invoices.
I helped with the event.	I organised the registration desk for 300 guests.
I was involved in sales.	I handled 15 corporate clients.
I worked on a project.	I built the database for our project.
I am hardworking. (no proof)	I completed my degree while working part-time.

Teacher's tip: Words like *did*, *helped*, *was involved in* and *worked on* are not wrong, but they hide **what you really did**. Replace them with a power verb whenever you can.

3 Examples

1. I'm responsible for opening new accounts at the Mirpur branch.
আমি মিরপুর শাখায় নতুন অ্যাকাউন্ট খোলার দায়িত্বে আছি।
responsible for + -ing / noun
2. I have two years of experience in garments merchandising.
গার্মেন্টস মার্চেন্টাইজিং-এ আমার দুই বছরের অভিজ্ঞতা আছে।
experience in + field
3. I'm familiar with Photoshop and Canva.
আমি ফটোশপ আর ক্যানভা সম্পর্কে জানি।
familiar with + tool
4. I'm a quick learner, so I can pick up new software fast.
আমি দ্রুত শিখি, তাই নতুন সফটওয়্যার তাড়াতাড়ি ধরতে পারি।
claim + proof
5. I work well under pressure, especially before shipment deadlines.
চাপের মধ্যেও আমি ভালো কাজ করি, বিশেষ করে শিপমেন্টের সময়সীমার আগে।
Add *when*: this makes it believable.
6. I led a team of four volunteers in Sylhet.
আমি সিলেটে চারজন স্বেচ্ছাসেবকের একটা দলকে নেতৃত্ব দিয়েছি।
led = past of lead
7. I increased our page followers from 2,000 to 9,000.
আমি আমাদের পেজের ফলোয়ার ২,০০০ থেকে ৯,০০০-এ বাড়িয়েছি।
from ... to ... shows the result clearly
8. I handled customer complaints by phone and email.
আমি ফোন ও ইমেইলে গ্রাহকদের অভিযোগ সামলেছি।
handled = dealt with
9. I coordinated between the buyer and the factory.
আমি ক্রেতা আর কারখানার মধ্যে সমন্বয় করেছি।
coordinated between A and B
10. I trained three new interns on our reporting system.
আমি তিনজন নতুন ইন্টার্নকে আমাদের রিপোর্টিং সিস্টেমে প্রশিক্ষণ দিয়েছি।
trained + person + on + thing

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I have experience of 2 years in sales.	I have two years of experience in sales.	Natural order: number + <i>years of experience in</i> .
I am responsible to check reports.	I am responsible for checking reports.	<i>Responsible</i> takes for + -ing.
I am familiar in Excel.	I am familiar with Excel.	Always <i>familiar with</i> .
I am very much hardworking.	I am very hardworking.	<i>Very much</i> goes with verbs (<i>I like it very much</i>), not adjectives.
I manage the club last year.	I managed the club last year.	Past job or project → past tense verb.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Sadia is at an interview for a customer service job.

Interviewer: Can you tell me about your last job?

Sadia: Sure. I worked at a mobile phone company's call centre in Gulshan for one year.

Interviewer: What were you responsible for?

Sadia: I was responsible for handling customer calls. I handled about 50 calls a day.

Interviewer: Are you familiar with any CRM software?

Sadia: Yes, I'm familiar with Salesforce. I'm also a quick learner, so new systems are not a problem for me.

Interviewer: Good. And busy days?

Sadia: I work well under pressure. During Eid, I resolved complaints even when calls doubled.

Now try this: Say three sentences about yourself using *I'm responsible for*, *I'm familiar with* and one power verb from the table.

6 Write it

Task: Rewrite these weak CV lines with power verbs and numbers: (a) *I helped in a seminar*. (b) *I did tuition*. (c) *I worked on a project about mobile banking*.

Model answer

- (a) Organised a career seminar for 150 students at my university.
- (b) Taught Maths and English to four Class 9 students for two years.
- (c) Analysed survey data from 120 bKash users for my final-year project.

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blank with the correct word (for, with, in, of)

37.1 I'm familiar _____ Google Sheets.

37.2 I have three years _____ experience.

37.3 I'm responsible _____ preparing the payroll.

37.4 I have experience _____ teaching.

B. Correct the mistakes

37.5 I am very much punctual.

37.6 Last year I organise a book fair.

37.7 I am responsible to answer emails.

C. Replace the weak words with a power verb

37.8 I **did** the monthly sales report.

37.9 I **was involved in** a tree-planting programme.

D. Make a sentence

37.10 Write one CV line about yourself: power verb + what + number.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Use ready phrases: *I'm responsible for, I have experience in, I'm familiar with.*
- Always add **proof**: a number, a tool or a short example.
- Start CV lines with a **power verb** in the past tense: *managed, led, handled, trained.*
- Formula: **power verb + what + number or result.**
- Replace weak words (*did, helped, worked on*) with words that show what you really did.

Chapter 38

Top 30 Interview Questions (Part 1): About You

1 Why this matters

Most interviews in Bangladesh, from a bank viva to an NGO or software company interview, **start with questions about you**. The first five minutes decide how the panel sees you. If you have a clear, honest and short answer ready for each of these 15 questions, you will feel calm and sound confident.

ইন্টারভিউয়ের শুরুর প্রশ্নগুলো সাধারণত আপনাকে নিয়ে। আগে থেকে উত্তর তৈরি থাকলে আপনি শান্ত ও আত্মবিশ্বাসী থাকবেন।

2 The rule in plain words

Every “about you” answer can follow one simple shape: **Point, Proof, Link**.

Point (your main idea) → **Proof** (a real example or number) → **Link** (why it matters for this job)

মূল কথা → প্রমাণ বা উদাহরণ → চাকরির সাথে সম্পর্ক

✓ Do	✗ Don't
Speak for 45-90 seconds per answer.	Give a five-minute speech.
Use one real example with a number.	Use only adjectives: <i>I am honest, sincere, hardworking.</i>
Be honest, even about weaknesses.	Memorise and recite like a poem.
Talk about study, work and skills.	Start with your family history and birthplace.

Teacher's tip: Do not memorise these model answers word for word. Use them as a **pattern**, then put in **your own** subject, university, internship and numbers. A true, simple answer always beats a perfect, copied one.

Each question below has: **why they ask**, a **tip**, and a **model answer** from a different Bangladeshi job seeker.

Q1. Tell me about yourself.

Why they ask: To hear a short summary of you and to check your English and confidence. আপনার সংক্ষিপ্ত পরিচয় ও আত্মবিশ্বাস দেখতে।

Tip: Use **Present** → **Past** → **Future**: who you are now, what you have done, what you want next.
Nusrat, BBA graduate, applying for a bank officer post:

Model answer

I'm Nusrat Jahan, and I recently completed my BBA in Finance from the University of Dhaka with a CGPA of 3.62. In my final year, I did a three-month internship at Dutch-Bangla Bank, where I assisted customers with account opening and prepared daily cash reports. That experience showed me that I enjoy working with numbers and with people at the same time. I'm also familiar with MS Excel and basic banking software. Now I'm looking to start my career as a probationary officer, and your bank's focus on SME banking really interests me.

(93 words)

Q2. Walk me through your CV.

Why they ask: To see how your steps connect and to check that your CV is true. আপনার পড়াশোনা ও কাজের ধাপগুলো কীভাবে যুক্ত, তা দেখাতে।

Tip: Go in time order. Give one reason or result for each step. Do not read the CV aloud.

Adiyat, CSE graduate, applying for a software developer job:

Model answer

Sure. I passed my HSC from Notre Dame College in 2019, and then I studied Computer Science and Engineering at North South University. In my third year, I started building small websites for local businesses as a freelancer, which taught me how to work with real clients. In 2023, I did a four-month internship at a software company in Banani, where I worked on the backend of a hotel booking system using Laravel. After graduating, I completed an online course in React. So each step has moved me closer to a full-stack role like this one.

(96 words)

Q3. What are your strengths?

Why they ask: To see if your strengths match the job. আপনার শক্তি চাকরির সাথে মেলে কিনা, তা দেখাতে।

Tip: Choose **two** strengths that the job needs, and give proof for each.

Tania, applying for a sales officer job:

Model answer

I'd say my two main strengths are communication and persistence. During my internship at an FMCG company, I visited 25 to 30 shops a day in Mirpur, and I learned to talk to shopkeepers in a friendly and respectful way. Persistence helped me even more. One shopkeeper refused our product three times, but I kept visiting, listened to his concerns about price, and finally he placed a regular order. By the end of my internship, I had added 12 new retailers to our list. Both strengths are important in sales.

(90 words)

Q4. What is your biggest weakness?

Why they ask: To test your honesty and self-awareness. আপনি সং কিনা এবং নিজেকে চেনেন কিনা, তা দেখাতে।

Tip: Choose a **real** weakness that is not the main skill of the job, then show **what you are doing to improve**. Avoid the old trick "I'm a perfectionist."

Hasan, applying for an IT support job:

Model answer

Honestly, public speaking used to be difficult for me. In my second year, I had to present a group project, and I was so nervous that I spoke too fast. Since then, I have been working on it. I joined my university's debate club, and I now volunteer to present whenever I can. Last semester, I presented our thesis to a panel of four teachers, and it went well. I still get a little nervous, but I prepare carefully and practise in front of a mirror, so it no longer stops me.

(92 words)

Q5. How would your friends describe you?

Why they ask: To learn about your personality from another angle. অন্যের চোখে আপনি কেমন, তা জানতে।

Tip: Give **three** adjectives and a short example for at least one.

Mitu, applying for a field officer job at an NGO:

Model answer

I think my friends would describe me as reliable, calm and caring. In group assignments, they usually asked me to keep track of deadlines because they knew I would finish my part on time. They also say I stay calm when things go wrong. For example, during a flood relief programme in Sunamganj, our truck arrived late, and I helped the team reorganise the distribution so that families did not have to wait in the sun. I think these qualities are useful for field work at an NGO like yours.

(90 words)

Q6. What are your hobbies?

Why they ask: To see you as a person. Hobbies often show useful skills. মানুষ হিসেবে আপনাকে জানতে; শখ থেকেও দক্ষতা বোঝা যায়।

Tip: Pick a **real** hobby and say what it gives you. "Watching TV" or "sleeping" alone is a weak answer.

Karim, applying for a garments merchandiser job:

Model answer

In my free time, I enjoy photography and cricket. I take photos of street life in Old Dhaka and post them on my Instagram page, which now has about 3,000 followers. Photography has trained my eye for colour and detail, which I think is useful in merchandising, where small differences in fabric shade matter a lot. I also play cricket with my friends every Friday morning. It keeps me fit and reminds me how important teamwork is.

(77 words)

Q7. Why did you choose your subject?

Why they ask: To understand your interests and how you make decisions. আপনার আগ্রহ ও সিদ্ধান্ত নেওয়ার ধরন বুঝতে।

Tip: Give a real reason. If your subject is different from the job, talk about the **skills** you can bring.

Farhana, English graduate, applying for a school teacher job:

Model answer

I chose English because I loved reading story books as a child, and my English teacher at school made the subject feel alive. At university, I became more interested in how people learn a language, so I took extra courses in ELT. In my third year, I started teaching spoken English to Class 7 and 8 students at a coaching centre in Dhanmondi. Seeing them speak with more confidence each month made me sure that teaching is the right career for me.

(82 words)

Q8. What is your biggest achievement?

Why they ask: To see what you value and what you can do. আপনি কী করতে পারেন এবং কী গুরুত্ব দেন, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Choose **one** achievement and use numbers. (Chapter 40 shows you the STAR method for this.)

Rahim, applying for a management trainee job:

Model answer

My biggest achievement so far was organising a job fair at my university in my final year. I was the general secretary of our Career Club, and we had only six weeks and a small budget. I led a team of 15 volunteers, contacted over 40 companies, and found two sponsors to cover the costs. On the day, 22 companies took part and more than 1,200 students attended. Around 60 students got interview calls. It taught me how to plan, manage people and keep going when companies said no.

(89 words)

Q9. How do you handle stress?

Why they ask: Every job has pressure; they want to know you can manage it. কাজের চাপ সামলাতে পারবেন কিনা, তা জানতে।

Tip: Give a **method** and a short **example**. Never say "I never feel stress."

Sadia, applying for a customer service job:

Model answer

I handle stress by breaking big tasks into small steps and doing the most urgent ones first. During my final exams, I also had a part-time job at a call centre, so some weeks were very busy. I made a simple plan every morning and took short breaks to clear my mind. When a customer is angry, I remind myself that he is upset with the problem, not with me. That helps me stay calm and polite. Outside work, an evening walk also helps me relax.

(86 words)

Q10. Do you prefer working alone or in a team?

Why they ask: To see if you will fit their way of working. আপনি তাদের কাজের পরিবেশে মানিয়ে নিতে পারবেন কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Say you can do both, give an example, and lean towards what the job needs.

Adiyat, software developer:

Model answer

I'm comfortable with both. As a developer, I often need quiet time alone to write and test code carefully. But I believe good software is built by teams. In my final-year project, four

of us built an online library system. I worked on the database, and we met every two days to check our progress and solve problems together. When one teammate was stuck on the login page, I helped him fix it. So I enjoy focusing on my own tasks, but I always stay connected with the team.

(89 words)

Q11. How do you handle criticism?

Why they ask: To see if you can accept feedback and learn from it. সমালোচনা মেনে নিয়ে শিখতে পারেন কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Show that you **listen**, do not argue, and **improve**. Give one example.

Tania, applying for an office executive job:

Model answer

I try to see criticism as free advice. During my internship at an NGO, my supervisor told me that my field reports were too long and hard to read. At first I felt a little disappointed, but I asked her to show me a good example. After that, I started using short headings and bullet points, and I kept each report to two pages. A month later, she shared one of my reports with the whole team as a model. So now, when I get feedback, I listen first, ask questions, and then act on it.

(96 words)

Q12. What motivates you?

Why they ask: To know what drives you and whether this job can give you that. কী আপনাকে কাজে উৎসাহ দেয়, তা জানতে।

Tip: Be honest and connect it to the job. "Money" alone sounds weak, even if salary matters to everyone.

Hasan, applying for a bank job:

Model answer

I'm motivated by clear goals and by seeing real results from my work. When I know the target, I plan my day around it and enjoy tracking my progress. For example, as a part-time tutor, I set a goal for each student, and it was very satisfying when one weak student improved his Maths grade from C to A-minus. I'm also motivated by learning new things. In a bank, there will be targets and new systems to learn, and that is exactly the kind of place where I work best.

(90 words)

Q13. Describe a challenge you faced.

Why they ask: To see how you solve problems. আপনি কীভাবে সমস্যার সমাধান করেন, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Keep the background short. Spend most time on **what you did**, then give the **result** and the lesson.

Karim, garments merchandiser:

Model answer

During my internship at a garments factory in Gazipur, an order of 5,000 T-shirts was about to miss its shipment date because the fabric arrived a week late. I checked the production plan with the floor manager and found that two lines could work on our order if we moved

a smaller order by three days. I also updated the buyer by email every day. In the end, the shipment left on time, and the buyer placed a repeat order. I learned that clear communication is as important as hard work.

(91 words)

Q14. Why are you leaving your job? / Why is there a gap in your CV?

Why they ask: To check that there is no serious problem. কোনো বড় সমস্যা আছে কিনা, তা নিশ্চিত হতে।

Tip: Stay positive. **Never criticise** your old employer. For a gap, be honest and show you stayed active.

(a) Rahim, leaving a sales job:

Model answer

I have learned a lot in my two years as a sales executive at a pharmaceutical company, and I'm grateful for that. I achieved my targets in six out of eight quarters and trained two new team members. However, I feel ready for a bigger challenge, and there is limited scope for growth in my current role. Your company is expanding into new districts, and I believe I can use my field experience to help build those markets while I grow as a professional.

(84 words)

(b) Mitu, explaining a one-year gap:

Model answer

After my graduation in 2023, I took about a year away from full-time work because my father was seriously ill and I needed to look after him and help with our family business in Rajshahi. During that time, I managed the shop's accounts and stock, and I also completed an online course in digital marketing. My father is much better now, and I'm fully ready and excited to start my career.

(71 words)

Q15. What did you learn at university?

Why they ask: To see what you bring beyond your certificate. সার্টিফিকেটের বাইরে আপনি কী শিখেছেন, তা জানতে।

Tip: Mention one **subject skill** and one or two **life skills**, with a quick example.

Nusrat, bank officer:

Model answer

Apart from subject knowledge such as financial analysis and banking law, university taught me two important things. First, I learned to manage my time. In my final year, I was writing my internship report, taking three courses and doing a part-time tuition, and I still finished with a good result. Second, I learned to work with people from different backgrounds through group projects and club activities. I believe these skills will help me in a busy bank branch just as much as my degree.

(84 words)

3 Examples

1. I recently completed my BBA in Finance from the University of Dhaka.

আমি সম্প্রতি ঢাকা বিশ্ববিদ্যালয় থেকে ফিন্যান্সে বিবিএ শেষ করেছি।

A strong first sentence for Q1.

2. I'd say my two main strengths are communication and persistence.

আমি বলব আমার প্রধান দুটি শক্তি হলো যোগাযোগ দক্ষতা ও লেগে থাকা।

I'd say sounds polite and natural.

3. Honestly, public speaking used to be difficult for me.

সত্যি বলতে, আগে সবার সামনে কথা বলা আমার জন্য কঠিন ছিল।

used to = true in the past, not now

4. I have been working on it since my second year.

দ্বিতীয় বর্ষ থেকে আমি এটা নিয়ে কাজ করছি।

since + a point in time

5. My friends would describe me as reliable and calm.

আমার বন্ধুরা আমাকে নির্ভরযোগ্য ও শান্ত বলবে।

describe me as + adjective

6. In my free time, I enjoy photography.

অবসর সময়ে আমি ছবি তুলতে ভালোবাসি।

enjoy + noun / -ing

7. My biggest achievement so far was organising a job fair.

এখন পর্যন্ত আমার সবচেয়ে বড় অর্জন ছিল একটা চাকরি মেলা আয়োজন করা।

so far = until now

8. I try to see criticism as free advice.

আমি সমালোচনাকে বিনা পয়সার পরামর্শ হিসেবে দেখার চেষ্টা করি।

A positive, mature attitude

9. I'm motivated by clear goals.

স্পষ্ট লক্ষ্য আমাকে অনুপ্রাণিত করে।

motivated by

10. I took a year away from work to look after my father.

বাবার দেখাশোনা করার জন্য আমি এক বছর কাজ থেকে বিরতি নিয়েছিলাম।

Honest and simple: no long story needed

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I passed out from DU in 2023.	I graduated from DU in 2023.	In standard English, <i>pass out</i> means to faint (অজ্ঞান হওয়া).
I am doing job since two years.	I have been working for two years.	Use <i>for</i> + a period, <i>since</i> + a point in time, with the present perfect.
I have no weakness.	Public speaking used to be hard for me, but ...	Everyone has a weakness. "None" sounds dishonest.
My old boss was very bad.	I'm looking for more scope to grow .	Never criticise a past employer in an interview.
I am hardworking, sincere, honest, punctual.	I'm hardworking. For example , I ...	A list of adjectives with no proof means nothing.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Sadia is starting an interview at a bank in Motijheel.

Interviewer: Good morning, Sadia. Please have a seat.

Sadia: Thank you, sir. Good morning.

Interviewer: So, tell me about yourself.

Sadia: I recently completed my MBA in Marketing from Jahangirnagar University. I also worked part-time at a call centre for a year, where I handled about 50 calls a day.

Interviewer: Interesting. What's your biggest weakness?

Sadia: Honestly, I used to find Excel difficult. So last year I did a short online course, and now I make all my reports in Excel.

Interviewer: Good. How would your friends describe you?

Sadia: I think they'd say I'm patient, organised and cheerful.

Now try this: Answer Q1, Q3 and Q4 aloud about yourself. Time yourself: each answer should be under 90 seconds.

6 Write it

Task: Write your own answer to "Tell me about yourself" in 70-90 words. Use Present → Past → Future.

Model answer

My name is Sadia Islam. I recently completed my MBA in Marketing from Jahangirnagar University. For the last year, I have worked part-time at a call centre in Gulshan, where I handle around 50 customer calls a day and solve billing problems. This job improved my patience and my spoken English a lot. I'm also familiar with MS Office and Salesforce. Now I want to grow in a customer service role, and your company's reputation for good service is the reason I applied.

(83 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blank

38.1 My friends would describe me _____ hardworking and friendly.

38.2 I'm motivated _____ learning new things.

38.3 I _____ (graduate) from Chittagong University in 2024.

38.4 I have been teaching _____ 2022.

B. Correct the mistakes

38.5 I passed out from NSU last year.

38.6 I am doing tuition since three years.

38.7 My last company was very bad, so I left.

C. Answer these questions about yourself (2-3 sentences each)

38.8 What are your hobbies? Say what your hobby teaches you.

38.9 What is your biggest weakness? Show how you are improving.

38.10 What is your biggest achievement? Use at least one number.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary**Remember**

- Shape every answer as **Point** → **Proof** → **Link** to the job.
- For *Tell me about yourself*, use **Present** → **Past** → **Future**, not your family history.
- Give a **real** weakness and show how you are improving.
- Add one example with a **number** to make your answer believable.
- Stay positive: never criticise a past employer, and be honest about gaps.

Chapter 39

Top 30 Interview Questions (Part 2): The Job and Your Future

1 Why this matters

After learning about you, the panel wants to know two things: **Do you really want this job?** and **Will you fit and stay?** Questions about the company, salary, joining date and your future decide whether you get the offer letter. A weak answer here ("I need money") can undo all your good work.

এই প্রশ্নগুলো দিয়ে তারা বোঝে আপনি সত্যিই চাকরিটা চান কিনা এবং টিকে থাকবেন কিনা।

2 The rule in plain words

For job and future questions, think of **three circles**: what **you** can give, what **the job** needs, and what **the company** does. A good answer touches all three.

My skill or experience + what this job needs + something specific about your company

আমার দক্ষতা + এই চাকরির চাহিদা + প্রতিষ্ঠান সম্পর্কে নির্দিষ্ট তথ্য

Teacher's tip: Before every interview, spend 30 minutes on the company's **website**, **Facebook page**, **LinkedIn** and recent **news**. Write down three facts. You will use them in Q16, Q17 and Q18.

Q16. Why do you want this job?

Why they ask: To check your motivation and fit. আপনার আগ্রহ সত্যি কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Connect your skills, the role and the organisation. Never say "because I need a job."

Mitu, applying for a field officer job at an NGO:

Model answer

I want this job because it combines two things I care about: working directly with communities and using data to make decisions. During my internship with a microfinance programme in Bogura, I collected data from 80 women entrepreneurs and saw how small loans changed their lives. Your organisation's work on women's livelihoods in the northern districts is exactly the kind of work I want to be part of. As a field officer, I can use my communication skills and my experience with KoBoToolbox from the first day.

(87 words)

Q17. What do you know about our company?

Why they ask: To see if you prepared. আপনি প্রস্তুতি নিয়ে এসেছেন কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Mention two or three **facts**, then say what **impressed** you. ("SkyLine Apparels" below is an example name; use real facts about your company.)

Karim, applying for a junior merchandiser job:

Model answer

I know that SkyLine Apparels is one of the leading knitwear exporters in Gazipur, with around 6,000 workers, and that you mainly export to buyers in Europe. I read on your website that your factory has a LEED Gold certificate, which shows your focus on safety and the environment. I also saw on LinkedIn that you recently opened a new washing unit. What impressed me most is your training programme for junior merchandisers. I would love to grow in a company that invests in its people like that.

(88 words)

Q18. Why should we hire you?

Why they ask: This is your chance to sell yourself. নিজেকে তুলে ধরার সুযোগ।

Tip: Give **three** short reasons (skill, experience, attitude) and match them to the job advertisement.

Tania, applying for a sales officer job:

Model answer

I think I'm a good fit for three reasons. First, I have real field experience. During my internship, I added 12 new retailers in Mirpur in three months. Second, I'm comfortable with numbers. I tracked my daily sales in Excel and always knew how far I was from my target. Third, I don't give up easily, which matters a lot in sales. Your job ad asks for someone who can build relationships with shopkeepers and reach monthly targets, and that is exactly what I have been doing.

(87 words)

Q19. Where do you see yourself in five years?

Why they ask: To check your ambition and whether you will stay. আপনার লক্ষ্য কী এবং আপনি টিকে থাকবেন কিনা, তা জানতে।

Tip: Show **realistic growth** inside the company. Avoid "in your chair" or "abroad for higher studies."

Nusrat, applying for a probationary officer post:

Model answer

In five years, I see myself as an experienced banker, perhaps working as a senior officer or a relationship manager in the SME division. In the first two years, I want to learn branch banking thoroughly, from cash and accounts to credit. I also plan to complete the JAIBB banking diploma during that time. Most importantly, I hope to be someone my team and customers can trust. I'd be very happy to build that career here with your bank.

(79 words)

Q20. What are your salary expectations?

Why they ask: To see if your expectation matches their budget. আপনার প্রত্যাশা তাদের বাজেটের সাথে মেলে কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Research first (Bdjobs, LinkedIn, friends in the field). Give a **range**, not one number, and show you are **flexible**. You can also ask first: *"Could you tell me the salary range for this position?"*

Entry-level job (Dhaka)	Rough monthly range
Probationary officer, private bank	Tk 45,000 – 70,000
Junior software engineer	Tk 35,000 – 60,000
NGO field officer	Tk 25,000 – 40,000
Junior merchandiser	Tk 25,000 – 40,000
Sales officer	Tk 20,000 – 35,000 + incentive
Customer service / call centre	Tk 18,000 – 28,000
Private school teacher	Tk 15,000 – 30,000

These figures are only rough examples. Salaries change every year and differ by company and city, so always check the current market.

Adiyat, applying for a junior developer job:

Model answer

Thank you for asking. Based on my research on Bdjobs and talking to friends in the industry, junior developers with my skills usually earn between Tk 40,000 and Tk 50,000 a month in Dhaka. So I would expect a salary in that range. However, the learning opportunity and growth in this role are just as important to me as the salary, so I'm open to discussing it, including benefits such as festival bonuses and training.

(75 words)

Q21. Can you work under pressure or do overtime?

Why they ask: Deadlines and busy seasons are real. সময়সীমা ও ব্যস্ত সময়ে কাজ করতে পারবেন কিনা, তা জানতে।

Tip: Say yes with an **example**, and show that you also **plan** to avoid last-minute pressure. *Karim, junior merchandiser:*

Model answer

Yes, I can. I know that in merchandising, shipment dates don't move, so some weeks will be very busy. During my internship, I stayed until 9 p.m. several times before a shipment to check final inspection reports, and I didn't mind because I understood how important it was. At the same time, I believe good planning reduces last-minute pressure, so I keep a daily task list and follow up with suppliers early. So yes, I'm ready to put in extra hours when the work needs it.

(86 words)

Q22. Are you willing to relocate or travel?

Why they ask: Many banks, NGOs and companies have offices outside Dhaka. ঢাকার বাইরে পোস্টিং বা ভ্রমণে রাজি কিনা, তা জানতে।

Tip: Be honest. If you have a limit, say it politely: *"At the moment I prefer Chattogram because of my family, but I'm open to discussing it."* *Mitu, NGO field officer:*

Model answer

Yes, I'm happy to relocate. I understand that most of your projects are in the northern and coastal districts, and I believe working in the field is the best way to understand the communities we serve. I lived in Rangpur for four years during my studies, so I'm used to living away from my family. I'm also comfortable with regular travel to project sites, even by motorbike or boat when needed.

(71 words)

Q23. How soon can you join?

Why they ask: To plan their team. কবে যোগ দিতে পারবেন, তা জেনে পরিকল্পনা করতে।

Tip: Give a **clear** answer. A fresh graduate can usually say "immediately" or "within a week."
Sadia, fresh MBA graduate, applying for a customer service job:

Model answer

I can join immediately. I have completed my MBA, and my final results are already published, so I don't have any other commitments right now. If you need me to submit any documents or complete a medical check first, I can do that within this week. I'm really excited about this role, so I'd be happy to start as early as next Sunday.

(63 words)

Q24. What is your notice period?

Why they ask: To know when you can really start. বর্তমান চাকরি ছাড়তে কত দিন নোটিশ দিতে হবে, তা জানতে।

Tip: Tell the truth, and show that you will leave your current job **properly**. That makes you look professional.

Rahim, sales executive:

Model answer

My current contract has a notice period of one month. I would like to give my present employer the full notice so that I can hand over my clients and files properly, because I believe that's the professional way to leave. So I could join you around the first week of next month. If it's urgent, I can ask my manager whether an earlier release is possible, but I don't want to promise that before speaking to him.

(78 words)

Q25. Why this industry?

Why they ask: To see if you are committed to the field, not just to any job. এই খাতের প্রতি আপনার আগ্রহ কতটা, তা বুঝতে।

Tip: Give a personal reason and show you know where the industry is going.
Hasan, applying for an IT support job:

Model answer

I chose the IT industry because it is growing fast in Bangladesh, and it touches almost every part of daily life, from bKash payments to online classes. I first got interested when I fixed computers for my neighbours in Khulna as a teenager. Later, during my internship, I saw how a small software fix could save a client hours of work every week. I like an industry where I keep learning, and where my work can help businesses and ordinary people directly.

(82 words)

Q26. How do you keep learning?

Why they ask: Jobs change fast; they want people who learn on their own. আপনি নিজে নিজে শেখেন কিনা, তা জানতে।

Tip: Name **specific** sources and one **recent** thing you learned.

Farhana, applying for a school teacher job:

Model answer

I try to learn something new every week. I follow the British Council's teaching resources and watch short training videos on YouTube. Last year, I completed a free online course on teaching young learners on Coursera. I also learn from colleagues. At my coaching centre, two other teachers and I meet once a month to share activities that worked in class. Recently, I started using simple quizzes on Google Forms, and my students love them.

(75 words)

Q27. What would you do in your first 90 days?

Why they ask: To see if you can plan and have realistic expectations. আপনি পরিকল্পনা করতে পারেন কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Use three steps: **learn** (first month) → **start doing** (second) → **deliver results** (third).

Tania, sales officer:

Model answer

In the first 30 days, I would focus on learning our products, prices, the sales system and my territory. I'd also travel with a senior colleague to meet our key retailers. In the next 30 days, I would start handling my own route and set small weekly targets to build confidence and relationships. By the end of 90 days, I hope to be reaching my full monthly target and to have added a few new shops to our list. Throughout, I would ask my manager for regular feedback.

(88 words)

Q28. Describe your ideal manager.

Why they ask: To see if you will work well with their managers. তাদের ম্যানেজারদের সাথে মানিয়ে চলতে পারবেন কিনা, তা দেখতে।

Tip: Stay positive and flexible. Talk about **clear goals** and **feedback**, not about a "soft" boss.

Hasan, applying for a bank job:

Model answer

My ideal manager is someone who gives clear goals and honest feedback. I don't need someone to watch every small task, but I appreciate a manager who is available when I have questions, especially when I'm new. During my internship, my supervisor met me for ten minutes every Thursday to review my work, and I improved very quickly because of that. That said, I know every manager has a different style, and I'm happy to adjust to the way my team works.

(82 words)

Q29. Are you applying elsewhere?

Why they ask: To understand your situation and timeline. আপনার অবস্থা ও সময়সূচি বুঝতে।

Tip: Be honest but brief. You do not need to name other companies.

Nusrat, probationary officer:

Model answer

Yes, I have applied to a few other banks, and I have one more interview next week. I think it's natural for a fresh graduate to explore different options. However, to be honest, this position is my first choice, because your training programme for new officers is one of the best in the country, and your SME focus matches my internship experience. So if I receive an offer from you, I would be very happy to accept it.

(78 words)

Q30. Do you have any questions for us?

Why they ask: To see your interest. "No" sounds like you don't care. আপনার আগ্রহ বোঝার জন্য; "না" বললে অনাগ্রহ বোঝায়।

Tip: Always ask one or two questions. Do not start with salary or leave. Chapter 42 gives you a full list of good questions.

Model answer

Yes, thank you. I have two questions. First, what does a typical day look like for a new officer in this role? And second, how do you measure success in the first six months? I'd like to know what I should focus on if I join.

(46 words)

3 Examples

1. I want this job because it matches my skills and interests.

চাকরিটা চাই কারণ এটা আমার দক্ষতা ও আগ্রহের সাথে মেলে।

Better than because I need a job.

2. I read on your website that you export to Europe.

আপনাদের ওয়েবসাইটে পড়েছি যে আপনারা ইউরোপে রপ্তানি করেন।

Shows you prepared.

3. I think I'm a good fit for three reasons.

আমার মনে হয় তিনটি কারণে আমি এই পদের জন্য উপযুক্ত।

good fit = right person for the job

4. In five years, I see myself as a senior officer.

পাঁচ বছর পর নিজেকে একজন সিনিয়র অফিসার হিসেবে দেখি।

see myself as + job

5. I'm expecting a salary between Tk 40,000 and Tk 50,000.

আমি ৪০,০০০ থেকে ৫০,০০০ টাকার মধ্যে বেতন আশা করছি।

between ... and ... = a range

6. I'm open to discussing it.

এটা নিয়ে আলোচনা করতে আমি রাজি।

Polite way to show you are flexible.

7. I'm happy to relocate.

অন্য জায়গায় বদলি হতে আমার আপত্তি নেই।

relocate = move to another city for work

8. I can join immediately.

আমি এখনই যোগ দিতে পারি।

Not from immediate.

9. My notice period is one month.

আমার নোটিশ পিরিয়ড এক মাস।

The time you must work after you resign.

10. Could you tell me what a typical day looks like?

একটা সাধারণ দিন কেমন কাটে, বলবেন কি?

A good question for the end of the interview.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I want this job because I need money.	I want this job because it matches my skills .	Talk about fit and growth, not only your need.
My expected salary is Tk 45,000, not less.	I'm expecting between Tk 40,000 and Tk 50,000, but I'm open to discussing it.	One fixed number sounds rigid. A range sounds professional.
In five years, I will go abroad.	In five years, I see myself growing here as a senior officer.	They want someone who will stay.
I can join from immediate.	I can join immediately .	<i>Immediately</i> is an adverb; no <i>from</i> .
No, I don't have any questions.	Yes, could you tell me ...?	"No" sounds like you are not interested.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Adiyat is at the end of his interview at a software company in Banani.

Interviewer: What are your salary expectations, Adiyat?

Adiyat: Based on my research, I'm expecting between Tk 40,000 and Tk 50,000, but I'm open to discussing it.

Interviewer: That's within our range. How soon can you join?

Adiyat: I can join immediately. I've finished all my exams.

Interviewer: Great. Are you applying elsewhere?

Adiyat: Yes, to two other companies, but honestly, this job is my first choice.

Interviewer: Good to know. Do you have any questions for us?

Adiyat: Yes. Which technologies will I work with in my first project?

Now try this: Answer Q20 and Q23 aloud for a job you want. Use a real salary range for that job.

6 Write it

Task: Write your answer to "Why should we hire you?" in 70-90 words. Give three reasons.

Model answer

You should hire me for three reasons. First, I have the right skills: I'm familiar with MS Office and Salesforce, and my spoken English is good. Second, I have relevant experience. For

one year, I handled around 50 customer calls a day at a call centre in Gulshan. Third, I stay patient with difficult customers, and my supervisor gave me the “Best Service” award twice. I believe I can start helping your customers from the first week.

(77 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blank

- 39.1** In five years, I see myself _____ a team leader.
- 39.2** I’m expecting a salary _____ Tk 30,000 and Tk 35,000.
- 39.3** I’m open _____ discussing the salary.
- 39.4** My notice period _____ two months.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 39.5** I can join from immediate.
- 39.6** I want this job because I need money.
- 39.7** No, I have no question.

C. Answer for a job you want (2-3 sentences each)

- 39.8** What do you know about our company? (Use a real company you like.)
- 39.9** Are you willing to relocate?
- 39.10** What would you do in your first 90 days?

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Link three things: **your skills, the job’s needs** and **the company**.
- Research the company before the interview and learn three facts.
- For salary, give a **range** in Tk and say you are open to discussing it.
- Show realistic growth **inside** the company when you talk about your future.
- Always ask one or two questions at the end (see Chapter 42).

Chapter 40

Answering Experience Questions with STAR

1 Why this matters

Many interview questions begin with “**Tell me about a time when...**” or “**Give me an example of...**”. The panel wants a **real story**, not a promise. Many candidates either talk for five minutes without a point, or give one vague line. The **STAR** method gives your story a clear beginning, middle and end.

“একটা উদাহরণ দিন” ধরনের প্রশ্নে বাস্তব ঘটনা চাই। STAR পদ্ধতি আপনার গল্পকে গুছিয়ে বলতে সাহায্য করে।

2 The rule in plain words

STAR stands for **S**ituation, **T**ask, **A**ction, **R**esult. Tell your story in this order.

Part	Answers the question	Useful phrases	Length
Situation	Where? When? What was happening?	<i>Last year, while I was working at... / During my internship at...</i>	1-2 lines
Task	What was your job or goal?	<i>My task was to... / I was asked to... / We needed to...</i>	1 line
Action	What did you do, step by step?	<i>First, I... Then I... I also... Finally, I...</i>	the longest part
Result	What happened? What did you learn?	<i>As a result,... / In the end,... / I learned that...</i>	1-2 lines

S + T (about 20%) → **A** (about 60%) → **R** (about 20%)

Tell the story in the **past tense**, and say **I**, not only **we**.

ঘটনা অতীত কালে বলুন, আর “আমি” কী করেছি তা স্পষ্ট করুন।

Teacher’s tip: Prepare **four or five** STAR stories before your interview: a problem you solved, a team project, a time you led, a mistake you fixed, and a busy or stressful time. One good story can answer many different questions.

Model 1: Past work

Question: “Tell me about a time you dealt with a difficult situation at work.”

Sadia, customer service executive:

Model answer

(S) Last year, I was working at a call centre for an internet company in Gulshan. After a system update, about 300 customers were charged twice on their monthly bill, and our phone lines were full of angry callers. **(T)** As a senior agent, my task was to help our team handle the calls quickly and keep customers calm.

(A) First, I asked the billing team for the exact cause and the refund date. Then I wrote a short, clear script in Bangla and English so every agent gave the same correct answer. I also made a simple Google Sheet to record each affected customer, so nobody had to explain the problem twice. Finally, I called back the ten angriest customers myself.

(R) As a result, our average call time fell from eight minutes to four, and all refunds were completed within five days. My manager later used my script as a model for other problems.

(152 words)

Model 2: A university project

Question: "Give me an example of when you worked in a team."

Adiyat, CSE graduate:

Model answer

(S) In my final year at North South University, four of us were building a hospital appointment app for our capstone project. Three weeks before the deadline, one teammate left the course for family reasons. **(T)** We had to finish his part, the payment module, without missing the deadline.

(A) I called a team meeting the same day, and we listed every unfinished task on a Trello board. I offered to take the payment module because I had used the bKash sandbox before. I watched tutorials in the evenings and asked our supervisor for help when I got stuck. I also suggested short online check-ins every two days, so problems did not grow.

(R) In the end, we submitted the app two days early and received an A. Our project was also chosen for the department's project fair. I learned that clear planning keeps a team calm, even when things go wrong.

(148 words)

Model 3: A problem you solved

Question: "Describe a problem you solved."

Mitu, NGO field officer:

Model answer

(S) During my internship with an NGO in Bogura, I worked with women's savings groups in three villages. Attendance at the weekly meetings had dropped to about 40%. **(T)** My supervisor asked me to find out why and to improve attendance within two months.

(A) First, I visited 20 members at home and simply asked them what the problem was. Most of them said the meetings started at 11 a.m., exactly when they were cooking lunch. I shared this with my supervisor and the group leaders, and we moved the meetings to 3 p.m. I also started calling each member the evening before as a reminder, and we added a short session on mobile banking, which many women had asked for.

(R) Within six weeks, attendance rose to 85%. The NGO later used the same timing in five more villages. I learned that the best solutions often come from listening first.

(133 words)

3 Examples

- 1.** During my internship at Robi, I worked in the customer care team.
রবিতে ইন্টার্নশিপের সময় আমি কাস্টমার কেয়ার টিমে কাজ করেছি।
Situation: set the scene quickly.
- 2.** Last year, while I was working at a garments factory, a shipment was delayed.
গত বছর একটা গার্মেন্টস কারখানায় কাজ করার সময় একটা শিপমেন্ট দেরি হয়েছিল।
Situation: *while I was + -ing*
- 3.** My task was to reduce customer complaints.
আমার কাজ ছিল গ্রাহকদের অভিযোগ কমানো।
Task: one clear goal
- 4.** I was asked to organise the annual sports day.
আমাকে বার্ষিক ক্রীড়া দিবস আয়োজন করতে বলা হয়েছিল।
Task: passive *I was asked to*
- 5.** First, I made a list of all the unpaid bills.
প্রথমে আমি সব বকেয়া বিলের একটা তালিকা করলাম।
Action: start with *First*
- 6.** Then I called each customer and explained the new rule.
তারপর আমি প্রত্যেক গ্রাহককে ফোন করে নতুন নিয়মটা বুঝিয়ে বললাম।
Action: *Then* shows the next step
- 7.** Finally, I shared a short report with my manager.
শেষে আমি ম্যানেজারকে একটা ছোট রিপোর্ট দিলাম।
Action: *Finally* ends the steps
- 8.** As a result, sales went up by 20% in two months.
ফলে দুই মাসে বিক্রি ২০% বেড়ে গেল।
Result: give a number
- 9.** In the end, the client renewed the contract.
শেষ পর্যন্ত ক্লায়েন্ট চুক্তি নবায়ন করলেন।
Result: what finally happened
- 10.** I learned that good planning saves time.
আমি শিখলাম যে ভালো পরিকল্পনা সময় বাঁচায়।
Lesson: one short line

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Stopping after the actions: "... and then I called the customers."	Add a result: " As a result , complaints fell by half."	No result means the story has no ending. Always say what happened.
A two-minute Situation about the company and the people.	Situation in one or two lines , then move on.	The panel cares most about your actions .
We did this, we did that.	I made the list. I called the buyer.	They are hiring you, not your team. Show your part.
<i>I always solve problems quickly.</i>	Last March , I solved...	STAR needs one specific time , not a general claim.
Then I call the manager and he say okay.	Then I called the manager and he said okay.	A finished story is in the past tense .

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Hasan is in an interview for an IT support job. Notice the S, T, A and R.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you solved a technical problem.

Hasan: Sure. During my internship at a school in Khulna, the computer lab's internet stopped working a day before an online exam.

Interviewer: What did you have to do?

Hasan: I had to get the lab working by the next morning. First, I checked the router and found a faulty cable. Then I replaced it and reset the network settings on all 30 computers. I also tested each one with a sample exam.

Interviewer: And the result?

Hasan: The exam started on time, and the principal asked me to check the lab every week after that.

Now try this: Tell a partner a STAR story about a time you helped a friend or family member. Keep it under two minutes.

6 Write it

Task: Answer "Tell me about a time you showed leadership" in 80–120 words. Label S, T, A and R.

Model answer

(S) In my third year at Chittagong University, our department planned a tree-planting day, but only eight students signed up. **(T)** As class representative, I had to get at least 50 volunteers in two weeks. **(A)** First, I made a short Facebook video explaining why the campus needed more trees. Then I visited every class and asked each to send five volunteers. I also asked a local nursery to donate 200 saplings. **(R)** As a result, 72 students joined, and we planted 200 trees in one morning. I learned that people join when they understand the reason.

(93 words)

7 Exercises

A. Which part of STAR is it? Write S, T, A or R.

- 40.1** As a result, we finished the project one week early.
- 40.2** During my internship at a bank in Sylhet, many customers complained about long queues.
- 40.3** First, I made a token system for the counters.
- 40.4** My task was to reduce the waiting time.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 40.5** Then I call the supplier and he agree to send the fabric.
- 40.6** In the end, the result was came very good.
- 40.7** My task was organise a seminar.

C. Write

- 40.8** Write a **Result** sentence with a number for this action: *I made a delivery schedule for our drivers.*
- 40.9** This answer has no result: *"Our club had no money for the event, so I asked three local shops for sponsorship."* Add one.
- 40.10** Write a full STAR answer (60–100 words) to: *"Tell me about a time you worked under pressure."*

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- STAR = **Situation, Task, Action, Result**. Use it for every "Tell me about a time..." question.
- Keep S and T short; spend most of your time on **Action**.
- Always finish with a **Result**, ideally with a number, and one lesson.
- Say **I** and use the **past tense**.
- Prepare four or five true stories before the interview.

Chapter 41

Handling Difficult Moments in an Interview

1 Why this matters

Every interview has a hard moment. You miss a question, you don't know an answer, or your mind goes blank. Interviewers know this. They are not only checking your answers; they are watching **how you stay calm**. A few ready phrases can turn a bad moment into a good impression.

প্রতিটি ইন্টারভিউতেই কঠিন মুহূর্ত আসে। কয়েকটি তৈরি বাক্য জানা থাকলে আপনি শান্তভাবে পরিস্থিতি সামলাতে পারবেন।

2 The rule in plain words

The rule is simple: **never stay silent and never panic**. Use a short, polite phrase, then answer.

Stay calm → Use a ready phrase → Give a short, honest answer

1. You didn't hear or understand the question

- *Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?*
- *I'm sorry, I didn't catch that. Could you say it again?*
- *Could you explain what you mean by "KPI"?*
- *Just to check, are you asking about my university project or my internship?*

প্রশ্ন বুঝতে না পারলে আন্দাজে উত্তর দেবেন না। ভদ্রভাবে আবার জিজ্ঞেস করুন।

2. You need a few seconds to think

- *That's a good question. Let me think for a moment.*
- *Let me think about that for a second.*
- *That's an interesting question. I'd say...*

Three to five seconds of quiet thinking is fine. It looks careful, not weak.

3. You don't know the answer

Say it honestly, then show **how you would find out**.

Step 1: Be honest	Step 2: Show what you would do
<i>I'm not sure about that, to be honest.</i>	<i>But I would check the company policy or ask my supervisor.</i>
<i>I haven't used that software yet.</i>	<i>But I learn quickly. I learned Excel in two weeks for my internship.</i>
<i>I don't know the exact figure.</i>	<i>I would look it up on Bangladesh Bank's website.</i>

4. You made a mistake

- *Sorry, let me correct that. I meant 2023, not 2021.*
- *Actually, can I say that again more clearly?*

Correct it quickly, smile, and move on. Don't apologise again and again.

5. Your mind goes blank

- *Sorry, I've lost my train of thought. Could you remind me of the question?*
- *Can I come back to this question in a minute?*

Take a slow breath. Repeat the question in your head, then start with one simple point.

6. A tough or unfair question

Some questions feel personal (*Why is your CGPA low? Are you planning to get married soon?*). Stay polite. Give a short answer and **turn back to the job**.

- *My CGPA is 2.9. I worked part-time during my studies, and that taught me time management.*
- *I'd prefer to keep my personal plans private, but I can assure you I'm fully committed to this role.*

Teacher's tip: Never argue with the interviewer and never say "That's a stupid question." A calm answer to a hard question often impresses more than a perfect answer to an easy one.

3 Examples

1. Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?
দুঃখিত, প্রশ্নটা কি আরেকবার বলবেন?
Polite and safe when you didn't hear clearly.
2. Could you explain what you mean by "cross-selling"?
"ক্রস-সেলিং" বলতে আপনি কী বোঝাচ্ছেন, একটু বুঝিয়ে বলবেন?
Ask about one word you don't know.
3. That's a good question. Let me think for a moment.
ভালো প্রশ্ন। আমাকে একটু ভাবতে দিন।
Buy you three to five seconds.
4. I'm not sure, but I would ask my team leader.
আমি নিশ্চিত নই, তবে আমি আমার টিম লিডারকে জিজ্ঞেস করতাম।
Honest + a plan.

5. I haven't worked with SAP yet, but I'm a fast learner.
আমি এখনো SAP নিয়ে কাজ করিনি, তবে আমি দ্রুত শিখি।
Admit the gap, then show a strength.
6. Sorry, let me correct that. I graduated in 2024.
দুঃখিত, আমি শুধরে বলছি। আমি ২০২৪ সালে স্নাতক হয়েছি।
Fix it quickly and move on.
7. I've lost my train of thought. Could you remind me of the question?
আমি কথার খেঁই হারিয়ে ফেলেছি। প্রশ্নটা কি আরেকবার মনে করিয়ে দেবেন?
Honest and natural.
8. Can I come back to this question in a minute?
আমি কি এক মিনিট পরে এই প্রশ্নে ফিরে আসতে পারি?
Use this only once in an interview.
9. Just to check, do you mean my final-year project?
নিশ্চিত হওয়ার জন্য বলছি, আপনি কি আমার ফাইনাল ইয়ারের প্রজেক্টের কথা বলছেন?
Check before you answer the wrong question.
10. I'd prefer to keep that private, but I'm fully committed to this job.
আমি বিষয়টা ব্যক্তিগত রাখতে চাই, তবে আমি এই চাকরির প্রতি পুরোপুরি আন্তরিক।
Polite way to handle a personal question.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
What? / Huh?	Sorry, could you repeat that, please?	<i>What?</i> alone sounds rude in an interview.
Please repeat again.	Could you repeat that, please?	<i>Repeat</i> already means "say again". <i>Repeat again</i> is extra.
I don't know. (and silence)	I'm not sure, but I would find out by...	Never stop at <i>I don't know</i> . Add a plan.
Sorry, sorry, sorry, I am very nervous...	Sorry, let me start again.	One short apology is enough. Then continue.
I am not understanding the question.	I don't understand the question.	<i>Understand</i> is not used in the -ing form here.

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Sadia is interviewing for a junior officer job at a bank in Motijheel.

Interviewer: What do you know about Basel III?

Sadia: Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?

Interviewer: Basel III. What do you know about it?

Sadia: That's a good question. Let me think for a moment... I know it is about bank capital rules. To be honest, I don't know the details yet, but I would study Bangladesh Bank's guidelines in my first week.

Interviewer: Fine. When did you finish your BBA?

Sadia: In 2022. Sorry, let me correct that. I finished in 2023.

Interviewer: No problem. Thank you.

Now try this: Your interviewer asks, “*What is your view on blockchain in banking?*” You don’t know much. Answer in two sentences: be honest and give a plan.

6 Write it

Task: Write what you would say to these three hard moments: (a) a question you didn’t hear, (b) a question you can’t answer, (c) a question about your low result.

Model answer

- (a) I’m sorry, I didn’t catch that. Could you say it again, please?
- (b) That’s a good question. I’m not sure about the answer, to be honest, but I would read the company’s annual report to find out.
- (c) My HSC result was not very strong because I was ill that year. But I worked hard at university and finished with a CGPA of 3.4.

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

- 41.1** Sorry, could you _____ the question, please?
- 41.2** That’s a good question. Let me _____ for a moment.
- 41.3** I’m not _____, but I would ask my supervisor.
- 41.4** Sorry, let me _____ that. I meant 2024.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 41.5** Please repeat again the question.
- 41.6** I am not understanding what you mean.
- 41.7** What? Say again.

C. What would you say?

- 41.8** The interviewer uses the word “onboarding” and you don’t know it.
- 41.9** Your mind goes blank in the middle of an answer.
- 41.10** The interviewer asks, “*Why should we hire you when you have no experience?*” Give a calm two-sentence answer.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Didn't hear? Say **Sorry, could you repeat that, please?** Never just *What?*
- Need time? Say **That's a good question. Let me think for a moment.**
- Don't know? Be honest, then say **how you would find out.**
- Made a mistake? **Correct it once** and move on.
- Tough question? Stay calm, answer briefly, and **bring it back to the job.**

Chapter 42

Questions to Ask and Closing the Interview

1 Why this matters

Almost every interview ends with: *“Do you have any questions for us?”* If you say “No”, you look uninterested. One or two good questions and a polite closing show that you are serious about the job. The last two minutes are what the interviewer remembers best.

ইন্টারভিউয়ের শেষে ভালো প্রশ্ন করা আর ভদ্রভাবে বিদায় নেওয়া আপনাকে আগ্রহী ও সিরিয়াস প্রার্থী হিসেবে তুলে ধরে।

2 The rule in plain words

10 good questions to ask

Prepare three. Ask one or two. Choose questions about **the work, learning and the team**.

Question	What it shows
1 What does a typical day look like in this role?	You want to understand the work.
2 What are the most important tasks in the first three months?	You plan ahead.
3 What kind of training do new employees get?	You want to learn.
4 Who will I work with most closely?	You care about the team.
5 How do you measure success in this position?	You want to do well.
6 What do you like most about working here?	Friendly, builds a connection.
7 What are the biggest challenges for this team right now?	You are ready for problems.
8 Are there chances to grow or move to other departments?	You want a long career here.
9 Is there anything in my background you would like me to explain more?	Confident and open.
10 What are the next steps in the hiring process?	Clear and practical.

Questions to avoid at first

Do not ask these in the **first** interview. Wait until they offer you the job or raise the topic.

- *How much is the salary? / When will I get an increment?*
- *How many days of leave do I get?*
- *Can I leave early on some days?*
- *What does your company do?* (You should already know this from their website.)

প্রথম ইন্টারভিউতে বেতন, ছুটি বা আগে চলে যাওয়ার কথা জিজ্ঞেস করবেন না।

Teacher's tip: If they ask about salary first, you can say: *"I'm open to a fair offer based on the company's salary structure."* If you must give a number, give a realistic range, for example *Tk 30,000 to Tk 35,000.*

Closing the interview: 3 steps

- 1. Thank** → *Thank you very much for your time today.*
- 2. Restate interest** → *I'm really interested in this role, and I believe I can add value to your team.*
- 3. Ask about next steps** → *When can I expect to hear from you?*

Then stand up, smile, shake hands if they offer, and say *"Have a good day."*

The thank-you email

Send a short email **on the same day** or the next morning. Keep it to 4–6 sentences: thank them, mention one thing you discussed, restate your interest, and sign off.

3 Examples

- 1. What does a typical day look like in this role?**
এই পদে একটা সাধারণ দিন কেমন কাটে?
The safest first question.
- 2. What kind of training do new employees get?**
নতুন কর্মীরা কী ধরনের প্রশিক্ষণ পায়?
Shows you want to learn.
- 3. How do you measure success in this position?**
এই পদে সফলতা কীভাবে মাপা হয়?
Shows you want to do well.
- 4. What do you like most about working here?**
এখানে কাজ করার কোন দিকটা আপনার সবচেয়ে ভালো লাগে?
A friendly, personal question.
- 5. What are the next steps in the hiring process?**
নিয়োগ প্রক্রিয়ার পরবর্তী ধাপ কী?
Always useful at the end.
- 6. Thank you very much for your time today.**
আজ সময় দেওয়ার জন্য আপনাকে অনেক ধন্যবাদ।
Step 1 of closing.
- 7. I'm really interested in this position.**
আমি এই পদের ব্যাপারে সত্যিই আগ্রহী।
Step 2: restate interest.
- 8. When can I expect to hear from you?**
আপনাদের কাছ থেকে কবে খবর পাওয়ার আশা করতে পারি?
Step 3: ask about next steps.
- 9. It was a pleasure meeting you.**

আপনার সাথে দেখা করে ভালো লাগল।

Say this while leaving.

10. I enjoyed learning about your new branch in Sylhet.

সিলেটে আপনাদের নতুন শাখা সম্পর্কে জানতে পেরে ভালো লাগল।

Mention a detail from the interview in your email.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
No, I have no question.	Yes, I'd like to ask what a typical day looks like.	Saying <i>no</i> shows low interest.
What is the salary? (first question)	What kind of training do new employees get?	Salary comes later, usually after an offer.
When you will inform me?	When will you inform me?	In questions, <i>will</i> comes before the subject.
Thanks for giving me your valuable time.	Thank you for your time today.	Simple is better; <i>valuable time</i> sounds old-fashioned.
I am very much interested in this post.	I am very interested in this position.	Use <i>very interested</i> ; <i>position</i> or <i>role</i> sounds more modern than <i>post</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this aloud. Adiyat is finishing his interview at a pharmaceutical company in Gulshan.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions for us?

Adiyat: Yes, thank you. What does a typical day look like for a junior sales officer?

Interviewer: You'll visit doctors and pharmacies in your area and report to the area manager.

Adiyat: That sounds great. And what kind of training do new officers get?

Interviewer: A two-week product training in Dhaka.

Adiyat: Wonderful. Thank you very much for your time today. I'm really interested in this role. When can I expect to hear from you?

Interviewer: Within ten days.

Adiyat: Thank you. It was a pleasure meeting you. Have a good day.

Now try this: Choose two questions from the list of 10 that fit your dream job. Then say the 3-step closing aloud.

6 Write it

Task: Write a short thank-you email after an interview (60–90 words).

Model answer

Subject: Thank you – Junior Officer interview

Dear Mr. Chowdhury,

Thank you for meeting me today for the Junior Officer position. I enjoyed learning about

your new branch in Sylhet and your training programme for new officers. Our conversation made me even more interested in joining your team. I believe my internship experience and customer service skills will help me do well in this role. Please let me know if you need any more information.

Best regards,
Nusrat Jahan
01712-345678

(72 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

- 42.1** What does a typical _____ look like in this role?
- 42.2** Thank you very much for your _____ today.
- 42.3** What are the next _____ in the hiring process?
- 42.4** It was a _____ meeting you.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 42.5** When you will inform me about the result?
- 42.6** No, I have not any question.
- 42.7** I am very much interested for this post.

C. Good or bad for a first interview? Write **Good** or **Avoid**.

- 42.8** *How many days of leave will I get?*
- 42.9** *What are the biggest challenges for this team right now?*

D. Write

- 42.10** Write the 3-step closing (thank, restate interest, ask about next steps) for a customer service job at a telecom company.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Never say “No questions.” Prepare three, ask **one or two**.
- Ask about the **work, training, team and next steps**.
- Avoid salary, leave and “leaving early” questions in the first interview.
- Close in 3 steps: **thank, restate interest, ask about next steps**.
- Send a short **thank-you email** the same day.

Chapter 43

Pronunciation and Clarity

1 Why this matters

You do not need a British or American accent to get a job. You need to be **clear**. If the interviewer must ask “Sorry?” again and again, even a great answer loses its power. Speaking a little slower, stressing the right part of a word and fixing a few sounds will make a big difference.

চাকরির জন্য বিদেশি উচ্চারণ লাগে না, লাগে স্পষ্টতা। ধীরে বলা আর কয়েকটি ধ্বনি ঠিক করলেই অনেক পার্থক্য হয়।

2 The rule in plain words

1. Slow down

When we are nervous, we speak fast. Aim for a **calm, steady speed**: finish each word fully before starting the next. Speaking slower also gives your brain time to find the right grammar.

2. Word stress: one part is strong

In English words with two or more parts (syllables), **one part is louder and longer**. Here the strong part is in CAPITALS. Wrong stress is one of the main reasons listeners don’t understand us.

Stress on part 1	Stress on part 2	Stress on part 3
COMpany	reSPONsible	opporTUnity
MANager	exPERience	organiZation
CUStomer	deVELOp	presenTAtion
PROject (noun)	aCOUNtant	communiCAtion
Office	sucCESSful	engiNEER
INterview	imPORtant	interNAtional
SALary	dePARTment	qualiFication

Teacher’s tip: Words ending in **-tion** and **-sion** are stressed **just before** the ending: *pre-senTAtion, deClision, poSition*. Words ending in **-ity** are also stressed just before it: *respon-siBility, uniVERsity, aBility*.

3. Sentence stress: stress the important words

In a sentence, we stress the **information words** (nouns, main verbs, adjectives, numbers) and say small words (*a, the, to, of, is*) quickly.

I **WORKED** at a **BANK** for **SIX MONTHS**.
I **LED** a **TEAM** of **FIVE STUDENTS**.

4. Pause instead of um, uh

Fillers like *um, uh, actually, basically, you know* make you sound unsure. A short **silent pause** sounds confident. Pause at commas and full stops, and before an important point: *My biggest strength is... (pause) ... problem solving.*

5. Sounds Bangla speakers find hard

Sound	Common problem	How to fix it
v (very, visa)	said like b or bh: "bhery"	Top teeth touch the lower lip, and blow. Practise: <i>very, van, value, interview.</i>
w (work, we)	said like v or o-a	Round your lips like a small "o", no teeth. Practise: <i>work, well, west, software.</i>
z (zero, busy)	said like j: "jero"	Make an "s" sound but use your voice, like a bee: zzz. Practise: <i>zero, organize, his, business.</i>
th (think, three)	said like t or thick Bangla থ	Put your tongue lightly between your teeth and blow. Practise: <i>think, thank, three, month.</i>
th (this, the)	said like d: "dis"	Tongue between teeth, use your voice. Practise: <i>this, that, they, other.</i>
Final consonants	dropped: "tes" for test	Say the last sound clearly: <i>test, asked, worked, desk, project.</i>
s-clusters	extra vowel: "ischool"	Start directly with s, no "i" before: <i>school, station, staff, skill, speak.</i>

6. Your daily 5-minute clarity drill

Time	What to do
Minute 1	Slowly say 10 job words from the stress table. Clap on the strong part.
Minute 2	Practise one hard sound pair: <i>very / berry, zero / jero, think / tink.</i>
Minute 3	Say five s-cluster words: <i>school, staff, skill, speak, strong.</i>
Minute 4	Read three sentences from your interview answers. Stress the key words.
Minute 5	Record yourself answering "Tell me about yourself". Count your ums, then try again with pauses.

3 Examples

1. I am reSPONsible for customer service.

আমি গ্রাহক সেবার দায়িত্বে আছি।

reSPONsible: stress on part 2, not REsponsible.

2. I have one year of exPERience.

আমার এক বছরের অভিজ্ঞতা আছে।

exPERience: stress on part 2.

3. I want to deVElop my skills.

আমি আমার দক্ষতা উন্নত করতে চাই।
deVElop, not DEvelop.

4. It is a large COMpany in Dhaka.

এটা ঢাকার একটা বড় কোম্পানি।
COMpany: stress on part 1.

5. I studied at a very good university.

আমি খুব ভালো একটা বিশ্ববিদ্যালয়ে পড়েছি।
very with a real v; uniVERsity.

6. We worked well with the software team.

আমরা সফটওয়্যার টিমের সাথে ভালোভাবে কাজ করেছি।
w in we, worked, well, software: round lips.

7. I think I can do this job.

আমার মনে হয় আমি এই কাজটা পারব।
think (tongue out, blow) and this (tongue out, voice).

8. My school was near the station.

আমার স্কুল স্টেশনের কাছে ছিল।
school, station: no "i" before s.

9. I asked my manager for more tasks.

আমি আমার ম্যানেজারের কাছে আরও কাজ চেয়েছিলাম।
Say the final sounds: asked, tasks.

10. My salary was zero during the internship.

ইন্টার্নশিপের সময় আমার বেতন শূন্য ছিল।
zero with a buzzing z, not "jero".

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
DE-ve-lop	de-VE-lop	The stress is on the second part.
i-SCHOOL, i-STA-tion	SCHOOL, STA-tion	Bangla adds a vowel before s + consonant. English starts directly with s.
bhery good, bhisa	very good, visa	v is made with teeth on the lip, not with the lips together.
jero, bijness	zero, business	z is a buzzing s sound, not j.
Um... actually... basically I am...	(pause) I am a business graduate.	Fillers sound nervous; silence sounds calm.

5 Speak it

Read these five sentences aloud **slowly**. Stress the words in CAPITALS and pause at each /.

1. My NAME is Farhana, / and I'm a BUSIness GRADuate / from CHATtogram.
2. I did a THREE-month INternship / at a SOFTware COMpany.
3. I was reSPONSible / for VISiting CUStomers / and WRITing REports.
4. This exPERience / taught me to WORK / under PRESsure.

5. I THINK / I can deVELOp / and GROW / in your organiZAtion.

Now try this: Record yourself reading the five sentences. Listen once. Did you say *very*, *work*, *think*, *school* clearly? Read again and fix one sound.

6 Write it

Task: Write three sentences about your studies or work. Mark the stressed part of each long word in CAPITALS and put a / where you will pause.

Model answer

1. I comPLEted my BBA / in ACcounting / from Dhaka uniVERsity.
2. I have GOOD comPUter skills, / esPEcially in EXcel.
3. I am HARDworking / and I am INTERested / in the BANKing sector.

7 Exercises

A. Write the stressed part in CAPITALS

- 43.1 experience
43.2 manager
43.3 responsible
43.4 presentation

B. Which sound is the problem? Write the correct word.

- 43.5 "I have a bhisa for Malaysia."
43.6 "My ischool was in Sylhet."
43.7 "The answer is jero."

C. Mark the sentence stress (CAPITALS for the key words)

- 43.8 I worked at a bank for two years.
43.9 I want to learn new skills.

D. Rewrite without fillers

- 43.10 "Um, actually, basically, I am, you know, a good team player."

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Clear is better than fast. **Slow down** and finish every word.
- Learn the **word stress** of common job words: reSPONsible, exPERience, deVElop, COM-pany.
- Stress the **key words** in a sentence; say small words quickly.
- Use a silent **pause** instead of um, uh, actually.
- Fix your sounds: **v, w, z, th**, final consonants and **school** (not "ischool"). Practise 5 minutes a day.

Chapter 44

Mock Interview Practice

1 Why this matters

Reading about interviews is not enough. You become confident only by **saying the answers aloud**, many times, before the real day. A mock interview is a practice interview. In this chapter you get three complete scripts, a simple way to practise, and a checklist to measure your progress.

শুধু পড়লে হবে না, জোরে বলে অনুশীলন করতে হবে। মক ইন্টারভিউ হলো আসল ইন্টারভিউয়ের আগে একটা অনুশীলন।

2 The rule in plain words

How to practise aloud

1. **Read** a script below twice, silently, and underline useful phrases.
2. **Read it aloud** as the Candidate. Ask a friend or family member to read the Interviewer's part.
3. **Change the answers** to your own name, degree, university and experience.
4. **Close the book.** Answer the same questions from memory. Don't learn every word; learn the **key points**.
5. **Record yourself** on your phone (video if possible). Watch it and fill in the checklist.
6. **Repeat** three times over a few days. Each time, fix one or two things only.

Teacher's tip: No partner? Record the interviewer's questions on your phone with a 30-second gap after each one. Play it and answer in the gaps. It feels surprisingly real.

Self-recording checklist

Tick a box each time you meet the goal. Aim for all ticks by Try 3.

Item	Goal	Try 1	Try 2	Try 3
Speed	Calm and steady, not rushed	☐	☐	☐
Clarity	Every word clear; good word stress	☐	☐	☐
Eye contact	Looked at the camera or partner, not the floor	☐	☐	☐
Answer length	Most answers 30-90 seconds	☐	☐	☐
Fillers	Fewer than 3 um/uh per answer	☐	☐	☐
STAR used	Behaviour answers had Situation, Task, Action, Result	☐	☐	☐
Grammar	Past tense for past events; no missing verbs	☐	☐	☐
Confidence	Sat straight, smiled, no "sorry" every minute	☐	☐	☐

Script 1: Fresh graduate, Junior Officer at a bank

Nusrat Jahan has a BBA in Finance. She is interviewing at a private bank in Motijheel.

Interviewer: Good morning. Please have a seat.

Candidate: Good morning, sir. Thank you.

Interviewer: So, tell me about yourself.

Candidate: My name is Nusrat Jahan. I completed my BBA in Finance from Jagannath University in 2024 with a CGPA of 3.52. During my studies, I did a three-month internship at a bank branch in Dhanmondi, where I helped with account opening and customer queries. I enjoy working with people and numbers, so banking is the right career for me.

Interviewer: Why do you want to join our bank?

Candidate: Your bank is growing fast, especially in digital banking and SME loans. I also read that you have a strong training programme for new officers. I want to learn and grow in a bank like that.

Interviewer: What did you learn from your internship?

Candidate: I learned how to fill in KYC forms correctly and how to stay patient with customers. One day the branch was very busy, and an elderly customer was upset about waiting. I listened to him, explained the process, and helped him fill in his form. He left happy, and my supervisor praised me.

Interviewer: Good. What is your biggest weakness?

Candidate: Sometimes I spend too long checking small details. Now I set a time limit for each task, and it has helped me work faster without losing accuracy.

Interviewer: How would you handle a customer who is angry about a bank charge?

Candidate: First, I would listen calmly and apologise for the trouble. Then I would check the account and explain the charge clearly. If it was a mistake, I would report it to my manager to fix it quickly.

Interviewer: Are you comfortable working in a branch outside Dhaka?

Candidate: Yes, I am. I'm happy to work wherever the bank needs me.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions for us?

Candidate: Yes. What kind of training do new junior officers get in the first few months?

Interviewer: A one-month foundation course at our training institute, then on-the-job training.

Candidate: That sounds great. Thank you very much for your time. I'm really interested in this position. When can I expect to hear from you?

Interviewer: Within two weeks. Thank you, Nusrat.

3 Examples

Ten strong lines from the scripts. Learn them and use them in your own answers.

1. I completed my BBA in Finance in 2024.

আমি ২০২৪ সালে ফিন্যান্সে বিবিএ সম্পন্ন করেছি।

Use past simple for finished studies.

2. I did a three-month internship at a bank branch.

আমি একটি ব্যাংক শাখায় তিন মাসের ইন্টার্নশিপ করেছি।

three-month has no -s when it comes before a noun.

3. I enjoy working with people and solving problems.

আমি মানুষের সাথে কাজ করতে আর সমস্যা সমাধান করতে পছন্দ করি।

enjoy + verb-ing.

4. I want to learn and grow in a company like yours.

আমি আপনাদের মতো একটা কোম্পানিতে শিখতে ও এগিয়ে যেতে চাই।
A natural reason for applying.

5. First, I would listen calmly. Then I would explain the problem clearly.
প্রথমে আমি শান্তভাবে শুনতাম। তারপর সমস্যাটা পরিষ্কারভাবে বুঝিয়ে বলতাম।
would for “what if” questions.

6. I fixed the problem in about twenty minutes.
আমি প্রায় বিশ মিনিটে সমস্যাটা ঠিক করেছিলাম।
A clear Result, with a number.

7. I’m comfortable working under pressure.
চাপের মধ্যে কাজ করতে আমার অসুবিধা হয় না।
Useful for sales and support roles.

8. I’m happy to work wherever the company needs me.
কোম্পানির যেখানে প্রয়োজন, আমি সেখানে কাজ করতে রাজি।
Shows flexibility.

9. My target was 40 customers a month, and I reached 46.
আমার মাসিক লক্ষ্য ছিল ৪০ জন গ্রাহক, আর আমি ৪৬ জনে পৌঁছেছিলাম।
Numbers make results believable.

10. Thank you for your time. I’m really interested in this role.
সময় দেওয়ার জন্য ধন্যবাদ। আমি এই পদের ব্যাপারে সত্যিই আগ্রহী।
The closing you should always use.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
I have completed my BBA in 2024.	I completed my BBA in 2024.	With a finished time (<i>in 2024</i>), use past simple.
I did a three-months internship.	I did a three-month internship.	Number + noun before another noun: no -s.
I am doing job in a call centre.	I work in a call centre. / I have a job in...	We don’t say <i>doing job</i> in English.
I enjoy to talk with customers.	I enjoy talking with customers.	<i>enjoy</i> is followed by verb-ing.
Memorising the whole script word by word.	Learning the key points and speaking naturally.	Memorised answers sound like a robot, and you panic if you forget one word.

5 Speak it

Practise these two scripts with a partner. Then swap roles.

Script 2: Junior Software Developer / IT Support

Hasan has a BSc in CSE. He is interviewing at a software company in Banani.

Interviewer: Hi Hasan, thanks for coming. How was the traffic?

Candidate: It was busy, but I left early, so it was fine. Thank you for inviting me.

Interviewer: Tell me a little about yourself.

Candidate: I'm Hasan Mahmud. I graduated in CSE from a university in Sylhet last year. I'm good at JavaScript and Python, and I've built two web projects. For the last six months, I've also been doing freelance website work for small local businesses.

Interviewer: Tell me about one of your projects.

Candidate: In my final year, our team built an online booking system for a local clinic. I was responsible for the back end and the database. The clinic now uses it, and patient waiting time has gone down.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you solved a difficult technical problem.

Candidate: During my freelance work, a client's website suddenly stopped loading. The client was losing orders, so I had to fix it fast. I checked the server logs and found that a plugin update had broken the site. I rolled back the update and tested everything. The site was back online in about twenty minutes, and the client hired me again.

Interviewer: A user calls and says, "My computer is very slow." What do you do?

Candidate: First, I would ask a few simple questions: when it started and what programs are open. Then I would check the memory and disk usage, close unused programs, and scan for malware. If the problem continued, I would arrange to check the computer in person.

Interviewer: What if you don't know the answer to a technical question at work?

Candidate: I would be honest and say I need to check. Then I would look at the documentation, search online, or ask a senior colleague. I always try to learn the solution so I can fix it myself next time.

Interviewer: How do you keep your skills up to date?

Candidate: I follow online courses and tech blogs. Right now I'm learning React through a free online course, about one hour every evening.

Interviewer: Any questions for me?

Candidate: Yes. Who would I work with most closely, and how are new developers supported?

Interviewer: You'll join a team of five, and a senior developer will mentor you.

Candidate: That's great. Thank you for your time. I'd really like to join your team. What are the next steps?

Interviewer: A short coding test next week. We'll email you.

Script 3: Customer Service / Sales Executive

Mitu has a BA in English and one year of call-centre experience. She is interviewing at a telecom company in Chattogram.

Interviewer: Good afternoon, Mitu. Please sit down.

Candidate: Good afternoon. Thank you.

Interviewer: Tell me about your current job.

Candidate: I work as a customer service executive at a call centre in Agrabad. I handle about 80 calls a day, mostly about billing and internet packages. My customer satisfaction score has been above 90% for the last six months.

Interviewer: Why do you want to move into sales?

Candidate: In my current job, I often suggest better packages to customers, and many of them buy. I enjoy that part the most. I want a role where I can use my communication skills to grow sales.

Interviewer: Tell me about a time you dealt with a very angry customer.

Candidate: A customer called because his internet had been down for two days, and he was shouting. My task was to calm him and solve the problem. I let him speak, apologised,

and promised to follow up. I escalated the issue to the technical team and called him back the same evening. His internet was fixed, and he thanked me.

Interviewer: Have you ever had a sales target?

Candidate: Yes. Last quarter, my target was to upgrade 40 customers a month to a bigger package. I listened carefully to their needs and offered only what was useful. I reached 46 a month on average.

Interviewer: Sell me this pen.

Candidate: Sure. Before I start, may I ask, how often do you sign documents? ... Then you need a pen that writes smoothly and never leaks. This one has quick-dry ink, so your papers stay clean, and it costs only Tk 50. Shall I give you two?

Interviewer: Very good. Can you work on weekends during campaigns?

Candidate: Yes, I'm comfortable with that if I know the schedule in advance.

Interviewer: What are your salary expectations?

Candidate: I'm open to a fair offer based on your salary structure. Based on my experience, I think a range of Tk 28,000 to Tk 32,000 would be reasonable.

Interviewer: Do you have any questions?

Candidate: Yes. How do you measure success for a sales executive in the first three months?

Interviewer: Mainly by monthly sales targets and customer feedback.

Candidate: Thank you. It was a pleasure meeting you. I'm very excited about this opportunity. When can I expect to hear from you?

Now try this: Choose the script closest to your target job. Replace every answer with your own information. Record it and fill in the checklist.

6 Write it

Task: Write your own answer to "Tell me about a time you solved a problem." Use STAR (Situation, Task, Action, Result) in 4-5 sentences.

Model answer

Situation: During my internship at an NGO in Mirpur, our survey data had many errors.

Task: My supervisor asked me to clean the data before a donor meeting in three days.

Action: I made a simple checklist in Excel, checked each column, and called field staff to confirm unclear entries. **Result:** I finished a day early, the report was accurate, and my supervisor used my checklist for later surveys.

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks (from the scripts)

44.1 I _____ my BBA in Finance in 2024.

44.2 I did a three-_____ internship at a bank branch.

44.3 I was _____ for the back end and the database.

44.4 I'm open to a fair _____ based on your salary structure.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 44.5** I have joined the call centre in 2023.
- 44.6** I enjoy to solve technical problems.
- 44.7** I am doing job in a software company for one year.

C. Answer like a candidate (2-4 sentences)

- 44.8** *Why do you want to work in a bank?*
- 44.9** *A customer says your product is too expensive. What would you do?*
- 44.10** Write the Result part of a STAR answer about a time you met a deadline. Include a number.
- Answers are in Chapter 52.*

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Practise **aloud**, with a partner or a recorded set of questions.
- Change each script to **your own** details; learn key points, not every word.
- **Record yourself** and use the checklist: speed, clarity, eye contact, length, fillers, STAR, grammar, confidence.
- Use **numbers** and **STAR** to make answers strong and believable.
- Do at least **three tries** over several days before the real interview.

PART V

Writing Tests

Chapter 45

Writing Under Time Pressure

1 Why this matters

In a bank, NGO or company written test, you usually get only **20 to 45 minutes** to write. Many good candidates fail not because their English is weak, but because they **run out of time** or write without a plan. A simple time plan will help you finish every task calmly.

চাকরির লিখিত পরীক্ষায় সময় খুব কম থাকে। একটা সহজ সময়-পরিকল্পনা থাকলে আপনি শান্তভাবে পুরো লেখা শেষ করতে পারবেন।

2 The rule in plain words

The 5-write-3 method

Use the same three steps for every writing task.

PLAN (5 minutes) → **WRITE** (most of the time) → **CHECK** (3 minutes)

৫ মিনিট পরিকল্পনা → লেখা → ৩ মিনিট যাচাই

- **Plan:** read the question twice, underline the key words, and write short notes (not full sentences).
- **Write:** follow your notes. One idea per paragraph. Short, clear sentences.
- **Check:** look for verb mistakes (*he go* → *he goes*), spelling, capital letters and full stops.

Time table for common test lengths

Test time	Plan	Write	Check	Target length
20 minutes	3 min	14 min	3 min	120-150 words (email, application, paragraph)
30 minutes	5 min	22 min	3 min	200-250 words (letter, cover letter, report)
45 minutes	5 min	35 min	5 min	300-350 words (one-page essay)
Two tasks in 45 minutes	3 + 3 min	15 + 18 min	3 + 3 min	Split by marks: more marks = more time

How many words is enough?

- If the question gives a number (*about 150 words*), stay within **10% more or less** (135-165 words).
- If there is no number, a learner writes about **10 words per minute**. So 14 minutes of writing = about 140 words. That is enough.

- **Quality beats length.** 150 correct words get more marks than 300 words full of mistakes.
- Do not count every word in the exam. Count one line (for example, 10 words), then count your lines.

A quick plan template

Copy this in the corner of your answer sheet. Use key words only.

Task: What must I write? (email / letter / essay) **To whom?** **How many words?**
Opening: one line that answers the question directly
Point 1 + one example **Point 2** + one example **Point 3** (optional)
Ending: one line (conclusion, request or thanks)

Handwriting and neatness

- Write **clearly**, not beautifully. The examiner must read every word easily.
- Leave a **blank line** between paragraphs.
- To correct a mistake, draw **one straight line** through it. Do not scribble.
- Use a blue or black pen. Keep a 2 cm margin on the left.

What to do if time runs out

- With 3 minutes left, **stop your current point** and write a one-line ending.
- A letter or email must always have a **sign-off** (*Yours sincerely*, your name).
- Never write "Sorry, no time." A short complete answer is better than a long unfinished one.

Teacher's tip: Wear a watch and write the **finish time** for each step at the top of your rough page, e.g. *Plan 10:05, Write 10:19, Check 10:22*. Mobile phones are not allowed in most exam halls.

3 Examples

These ready-made sentences save time. Learn them by heart.

1. I am writing to apply for the post of Junior Officer.

আমি জুনিয়র অফিসার পদে আবেদন করার জন্য লিখছি।

A fast first line for any application.

2. In my opinion, online banking is very useful.

আমার মতে, অনলাইন ব্যাংকিং খুবই উপকারী।

Gives your opinion in the first sentence.

3. There are two main reasons for this.

এর দুটি প্রধান কারণ আছে।

Tells the reader your plan.

4. First, it saves time.

প্রথমত, এটি সময় বাঁচায়।

Start each point with a linking word.

5. For example, I can pay my electricity bill from home.
যেমন, আমি বাসা থেকেই বিদ্যুৎ বিল দিতে পারি।
One short example is enough.
6. Second, it is safe if we use a strong password.
দ্বিতীয়ত, শক্ত পাসওয়ার্ড ব্যবহার করলে এটি নিরাপদ।
Second point, same pattern.
7. However, some older people find it difficult.
তবে কিছু বয়স্ক মানুষের কাছে এটা কঠিন মনে হয়।
Shows the other side in one line.
8. In conclusion, the benefits are greater than the problems.
উপসংহারে বলা যায়, সমস্যার চেয়ে সুবিধা বেশি।
A quick ending when time is short.
9. I look forward to hearing from you.
আপনার উত্তরের অপেক্ষায় রইলাম।
Standard last line of a formal letter or email.
10. Thank you for your kind consideration.
আপনার সদয় বিবেচনার জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
Polite ending for an application.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
In this modern era of science and technology, traffic jam is a burning question...	Traffic jams waste a lot of time in Dhaka.	Long memorised openings waste time and say nothing. Answer the question in the first line .
I want this job I like banking I am hard-working.	I want this job because I like banking. I am also hard-working.	When we write fast, we join sentences with no full stop. Use a full stop or a linking word.
i am writing to apply for the post.	I am writing to apply for the post.	<i>I</i> is always a capital letter. Check this in your 3 minutes.
He work in a bank since 2020.	He has worked in a bank since 2020.	Fast writers often forget verb forms. Check every verb.
Because of the rain, I was late.	Because of the rain, I was late.	Common spelling slips: <i>because, receive, sincerely, definitely</i> . Learn them.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Adiyat is preparing for a bank exam. His friend Sadia passed last year.

Adiyat: Sadia, I always run out of time in the written part. What should I do?

Sadia: Do you make a plan before you start?

Adiyat: No, I just start writing. Planning feels like a waste of time.

Sadia: It isn't. Spend five minutes on notes. Then the writing is much faster.

Adiyat: And how many words should I write?

Sadia: Follow the question. If it says 150, write about 150. Don't write 400.

Adiyat: What if I still don't finish?

Sadia: Stop three minutes early, write a short ending and check your verbs.

Adiyat: Thanks! I'll practise with a timer tonight.

Now try this: Set a timer for 1 minute. Tell a friend your plan for the topic "Why I want a job in an NGO": your opening, two points and your ending.

6 Write it

Task (20 minutes): Write a paragraph of about **120 words** on "The importance of being on time." First make a 3-minute plan.

My plan: Opening: punctuality = respect + success P1: office, boss trusts you, e.g. 9 am meeting P2: saves others' time, e.g. bus, exam Ending: leave home early, start today

Model answer

Being on time is one of the most important habits in life. First, it shows respect for other people. If I come to a 9 am office meeting at 9:30, my boss and colleagues have to wait for me, and they lose their trust in me. Second, being on time helps us succeed. Students who reach the exam hall early can sit calmly and read the questions carefully. In Dhaka, traffic jams are a big problem, but this is not an excuse. We can simply leave home a little earlier. A punctual person gets more chances at work and is respected by everyone. In short, being on time costs us nothing, but it gives us a lot. We should start this habit today.

(123 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

- 45.1** In the 5-write-3 method, you spend _____ minutes planning and _____ minutes checking.
- 45.2** In a 30-minute test, a good target is about _____ words.
- 45.3** If the question asks for about 150 words, you should write between _____ and _____ words.
- 45.4** To correct a mistake neatly, draw one _____ line through it.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 45.5** i want to join your company becouse it is famous.
- 45.6** She work in an NGO in Sylhet since 2019.
- 45.7** Banking is a good career it gives a good salary.

C. Plan and write

- 45.8** You have 45 minutes for one essay. Write your time plan (plan, write, check) and your word target.

- 45.9** Make a quick plan (opening, two points with examples, ending) for the topic "Mobile phones for students."
- 45.10** You have only 3 minutes left and you are in the middle of your second point in a letter. Write what you will do, in two or three sentences.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- Use **5-write-3**: plan for 5 minutes, write, then check for 3 minutes.
- Aim for about **10 words per minute** of writing, and follow the word limit in the question.
- A plan needs only key words: opening, two points with examples, ending.
- Write clearly, leave space between paragraphs, and cross out with **one line**.
- If time runs out, stop and write a **short ending**. A finished answer always wins.

Chapter 46

Writing Test Formats (1): Email, Letter, Cover Letter and Application

1 Why this matters

Almost every written test for a bank, NGO or private company has one “letter-type” task: a formal email, a letter, a cover letter or an application. Examiners first look at the **format**. If your layout is right, you already get easy marks, even before they read your ideas.

চাকরির লিখিত পরীক্ষায় প্রায় সবসময় একটা ইমেইল, চিঠি বা দরখাস্ত লিখতে হয়। ফরম্যাট ঠিক থাকলেই সহজে নম্বর পাওয়া যায়।

2 The rule in plain words

All four formats follow the same basic shape:

Greeting → **Why you are writing** (1 line) → **Details** (1-2 paragraphs) → **Request or next step** → **Polite ending + name**

সম্বোধন → লেখার কারণ → বিস্তারিত → অনুরোধ → বিনীত সমাপ্তি ও নাম

Dear... and Yours...: the matching rule

If you start with...	End with...	When
Dear Sir or Madam, / Dear Hiring Manager,	Yours faithfully,	You do not know the person's name.
Dear Mr Chowdhury, / Dear Ms Rahman,	Yours sincerely,	You know the name.
Dear Nusrat, / Hi Adiyat,	Best regards, / Regards,	Emails to colleagues you know.

Teacher's tip: In this chapter, word counts start at the greeting (*Dear...*) and end with your name (and post, if given). Addresses, dates and the subject line are not counted. In the exam, if the question says “Write your name as X”, use X. Never write your real name or roll number inside the answer.

Format 1: Formal email (about 150 words)

When it's used: asking for information, confirming an interview, sending documents, replying to an office request.

Layout: To → Subject (short and clear) → Dear... → purpose → details → request → Best regards / Yours sincerely → name, phone number.

Useful phrase	Bangla
I am writing to ask about...	আমি... সম্পর্কে জানতে লিখছি।
Thank you for your email of 12 May.	১২ মে-র ইমেইলের জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
Please find attached my CV.	সংযুক্ত আমার সিভি দেখুন।
Could you please let me know...?	অনুগ্রহ করে আমাকে জানান কি...?
I would be grateful if you could...	আপনি যদি... করতেন, আমি কৃতজ্ঞ থাকব।
Please feel free to contact me at...	প্রয়োজনে আমার সাথে... নম্বরে যোগাযোগ করুন।

Exam task: You have been called for an interview at Shapla Foods Ltd. on Sunday, but you have a university exam that day. Write an email to the HR Manager, Ms Farhana Haque, asking for a new date.

Model answer

To: hr@shaplafoods.com

Subject: Request to reschedule interview, Management Trainee post

Dear Ms Haque,

Thank you for your email of 10 March inviting me to an interview for the post of Management Trainee on Sunday, 16 March at 11 am.

I am very interested in this position, and I am sorry to ask for a change. Unfortunately, I have my final MBA exam at the University of Dhaka on the same day, and I cannot miss it. My exams finish on 18 March.

I would be very grateful if you could give me another date. I am free at any time from 19 March onwards, and I can come to your Gulshan office at short notice.

Please find attached a copy of my exam schedule. If you need any more information, please feel free to contact me at 01712-345678.

Thank you for your kind understanding. I look forward to hearing from you.

Yours sincerely,
Tania Akter

(145 words)

Format 2: Formal letter (about 200 words)

When it's used: complaints, requests to a bank or office, letters to a city corporation or a newspaper editor.

Layout (block style, everything on the left):

Your address → Date (15 April 2026) → Receiver's name, post and address → **Subject:** ...
→ Dear... → Para 1: purpose → Para 2: details (what, when, where) → Para 3: what you want them to do → Yours faithfully / sincerely → signature and name

Useful phrase	Bangla
I am writing to complain about...	আমি... বিষয়ে অভিযোগ জানাতে লিখছি।
I would like to draw your attention to...	আমি... বিষয়ে আপনার দৃষ্টি আকর্ষণ করতে চাই।
On 2 April, I...	২ এপ্রিল আমি...
Unfortunately, the problem has not been solved yet.	দুঃখজনকভাবে সমস্যাটির এখনো সমাধান হয়নি।
I would appreciate it if you could take action soon.	দ্রুত ব্যবস্থা নিলে আমি কৃতজ্ঞ থাকব।

Exam task: An ATM of your bank took Tk 10,000 from your account but gave you no cash. Write a letter to the Branch Manager.

Model answer

House 12, Road 5, Mirpur 10, Dhaka 1216

15 April 2026

The Branch Manager, Nilgiri Bank PLC, Mirpur Branch, Dhaka

Subject: Complaint about a failed ATM withdrawal

Dear Sir or Madam,

I am writing to complain about a problem with your ATM. I have a savings account at your branch (Account No. 1234567890), and I have been a customer of your bank for over five years.

On 2 April 2026, at about 7:30 pm, I tried to withdraw Tk 10,000 from your ATM booth near Mirpur 10 roundabout. The machine showed "Transaction successful", but it did not give me any cash. A few minutes later, I received an SMS saying that Tk 10,000 had been taken from my account.

I called your helpline the same night, and they gave me a complaint number (C-58214). They told me the money would be returned within seven working days. However, almost two weeks have passed, and the money has still not come back to my account.

This money is very important for my family's monthly expenses. I would appreciate it if you could check the matter and return the amount as soon as possible. I have attached a copy of the SMS and my bank statement. Please let me know if you need any other information from me.

Thank you for your help.

Yours faithfully,
Karim Hossain

(197 words)

Format 3: Cover letter (about 250 words)

When it's used: sent with your CV when you apply for a job. Some tests ask you to write one for a job advertisement.

Layout: Date → receiver → Subject: Application for the post of... → Dear... → **Para 1:** the post and where you saw it → **Para 2:** education and experience → **Para 3:** skills and why this company → **Para 4:** interview request → sign-off.

Useful phrase	Bangla
I wish to apply for the post of... advertised on...	...-এ প্রকাশিত... পদে আমি আবেদন করতে চাই।
I have completed my BBA in... from...	আমি... থেকে... বিষয়ে বিবিএ সম্পন্ন করেছি।
I have two years' experience in...	... বিষয়ে আমার দুই বছরের অভিজ্ঞতা আছে।
I am confident that I can...	আমি নিশ্চিত যে আমি... পারব।
I would welcome the chance to discuss...	... নিয়ে আলোচনার সুযোগ পেলে খুশি হব।

Teacher's tip: A cover letter is not your CV in sentences. Choose **two or three** things that match the job advertisement and give one real example for each.

Exam task: Hope for All Foundation, an NGO, is looking for a Field Officer in Sylhet. Write a cover letter.

Model answer

20 May 2026

The Human Resources Manager, Hope for All Foundation, House 8, Road 3, Dhanmondi, Dhaka

Subject: Application for the post of Field Officer, Sylhet

Dear Sir or Madam,

I wish to apply for the post of Field Officer in Sylhet, advertised on bdjobs.com on 15 May 2026. I believe my education and field experience make me a strong candidate for this role.

I completed my Master's in Social Work from Shahjalal University of Science and Technology in 2024. For the last two years, I have worked as a Community Mobiliser with a small development organisation in Sunamganj. In this job, I organised monthly meetings with women's savings groups, collected field data and wrote short weekly reports for my manager. I also trained new volunteers to keep simple record books.

I have good communication skills, and I can speak the Sylheti dialect, which helps me to build trust with local people quickly. I am also comfortable with Microsoft Excel and mobile data collection apps. I work well in a team, and I always meet my deadlines. I can ride a motorcycle and I am happy to travel to remote areas, including the haor region.

I am especially interested in your organisation because of your work on safe water and girls' education. I would like to use my experience to support these projects and to learn from your experienced team.

I have attached my CV and copies of my certificates. I would welcome the chance to discuss my application with you at an interview. I can be reached at 01812-998877 or sadia.rahman@email.com.

Thank you for your time and consideration.

Yours faithfully,
Sadiah Rahman

(247 words)

Format 4: Job or leave application (about 150 words)

When it's used: asking your office for leave, or the traditional "application for a job" to a head of an office. Many Bangladeshi tests still ask for this format.

Layout:

Date → To → The Manager / Principal, office name, address → **Subject:** Application for... → Dear Sir / Madam, → reason + dates (or post + qualifications) → request → Yours faithfully / sincerely → name, post or ID

Useful phrase	Bangla
I would like to request leave for three days, from... to...	আমি... থেকে... পর্যন্ত তিন দিনের ছুটি চাই।
My colleague, Mr Hasan, has agreed to handle my work.	আমার সহকর্মী হাসান সাহেব আমার কাজ সামলাতে রাজি হয়েছেন।
I will be available on my phone if needed.	প্রয়োজনে আমাকে ফোনে পাওয়া যাবে।
I hope you will grant me leave for these days.	আশা করি এই দিনগুলোর জন্য আমাকে ছুটি মঞ্জুর করবেন।

The model leave application is in **Write it** below.

3 Examples

- I am writing to confirm my attendance at the interview.
আমি সাক্ষাৎকারে উপস্থিত থাকার বিষয়টি নিশ্চিত করতে লিখছি।
Email: confirming an interview.
- Could you please tell me which documents I should bring?
অনুগ্রহ করে জানাবেন কি, আমাকে কোন কোন কাগজপত্র আনতে হবে?
Email: polite question with *Could you please*.
- Please find attached a scanned copy of my NID.
সংযুক্ত আমার জাতীয় পরিচয়পত্রের স্ক্যান কপি দেখুন।
Email: sending a file.
- I would like to draw your attention to the broken streetlights on our road.
আমি আমাদের রাস্তার নষ্ট স্ট্রিটলাইটের বিষয়ে আপনার দৃষ্টি আকর্ষণ করতে চাই।
Letter: to a city corporation officer.
- I have not received my new cheque book, although I applied a month ago.
এক মাস আগে আবেদন করলেও আমি নতুন চেক বই পাইনি।
Letter: complaint with facts.
- I wish to apply for the post of Sales Executive advertised in The Daily Star.
দ্য ডেইলি স্টারে প্রকাশিত সেলস এক্সিকিউটিভ পদে আমি আবেদন করতে চাই।
Cover letter: first line. Name the newspaper or website.
- During my internship at a bank in Chattogram, I helped customers open accounts.
চট্টগ্রামের একটি ব্যাংকে ইন্টার্নশিপের সময় আমি গ্রাহকদের হিসাব খুলতে সাহায্য করেছি।
Cover letter: one real example of a skill.
- I would like to request two days' leave because my mother is ill.
মা অসুস্থ থাকায় আমি দুই দিনের ছুটি চাই।
Leave application: reason in one line.
- I will join the office again on Sunday, 12 October.

আমি রবিবার, ১২ অক্টোবর আবার অফিসে যোগ দেব।

Leave application: give the return date.

10. I look forward to hearing from you.

আপনার উত্তরের অপেক্ষায় রইলাম।

Last line for emails, letters and cover letters.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
With due respect, I beg to state that I am a candidate...	I am writing to apply for the post of...	Old phrases like <i>I beg to state</i> and <i>your most obedient servant</i> sound out of date. Be polite but direct.
Dear Sir, ... Yours sincerely,	Dear Sir, ... Yours faithfully ,	No name → <i>faithfully</i> . Name → <i>sincerely</i> .
Kindly do the needful.	Please send me the new card by Thursday.	Say exactly what you want. <i>Do the needful</i> is unclear.
I am writing you to ask about the job.	I am writing to you to ask about the job.	In British English we write to someone.
Please revert back as soon as possible.	Please reply as soon as possible.	<i>Revert back</i> is a common office mistake. Use <i>reply</i> or <i>get back to me</i> .

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Hasan is helping his cousin Mitu with an email before her test.

Mitu: Bhaiya, should I start the email with "Respected Sir"?

Hasan: Better to write "Dear Sir or Madam". It's the standard form.

Mitu: And at the end? "Your obedient servant"?

Hasan: No, no! If you don't know the name, write "Yours faithfully".

Mitu: What if I know the HR manager's name?

Hasan: Then write "Dear Ms Haque" and finish with "Yours sincerely".

Mitu: Got it. Should I write a long introduction about myself?

Hasan: Not at all. Say why you're writing in the first line. Examiners love that.

Mitu: That's much easier than I thought. Thanks, Bhaiya!

Now try this: Say aloud the first line you would write in (a) an email asking about a job, (b) a complaint letter about load-shedding, and (c) a leave application.

6 Write it

Task: You are Adiyat Mahmud, Junior Officer in the Accounts Department of Meghna Traders Ltd., Chattogram. Your sister's wedding is next week. Write a leave application to your manager, Mr Chowdhury, in about **150 words**.

Model answer

5 October 2026
To

Mr Rafiq Chowdhury, Manager, Accounts Department
Meghna Traders Ltd., Agrabad, Chattogram
Subject: Application for four days' leave

Dear Mr Chowdhury,

I would like to request four days' leave, from Monday, 13 October to Thursday, 16 October 2026. My younger sister's wedding will take place in our village home in Cumilla on 15 October. As the eldest son, I have many responsibilities for the arrangements, so I need to be with my family for these days.

I have already finished the September salary reports. My colleague, Mr Hasan Ali, has kindly agreed to handle any urgent payments while I am away. I have shared all the necessary files with him.

I will be available on my phone (01911-223344) if anything important comes up. I will return to the office on Sunday, 19 October. I am sorry for any inconvenience this may cause during this busy time.

I hope you will grant me leave for these days. Thank you for your kind consideration.

Yours sincerely,
Adiyat Mahmud
Junior Officer, Accounts Department

(152 words)

7 Exercises

A. Choose the correct ending

- 46.1** Dear Sir or Madam, ... Yours (sincerely / faithfully),
- 46.2** Dear Mr Karim, ... Yours (sincerely / faithfully),
- 46.3** Which format do you use when you send your CV for a job: an email, a cover letter or a leave application?

B. Correct the mistakes

- 46.4** I beg to state that I want leave for two days.
- 46.5** Please revert back by Sunday.
- 46.6** I am writing you to complain about my internet bill.
- 46.7** Kindly do the needful about my ATM card.

C. Write

- 46.8** Write a subject line for an email asking a bank to change your phone number.
- 46.9** Write the first sentence of a cover letter for the post of Customer Service Officer advertised on bdjobs.com.
- 46.10** Write a short leave application (about 60 words) to your manager for one day off because you are ill.

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- All four formats: greeting → purpose → details → request → polite ending + name.
- No name → *Dear Sir or Madam / Yours faithfully*. Name → *Dear Mr X / Yours sincerely*.
- Say **why you are writing** in the first line. Avoid old phrases like *I beg to state*.
- A cover letter picks two or three skills that match the job, each with a real example.
- Lengths to aim for: email 150, letter 200, cover letter 250, application 150 words.

Chapter 47

Writing Test Formats (2): Report, Opinion Paragraph and One-Page Essay

1 Why this matters

After letters and emails, the most common written test tasks are a **short report**, an **opinion paragraph** and a **one-page essay** on a general topic like social media or traffic jams. Each one has a simple shape. Learn the shape once, and you can write on almost any topic.

রিপোর্ট, মতামতমূলক অনুচ্ছেদ আর ছোট রচনা প্রতিটির একটা নির্দিষ্ট কাঠামো আছে। কাঠামো জানলে যেকোনো বিষয়ে লেখা যায়।

2 The rule in plain words

How long is enough?

Task	Usual time	Words	Paragraphs
Opinion paragraph	15-20 min	120-150	1 paragraph: opinion, 2-3 reasons, ending
Short report	25-30 min	180-220	3 headed parts: Introduction, Findings, Recommendations
One-page essay	40-45 min	280-350	4-5 paragraphs: introduction, 2-3 body, conclusion

Teacher's tip: A one-page essay is about **one side of an A4 answer sheet** in normal hand-writing. If you have written two full pages, you have probably written too much and checked too little.

Format 1: Short report (about 200 words)

When it's used: your manager wants facts about something that happened or a problem at work: a training day, customer complaints, a field visit. A report is for **information**, not feelings.

Layout:

To / From / Date / Subject (like a memo)

- 1. Introduction:** why you wrote the report and how you got the information (1-2 sentences)
- 2. Findings:** what you found, in short points or a short paragraph; use numbers
- 3. Recommendations:** what should be done next; use *should* or *I recommend that...*

Useful phrase	Bangla
The aim of this report is to...	এই রিপোর্টের উদ্দেশ্য হলো...
The information is based on...	তথ্যগুলো... এর উপর ভিত্তি করে নেওয়া।
Most customers said that...	বেশিরভাগ গ্রাহক বলেছেন যে...
About 40% of the staff...	প্রায় ৪০% কর্মী...
It is recommended that... / The branch should...	সুপারিশ করা হচ্ছে যে... / শাখার উচিত...

Exam task: You work at the Dhanmondi branch of a bank. Customers are unhappy about long waiting times. Your manager has asked you to write a short report. (The To, From, Date and Subject lines are not counted.)

Model answer

To: Mr Kamal Chowdhury, Branch Manager
From: Nusrat Jahan, Customer Service Officer
Date: 12 June 2026
Subject: Long waiting times at the branch

1. Introduction

The aim of this report is to explain why customers wait so long at our branch and to suggest some solutions. The information is based on a short survey of 50 customers and my own notes from 1 to 10 June.

2. Findings

- The average waiting time was 35 minutes. On Sundays and after salary day, it was more than one hour.
- Only two of our four cash counters were open most of the day.
- About 60% of customers came only to deposit cash or pay bills, which they could do online.
- Many older customers said that the waiting area has too few chairs.
- Staff told me that the bill payment machine has been broken since May.

3. Recommendations

I recommend that we open all four cash counters between 11 am and 2 pm, when the branch is busiest. We should also place one staff member near the door to guide customers and teach them to use our mobile app. Finally, the branch should add ten more chairs to the waiting area, and the bill payment machine should be repaired this week. These simple steps would make our customers much happier. I would be happy to discuss these ideas with you.

(203 words)

Format 2: Opinion paragraph (about 150 words)

When it's used: short questions like "Do you agree or disagree...?" or "What is your opinion about...?"

Shape (one paragraph only):

Topic sentence: your clear opinion → **Reason 1** + example → **Reason 2** + example → (**Other side** in one line) → **Concluding sentence:** repeat your opinion in new words

Useful phrase	Bangla
In my opinion, / I strongly believe that...	আমার মতে, / আমি দৃঢ়ভাবে বিশ্বাস করি যে...
The main reason is that...	প্রধান কারণ হলো...
Another reason is that...	আরেকটি কারণ হলো...
It is true that..., but...	এটা সত্য যে..., কিন্তু...
For these reasons, I think...	এসব কারণে আমি মনে করি...

Exam task: "Office workers should be allowed to work from home two days a week." Do you agree?

Model answer

I strongly believe that office workers should be allowed to work from home two days a week. The main reason is that it saves time and money. In Dhaka, many people spend three or four hours a day in traffic. If they work from home, they can use this time to work or to rest, and they also save money on bus or CNG fares. Another reason is that many workers can focus better in a quiet room at home. For example, an accountant can finish a report quietly without phone calls and meetings all the time. It is true that some jobs, like bank cashiers or doctors, need people to be present. Also, some homes are noisy or have weak internet. However, for most office jobs, two days at home is a fair balance. For these reasons, I think a flexible plan makes workers happier, less stressed and more productive.

(151 words)

Format 3: One-page essay (about 300 words)

When it's used: general topics such as "The impact of social media on young people", "Traffic jam in Dhaka", "Climate change and Bangladesh" or "The role of women in development".

Shape (4-5 paragraphs):

Title

Introduction (2-3 sentences): introduce the topic and give your main idea

Body 1: first main point (causes / advantages) + example

Body 2: second main point (effects / disadvantages) + example

Body 3 (optional): solutions

Conclusion (2-3 sentences): sum up and give a final thought; no new ideas

Useful phrase	Bangla
Nowadays, ... has become a serious problem.	বর্তমানে... একটি গুরুতর সমস্যা হয়ে দাঁড়িয়েছে।
There are several causes of this problem.	এই সমস্যার কয়েকটি কারণ আছে।
As a result, ...	ফলে...
To solve this problem, the government should...	এই সমস্যা সমাধানে সরকারের উচিত...
To sum up, ...	সংক্ষেপে বলা যায়,...

Teacher's tip: Do not memorise a whole essay. Examiners can see it at once, and the topic may change a little. Memorise the **shape** and 10-15 useful phrases instead.

The model essay on “Traffic jam in Dhaka” is in **Write it** below.

3 Examples

1. The aim of this report is to describe the staff training held on 5 May.
এই রিপোর্টের উদ্দেশ্য হলো ৫ মে অনুষ্ঠিত কর্মী প্রশিক্ষণের বিবরণ দেওয়া।
Report: first line of the introduction.
2. Out of 30 participants, 25 said the training was useful.
৩০ জন অংশগ্রহণকারীর মধ্যে ২৫ জন বলেছেন প্রশিক্ষণটি কাজে লেগেছে।
Report: findings with numbers.
3. It is recommended that the next training should be longer.
সুপারিশ করা হচ্ছে যে পরবর্তী প্রশিক্ষণ আরও দীর্ঘ হওয়া উচিত।
Report: recommendation.
4. In my opinion, students should learn computer skills from class six.
আমার মতে, ষষ্ঠ শ্রেণি থেকেই শিক্ষার্থীদের কম্পিউটার শেখা উচিত।
Opinion paragraph: topic sentence.
5. It is true that private tuition helps some students, but it is very expensive.
এটা সত্য যে প্রাইভেট টিউশন কিছু শিক্ষার্থীকে সাহায্য করে, কিন্তু এটা খুব ব্যয়বহুল।
Opinion paragraph: the other side in one line.
6. Nowadays, social media has become a part of every young person's life.
বর্তমানে সামাজিক যোগাযোগমাধ্যম প্রত্যেক তরুণের জীবনের অংশ হয়ে গেছে।
Essay: opening sentence.
7. On the positive side, young people can learn new skills from YouTube.
ইতিবাচক দিক হলো, তরুণেরা ইউটিউব থেকে নতুন দক্ষতা শিখতে পারে।
Essay: advantage + example.
8. On the other hand, many students stay awake late scrolling Facebook.
অন্যদিকে, অনেক শিক্ষার্থী রাত জেগে ফেসবুক স্ক্রল করে।
Essay: disadvantage + example.
9. As a result, they feel tired in class the next day.
ফলে পরদিন ক্লাসে তারা ক্লান্ত বোধ করে।
Essay: showing an effect.
10. To sum up, social media is a useful tool if we use it wisely.
সংক্ষেপে বলা যায়, বুদ্ধিগত ব্যবহার করলে সামাজিক যোগাযোগমাধ্যম একটি উপকারী মাধ্যম।
Essay: conclusion.

4 Common mistakes

✗ Wrong	✓ Correct	Why
Traffic jam is a big problem in Dhaka city. Traffic jam wastes time. Traffic jam...	Traffic jams are a big problem in Dhaka. They waste time, and this problem...	Do not repeat the same words again and again. Use <i>it, they, this problem</i> .
I think that, in my opinion, I believe social media is bad.	In my opinion , social media can be harmful.	Use one opinion phrase, not three.
The customers is not happy with the service. I feel very sad that the staff are so lazy and careless!!	The customers are not happy with the service. Two of the four counters were closed for most of the day.	Plural subject → <i>are</i> . Check every verb in your findings. A report gives facts and numbers , not feelings. No exclamation marks.
Social media has many advantage and disadvantage.	Social media has many advantages and disadvantages .	After <i>many</i> , the noun must be plural.

5 Speak it

Read this conversation aloud. Farhana and Rahim are practising for an NGO written test.

Farhana: What if they ask us to write an essay on social media?

Rahim: Easy. Introduction, two body paragraphs, conclusion. About three hundred words.

Farhana: What would you write in the body paragraphs?

Rahim: One paragraph on the good side, like online learning. One on the bad side, like addiction.

Farhana: And a report? I always get confused.

Rahim: A report has headings: Introduction, Findings and Recommendations. Just facts, no feelings.

Farhana: And the opinion paragraph is only one paragraph, right?

Rahim: Exactly. Give your opinion in the first line, two reasons, then finish.

Farhana: Great. Let's time each other tomorrow.

Now try this: Give your opinion aloud in 4-5 sentences: "Should mobile phones be banned in schools?" Use *In my opinion*, *The main reason is that*, and *For these reasons*.

6 Write it

Task (45 minutes): Write an essay of about **300 words** on "Traffic jam in Dhaka." (The title is not counted.)

Model answer

Traffic Jam in Dhaka

Dhaka is one of the most crowded cities in the world. Every day, millions of people get stuck in traffic for hours. Nowadays, traffic jams have become one of the biggest problems of city life, and they affect everyone, from office workers to schoolchildren.

There are several causes of this problem. First, the number of cars, buses and motorbikes is growing much faster than the number of roads. Second, many drivers do not follow traffic rules. Buses stop in the middle of the road to pick up passengers, and rickshaws often move in the wrong direction. In addition, footpaths are full of shops, so people walk on the road and slow down the traffic.

The effects of traffic jams are very serious. People waste a lot of time on the road. For example, a 10-kilometre trip from Mirpur to Motijheel can take two hours. As a result, workers reach the office tired, and students are late for class. Traffic also wastes fuel and makes the air dirty. Even ambulances get stuck, which can put patients' lives at risk.

To solve this problem, the government should improve public transport. The metro rail has already helped many people, and more lines and better buses are needed. The traffic police should also make sure that everyone follows the rules. Strict fines for illegal parking would also help. At the same time, offices and schools can start at different times, so that not everyone is on the road together. As citizens, we can also help by walking short distances and using footpaths and foot overbridges.

To sum up, traffic jams in Dhaka cost us time, money and health. The problem will not disappear in a day, but with good planning and discipline from everyone, we can make our capital a better place to live.

(300 words)

7 Exercises

A. Fill in the blanks

- 47.1** The three headings of a short report are Introduction, _____ and _____.
- 47.2** An opinion paragraph has _____ paragraph(s) and about _____ words.
- 47.3** A one-page essay usually has _____ paragraphs and about _____ words.

B. Correct the mistakes

- 47.4** The staff is very happy with the new canteen and they is eating there every day.
- 47.5** Online shopping has many benefit.
- 47.6** I think that, in my opinion, uniforms are good.
- 47.7** The manager is so careless and I am very angry!! (Rewrite as a factual report sentence.)

C. Write

- 47.8** Write a topic sentence for an opinion paragraph: "Should university students do part-time jobs?"
- 47.9** Write one recommendation for a report on "Late arrival of staff at the office."
- 47.10** Write an introduction (2–3 sentences) for an essay on "The impact of social media on young people."

Answers are in Chapter 52.

8 Quick summary

Remember

- **Report** (about 200 words): Introduction, Findings, Recommendations. Facts and numbers, no feelings.
- **Opinion paragraph** (about 150 words): opinion first, two reasons with examples, one-line other side, conclusion.
- **Essay** (about 300 words): introduction, 2-3 body paragraphs, conclusion with no new ideas.
- Memorise the **shape** and useful phrases, not whole essays.
- Avoid repeating the same words; use *it, they, this problem*.

PART VI

Practice and Reference

Chapter 48

30-Day Practice Schedule

Reading a book once is not enough. Language grows with **small, daily practice**. This plan gives you **about 45 minutes a day** for 30 days. It takes you through the whole book: grammar first, then daily speaking, then writing, and in the last days, job interviews and timed writing tests.

প্রতিদিন মাত্র ৪৫ মিনিট অনুশীলন করুন। ৩০ দিনে পুরো বইটি একবার ভালোভাবে শেষ হবে।

1 How to use this schedule

- **Each day has three parts:** read the chapter(s) (grammar or topic), do a speaking task, and do a short writing task.
- **The "Time" column** shows minutes for each part: *20/15/10* means 20 minutes reading, 15 minutes speaking, 10 minutes writing.
- **Speak aloud, every day.** Talk to a friend, a family member, or the mirror. Record yourself on your phone and listen back.
- **Keep one notebook** for all writing tasks. On review days you will check and improve what you wrote.
- **Missed a day?** No problem. Just continue the next day. Do not try to do two days at once.
- **Review days** (Days 7, 14, 21) are for revision and the weekly self-check. Do not skip them!

Teacher's tip: Choose a **fixed time** for practice: after Fajr, on the bus to the office, or after dinner. When practice becomes a habit, you will not need willpower.

প্রতিদিন একই সময়ে অনুশীলন করুন। অভ্যাস হয়ে গেলে আর কষ্ট লাগবে না।

2 Week 1: Grammar foundations

Goal: build simple, correct sentences about your life in the present, past and future.

Day	Grammar / Topic	Speaking task	Writing task	Time
1	Parts of speech, sentence structure (Ch 1-2)	Greet 3 people in English and make small talk (Ch 16)	Write 5 S + V + O sentences about your day	20/15/10
2	Present tenses (Ch 3)	Introduce yourself for 1 minute and record it (Ch 17)	Write 6 sentences about your family	20/15/10
3	Past tenses (Ch 4)	Tell a friend what you did yesterday	Write 6 sentences about last Friday	20/15/10
4	Future forms (Ch 5)	Describe your plans for next weekend (Ch 18)	Write 5 plans with <i>going to</i> and <i>will</i>	20/15/10
5	Present perfect (Ch 6)	Talk about 5 things you have done this year	Write 5 <i>I have...</i> and <i>I have never...</i> sentences	20/15/10
6	Articles and nouns (Ch 7-8)	Role-play buying vegetables at the bazaar (Ch 20)	Write a shopping list, then 5 sentences with <i>a/an/the</i>	20/15/10
7	Review: Ch 1-8 summaries, 100 verbs (Ch 49)	Re-record your Day 2 introduction. Compare!	Correct your Week 1 notebook; do the self-check	20/10/15

Week 1 self-check

- ☐ I can introduce myself for 1 minute without stopping.
- ☐ I can use present, past and future tenses in simple sentences.
- ☐ I know when to use *a*, *an* and *the*.
- ☐ I know the three forms of at least 30 common verbs.
- ☐ I practised on at least 6 days this week.

যেগুলোতে টিক দিতে পারছেন না, পরের সপ্তাহে সেই অধ্যায়গুলো আবার দেখে নিন।

3 Week 2: More grammar and daily speaking

Goal: handle everyday situations (directions, phone calls, office, doctor) politely and clearly.

Day	Grammar / Topic	Speaking task	Writing task	Time
8	Pronouns (Ch 9)	Ask for and give directions to your home (Ch 21)	Write directions from the bus stop to your house	15/20/10
9	Prepositions (Ch 10)	Practise a phone call to book a doctor's appointment (Ch 22)	Write 8 sentences with <i>in/on/at</i> for time and place	15/20/10
10	Adjectives and adverbs (Ch 11)	Describe how you feel to a doctor (Ch 24)	Describe a friend or family member in 6 sentences	15/20/10
11	Modals (Ch 12)	Ask a colleague for help, politely (Ch 19, 23)	Write 5 polite requests with <i>could</i> , <i>would</i> , <i>may</i>	15/20/10
12	Questions and negatives (Ch 13)	Thank, apologize and invite: 3 short role-plays (Ch 25)	Write 8 questions you can ask a new friend	15/20/10
13	Linking words (Ch 14)	Give your opinion on Dhaka traffic for 1 minute (Ch 26)	Join 10 short sentences with <i>and</i> , <i>but</i> , <i>because</i> , <i>so</i>	15/20/10
14	Review: 25 common mistakes (Ch 15), fillers (Ch 27)	Read 50 sentences from Ch 28 aloud	Correct your Week 2 notebook; do the self-check	15/15/15

Week 2 self-check

- ☐ I can ask for directions and make a simple phone call in English.
- ☐ I can make polite requests with *could you...?* and *would you...?*
- ☐ I can ask correct questions with *do/does/did*.
- ☐ I can join ideas with *because, so* and *but*.
- ☐ I use fillers (*well, let me think*) instead of long silences.

প্রতিটি পয়েন্ট সংভাবে যাচাই করুন। দুর্বল জায়গাগুলো খাতায় লিখে রাখুন।

4 Week 3: Basic writing

Goal: write clear paragraphs, emails, applications and short essays.

Day	Grammar / Topic	Speaking task	Writing task	Time
15	Sentences to paragraphs (Ch 29), punctuation (Ch 30)	Read 25 sentences from Ch 28 aloud, with good pauses	Write a 6-sentence paragraph about your hometown	15/10/20
16	PEEL paragraphs (Ch 31)	Give a 1-minute opinion: "Should students have part-time jobs?"	Write one PEEL paragraph on the same topic	15/10/20
17	Descriptive and opinion paragraphs (Ch 32)	Describe your favourite place (Cox's Bazar, a park, a café)	Write a descriptive paragraph (80-100 words)	15/10/20
18	Emails (Ch 33)	Role-play: call your manager to say you will be late (Ch 22)	Write a formal email asking for a meeting	15/10/20
19	Messages and applications (Ch 34)	Explain a problem to an office colleague (Ch 23)	Write a leave application to your manager	15/10/20
20	Short essays (Ch 35)	Talk for 2 minutes on "Mobile phones: good or bad?"	Write a short essay (150 words) on the same topic	15/10/20
21	Review: editing your work (Ch 36)	Read your best paragraph aloud and record it	Edit two pieces from this week with the Ch 36 checklist; do the self-check	15/10/20

Week 3 self-check

- ☐ My paragraphs have a clear topic sentence and a closing sentence.
- ☐ I use full stops, commas and capital letters correctly.
- ☐ I can write a polite formal email and a leave application.
- ☐ I can write a 150-word essay with an introduction, body and conclusion.
- ☐ I check my writing for mistakes before I finish.

লেখা শেষ করে সবসময় একবার পড়ে ভুল সংশোধন করুন।

5 Week 4 and the final days: interviews and timed tests

Goal: get ready for real job interviews and writing tests. From now on, **use a timer** for every writing task.

Day	Grammar / Topic	Speaking task	Writing task	Time
22	Interview vocabulary and power verbs (Ch 37)	Answer "Tell me about yourself" in 1–2 minutes; record it	Write your own "Tell me about yourself" answer using 5 power verbs	15/15/15
23	Top interview questions, part 1 (Ch 38)	Answer 5 questions aloud without reading	Write short answers to 3 questions (strengths, weakness, why this job)	15/20/10
24	Top interview questions, part 2 (Ch 39)	Answer 5 more questions; ask a friend to play the interviewer	Write answers to 3 more questions	15/20/10
25	The STAR method (Ch 40)	Tell 2 STAR stories from your study or work	Write 1 STAR story (about 120 words)	15/15/15
26	Difficult moments (Ch 41), pronunciation (Ch 43)	Practise "Sorry, could you repeat that?" and salary answers; drill 10 hard words	Write 3 polite answers to difficult questions	15/20/10
27	Questions to ask and closing (Ch 42); time pressure (Ch 45)	Practise 3 questions to ask the interviewer and a strong closing line	Timed: a formal email in 20 minutes (Ch 46)	10/15/20
28	Full mock interview (Ch 44)	Do a complete mock interview (about 15 minutes) and record it	Write a thank-you email after the interview	5/25/15
29	Reports, opinion essays (Ch 47)	Mock interview 2: fix the problems from Day 28	Timed: an opinion essay in 30 minutes	5/10/30
30	Final test day: cover letters (Ch 46) and a last look at your weak areas	Final mock interview; compare with your Day 2 recording	Timed: a cover letter or job application in 25 minutes; do the final self-check	5/15/25

Final self-check

- ☐ I can answer "Tell me about yourself" confidently in under 2 minutes.
- ☐ I have 3 ready STAR stories and answers to the 10 most common interview questions.
- ☐ I can stay calm when I don't understand a question, and ask politely to repeat.
- ☐ I can write an email, an application and a cover letter within the time limit.
- ☐ I can write a 250-word opinion essay in 30 minutes.

অভিনন্দন! ৩০ দিন শেষ করেছেন। এখন দুর্বল অংশগুলো আবার অনুশীলন করুন এবং প্রতিদিন ইংরেজি ব্যবহার চালিয়ে যান।

6 After 30 days: keep going

- **Repeat the plan** a second time. It will feel much easier, and you will notice your progress.
- **Use English every day:** write your shopping list, WhatsApp messages to friends, or a short diary in English.
- **Keep the reference chapters close:** the verb lists (Ch 49–50) and the phrase bank (Ch 51) are perfect for 10-minute revision on the bus.
- **Find a practice partner.** Two friends speaking English for 15 minutes a day can improve faster than one person studying alone.

Teacher's tip: Compare your Day 2 recording with your Day 30 recording. You will hear the difference, and that is the best motivation to continue!

প্রথম দিনের আর শেষ দিনের রেকর্ডিং মিলিয়ে শুনুন। নিজের উন্নতি নিজেই বুঝতে পারবেন।

Chapter 49

100 Most Common English Verbs

Verbs are the engine of every sentence. If you know these **100 verbs** well, you can talk about almost anything in daily life: home, work, study, shopping and travel. Learn all three forms of each verb:

- **Base form (V1):** for the present and the future. *I **go** to the office every day.*
- **Past (V2):** for finished actions. *I **went** to Sylhet last week.*
- **Past participle (V3):** after *have/has/had* and in the passive. *I have **gone** there twice. The letter was **sent**.*

এই ১০০টি ক্রিয়া ভালো করে শিখলে দৈনন্দিন প্রায় সব কথা বলতে পারবেন। প্রতিটি ক্রিয়ার তিনটি রূপই মুখস্থ করুন।

1 How to use this list

- Verbs in **bold** are **irregular**: their V2 and V3 do not end in *-ed*. You must learn them by heart. Chapter 50 groups them by pattern to make this easier.
- All other verbs are **regular**: just add *-ed* for V2 and V3 (*work* → *worked* → *worked*).
- Learn **10 verbs a day**. Say all three forms aloud, then make one sentence about your own life with each.
- The past tenses are in Chapter 4 and the present perfect is in Chapter 6.

2 The 100 verbs

No.	Base form (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla meaning
1	be	was / were	been	হওয়া, থাকা
2	have	had	had	থাকা, আছে, খাওয়া
3	do	did	done	করা
4	say	said	said	বলা
5	go	went	gone	যাওয়া
6	get	got	got / gotten	পাওয়া, হয়ে যাওয়া
7	make	made	made	বানানো, তৈরি করা
8	know	knew	known	জানা, চেনা
9	think	thought	thought	ভাবা, মনে করা
10	take	took	taken	নেওয়া
11	see	saw	seen	দেখা
12	come	came	come	আসা
13	want	wanted	wanted	চাওয়া

continued on next page

No.	Base form (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla meaning
14	look	looked	looked	তাকানো, দেখতে লাগা
15	use	used	used	ব্যবহার করা
16	find	found	found	খুঁজে পাওয়া
17	give	gave	given	দেওয়া
18	tell	told	told	বলা, জানানো
19	work	worked	worked	কাজ করা
20	call	called	called	ডাকা, ফোন করা
21	try	tried	tried	চেষ্টা করা
22	ask	asked	asked	জিজ্ঞেস করা, চাওয়া
23	need	needed	needed	দরকার হওয়া
24	feel	felt	felt	অনুভব করা
25	become	became	become	হয়ে ওঠা
26	leave	left	left	ছেড়ে যাওয়া, রওনা দেওয়া
27	put	put	put	রাখা
28	mean	meant	meant	বোঝানো, অর্থ হওয়া
29	keep	kept	kept	রাখা, ধরে রাখা
30	let	let	let	করতে দেওয়া
31	begin	began	begun	শুরু করা
32	seem	seemed	seemed	মনে হওয়া
33	help	helped	helped	সাহায্য করা
34	talk	talked	talked	কথা বলা
35	turn	turned	turned	ঘোরা, ঘোরানো
36	start	started	started	শুরু করা
37	show	showed	shown	দেখানো
38	hear	heard	heard	শোনা
39	play	played	played	খেলা, বাজানো
40	run	ran	run	দৌড়ানো, চালানো
41	move	moved	moved	সরানো, নড়া
42	like	liked	liked	পছন্দ করা
43	live	lived	lived	বাস করা, থাকা
44	believe	believed	believed	বিশ্বাস করা
45	hold	held	held	ধরা, ধরে রাখা
46	bring	brought	brought	নিয়ে আসা
47	happen	happened	happened	ঘটা
48	write	wrote	written	লেখা
49	sit	sat	sat	বসা
50	stand	stood	stood	দাঁড়ানো
51	lose	lost	lost	হারানো
52	pay	paid	paid	টাকা দেওয়া, পরিশোধ করা
53	meet	met	met	দেখা করা
54	continue	continued	continued	চালিয়ে যাওয়া
55	learn	learned	learned	শেখা

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No.	Base form (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla meaning
56	change	changed	changed	বদলানো
57	understand	understood	understood	বোঝা
58	watch	watched	watched	মনোযোগ দিয়ে দেখা
59	follow	followed	followed	অনুসরণ করা
60	stop	stopped	stopped	থামা, থামানো
61	speak	spoke	spoken	কথা বলা
62	read	read	read	পড়া
63	allow	allowed	allowed	অনুমতি দেওয়া
64	spend	spent	spent	খরচ করা, সময় কাটানো
65	open	opened	opened	খোলা
66	walk	walked	walked	হাঁটা
67	win	won	won	জেতা
68	offer	offered	offered	প্রস্তাব দেওয়া
69	remember	remembered	remembered	মনে রাখা, মনে পড়া
70	love	loved	loved	ভালোবাসা
71	buy	bought	bought	কেনা
72	wait	waited	waited	অপেক্ষা করা
73	send	sent	sent	পাঠানো
74	expect	expected	expected	আশা করা
75	build	built	built	নির্মাণ করা, গড়ে তোলা
76	stay	stayed	stayed	থাকা
77	fall	fell	fallen	পড়ে যাওয়া
78	cut	cut	cut	কাটা
79	reach	reached	reached	পৌঁছানো
80	eat	ate	eaten	খাওয়া
81	drink	drank	drunk	পান করা
82	sleep	slept	slept	ঘুমানো
83	cook	cooked	cooked	রান্না করা
84	study	studied	studied	পড়াশোনা করা
85	clean	cleaned	cleaned	পরিষ্কার করা
86	drive	drove	driven	গাড়ি চালানো
87	suggest	suggested	suggested	পরামর্শ দেওয়া
88	pass	passed	passed	পার হওয়া, পাস করা
89	sell	sold	sold	বিক্রি করা
90	decide	decided	decided	সিদ্ধান্ত নেওয়া
91	pull	pulled	pulled	টানা
92	add	added	added	যোগ করা
93	grow	grew	grown	বেড়ে ওঠা, চাষ করা
94	forget	forgot	forgotten	ভুলে যাওয়া
95	carry	carried	carried	বহন করা
96	wash	washed	washed	ধোয়া
97	close	closed	closed	বন্ধ করা

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No.	Base form (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla meaning
98	teach	taught	taught	শেখানো, পড়ানো
99	wear	wore	worn	পরা
100	finish	finished	finished	শেষ করা

Teacher's tip: *Learn* also has the past form *learnt* in British English. Both *learned* and *learnt* are correct. *Read* keeps the same spelling in all three forms, but V2 and V3 sound like "red".

3 Spelling: how to add -ed

Verb ends in...	What to do	Examples
most letters	add -ed	work → worked, call → called
-e	add only -d	live → lived, like → liked
consonant + y	change y to i , add -ed	study → studied, try → tried
vowel + y	just add -ed	play → played, stay → stayed
one vowel + one consonant (short word, stress at the end)	double the last letter, add -ed	stop → stopped, plan → planned

4 Pronunciation: three sounds of -ed

The ending *-ed* is not always said the same way. Listen to the **last sound** of the base verb.

Sound	When	Examples
/t/	after the sounds p, k, s, sh, ch, f	helped, worked, passed, washed, watched
/d/	after vowel sounds and b, g, l, m, n, r, v, z	played, called, lived, opened, cleaned
/id/	only after t or d (an extra syllable)	wanted, started, needed, decided, added

Teacher's tip: The extra syllable */id/* comes **only** after t and d. So *worked* is one syllable ("workt"), not "work-ed". *Wanted* has two syllables: "want-id". Say the words aloud slowly until it feels natural.

শুধু t বা d দিয়ে শেষ হলে -ed এর উচ্চারণ "ইড" হয়। অন্য সব ক্ষেত্রে বাড়তি শব্দাংশ যোগ হয় না।

Chapter 50

Common Irregular Verbs

Irregular verbs do not follow the *-ed* rule, so we must learn them by heart. The good news: most of them follow a few **patterns**. In this chapter, about 90 common irregular verbs are put into **four groups**. Learn one group at a time, and the list will feel much shorter.

অনিয়মিত ক্রিয়ার রূপ মুখস্থ করতে হয়। তবে এগুলোকে চারটি দলে ভাগ করলে শেখা অনেক সহজ হয়।

Group	Pattern	Example
1	All three forms are the same	cut – cut – cut
2	V2 and V3 are the same	buy – bought – bought
3	All three forms are different	go – went – gone
4	V1 and V3 are the same	come – came – come

Teacher's tip: Say each verb as a little chant: “*buy, bought, bought*”. Three words together, like a song. Your ear will remember the rhythm. For how to use V2 and V3 in sentences, see Chapter 4 (past tenses) and Chapter 6 (present perfect).

1 Group 1: all three forms are the same

These are the easiest. Nothing changes!

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
cut	cut	cut	কাটা
put	put	put	রাখা
let	let	let	করতে দেওয়া
set	set	set	স্থাপন করা, ঠিক করা
hit	hit	hit	আঘাত করা
hurt	hurt	hurt	ব্যথা দেওয়া
cost	cost	cost	দাম হওয়া
shut	shut	shut	বন্ধ করা
read	read	read	পড়া
spread	spread	spread	ছড়ানো
quit	quit	quit	ছেড়ে দেওয়া
bet	bet	bet	বাজি ধরা
burst	burst	burst	ফেটে যাওয়া
fit	fit	fit	মাপমতো হওয়া

Memory tip: Most of these are **short words ending in -t or -d** (cut, put, hit, cost, spread). Since the verb doesn't change, the **time word** shows the tense: *I **cut** my hair **every month**.* / *I **cut** my hair **yesterday**.* Watch out for read: V2 and V3 sound like "red".
 এই ক্রিয়াগুলো বদলায় না, তাই সময়সূচক শব্দ (yesterday, every day) দেখে কাল বুঝতে হয়।

2 Group 2: V2 and V3 are the same

This is the biggest group. Learn the past form once, and you get V3 free. The verbs are sorted into small families that sound alike.

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
<i>The "-ought / -aught" family</i>			
buy	bought	bought	কেনা
bring	brought	brought	নিয়ে আসা
think	thought	thought	ভাবা
fight	fought	fought	লড়াই করা
teach	taught	taught	শেখানো
catch	caught	caught	ধরা
<i>The "-ept" family (long ee sound becomes short e)</i>			
keep	kept	kept	রাখা
sleep	slept	slept	ঘুমানো
sweep	swept	swept	ঝাড়ু দেওয়া
feel	felt	felt	অনুভব করা
leave	left	left	ছেড়ে যাওয়া
mean	meant	meant	বোঝানো
meet	met	met	দেখা করা
feed	fed	fed	খাওয়ানো
lead	led	led	নেতৃত্ব দেওয়া
<i>The "-d becomes -t" family</i>			
send	sent	sent	পাঠানো
spend	spent	spent	খরচ করা, সময় কাটানো
lend	lent	lent	ধার দেওয়া
build	built	built	নির্মাণ করা
<i>The "-old / -old" and "-aid" family</i>			
sell	sold	sold	বিক্রি করা
tell	told	told	বলা, জানানো
hold	held	held	ধরা
pay	paid	paid	টাকা দেওয়া
say	said	said	বলা
<i>The "-ood" and "-ound" family</i>			
stand	stood	stood	দাঁড়ানো
understand	understood	understood	বোঝা

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
find	found	found	খুঁজে পাওয়া
<i>The "-ung / -uck / -ug" family</i>			
hang	hung	hung	ঝোলানো
stick	stuck	stuck	আটকানো, আটকে যাওয়া
dig	dug	dug	খোঁড়া
<i>Other useful ones</i>			
make	made	made	বানানো
have	had	had	থাকা, খাওয়া
hear	heard	heard	শোনা
sit	sat	sat	বসা
win	won	won	জেতা
lose	lost	lost	হারানো
get	got	got (US: gotten)	পাওয়া
shoot	shot	shot	গুলি করা, ছবি তোলা
light	lit	lit	জ্বালানো

Memory tip: Learn the **families**, not single words. If you know *buy - bought*, then *bring - brought* and *think - thought* are easy. Remember the spelling trick: only *teach* and *catch* take **-aught**; all the others here take **-ought**.

একই রকম শোনায় এমন ক্রিয়াগুলো একসাথে মুখস্থ করুন। একটা মনে থাকলে বাকিগুলোও মনে থাকবে।

3 Group 3: all three forms are different

These need the most practice. Look for the patterns: many V3 forms end in **-n** or **-en**.

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
<i>The most important five: learn these first</i>			
be	was / were	been	হওয়া, থাকা
do	did	done	করা
go	went	gone	যাওয়া
see	saw	seen	দেখা
take	took	taken	নেওয়া
<i>V3 ends in -en</i>			
give	gave	given	দেওয়া
eat	ate	eaten	খাওয়া
write	wrote	written	লেখা
drive	drove	driven	গাড়ি চালানো
ride	rode	ridden	চড়া (সাইকেল, রিকশা)

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
hide	hid	hidden	লুকানো
bite	bit	bitten	কামড়ানো
forget	forgot	forgotten	ভুলে যাওয়া
fall	fell	fallen	পড়ে যাওয়া
shake	shook	shaken	ঝাঁকানো
rise	rose	risen	ওঠা, বাড়া
<i>V2 ends in -o-, V3 ends in -en</i>			
speak	spoke	spoken	কথা বলা
break	broke	broken	ভাঙা
choose	chose	chosen	বেছে নেওয়া
steal	stole	stolen	চুরি করা
wake	woke	woken	ঘুম থেকে ওঠা
freeze	froze	frozen	জমে যাওয়া
<i>V2 ends in -ew, V3 ends in -wn</i>			
know	knew	known	জানা
grow	grew	grown	বেড়ে ওঠা
throw	threw	thrown	ছুড়ে মারা
draw	drew	drawn	আঁকা
fly	flew	flown	ওড়া, বিমানে যাওয়া
show	showed	shown	দেখানো
<i>The i - a - u family</i>			
begin	began	begun	শুরু করা
drink	drank	drunk	পান করা
sing	sang	sung	গান গাওয়া
swim	swam	swum	সাঁতার কাটা
ring	rang	rung	বাজা, ফোন করা
<i>The "-ore / -orn" family</i>			
wear	wore	worn	পরা
tear	tore	torn	ছেঁড়া

Memory tip: Two quick rules help a lot. (1) **V3 often ends in -n:** given, eaten, spoken, known, worn. (2) **i - a - u:** begin, began, begun; drink, drank, drunk. Make a sentence with V3 to test yourself: *I have eaten. I have spoken. I have drunk.* Never say "I have went": it is always *I have gone.*

V3 অনেক সময় -n দিয়ে শেষ হয়। have/has এর পরে সবসময় V3 বসবে, V2 নয়।

4 Group 4: V1 and V3 are the same

A very small group: only the past (V2) is different.

Base (V1)	Past (V2)	Past participle (V3)	Bangla
come	came	come	আসা
become	became	become	হয়ে ওঠা
overcome	overcame	overcome	কাটিয়ে ওঠা
run	ran	run	দৌড়ানো, চালানো

Memory tip: Think of it as a **sandwich**: the same word on both sides, and only the middle (V2) changes to **-a-**: **come** - **came** - **come**, **run** - **ran** - **run**. *Rahim **came** late yesterday. / Rahim has **come** late again!*

এখানে শুধু মাঝের রূপ (V2) বদলায়; প্রথম ও তৃতীয় রূপ একই।

5 A simple study plan

- **Day 1:** Group 1 and Group 4 (easy wins).
- **Days 2-3:** Group 2, two or three families a day.
- **Days 4-5:** Group 3, starting with the “most important five”.
- **Every day:** cover the V2 and V3 columns with a paper, say them aloud, then check. Mark the ones you miss and repeat them tomorrow.

প্রতিদিন V2 ও V3 কলাম ঢেকে নিজেকে পরীক্ষা করুন। যেগুলো ভুল হয়, পরদিন আবার অনুশীলন করুন।

Chapter 51

Useful Phrase Bank

Good speakers and writers don't build every sentence from zero: they use **ready-made phrases**. This chapter collects the most useful ones in one place: for giving opinions, linking ideas, writing emails and answering interview questions. Each phrase has a real example and a Bangla translation.

ভালো বক্তা ও লেখকেরা তৈরি বাক্যাংশ ব্যবহার করেন। এই অধ্যায়ে সবচেয়ে দরকারি বাক্যাংশগুলো এক জায়গায় দেওয়া হলো।

- **Don't try to learn everything at once.** Pick **2-3 phrases** from each table and use them this week.
- **Speaking vs writing:** short phrases like *I think*, *so* and *also* work everywhere. Longer ones like *Moreover* and *In conclusion* are better for writing and formal speaking.
- **Punctuation:** phrases shown with a comma (*However,...*) usually start a sentence and are followed by a comma (Ch 30).

1 Giving opinions

Use these to share what you think in speaking, essays and interviews (Ch 26, 31, 47).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
I think (that)...	I think online classes are useful for working people.	আমার মনে হয়, কর্মজীবী মানুষের জন্য অনলাইন ক্লাস উপকারী।
In my opinion,...	In my opinion, Dhaka needs more footpaths.	আমার মতে, ঢাকায় আরও ফুটপাথ দরকার।
I believe (that)...	I believe hard work always pays off.	আমি বিশ্বাস করি, পরিশ্রম সবসময় সুফল দেয়।
As far as I'm concerned,...	As far as I'm concerned, the price is too high.	আমার দিক থেকে বলতে গেলে, দামটা অনেক বেশি।
From my point of view,...	From my point of view, teamwork is more important than talent.	আমার দৃষ্টিতে, প্রতিভার চেয়ে দলগত কাজ বেশি গুরুত্বপূর্ণ।
It seems to me (that)...	It seems to me that prices are going up every month.	আমার কাছে মনে হচ্ছে, প্রতি মাসে দাম বাড়ছে।
Personally, I feel...	Personally, I feel that school uniforms are a good idea.	ব্যক্তিগতভাবে আমার মনে হয়, স্কুল ইউনিফর্ম ভালো একটা ব্যবস্থা।
I'm not sure, but I think...	I'm not sure, but I think the meeting is at three.	নিশ্চিত না, তবে মনে হয় মিটিংটা তিনটায়।

Teacher's tip: Don't start every sentence with *I think*. Mix it up: *In my opinion...*, *I believe...*, *Personally...*. In an essay, one or two opinion phrases are enough. প্রতিটি বাক্য *I think* দিয়ে শুরু করবেন না। ভিন্ন ভিন্ন বাক্যাংশ ব্যবহার করুন।

2 Giving examples

Use these to support your ideas with real examples.

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
For example,...	Many people work from home now. For example, my brother works online.	এখন অনেকে বাসা থেকে কাজ করে। যেমন, আমার ভাই অনলাইনে কাজ করে।
For instance,...	Some foods are very healthy. For instance, fish is full of protein.	কিছু খাবার খুব স্বাস্থ্যকর। যেমন, মাছে প্রচুর প্রোটিন আছে।
such as...	I like fruits such as mangoes and lychees.	আমি আম আর লিচুর মতো ফল পছন্দ করি।
like...	Big cities like Dhaka and Chattogram are very crowded.	ঢাকা আর চট্টগ্রামের মতো বড় শহরগুলো খুব ভিড়।
A good example of this is...	A good example of this is bKash, which changed how we pay.	এর একটি ভালো উদাহরণ হলো বিকাশ, যা আমাদের টাকা দেওয়ার পদ্ধতি বদলে দিয়েছে।
To give you an example,...	To give you an example, I once solved a customer complaint in one day.	একটা উদাহরণ দিই, আমি একবার এক দিনেই একজন গ্রাহকের অভিযোগের সমাধান করেছিলাম।
In my case,...	In my case, cycling to work saves a lot of time.	আমার ক্ষেত্রে, সাইকেলে অফিসে গেলে অনেক সময় বাঁচে।

3 Cause and effect

Use these to explain why something happens and what happens next (Ch 14).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
because...	I was late because the bus broke down.	বাস নষ্ট হয়ে যাওয়ায় আমার দেরি হয়েছিল।
because of...	The flight was cancelled because of bad weather.	খারাপ আবহাওয়ার কারণে ফ্লাইট বাতিল হয়েছিল।
due to...	The office is closed due to the holiday.	ছুটির কারণে অফিস বন্ধ।
so...	It was raining, so we took a CNG.	বৃষ্টি হচ্ছিল, তাই আমরা সিএনজি নিলাম।
As a result,...	He practised every day. As a result, his English improved quickly.	সে প্রতিদিন অনুশীলন করত। ফলে তার ইংরেজি দ্রুত উন্নত হয়েছিল।
Therefore,...	The road is closed. Therefore, we must take another route.	রাস্তা বন্ধ। তাই আমাদের অন্য পথে যেতে হবে।
This leads to...	Too much screen time leads to poor sleep.	বেশি সময় স্ক্রিনে থাকলে ঘুম খারাপ হয়।
The main reason is that...	The main reason is that people do not have enough time.	মূল কারণ হলো, মানুষের হাতে যথেষ্ট সময় নেই।

Teacher's tip: *Because* is followed by a full sentence (subject + verb): *because the bus broke down*. *Because of* and *due to* are followed by a noun: *because of the rain*.
because এর পরে পূর্ণ বাক্য বসে, কিন্তু because of এর পরে শুধু বিশেষ্য বসে।

4 Comparison and contrast

Use these to show how things are similar or different.

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
Similarly,...	Dhaka is very busy. Similarly, Chattogram has heavy traffic.	ঢাকা খুব ব্যস্ত। একইভাবে চট্টগ্রামেও প্রচুর যানজট।
Likewise,...	Nusrat works hard. Likewise, her sister never misses a class.	নুসরাত খুব পরিশ্রমী। একইভাবে তার বোনও কখনো ক্লাস মিস করে না।
both...and...	Both trains and buses go to Sylhet.	ট্রেন আর বাস দুটোই সিলেটে যায়।
However,...	The flat is big. However, it is far from my office.	ফ্ল্যাটটা বড়। তবে এটা আমার অফিস থেকে অনেক দূরে।
On the other hand,...	City life is exciting. On the other hand, it is very expensive.	শহরের জীবন রোমাঞ্চকর। অন্যদিকে, এটা খুব ব্যয়বহুল।
while / whereas...	Rahim loves tea, while his wife prefers coffee.	রহিম চা ভালোবাসে, অথচ তার স্ত্রী কফি পছন্দ করেন।
Although...	Although it was late, the shop was still open.	যদিও দেরি হয়ে গিয়েছিল, দোকানটা তখনও খোলা ছিল।
compared to...	Compared to last year, prices are much higher.	গত বছরের তুলনায় দাম অনেক বেশি।

5 Adding information

Use these to add one more point.

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
also	I speak Bangla and English. I also know some Hindi.	আমি বাংলা ও ইংরেজি বলি। আমি কিছুটা হিন্দিও জানি।
In addition,...	The job pays well. In addition, the office is near my home.	চাকরিটার বেতন ভালো। তাছাড়া অফিসটা আমার বাসার কাছে।
Moreover,...	Walking is free. Moreover, it keeps you healthy.	হাঁটতে টাকা লাগে না। তাছাড়া এটা আপনাকে সুস্থ রাখে।
Furthermore,...	The plan is cheap. Furthermore, it is easy to follow.	পরিকল্পনাটা সস্তা। এছাড়াও এটা মনে চলা সহজ।
as well as...	She manages the team as well as the budget.	তিনি দলের পাশাপাশি বাজেটও সামলান।
not only...but also...	He is not only smart but also very kind.	সে শুধু বুদ্ধিমানই নয়, খুব দয়ালুও।
What's more,...	The food was tasty. What's more, it was cheap!	খাবারটা মজার ছিল। তার উপর দামও কম ছিল!

6 Sequencing

Use these to put steps or events in order (stories, instructions, processes).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
First / First of all,...	First of all, fill in the form.	প্রথমে ফর্মটা পূরণ করুন।

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
Then / Next,...	Next, submit it at the front desk.	এরপর সামনের ডেস্কে জমা দিন।
After that,...	After that, wait for your token number.	তারপর আপনার টোকেন নম্বরের জন্য অপেক্ষা করুন।
Meanwhile,...	I cooked the rice. Meanwhile, Tania made the salad.	আমি ভাত রান্না করলাম। এর মধ্যে তানিয়া সালাদ বানাল।
Before that,...	I joined this company in 2022. Before that, I was a student.	আমি ২০২২ সালে এই কোম্পানিতে যোগ দিই। তার আগে আমি ছাত্র ছিলাম।
Finally,...	Finally, collect your receipt.	সবশেষে রসিদটা সংগ্রহ করুন।
In the end,...	We got lost, but in the end we reached Cox's Bazar.	আমরা পথ হারিয়েছিলাম, কিন্তু শেষ পর্যন্ত কক্সবাজারে পৌঁছে গেলাম।

7 Agreeing and disagreeing

Use these in discussions and meetings. Disagree politely (Ch 26).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
I agree with you.	I agree with you. The plan is good.	আমি আপনার সাথে একমত। পরিকল্পনাটা ভালো।
That's true. / Exactly.	That's true. Traffic is getting worse.	ঠিক বলেছেন। যানজট আরও খারাপ হচ্ছে।
You have a point.	You have a point. We do need more time.	আপনার কথায় যুক্তি আছে। আমাদের আসলেই আরও সময় দরকার।
I partly agree, but...	I partly agree, but the cost is still a problem.	আমি কিছুটা একমত, কিন্তু খরচটা এখনও একটা সমস্যা।
I see what you mean, but...	I see what you mean, but I think we should wait.	আপনার কথা বুঝতে পারছি, কিন্তু আমার মনে হয় আমাদের অপেক্ষা করা উচিত।
I'm afraid I don't agree.	I'm afraid I don't agree. The deadline is too short.	দুঃখিত, আমি একমত নই। সময়সীমাটা খুব কম।
I'm not so sure about that.	I'm not so sure about that. Let's check the numbers.	এ ব্যাপারে আমি অতটা নিশ্চিত নই। চলুন হিসাবটা দেখি।

8 Concluding and summarising

Use these at the end of an essay, report, presentation or meeting.

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
In conclusion,...	In conclusion, reading every day improves your English.	উপসংহারে বলা যায়, প্রতিদিন পড়লে ইংরেজির উন্নতি হয়।
To sum up,...	To sum up, the project was a success.	সংক্ষেপে বললে, প্রকল্পটি সফল হয়েছিল।
Overall,...	Overall, the customers were happy with our service.	সব মিলিয়ে, গ্রাহকেরা আমাদের সেবায় খুশি ছিলেন।
In short,...	In short, we need more staff.	সংক্ষেপে, আমাদের আরও কর্মী দরকার।
All in all,...	All in all, it was a great trip.	সব মিলিয়ে, ভ্রমণটা দারুণ ছিল।

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
For these reasons,...	For these reasons, I support the new rule.	এসব কারণে আমি নতুন নিয়মটি সমর্থন করি।

9 Formal email phrases

Use these in office emails, applications and writing tests (Ch 33, 46).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
Dear Mr./Ms. [Name],	Dear Mr. Chowdhury,	প্রিয় জনাব চৌধুরী,
I am writing to...	I am writing to apply for the post of Sales Officer.	আমি সেলস অফিসার পদে আবেদন করার জন্য লিখছি।
I would like to...	I would like to request two days' leave.	আমি দুই দিনের ছুটির অনুরোধ করতে চাই।
Thank you for your email.	Thank you for your email about the meeting.	মিটিং সম্পর্কে আপনার ইমেইলের জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
Please find attached...	Please find attached my CV.	অনুগ্রহ করে সংযুক্ত আমার সিভিটি দেখুন।
Could you please...?	Could you please send me the report by Monday?	আপনি কি অনুগ্রহ করে সোমবারের মধ্যে রিপোর্টটি পাঠাতে পারবেন?
I apologise for...	I apologise for the late reply.	দেরিতে উত্তর দেওয়ার জন্য আমি দুঃখিত।
Please let me know if...	Please let me know if you need any more information.	আর কোনো তথ্য লাগলে অনুগ্রহ করে আমাকে জানাবেন।
I look forward to...	I look forward to hearing from you.	আপনার উত্তরের অপেক্ষায় রইলাম।
Best regards, / Yours sincerely,	Best regards, Farhana Akter	শুভেচ্ছান্তে, ফারহানা আক্তার

Teacher's tip: Don't mix formal and informal styles in one email. Avoid *Hi dude, plz, thx* and emojis in office emails. If you start with *Dear Sir/Madam*, end with *Yours faithfully*; if you use the person's name, end with *Yours sincerely* or *Best regards*.

অফিসের ইমেইলে plz, thx বা ইমোজি ব্যবহার করবেন না। শুরু ও শেষ একই আনুষ্ঠানিক ধরনে রাখুন।

10 Interview phrases

Use these to sound confident and polite in job interviews (Ch 37-42).

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
Thank you for having me.	Thank you for having me today.	আজ আমাকে ডাকার জন্য ধন্যবাদ।
I have...years of experience in...	I have three years of experience in customer service.	গ্রাহকসেবায় আমার তিন বছরের অভিজ্ঞতা আছে।
My main strength is...	My main strength is solving problems quickly.	আমার প্রধান শক্তি হলো দ্রুত সমস্যার সমাধান করা।

Phrase	Example sentence	Bangla
I'm good at...	I'm good at working with a team.	আমি দলের সাথে কাজ করতে ভালো পারি।
I'm interested in this role because...	I'm interested in this role because I enjoy working with numbers.	আমি এই পদে আগ্রহী কারণ আমি সংখ্যা নিয়ে কাজ করতে উপভোগ করি।
In my previous job, I...	In my previous job, I managed a team of five.	আমার আগের চাকরিতে আমি পাঁচজনের একটি দল পরিচালনা করতাম।
That's a good question. Let me think.	That's a good question. Let me think for a moment.	ভালো প্রশ্ন। একটু ভেবে বলি।
Sorry, could you repeat the question?	Sorry, could you repeat the question, please?	দুঃখিত, প্রশ্নটা কি আরেকবার বলবেন?
Could you tell me more about...?	Could you tell me more about the training programme?	প্রশিক্ষণ কার্যক্রম সম্পর্কে আরেকটু বলবেন কি?
I look forward to hearing from you.	Thank you for your time. I look forward to hearing from you.	সময় দেওয়ার জন্য ধন্যবাদ। আপনার কাছ থেকে শোনার অপেক্ষায় থাকব।

Teacher's tip: Make your own **phrase card**. Write 10 favourite phrases from this chapter on a small card or in your phone notes. Before a meeting, an interview or a writing test, read them once. They will come out naturally when you need them.

পছন্দের ১০টি বাক্যাংশ একটি কার্ডে বা ফোনে লিখে রাখুন। ইন্টারভিউ বা পরীক্ষার আগে একবার পড়ে নিন।

Chapter 52

Answer Key

Here are the answers to all the exercises in Chapters 1–47. For “make a sentence” and writing questions, a **sample answer** is given – your answer can be different and still be correct. If you are not sure, check that your sentence follows the rule in the chapter.

Teacher’s tip: Don’t look at the answers until you have finished all 10 questions. Mark your work honestly, and write every mistake in your mistake notebook.

Part 1: Essential Grammar

Chapter 1: Parts of Speech

- 1.1 verb
- 1.2 adjective
- 1.3 adverb
- 1.4 preposition
- 1.5 pronoun
- 1.6 conjunction
- 1.7 My brother **is** very tall.
- 1.8 She cooks very **well**.
- 1.9 I have two **new** phones.
- 1.10 Sample answer: My mother **always** cooks **delicious** food. (Any correct sentence with an adjective and an adverb is fine.)

Chapter 2: Basic Sentence Structure

- 2.1 **Do** you like spicy food?
- 2.2 Karim **does** not live in Dhaka.
- 2.3 **Are** they at the hospital now?
- 2.4 **Did** you go to Cox’s Bazar last year?
- 2.5 I **drink tea** every morning.
- 2.6 She **doesn’t speak** English.
- 2.7 Did he **go** to the bank?
- 2.8 **Are you** tired?
- 2.9 Tania **doesn’t work** in a bank.
- 2.10 **Did** they **watch** the match?

Chapter 3: Present Simple and Present Continuous

- 3.1 My father **reads** the newspaper every morning.
- 3.2 Be quiet! The baby **is sleeping**.
- 3.3 Sadia **doesn't eat** meat.
- 3.4 Look! It **is raining** again.
- 3.5 I **know** his phone number.
- 3.6 He **works** in a bank.
- 3.7 I **like** this song.
- 3.8 They **are watching** TV now.
- 3.9 Sample answer: I **visit** my grandparents every weekend.
- 3.10 Sample answer: I **am learning** to drive these days.

Chapter 4: Past Simple and Past Continuous

- 4.1 I **bought** a new phone last week.
- 4.2 We **didn't see** Karim at the party.
- 4.3 At 6 pm, Nusrat **was studying** in her room.
- 4.4 I was walking home when it **started** to rain.
- 4.5 **Did** you **call** your mother yesterday?
- 4.6 Did she **buy** a ticket?
- 4.7 The children **were** playing outside.
- 4.8 While I **was watching** TV, my friend **called** me.
- 4.9 I **was taking** a shower **when** someone **knocked** on the door.
- 4.10 Sample answer: Last weekend I **visited** my aunt in Chattogram.

Chapter 5: Future Forms

- 5.1 "I'm thirsty." "Wait, I'll **get** you some water."
- 5.2 Look at that man! He's **going to fall** off the ladder!
- 5.3 I'm **meeting** Dr. Rahman at 4 pm tomorrow. It's booked.
- 5.4 I promise I **won't tell** anyone.
- 5.5 Tania has decided. She's **going to learn** to drive this year.
- 5.6 He will **come** to the party.
- 5.7 We **are** going to visit our grandparents.
- 5.8 I will **send** the email tomorrow.
- 5.9 Sample answer: I think Dhaka **will have** more metro rail lines in 2035.
- 5.10 Sample answer: I'm **going to visit** Sylhet with my friends on my next holiday.

Chapter 6: Present Perfect

- 6.1 Tania **has finished** her report.
- 6.2 **Have** you ever **eaten** hilsa curry?
- 6.3 We **haven't seen** the new film yet.
- 6.4 since
- 6.5 for
- 6.6 visited (*last month* is a finished time)
- 6.7 has broken (news, no time given)
- 6.8 He has **written** three emails today.
- 6.9 I **have known** Hasan since 2010.
- 6.10 Sample answer: I have **never** flown in a plane. (Any correct sentence with *have/has never* + V3 is fine.)

Chapter 7: Articles

- 7.1 an umbrella
- 7.2 a uniform ("you" sound)
- 7.3 an honest man (silent *h*)
- 7.4 I saw **a** cat in the garden. **The** cat was white.
- 7.5 **The** moon looks beautiful tonight.
- 7.6 My father goes to - work at 9. (no article)
- 7.7 Do you speak - French? (no article)
- 7.8 My sister is **a** nurse.
- 7.9 We had lunch at a restaurant in Gulshan. (no article with meals)
- 7.10 Sample answer: I bought **a** new bag yesterday. **The** bag is brown and very strong.

Chapter 8: Nouns

- 8.1 cities
- 8.2 watches
- 8.3 men
- 8.4 How **much** money do you have?
- 8.5 There are only **a few** students in the class today.
- 8.6 Can I have **some** information about the flight?
- 8.7 I'd like a **cup** of tea, please.
- 8.8 My mother gave me **a piece of** good advice. / My mother gave me **some** good advice.
- 8.9 The **furniture** in this room **is** very old.
- 8.10 Sample answer: There is **a lot of** rice in my kitchen, but there are only **a few** eggs.

Chapter 9: Pronouns and Possessives

- 9.1 She
- 9.2 me
- 9.3 your
- 9.4 mine
- 9.5 it
- 9.6 This is Karim's car.
- 9.7 My parents' house is in Dhanmondi.
- 9.8 My friend and I went to the cinema.
- 9.9 My grandmother is 80, and she is still very active.
- 9.10 Sample answer: Nusrat bought a new phone last week, and her phone is great because it has a very good camera.

Chapter 10: Prepositions of Time, Place and Movement

- 10.1 at
- 10.2 on
- 10.3 at; in
- 10.4 on
- 10.5 from; to
- 10.6 out of
- 10.7 for
- 10.8 I will call you tomorrow. (No preposition before *tomorrow*.)
- 10.9 My sister is at home now.
- 10.10 Sample answer: I start work at 9 am, and in the evening I have tea with my family. (Any correct sentence with *at*, *in* and *with* is fine.)

Chapter 11: Adjectives and Adverbs

- 11.1 boring
- 11.2 beautifully
- 11.3 well
- 11.4 bigger
- 11.5 the best
- 11.6 easier
- 11.7 more expensive
- 11.8 My brother is younger than me.
- 11.9 I am not old enough to drive. (*Enough* comes after the adjective.)
- 11.10 Sample answer: My sister is as tall as my mother. / My father is not as old as my uncle. (Any correct sentence is fine.)

Chapter 12: Modal Verbs

- 12.1 should
12.2 Would
12.3 could
12.4 must
12.5 She can **sing** very well.
12.6 We should **leave** now.
12.7 He **must** pay the bill today.
12.8 **Could** you give me a glass of water, **please**? / **May** I have a glass of water, please?
12.9 **I'd like** the bill, please. / **Could** I have the bill, please?
12.10 Sample answer: We **have to** wear our ID cards at the office. / Students **must** switch off their phones in the exam hall. (Any correct sentence is fine.)

Chapter 13: Questions and Negatives

- 13.1 **Does she live** in Khulna?
13.2 **Where did they go**?
13.3 **Who opened the window**? (Subject question: no *did*.)
13.4 Karim **doesn't drink** coffee.
13.5 We **didn't watch** the match last night.
13.6 isn't it
13.7 can't you
13.8 What time **do you** wake up?
13.9 Could you tell me where **the post office is**?
13.10 Sample answers: **How much** is a kilo of potatoes? **How many** eggs do you want? (Any correct questions are fine.)

Chapter 14: Linking Words

- 14.1 but
14.2 or
14.3 so
14.4 because
14.5 Although the food was cheap, it was tasty. (or: The food was cheap, **but** it was tasty.)
14.6 Because it was raining, we stayed inside. (or: It was raining, **so** we stayed inside.)
14.7 The hotel was clean. **However**, the staff were rude.
14.8 I am **also** from Sylhet.
14.9 **Although** he is rich, he lives in a small flat. (or: He lives in a small flat **although** he is rich.)
14.10 Sample answer: I bought a new phone **because** my old one broke. My phone has a big battery, **so** I charge it only once a day.

Chapter 15: The 25 Most Common Grammar Mistakes

- 15.1 many
- 15.2 advice
- 15.3 to
- 15.4 since
- 15.5 Did she **go** to the hospital?
- 15.6 My **cousin** works in a bank. (or: My cousin... **she** works in a bank.)
- 15.7 **Although** he is poor, he is happy. (or: He is poor, **but** he is happy.)
- 15.8 I am **interested** in football.
- 15.9 Why **are you** late?
- 15.10 Sample answer: Nusrat **told me** that she was sick. Nusrat **said** that she was sick.

Part 2: Daily Speaking

Chapter 16: Greetings and Small Talk

- 16.1 too
- 16.2 evening
- 16.3 This
- 16.4 bad
- 16.5 **I'm** Karim. I'm from Bogura. / **My name is** Karim, and I'm from Bogura.
- 16.6 Good **morning**, sir.
- 16.7 **This is** my friend Adiyat. Adiyat, **this is** Rahim.
- 16.8 Formal: Hello. How are you?
- 16.9 Informal: Nice meeting you. See you! / Take care!
- 16.10 Sample answers: How was the traffic this morning? / Where are you from originally? (Any friendly question about weather, travel, work or hometown is fine.)

Chapter 17: Talking About Yourself

- 17.1 as
- 17.2 are
- 17.3 at
- 17.4 for (also correct: at)
- 17.5 I **am** 19 years old.
- 17.6 My sister **works** in a bank.
- 17.7 My father is **a** businessman.
- 17.8 I **work** in a garments factory.
- 17.9 Sample answer: My elder brother works as an engineer. He lives in Chattogram with his wife.

17.10 Sample answer: In my free time, I enjoy watching movies with my friends.

Chapter 18: Daily Routines and Habits

- 18.1** I **never drink** coffee at night.
18.2 My brother **is always** hungry.
18.3 We **often go** to Cox's Bazar in winter.
18.4 Do you **usually take** a rickshaw to college?
18.5 She **sometimes goes** to the gym. (also correct: **Sometimes** she goes to the gym.)
18.6 My father **watches** the news every night.
18.7 I **never** miss my class. (or: I don't **ever** miss my class.)
18.8 Sample answer: How often do you visit your grandparents? → About once a month.
18.9 Sample answer: I rarely eat fast food.
18.10 Sample answer: My mother usually makes tea for everyone at seven o'clock.

Chapter 19: Asking for Help, Permission and Information

- 19.1** **Could you** open the door, please?
19.2 **May I** use your laptop?
19.3 **Would you mind turning** down the music?
19.4 Do you know where the post office **is**?
19.5 Could you tell me when the train **leaves**?
19.6 Would you mind **waiting** a minute?
19.7 **Could** you give me a glass of water, please?
19.8 Can you tell me where **the toilet is**?
19.9 No, not at all. / Of course not. Go ahead.
19.10 Sample answer: Excuse me, could you tell me how to get to Dhanmondi Lake, please?

Chapter 20: Shopping, Restaurants and Bargaining

- 20.1** are
20.2 on
20.3 have
20.4 bill
20.5 How much **is** this bag? / **What's the price of** this bag?
20.6 **Could I have two plates of** kacchi, please?
20.7 This phone cover is too **expensive. Can you give me a better price?**
20.8 Sample answer: These are too small. Do you have them in a bigger size?
20.9 Sample answer: 1,000 is a bit expensive. Can you do it for 700 taka? (or: What's your best price?)
20.10 Sample answer: Excuse me, this is too spicy for my son. Could you make it less spicy, please?

Chapter 21: Directions, Transport and Travel

- 21.1 straight
- 21.2 next to
- 21.3 opposite
- 21.4 get off
- 21.5 under
- 21.6 Go straight and **turn left** at the corner.
- 21.7 I will **get off** the train at Airport station.
- 21.8 **Excuse me**, where is the bus stand? / Excuse me, could you tell me where the bus stand is?
- 21.9 Sample answer: Mama, will you go to Banani for Tk 200? (Any polite sentence with a place and a price is fine.)
- 21.10 Sample answers: What time is check-out? Is breakfast included?

Chapter 22: Phone Calls and Appointments

- 22.1 this is
- 22.2 speak to
- 22.3 take
- 22.4 line
- 22.5 cancel
- 22.6 Hello, **this is** Adiyat from Robi.
- 22.7 **May I ask who's calling?** / May I ask what it's about?
- 22.8 I'd like to **make** an appointment with the dentist.
- 22.9 Sample answer: Hello, I have an appointment on Monday at 5 p.m. Could I change it to Wednesday, please?
- 22.10 Sample answer: Thank you very much for your help. Have a nice day. Goodbye!

Chapter 23: Workplace and Office English

- 23.1 Could
- 23.2 checking
- 23.3 working
- 23.4 by
- 23.5 finished
- 23.6 Would you mind **sending** me the file?
- 23.7 I will finish it **by** tomorrow.
- 23.8 Sir, **could I take** a day off on Thursday?
- 23.9 Sample answer: I see your point, but I think we need more time to test it.
- 23.10 Sample answer: I'm sorry, I'm running a bit behind because the client changed the design. Could I have two more days?

Chapter 24: Health, Doctor and Emergencies

- 24.1** have
- 24.2** hurts
- 24.3** for
- 24.4** since
- 24.5** allergic
- 24.6** My stomach **has been hurting** since morning. / I've had a stomach ache since morning.
- 24.7** I **have a** fever.
- 24.8** I'm **allergic to** prawns.
- 24.9** Sample answers: How many times a day should I take it? Should I take it before or after meals?
- 24.10** Sample answer: There's been a road accident at Farmgate, near the Ananda Cinema Hall. A man on a motorbike is badly hurt and bleeding. Please send an ambulance quickly. My name is Rahim, and my number is 01711-445566.

Chapter 25: Thanking, Apologizing, Inviting, Accepting and Refusing

- 25.1** inviting
- 25.2** welcome
- 25.3** apologize
- 25.4** love
- 25.5** kind
- 25.6** Thank you for **helping** me yesterday.
- 25.7** Sorry **I'm late**, sir. / Sorry for **being** late, sir.
- 25.8** B: **You're welcome.** / My pleasure.
- 25.9** Sample answer: Want to grab some fuchka this evening? / How about fuchka at Dhanmondi Lake this evening?
- 25.10** Sample answer: Thank you so much for the invitation, sir. I'd love to come, but my mother is not well and I need to be with her that evening. I hope everyone has a great time.

Chapter 26: Giving Opinions, Agreeing and Disagreeing

- 26.1** In my opinion, English is very important for jobs.
- 26.2** "I don't like spicy food." - "**Neither** do I."
- 26.3** I see your **point**, but I think we need more time.
- 26.4** I want to work from home **because** the traffic is terrible. (as or *since* is also correct.)
- 26.5** I **agree** with your idea.
- 26.6** In my **opinion**, the price is too high. (or: **I think** the price is too high.)
- 26.7** I **don't think** he is coming today.
- 26.8** Sample answer: I see your point, sir, but I'm afraid we can't finish it tonight. Could we finish it by tomorrow afternoon?

- 26.9** Sample answer: In my opinion, Dhaka is a good city for jobs because most big companies are here. But I don't think it's good for families because of the traffic and pollution.
- 26.10** Sample answer: Personally, I think a laptop is better for students because it is easier to type assignments and make slides on it.

Chapter 27: Filler Phrases

- 27.1** Sorry, could you say that again?
- 27.2** Really? That's great!
- 27.3** That's a good question.
- 27.4** Does that make sense?
- 27.5** **Could you repeat that, please?** (or: Please say that again.)
- 27.6** I **don't understand** your point.
- 27.7** Sorry, can you speak more **slowly**?
- 27.8** Sample answer: It's a person who works in a hospital and treats sick people.
- 27.9** Sample answer: It's something you use to stay dry when it rains.
- 27.10** Sample answer: It's a place where you keep your money and take loans.

Chapter 28: 100 Most Useful Everyday Sentences

- 28.1** How much is this?
- 28.2** Can I try it on?
- 28.3** Congratulations! I'm so happy for you!
- 28.4** Please stop here.
- 28.5** Sorry for the late reply.
- 28.6** **Turn off** the fan, please.
- 28.7** I will **reach the office** at nine. (or: I will **get to** the office at nine.)
- 28.8** **How much is** this bag? (or: What's the price of this bag?)
- 28.9** I've had a fever since yesterday.
- 28.10** It's my treat today.

Part 3: Basic Writing

Chapter 29: From Words to Sentences to Paragraphs

- 29.1** C (complete)
- 29.2** F (fragment: no subject and no verb)
- 29.3** R (run-on). Correct: It is late. I have to go home. / It is late, **so** I have to go home.
- 29.4** My brother **is** very busy these days.
- 29.5** The traffic was terrible, **so** I was late for the meeting. (Or: The traffic was terrible. I was late for the meeting.)

- 29.6** Sample answer: I went home **because** the shop was closed. (Add a main idea to complete the sentence.)
- 29.7** I was hungry, **so** I ate two parathas.
- 29.8** The hotel was small, **but** it was very clean.
- 29.9** (b) Rice is the most important food in my family.
- 29.10** Sample answer: That is why Cox's Bazar is my favourite place in Bangladesh.

Chapter 30: Punctuation and Capital Letters

- 30.1** My cousin lives in **L**ondon.
- 30.2** **W**here is the bank?
- 30.3** Rahim speaks **B**angla, **E**nglish and **H**indi.
- 30.4** **We** have an exam on **M**onday.
- 30.5** Mr. Chowdhury's car
- 30.6** the students' books
- 30.7** I'm not
- 30.8** I am going to **S**ylhet in **D**ecember.
- 30.9** The cat is drinking **its** milk.
- 30.10** My **sisters** are both doctors.

Chapter 31: The PEEL Paragraph

- 31.1** E (Example)
- 31.2** L (Link)
- 31.3** P (Point)
- 31.4** E (Explain)
- 31.5** **In my opinion**, sports are important for children. (Or: **I believe** sports are important for children.)
- 31.6** Sample answer: For example, **my cousin Adiyat plays football every afternoon, and he is the fittest boy in his class.**
- 31.7** Sample answer: I believe that learning English helps people get better jobs.
- 31.8** Sample answer: This is because many companies in Bangladesh use English for emails, reports and meetings.
- 31.9** Sample answer: For example, my friend Nusrat got a job at a bank in Gulshan because she spoke English well in her interview.
- 31.10** Sample answer: Therefore, learning English is one of the best ways to build a good career.

Chapter 32: Descriptive and Opinion Paragraphs

- 32.1** taste
- 32.2** smell
- 32.3** touch

- 32.4** Sample answer: We had a **delicious** dinner at a restaurant in Gulshan.
- 32.5** Sample answer: My teacher is a **kind** (or **patient, helpful**) person.
- 32.6** She is wearing a **beautiful dress**.
- 32.7** **In my opinion**, homework is useful. (Or: **I think** homework is useful.)
- 32.8** Chattogram is **very** hilly.
- 32.9** Sample answer: My father is tall and has short grey hair. He is very hard-working and never complains.
- 32.10** Sample answer: In my opinion, young children should not have smartphones because they spend too much time on games and videos.

Chapter 33: Writing Emails

- 33.1** I (informal)
- 33.2** F (formal)
- 33.3** F (formal)
- 33.4** I (informal)
- 33.5** Please find **attached** my CV.
- 33.6** **I look forward to hearing from you.**
- 33.7** **Could you please** send me the form? (Say exactly what you want.)
- 33.8** Sample answer: Subject: Leave request for 20 June
- 33.9** Sample answer: I am writing to report a problem with my debit card.
- 33.10** **Could you please send me the form? / I would be grateful if you could send me the form.**

Chapter 34: Messages, Applications and Short Letters

- 34.1** since
- 34.2** like
- 34.3** complain
- 34.4** obediently (at an office: Yours sincerely)
- 34.5** I **have had** a fever **for** two days.
- 34.6** Sir, **could I please take leave tomorrow?**
- 34.7** I **would like a refund** for this **faulty** phone, **please**.
- 34.8** Sample answer: Hi Tania, sorry, I'm stuck in traffic. I'll be about 20 minutes late.
- 34.9** Sample answer: Karim, I've gone to the bazaar. I'll be back in an hour. Adiyat
- 34.10** Sample answer: Subject: Complaint about a faulty ceiling fan

Chapter 35: Short Essays

- 35.1** conclusion
- 35.2** body (an example)

- 35.3** introduction (the thesis sentence)
- 35.4** For example, / For instance,
- 35.5** However, / On the other hand,
- 35.6** As a result, / So, / Therefore,
- 35.7** **We should exercise every day because** exercise is good for health. (Join the *because* part to a main clause.)
- 35.8** In conclusion, **I believe it is a good idea because it is cheap.** (Do not add a new idea; repeat your answer.)
- 35.9** Sample answer: In my opinion, children should not have their own mobile phones because phones waste their study time and can harm their eyes.
- 35.10** Sample answer: The first reason is that regular exercise gives us more energy for work and study.

Chapter 36: How to Edit Your Own Writing

- 36.1** My father **works** in a garment factory.
- 36.2** Last week I **bought** a new phone.
- 36.3** She is **an** honest person. (*honest* starts with a vowel sound)
- 36.4** **We** went to **Sylhet** in **June**.
- 36.5** There **are** many shops in New Market.
- 36.6** I **agree** with you.
- 36.7** The weather was **hot**. **We** stayed inside. / The weather was hot, **so** we stayed inside.
- 36.8** spelling
- 36.9** articles
- 36.10** **Dear Sir, I cannot come to the office today because I am sick. I will come tomorrow.**

Part 4: Job Interview English

Chapter 37: Professional Vocabulary and Power Verbs

- 37.1** with
- 37.2** of
- 37.3** for
- 37.4** in
- 37.5** I am **very** punctual.
- 37.6** Last year I **organised** a book fair.
- 37.7** I am responsible **for answering** emails.
- 37.8** I **prepared** the monthly sales report.
- 37.9** I **organised** / **volunteered in** a tree-planting programme. (Also: *I planted 200 trees with my team.*)
- 37.10** Sample answer: **Handled** 30 customer queries a day at a Grameenphone service centre. (Any line with a power verb, a task and a number is fine.)

Chapter 38: Interview Questions (Part 1): About You

- 38.1** as
- 38.2** by
- 38.3** graduated
- 38.4** since
- 38.5** I **graduated** from NSU last year.
- 38.6** I **have been doing** tuition **for** three years.
- 38.7** I'm looking for **more scope to grow / a new challenge**. (Never criticise your last company.)
- 38.8** Sample answer: In my free time, I enjoy playing chess. It teaches me to think ahead and stay patient, which helps me plan my work.
- 38.9** Sample answer: My weakness is that I sometimes say yes to too many tasks. Now I use a to-do list and check my time before I agree to new work.
- 38.10** Sample answer: My biggest achievement was raising Tk 80,000 for flood victims in Kuri-gram with five friends. We helped 120 families with food and medicine.

Chapter 39: Interview Questions (Part 2): The Job and Your Future

- 39.1** as
- 39.2** between
- 39.3** to
- 39.4** is
- 39.5** I can join **immediately**.
- 39.6** I want this job because it **matches my skills and interests**. (Talk about fit, not only money.)
- 39.7** Yes, I have a question. **Could you tell me ...?** (Always ask one or two questions.)
- 39.8** Sample answer: I know that your company is one of the biggest mobile financial service providers in Bangladesh, with millions of users. I was impressed by your work to bring digital payments to rural areas.
- 39.9** Sample answer: Yes, I'm happy to relocate. I'm young and I would like to see how your branches work in different districts.
- 39.10** Sample answer: In the first month, I would learn our products and systems. In the second month, I would start handling my own tasks. By the third month, I hope to reach my targets and give useful ideas to the team.

Chapter 40: Answering Experience Questions with STAR

- 40.1** R
- 40.2** S
- 40.3** A
- 40.4** T
- 40.5** Then I **called** the supplier and he **agreed** to send the fabric.
- 40.6** In the end, the result **was** very good.

- 40.7** My task was **to organise** a seminar.
- 40.8** Sample answer: As a result, late deliveries fell from 15 a week to just 3.
- 40.9** Sample answer: ... As a result, two shops agreed to sponsor us, and we raised Tk 20,000 for the event.
- 40.10** Sample answer: (S) Last December, I was working at a mobile shop in Mirpur during a big sale. (T) Two staff members were sick, so I had to handle sales and the cash counter alone. (A) First, I asked customers to form one queue. Then I served simple purchases first and wrote down the phone numbers of people with bigger questions to call them back. (R) As a result, we made our best daily sales of the month, and no customer left unhappy.

Chapter 41: Handling Difficult Moments

- 41.1** repeat
- 41.2** think
- 41.3** sure
- 41.4** correct
- 41.5** Could you **repeat the question**, please? (Do not use *again* with *repeat*.)
- 41.6** I **don't understand** what you mean.
- 41.7** **Sorry, could you say that again, please?**
- 41.8** Sample answer: Sorry, could you explain what you mean by "onboarding"?
- 41.9** Sample answer: Sorry, I've lost my train of thought. Could you remind me of the question?
- 41.10** Sample answer: That's a fair question. I don't have full-time experience yet, but I did a three-month internship at a bank, and I learn quickly and work hard.

Chapter 42: Questions to Ask and Closing

- 42.1** day
- 42.2** time
- 42.3** steps
- 42.4** pleasure
- 42.5** When **will you** inform me about the result?
- 42.6** **Yes, I'd like to ask** what a typical day looks like. (Or, if you really have none: *No, thank you. You have answered all my questions.*)
- 42.7** I am very interested **in** this **position**.
- 42.8** Avoid
- 42.9** Good
- 42.10** Sample answer: Thank you very much for your time today. I'm really interested in this customer service role, and I believe my communication skills will help your customers. When can I expect to hear from you?

Chapter 43: Pronunciation and Clarity

- 43.1** exPErience

43.2 MANager

43.3 reSPONsible

43.4 presenTAtion

43.5 v sound → **visa** (teeth on the lower lip)

43.6 extra "i" before s → **school**

43.7 z sound → **zero** (buzzing s, not j)

43.8 I **WORKED** at a **BANK** for **TWO YEARS**.

43.9 I **WANT** to **LEARN NEW SKILLS**.

43.10 I am a good team player. (Or: (pause) I am a good team player.)

Chapter 44: Mock Interview Practice

44.1 completed

44.2 month

44.3 responsible

44.4 offer

44.5 I **joined** the call centre in 2023. (Finished time → past simple.)

44.6 I enjoy **solving** technical problems.

44.7 I **have been working** in a software company for one year. (Or: I **have worked** at a software company for one year.)

44.8 Sample answer: I enjoy working with numbers and helping people. Banking gives me both. I also want a stable career where I can keep learning, and banks in Bangladesh offer good training.

44.9 Sample answer: First, I would listen and understand what the customer needs. Then I would explain the extra value, for example the warranty and free service. If the price is still a problem, I would suggest a cheaper model that fits their budget.

44.10 Sample answer: As a result, I submitted the report two days before the deadline, and my manager shared it with all 12 team members as an example.

Part 5: Writing Tests

Chapter 45: Writing Under Time Pressure

45.1 5 minutes planning and 3 minutes checking.

45.2 About 200–250 words.

45.3 Between 135 and 165 words.

45.4 One **straight** line.

45.5 I want to join your company **because** it is famous.

45.6 She **has worked** in an NGO in Sylhet since 2019.

45.7 Banking is a good career. **It** gives a good salary. (Or: Banking is a good career **because** it gives a good salary.)

- 45.8** Sample answer: Plan 5 minutes, write 35 minutes, check 5 minutes. Target: about 300–350 words.
- 45.9** Sample plan: Opening: phones help students, but need control. Point 1: study help, e.g. YouTube lessons, online dictionary. Point 2: waste of time, e.g. Facebook late at night. Ending: use phones for study, set time limits.
- 45.10** Sample answer: I will stop my second point and finish the sentence I am writing. Then I will write a one-line ending such as “I hope you will consider my request.” Finally, I will add “Yours sincerely” and my name.

Chapter 46: Email, Letter, Cover Letter and Application

- 46.1** Yours **faithfully**,
- 46.2** Yours **sincerely**,
- 46.3** A **cover letter** (sent with the CV, often by email).
- 46.4** I **would like to request** leave for two days.
- 46.5** Please **reply** by Sunday. (Or: Please get back to me by Sunday.)
- 46.6** I am writing **to** you to complain about my internet bill.
- 46.7** Sample answer: Please **replace my damaged ATM card** as soon as possible. (Say exactly what you want.)
- 46.8** Sample answer: Subject: Request to change my registered phone number
- 46.9** Sample answer: I wish to apply for the post of Customer Service Officer advertised on bdjobs.com on 2 June 2026.
- 46.10** Sample answer: Dear Mr Chowdhury, I would like to request one day's leave today, 8 October, because I have a high fever and the doctor has advised me to rest. My colleague Nusrat will reply to urgent emails. I hope to return tomorrow. Thank you for your understanding. Yours sincerely, Hasan Ali

Chapter 47: Report, Opinion Paragraph and One-Page Essay

- 47.1** Findings and Recommendations.
- 47.2** One paragraph; about 120–150 words.
- 47.3** 4–5 paragraphs; about 280–350 words.
- 47.4** The staff **are** very happy with the new canteen, and they **eat** there every day.
- 47.5** Online shopping has many **benefits**.
- 47.6** **In my opinion**, uniforms are good. (Use only one opinion phrase.)
- 47.7** Sample answer: The manager **did not check** the cash counters on 3 and 4 June.
- 47.8** Sample answer: In my opinion, university students should do part-time jobs, but only for a few hours a week.
- 47.9** Sample answer: I recommend that the office **should** record arrival times and give a small reward to staff who are never late.
- 47.10** Sample answer: Nowadays, social media has become a part of every young person's life. Facebook, YouTube and TikTok can help young people learn and stay connected, but they also bring serious problems. This essay looks at both sides.

A Closing Note

Dear learner,

You have reached the end of this book – well done! Think about where you started. You now know the grammar that English speakers use every day. You have practised real conversations, written emails and paragraphs, prepared answers for job interviews, and learned how to write under time pressure.

But the end of this book is really a **beginning**. English is not a subject you finish; it is a skill you keep using. Like riding a bicycle or cooking, it gets easier and more natural every time you do it.

Keep going: five small habits

1. **Speak a little every day** – even five minutes, even to yourself in front of a mirror.
2. **Read something short in English every day** – a news headline, a post, a page of a story.
3. **Write one paragraph a week** about your life, your work, or your opinion on something.
4. **Keep your mistake notebook** and look at it once a week.
5. **Come back to this book.** Use the summaries, the 100 sentences, the verb lists and the phrase bank whenever you need them.

Don't be afraid of mistakes, and don't wait until your English is "perfect" to use it. Nobody's English is perfect. People will remember that you were clear, polite and confident – not that you forgot one article.

ভুলের ভয় পাবেন না। নিখুঁত হওয়ার জন্য অপেক্ষা করবেন না --- আজ থেকেই ইংরেজি ব্যবহার শুরু করুন।

I wish you every success – in your studies, in your interviews, in your work, and in every conversation ahead.

With best wishes,

Aifee Aadil